The Sūtra Called the Wise and the Foolish

Toh 341 · Derge Kangyur
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The Sūtra Called the Wise and the Foolish, known in Tibetan as Dzanglun, is Toh 341 in the Kangyur, where it is placed in the General Sūtra section. Unlike most canonical sūtras it has no Sanskrit title line, and its own colophon notes that it appears to have been translated from Chinese; it corresponds to a collection compiled in Central Asia from stories heard by Chinese monks, and the Sanskrit title sometimes proposed for it is only a modern reconstruction. The work is a large anthology of fifty-one chapters of narrative, opening with the Buddha, newly awakened in Magadha, considering whether to pass into nirvāṇa and being moved to teach. Each chapter tells a story set in the Buddha's lifetime and then reveals its roots in past lives, showing through vivid tales of kings, merchants, monks and animals how generosity, faith and restraint ripen into happiness and liberation, while harsh words and ill will bring long suffering. Beloved in Tibet and Mongolia as a source of teaching stories, it illustrates the workings of karma in a way that is accessible to every listener.

The Sūtra Called The Wise and the Foolish. Fascicle One. The Chapter Presenting Various Examples.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One (the Buddha) was dwelling in the land of Magadha, at the place of complete victory. Not long after he had attained complete and perfect awakening, he had this thought: "These sentient beings have long been thoroughly corrupted by wrong views, and they are extremely difficult to teach and to correct. However long I remain in the world, it will bring them no benefit. Therefore I shall pass fully beyond sorrow into the nirvāṇa without remainder."

The very moment he had this thought, the gods of Brahmā's realm knew and understood the Blessed One's intention. They descended from the sky and came to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived there, they bowed their heads at his feet, joined their palms, and requested and urged the Blessed One to turn the wheel of Dharma. To them the Blessed One declared, "Gods of Brahmā's realm, these sentient beings are thoroughly stained by the defilement of wrongdoing. Attached to worldly pleasures, they have no mind endowed with wisdom. However long I remain in the world, the work will be pointless, and so I think that it would be happiness to pass into nirvāṇa."

Then the gods of Brahmā's realm again addressed the Blessed One: "Blessed One, the ocean of Dharma is completely full, the banner of Dharma has been planted, and the time for teaching and training has come. The sentient beings who will be liberated are also very many. Why then does the Blessed One intend to pass into nirvāṇa, and not become the protector and refuge of these who are so deeply blinded? Blessed One, in the past, beyond countless eons gone by, when you sought learning for the sake of sentient beings, you gave up your own body, your wives, your sons, and your daughters even for the sake of as little as a single verse. Why do you now intend to abandon these who have no protector?

"Long ago, in a past age, there arose here in Jambudvīpa a great king called Excellent Color, who held sway over this world. That king possessed eighty-four thousand vassal kings, and within sixty thousand great provinces he possessed eight hundred thousand cities. That king had twenty thousand queens and some ten thousand great ministers. The splendor and might of King Excellent Color were great beyond compare. Endowed with wealth, happiness, good harvests, and a great and teeming population of humans and other beings, he thought: 'I have benefited all beings with jewels and riches, but I have not benefited them with the true Dharma. This will be my failing. I shall seek out wherever the true Dharma is to be found, and liberate them all.' Having thought this, he issued a decree: 'Whoever in this Jambudvīpa possesses the true Dharma and teaches it to me, I will give him whatever he wishes, without going against his mind.' Yet though this was proclaimed, no one appeared who was able to teach it.

"At that time the king's mind was tormented with grief and he became joyless. The Reliever heard of this and, in order to rouse him, transformed his own body into a yakṣa. His color was a deep blue-black, his eyes were red as blood, his fangs jutted upward, his hair bristled on end, and flames blazed from his mouth. He came to the palace gate and said, 'Who wishes to hear the Dharma? Listen to me!'

"When the king heard these words, he was overjoyed. He went out to meet the yakṣa, bowed his head to him, and seated him on a high seat. He assembled his ministers and a great retinue and had them sit around him in a circle so that they might listen to the Dharma. Then the yakṣa said to the king, 'O king, hearing the Dharma is extremely difficult. If you wish to hear the Dharma, this alone is not enough.' The king joined his palms toward him and said, 'Whatever you wish, I will give it all without refusing.' Then the yakṣa said to

the king, 'O king, if you let me eat whichever of your queens and sons you hold most dear, I will give you the true Dharma.' At that, the great king offered to the yakṣa the dearest among his queens and the foremost of his sons, and the yakṣa ate them in the midst of the great assembly while everyone looked on.

"At that time, when the king's ministers saw what had happened, they cried out and, rolling on the ground, pleaded, 'Great king, give up such improper deeds as these!' But the king was utterly steadfast in seeking the true Dharma, and they could not turn him back. Then the yakṣa, having eaten the king's queen and son, spoke this verse:

All formations are impermanent;
Whatever is born is bound up with suffering;
The five aggregates are empty, being without signs;
There is neither self nor anything belonging to a self.

"When he had spoken this verse, the king was overjoyed and delighted, and not even a hair's breadth of regret arose in his mind. Then he had it written down and proclaimed throughout all of Jambudvīpa, and made everyone study it. Then the Reliever changed back into his own body and praised and extolled the king, saying, 'Excellent indeed! How wonderful and marvelous!' And the king's queen and son were, as before, entirely unharmed.

"The king at that time was the Buddha. Blessed One, if in the past you undertook such hardships for the sake of the Dharma, why now abandon so many sentient beings and pass into nirvāṇa?" So they said.

"Blessed One, furthermore, in the past, beyond countless eons, there was here in Jambudvīpa a great king called Kanaśinipali, who ruled over many vassal kings. He held some eighty-four thousand cities, had twenty thousand queens and palace women, and also some ten thousand great ministers. That king was deeply compassionate, and he became like a father and mother to the many people and other beings. At that time the king thought thus:

'I have become the chief of all these many beings, and these many people also are devoted to me and love me. I shall benefit them all with the precious jewel of the true Dharma.' Having thought this, he had a minister proclaim a decree everywhere, commanding: 'Whoever possesses the true Dharma and teaches it to me, I will give him whatever he wishes, just as he desires.'

"At that time a brahmin called Leuduci came to the palace gate and said, 'I have the true Dharma.' When the king heard these words, he went out to meet

him, paid him homage, and seated him on a seat that had been spread for him. When the brahmin had sat down on the seat, the king and his retinue joined their palms and urged him, 'Great teacher, the time has come to expound and teach the true Dharma to those blinded by delusion.' The brahmin said to the king, 'I did not learn this knowledge so easily. If you wish to hear it, this alone is not enough.' The king said, 'Tell me whatever you wish, and I will give it all just as you desire.' The brahmin said to the king, 'Great king, if you are able to make an offering by planting a thousand lamps in your body, I shall teach the Dharma.'

"The king was overjoyed and delighted. He then dispatched a messenger on an elephant that could travel a hundred thousand leagues, and had this proclamation made throughout all of Jambudvīpa. To the vassal kings and all the people it was announced: 'In seven days from now, King Kanaśinipali will pierce the flesh of his body for the sake of the Dharma and plant a thousand lamps in it.'

"When they heard this proclamation, each and every one of them was tormented with grief. They came to where the king was, paid homage, and all said this: 'All who live and breathe in this world rely on you, O king, just as a blind man relies on his guide, or a small child relies on its mother. If the king is no longer here, to whom shall we go for refuge? If you plant a thousand lamps in your body, you will certainly lose your life. Why would you abandon the beings of this world for the sake of a single brahmin?'

"At that time the queens, the sons, the crown princes, five hundred palace women, and some ten thousand ministers joined their palms and implored him. But the king was steadfast in his resolve and was not turned back. He said, 'When I attain full awakening, I will surely liberate you all.' Then the many people realized that the king was steadfast in his resolve. They were deeply distressed, cried out, and fell to the ground.

"The king's intention did not waver, and he said to the brahmin, 'The time has come to plant the thousand lamps in my body. Pierce it!' The brahmin pierced the king's body and smeared the lamp wicks with oil. When the great retinue saw this happen, they threw themselves to the ground like falling mountains.

"Then the king said to the brahmin, 'Great teacher, please be kind. First teach me the Dharma, and plant the lamps after that. If I should die, I would not get to hear the Dharma.' The brahmin then spoke these verses:

All that is permanent will come to an end;
What is lofty also falls at last;
Where there is meeting, parting will come;
Where there is birth, there will be death.

"The moment he had spoken these verses, the king was overjoyed and delighted, and without any thought of regret he made this pledge: 'This seeking of the Dharma of mine is for the sake of attaining buddhahood. When I later attain complete and perfect awakening, may the light of my wisdom shine brilliantly upon the beings blinded by delusion!' The moment he made this vow, heaven and earth shook violently. The shaking reached as far as the palaces of the gods of the Pure Abodes, and those gods descended from the sky and came to the place where he was making the offering of his body. When the gods saw the bodhisattva's body ruined in this way, they filled the whole sky above and wept. Their tears fell like rain, and they also rained down divine flowers and made offerings.

"At that time Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, also came to where the king was, praised and extolled him in many ways, and said, 'Great king, tormented by such intense suffering as this, do you not feel regret?' The king said, 'I have no regret.' Śakra said, 'Great king, how can one believe your words that you have no regret, when your body is trembling like this and you are in such distress?' The king said, 'If from first to last I have had no thought of regret, may the wounds of my body heal as they were before!' The moment he said this, his body became just as it was before, without any wound.

"The king at that time, in that age, was the Buddha. Blessed One, if in the past too you endured unbearable suffering for the sake of sentient beings and so found the Dharma, why do you now intend to abandon all beings, bereft of the light of the Dharma, and pass into nirvāṇa?

"Furthermore, Blessed One, in a past age there was here in Jambudvīpa a great king called Byinglinggarli, who ruled over the vassal kings. He possessed eighty-four thousand cities and had twenty thousand queens and palace women, five hundred crown princes and princes, and ten thousand great ministers. That king was compassionate and regarded all his subjects as if each were his only son. At that time, because the great king was devoted to and delighted in the true Dharma, he commanded a minister to issue this decree: 'Whoever it may be who possesses a sūtra or the true Dharma and teaches it to me, I will give him whatever he wishes, just as he desires.'

"Then a brahmin called Leunguchu came to the palace gate and said, 'I have the true Dharma, and I shall teach it to whoever wishes to hear it.' When the king heard what he said, he was overjoyed and delighted. He went out to meet him, bowed his head at his feet, spoke pleasant words to him, and led him into the palace. He seated him on a seat that had been spread for him, joined his palms, and said this:

'Great teacher, please teach me the true Dharma.' The brahmin said, 'I experienced all kinds of suffering in my body and spent a very long time before I finally learned it. Great king, if you wish to hear it, this alone is not enough.' The king joined his palms and said, 'Tell me whatever you wish. Teacher, I will offer you everything, holding nothing back.' The brahmin said, 'If a thousand iron nails are driven into your body, I will give you the Dharma.' The king said, 'I shall do just that. Seven days from now I shall make these things ready.'

"At that time the king dispatched a messenger on an elephant that could travel some eighty-four thousand leagues, and had this proclaimed throughout Jambudvīpa: 'Seven days from now the great king Byinglinggarli will have a thousand iron nails driven into his body.' When the ministers and the many beings heard this proclamation, they all came before the king and said, 'All of us beings living in the four directions each enjoy happiness and well-being through the king's virtues and kindness. Great king, we now implore you for our sake: please do not have a thousand iron nails driven into your body.' At that time the queens, the palace women, the crown princes, the princes, and all the ministers also implored him: 'Great king, please have compassion on us. It is not right to die for the sake of one man and abandon all your subjects.'

"To this the king replied, 'For a long time I have wasted countless bodies in saṃsāra. At times, through attachment, aversion, and delusion, this body was killed; the white bones heaped up from that are higher than Mount Meru. The blood shed when my head was cut off is greater than the five great rivers. The tears I have wept exceed the four oceans. Though I have wasted body and life in all these various ways, not once was it for the sake of the Dharma. Now I shall have the nails driven in and so attain buddhahood. When I later attain full awakening and cut through the disease of your afflictions with the sword of wisdom, why do you obstruct my mind of awakening?' At that the great assembly fell completely silent.

"Then the king said to the brahmin, 'Great teacher, please be kind. First teach the Dharma, and after that drive in the iron nails. If I should die, I would not get to hear the Dharma.' The brahmin then spoke in verse:

All formations are impermanent;
All that is born is bound up with suffering;
All phenomena are empty and without an owner;
Nor is there anything that belongs to a self.

"Having spoken this verse, he drove a thousand iron nails into the king's body. At that time, when the vassal kings, the ministers, and the great retinue saw this happen, they threw themselves to the ground like great mountains toppling, wept, and rolled on the ground, losing all awareness. Then heaven and earth shook in six ways. The gods of the desire realm and the form realm were amazed. They all descended from the sky and came before the bodhisattva. When they saw him enduring great suffering in his body for the sake of the Dharma, they all wept, their tears falling like rain, and they made offerings with divine flowers.

"At that time Śakra, lord of the gods, came to where the king was and said, 'Great king, you have undertaken intense diligence and pay no heed to suffering. Is this for the sake of the Dharma? Or do you wish to become Śakra, or a universal monarch? Or do you wish to become the king of the māras, or the king Brahmā, or Maheśvara (Śiva)?' The king said, 'What I have done is not out of a wish to enjoy the happiness of the three realms. All the merit there is from it is for the sake of seeking buddhahood.' Śakra said, 'When I look at you, the king's body is trembling and in unbearable pain. How can one believe you when you say this and claim to have no regret?' The king said, 'If what I have said is true and I have no thought of regret, may my body become just as it was before, without any wound!' The moment he said this, it became just as before, and gods and humans were overjoyed and delighted.

"If at that time too you sought the Dharma in order to protect many beings, then now that the Blessed One has completely fulfilled the ocean of Dharma and is endowed with immeasurable qualities, why do you intend to abandon so many beings and pass into nirvāṇa without even teaching the Dharma?

"Furthermore, Blessed One, in a past age, beyond immeasurable and countless eons, there was here in Jambudvīpa a great king called Brahmadeva, who had a crown prince called Damgam. This prince was devoted to and delighted in the true Dharma, but though he searched for the true Dharma in

every direction, he could not find it. He was tormented with grief and fell into despair. At that time Śakra, lord of the gods, fully knew and understood his thoughts. He transformed himself into a brahmin, came to the gate of the royal palace, and said, 'I have the true Dharma, and I shall teach it.'

"When the prince heard this, he went out to meet him, paid homage at his feet, led him into the palace, and seated him on a seat that had been spread for him. The prince joined his palms and said, 'Great teacher, out of your kindness, please teach the true Dharma.' The brahmin said, 'Studying and learning it is extremely hard, and it is not easy to attend on a master and come to understand it either. This alone will not suffice; it is not right merely to wish to hear the Dharma.' The prince said, 'Great teacher, tell me whatever you wish. Even if you want my body, my wife, and my sons, I will hold nothing back, and I will do as you command.' The brahmin said, 'If you fill a fire pit ten cubits deep with glowing embers and leap into it as an offering, I shall teach you the true Dharma.' At that time the prince made a great fire pit, just as the master had instructed.

"Then, when the king, the queens, the ministers, and the palace women heard what had come about, they were distressed in body and mind. They all came to the prince's palace and implored the prince. They also all earnestly surrounded the brahmin and pleaded, 'Venerable one, please have compassion. For our sake, please do not make this prince leap into the fire pit. If you want our retinues, our wives, our daughters, or even our own bodies, we will offer them.' The brahmin said, 'I am not forcing anyone to do anything; it is simply what the prince has undertaken. If he is able to do it, I shall teach the Dharma. If he is not able, I shall not teach the Dharma.' The retinue, knowing and understanding that the prince's pledge was firm, fell completely silent.

"At that time the king, too, dispatched a messenger on an elephant that could travel a hundred thousand leagues, sending him throughout all of Jambudvīpa with this proclamation: 'Seven days from now Crown Prince Damgam will leap into a fire pit out of his longing for the Dharma. If you wish to see him, come quickly!' Then the vassal kings and the many subjects, weeping and feeble, led one another along and came before the prince. They set their right knees on the ground, joined their palms, and all said with one voice, 'We rely on you, prince. You are like a father and mother to us. If you leap into the fire pit, all these subjects will be left without protector, refuge, or shelter. Do not, for the sake of a mere few people, leave all your subjects without an ally.'

"Then the prince addressed the many people with these words: 'For a long time, as I have wandered in saṃsāra, I have passed through countless bodies. When I was born among humans, never satisfied by desire, we harmed and injured one another. When I was born as a god in the heavens, when the god's lifespan ran out I experienced the suffering of being parted from what I desired. When I was born as a being in the hells, I was burned in fire, boiled in copper cauldrons, hacked and chopped by swords and weapons, plunged into poisonous waters, and made to climb ridges of sword blades; even in a single day I underwent countless deaths, and I experienced the sufferings of sickness and death, pain that pierced to the bone, beyond what words can tell. When I was born as a hungry ghost, I experienced all kinds of suffering that the body could not bear. In the birthplaces of animals, my very body was wasted: loaded with heavy burdens, eating nothing but grass, I experienced suffering hard to endure. Though I wasted body and life, never once did I give rise to even the slightest virtuous thought for the sake of the true Dharma. Now I shall make an offering of this foul and lowly body for the sake of the Dharma. Do not act to obstruct my generating the mind set on unsurpassed awakening! In order to attain buddhahood I shall give up this body entirely, and when I attain full awakening I shall give you the body of Dharma.' At that the great assembly fell silent.

"At that time the prince stood at the edge of the fire pit and said to the brahmin, 'Great teacher, first teach me the true Dharma. If I should die, I would not hear the Dharma.' The brahmin then spoke these verses:

Cultivate the mind of loving-kindness;
Abandon perceptions of aversion and wrath;
With great compassion, protect sentient beings;
Shed tears of tender love for all.
Cultivate great joy;
For others too, the Dharma that accords with your own:
To protect them with the mind of awakening
Is to be endowed with the conduct of a bodhisattva.

"The moment this verse had been spoken, as he was leaping into the fire pit, Śakra and King Brahmā each seized one of his hands and said, 'All the beings of Jambudvīpa, through your kindness, O king, have not the least unhappiness. If you now leap into the fire pit, it will be as if the father and mother of all your subjects had died. Why do you abandon all beings and leap into the fire pit?' The prince looked at the king of the gods and the great assembly and said, 'Do

not act to obstruct my generating the mind set on unsurpassed awakening!' They all fell completely silent, and at once he leapt into the fire pit.

"At that moment heaven and earth shook violently. The gods of the sky wept, and their tears fell like rain. The fire pit turned into a pool of flowers, the prince was found seated on a lotus, and all the gods rained down flowers until they lay knee-deep.

"King Brahmadeva at that time, in that age, is King Śuddhodana, the father. His mother at that time, in that age, is Queen Māyā, the mother. The prince, the crown prince, at that time, in that age, was the Blessed One. Blessed One, if at that time, in that age, you sought the Dharma in order to protect many beings, why now, when it has been brought to completion, do you intend to pass into nirvāṇa without letting the rain of Dharma fall on the many sentient beings who are so tormented?

"Furthermore, Blessed One, beyond countless and immeasurable eons gone by, at that time, in that age, five hundred sages lived here in the land of Vārāṇasī. Their teacher, called Utpala, delighted in studying and meditating on the true Dharma, and he wandered everywhere, proclaiming, 'Whoever possesses the true Dharma and tells it to me, I will give him whatever he wishes, just as he desires, and I will be his servant.' A brahmin came there and said to him, 'I have the true Dharma. If you wish to hear it, I shall teach it.' When the sage heard this, he joined his palms and said, 'Out of kindness to me, please teach the true Dharma.' The brahmin said, 'Learning the Dharma is extremely hard; I learned the Dharma by undergoing much suffering. It is not right to wish to hear the Dharma for this alone. If you wish from your heart to hear it, do as I command.' The sage said, 'I will do as the great teacher commands, without disobeying.' Then the brahmin commanded him thus:

'If you flay your skin and make it into paper, make your bone into a pen, and make your blood into ink, and write down the Dharma that I teach, I shall teach you the Dharma.' When the sage heard these words, he was overjoyed and delighted. In order to honor the teaching of the Tathāgata, he flayed his skin and made it into paper, made his bone into a pen, made his blood into ink, and said, 'The time has come; speak quickly!' The brahmin then spoke these verses:

Restrain well the conduct of the body;
Do not kill, steal, or commit sexual misconduct;
Do not speak divisive words, lies, harsh words,

Or idle chatter.
Do not be attached to sensual pleasures,
And have no thought of aversion;
If you abandon all wrong views,
That is the conduct of a bodhisattva.

"The moment these verses had been spoken, he wrote them down and had them proclaimed throughout Jambudvīpa, and made all the many people study them and diligently practice them just as they had been taught. Blessed One, if at that time, in that age, you had no thought of regret in seeking the Dharma for the sake of many sentient beings, why do you now intend to abandon them all and pass into nirvāṇa without even teaching the Dharma?

"Furthermore, Blessed One, beyond countless and immeasurable eons gone by, there was here in Jambudvīpa a king called Śibi. The palace where that king lived was called Devabarta, and it was endowed with wealth, happiness, good harvests, and immeasurable riches. At that time this king ruled over Jambudvīpa. He held sway over eighty-four thousand vassal kings, eight hundred thousand cities within sixty thousand provinces, twenty thousand queens and palace women, about five hundred princes, and ten thousand great ministers. There was no one whom his loving-kindness and compassion did not reach.

"At that time Śakra, lord of the gods, had lost the five excellences of his body and was close to death, and so he was deeply unhappy. When Viśvakarman saw him grieving, he asked Śakra, 'Why are you grieving and unhappy?' Śakra said, 'I am close to death, and the omens of passing away have appeared. In this world the Dharma of the buddhas has declined, and no bodhisattva remains in the world either. I grieve because I do not know to whom I should go for refuge.' Viśvakarman said, 'Lord of the gods, in Jambudvīpa there lives a great king called Śibi who practices the conduct of a bodhisattva. He is utterly steadfast in his resolve and has undertaken great diligence, so he will certainly attain full awakening. If you go to him for refuge, he will certainly become your ally, and you will be freed from obstacles.'

"Śakra said, 'If he is a bodhisattva, we must test him first. Let us go and test him. You transform yourself into a dove. I shall transform myself into a hawk and swiftly follow after you. Go to where that king is, seek refuge, and we will test him, and so we will discover whether he is a fraud or genuine.'

Viśvakarman said, 'Lord of the gods, a great being, a bodhisattva, is one worthy of offerings, not of harm. It is not right to torment him with so extremely hard a thing as this.' Śakra, lord of the gods, then spoke these verses:

I bear him no ill will;
Like gold, when tested, it becomes plain.
Since I wish to discover the truth,
I shall test the bodhisattva.

"Having spoken these verses, Viśvakarman transformed himself into a dove and Śakra transformed himself into a hawk. The hawk pursued the dove as if about to seize it, and the dove, terrified, flew into the king's armpit and begged the king to save its life. The hawk at once arrived too, perched near the palace, and said to the king, 'This dove is my food. It has come down here to the king, so give it to me quickly. I am tormented by hunger.' The king said, 'I have vowed never to turn away anyone who comes to me for refuge, so I will not give this one up either.' The hawk spoke again: 'If, as the king says, you are the refuge of all, then if you do not give me my food, I too will be deprived of life. Am I not also included among "all"?' The king said, 'If I give you some other meat, will you eat it?' The hawk said, 'If there is fresh meat, newly killed, I want it.'

"The king thought, 'If I provide fresh meat from some newly killed creature, it would not be right to kill one in order to save another; it would be pointless.' Having thought this, he thought further, 'Apart from my own body alone, all others that have life hold their lives dear.' Having thought this, he took up a sharp knife, cut flesh from his thigh, and gave it to the hawk, and so ransomed the dove's life. The hawk said, 'O king, you have become a generous patron and treat all alike. Though I am only a small bird, I ask that you treat me fairly too. If you are ransoming the dove's life, please weigh it on a scale and make the two equal.'

"The king commanded, 'Bring a scale!' The dove was placed in one pan of the scale, and the flesh he cut off was heaped in the other pan. Even when the flesh of his thighs was used up, it was lighter than the dove. Even when he had cut away all the flesh of both shoulders, of his right and left sides, and of his body, it did not equal the dove. Then the king himself rose and tried to climb into the scale, but he had no strength left; he fell to the ground and fainted.

"After a long while he regained consciousness and rebuked his own mind with these words: 'Since beginningless time, because of your incapacity, you have wandered in the three realms and experienced all kinds of suffering, yet it never became an accumulation of merit. The time has come to take up diligence; this is no time for laziness.' Having restrained himself with rebukes of many kinds, he then struggled with all his might and got into the pan of the scale, and a mind of great joy arose in him: 'Now it is well!'

"At that moment heaven and earth quaked in six ways, and even the palaces of the gods shook and swayed. The gods, up to those of the form realm, came down and stationed themselves in the sky above. When they saw these deeds of the bodhisattva, how he had practiced such extreme austerity and utterly ruined his body, paying no heed to body or life for the sake of the Dharma, their tears fell like rain and they wept, and they made offerings, raining down divine flowers like rain.

"Then Śakra changed back into his former body and spoke to the king: 'What does Your Majesty seek by performing such an extremely difficult deed as this? Do you seek to be a universal monarch? Or Śakra? Or the king of the māras? Or do you seek to be lord of the three realms? What is it that you seek?'

"The bodhisattva replied, 'What I desire is not the grand enjoyments of the three realms. Whatever merit I make, I desire unsurpassed awakening.'

"Śakra said, 'Your body has been broken and ruined like this, and you have experienced suffering that reaches to the bone. Do you not regret it?'

"The king said, 'I have no regret.'

"Śakra said, 'You say you have no regret, but when one sees how your body trembles and shakes, and your breath is all but cut off so that you cannot even speak, how can one believe that you have no regret?'

"The king said, 'If from first to last I have not had a thought of regret even as fine as the tip of a hair, then whatever I wish will come about without fail. If these words I have spoken are true, then by speaking these words of truth, may this body of mine become unwounded, just as it was before!'

"No sooner had he said this than the king's body became even more beautiful than before, and the whole world with its gods and humans was delighted, overjoyed and thrilled, and was filled with wonder.

"The King Śibi of that time and occasion is now the Buddha. Blessed One, if in past times too you did not regard your own life for the sake of many beings, then now, Blessed One, when your ocean of Dharma is complete, when you have raised the banners of Dharma, beaten the drum of Dharma, and made the lamp of Dharma shine brightly, and the time has come to work for benefit and happiness, why do you intend to abandon all beings and pass into nirvāṇa without teaching the Dharma?"

Then King Brahmā, his palms joined before the Tathāgata, praised and extolled him, recounting how the Tathāgata had sought the Dharma in his former lives and how, for the sake of beings, he had given up as many as a thousand heads.

Then the Blessed One granted what King Brahmā had requested, and going to the place in the land of Vārāṇasī where fearlessness was given to the deer, he turned the wheel of Dharma. Through his turning the wheel of Dharma in this way, the Three Jewels too became manifest in the world.

When he had spoken thus, all the gods, humans, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras and the rest of the eight classes rejoiced and followed his teaching.

This concludes the first chapter, the Teaching of Various Examples.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. Then, when the time had come for the alms round, the Blessed One put on his lower robe and Dharma robe, took up his alms bowl, and went for alms with Ānanda.

At that time in that city there was an old woman who had two sons who were always stealing. They were caught by the owner of the goods and taken before the magistrate, and when the law was applied to them it came to the point of execution. The low-caste executioners were leading them, terrified, to the place of execution, when the old woman and her sons, the three of them, saw the Blessed One coming from afar. They bowed down in the direction from which the Buddha was coming and said, "Chief among gods, have compassion on us and please become the refuge of these sons of mine, who have come to the point of death!"

The Blessed One heard them, and the Tathāgata, out of great compassion, felt tender love for them. In order to save their lives, the Blessed One instructed Ānanda and sent him to petition the king, and the king, in accordance with the Blessed One's word, released them.

Remembering the Blessed One's kindness, they felt great joy. They went to where the Blessed One was, bowed their heads at his feet, joined their palms, and said to the Blessed One, "Through the Blessed One's great kindness, what little remains of our lives has been spared. Chief among gods, have compassion on us, and would you grant us ordination into the Dharma?"

When the Blessed One said, "Welcome!" their hair and beards fell away of themselves and their clothes turned into saffron robes. Their minds became steadfast in deep faith, and when the Blessed One taught them the Dharma as suited them, their dust and stains were exhausted and they became arhats. Their old mother too, by hearing the Dharma, attained the state of no return.

Then Ānanda, seeing such wondrous things, praised him, saying, "So many are the qualities the Tathāgata possesses!" And he further thought, "What good did these three, the old woman and her sons, do in the past, that now they have met the Blessed One, have escaped from great peril, and have attained the bliss of nirvāṇa, gaining benefit and happiness in a single life? How excellent!"

The Blessed One knew this and said to Ānanda, "It is not only now, at this time alone, that I have saved this mother and her sons; in times past too they were saved through my kindness."

Ānanda said, "Blessed One, please explain how this mother and her sons were saved in times past as well."

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "In times past, countless eons ago, there was in this Jambudvīpa a king called Mahāratha, who ruled over some five thousand vassal kings. That king had three sons. The eldest was called Mahāpraṇāda, the middle one was called Mahādeva, and the youngest was called Mahāsattva. From childhood the youngest son was endowed with loving-kindness and compassion, and regarded everyone as though they were his only child.

"At that time the king, together with his ministers, his queen and his sons, went out to stroll in the countryside. While they rested for a little while, the three sons went into a forest, and there they saw a tigress who had given birth not many days before. Tormented by hunger and thirst, she was on the point of eating her own cubs.

"The youngest prince said to his two elder brothers, 'This tigress is gravely afflicted by suffering. She is so weak and emaciated that she is near death,

and she wants to eat even her newborn cubs.'

"The two elder brothers said, 'What you say is true.'

"The youngest brother then asked his two elder brothers, 'What does this tigress eat for food?'

"The two elder brothers said, 'Fresh flesh just killed and warm blood would satisfy her.'

"He spoke again, saying, 'Is there anyone at all who could save her life with such a thing and keep her from perishing?'

"The two elder brothers said, 'That would be extremely difficult, so there is no one.'

"Then the youngest prince thought to himself, 'For a long time I have wandered in saṃsāra and wasted countless bodies and lives. Sometimes it was for the sake of attachment, sometimes for the sake of aversion, sometimes for the sake of delusion. Though I have given up bodies, not once have I met with a field of merit for the sake of the Dharma. What use is this body?'

"Having thought this, he went on together with the other two, but before they had gone far he said to his two elder brothers, 'Brothers, go on ahead. I have some business to see to, and I will come after you.'

"Taking that same path back, he went quickly to where the tigress's den was and lay down in front of the tigress. But the tigress's jaws were clamped shut, and she could not eat. Then the prince drew blood from his body with a sharp splinter of wood and let the tigress lick it, and she opened her mouth and ate the flesh of his body, leaving none.

"The two elder brothers waited, and when he did not come for a long time, they went back along his tracks to search for him. When they considered what he had said earlier, they thought, 'Surely the hungry tigress has killed him.' They went there and looked, and saw that their youngest brother had been eaten by the tiger and lay in a heap, smeared all over with flesh and blood. They threw themselves to the ground and fainted. After a long while they came to, and wailing in lamentation they rolled on the ground and fainted again.

"At that time the queen, the mother, dreamed in her sleep that three doves were flying all around and playing, when a hawk carried off the smallest of

them. As soon as she had dreamed this she awoke, and in terror she told the king, 'I have heard it said that doves are the life-spirit of sons. Since the smallest of the doves was carried off by a hawk, misfortune has surely befallen the dearest of my sons.' At once she sent people searching everywhere.

"Before long the two princes arrived, and she asked them, 'Has nothing happened to my dearest son, or what is it?' The two elder brothers were choked with sobs; for a long time they could not catch their breath or speak. Then, when they had recovered their breath, they said, 'He has been eaten by a tiger.'

"When the queen heard them say this, she fainted and fell to the ground. After a long while she recovered her breath, and together with the two sons, the king, and the palace retinue, she went quickly to the place where the prince had died. By then the tigress had finished eating all the prince's flesh, and they saw only bones and blood lying in a heap on the ground. The queen took hold of the head and the king took hold of the hands, and they wailed in lamentation and wept. There too they fainted, and after a long while they came to again.

"Prince Mahāsattva, having died there, was born in the abode of the gods of Tuṣita. He wondered, 'Why is this? What did I do to be born here?' and looked over the five realms of rebirth with his divine eye. He saw the bones of his own dead body lying in the forest, with his father and mother around them, heartbroken, pierced by the thorn of grief, suffering and lamenting.

"The god thought, 'Through this unhappy circumstance, my father and mother may come to harm in body and life. I will go to speak with them and cheer them.' Having thought this, he descended from the heavens, and from the sky above he cheered his father and mother with many kinds of sweet words.

"The father and mother looked up at the sky and said, 'God, tell us who you are!'

"The god said, 'I am the one called Prince Mahāsattva. Because I fed my body to the starving tigress, I have been born in the abode of the gods of Tuṣita. Great King, please understand this: all things bound up with craving come to destruction in the end. Where there is birth, there will certainly be destruction. If beings do evil, they fall into hell; if they do good, they are born in the higher realms. Since birth and destruction exist for all, why do you not see that you are falling into an ocean of grief merely for the sake of fondness? Exert yourselves in virtuous Dharma!'

"His father and mother said, 'Out of great compassion you fed yourself to the tigress and showed love to all, yet you abandoned us and died. Now, remembering you, we are tormented by suffering as though our flesh were being cut to pieces. Is it fitting that you, who practice great compassion, should act like this?'

"Then the god consoled them again with many kinds of sweet words and cheered them, and his father and mother too were somewhat cheered. They made a casket of the seven kinds of precious things, placed the bones inside it and buried it, and over it they built a stūpa. The god returned to his own abode, and the king and his large retinue returned to the palace."

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "What do you think? Who do you suppose King Mahāratha was at that time, on that occasion? He is now my father, King Śuddhodana. The king's queen at that time, on that occasion, is now my mother Māyā. The eldest son at that time, Mahāpraṇāda, is Maitreya. The middle son, Mahādeva, is Vamisutra. As for the youngest prince at that time, on that occasion, Mahāsattva, do not think he was anyone else: he is now I myself. The tiger cubs at that time, on that occasion, are these two men. Long ago too I freed them from peril, saved their lives, and made them safe.

And now that I have attained perfect awakening, I have again freed them from peril, and they are completely liberated from the great suffering of saṃsāra."

Then Ānanda and all the large assembly rejoiced at what the Blessed One had said and praised it highly.

This concludes the second chapter, Mahāsattva Gives His Body to the Tigress.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time, in the first watch of the night, two gods came to where the Buddha was. The light of those gods' bodies made the whole of Prince Jeta's Grove shine with a single golden hue. The Blessed One taught them the sublime Dharma as suited them, and their minds were liberated. Both of them attained the fruit of awakening, bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet, and went back to the abode of the gods.

The next day, as soon as dawn broke, Ānanda said to the Blessed One, "Last night two gods came and paid homage to the Blessed One, and the light of their bodies lit everything up and made it beautiful. What action did they do in the past to obtain such a result?"

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "Long ago, after the Buddha Kāśyapa had passed into nirvāṇa and the sublime Dharma was close to vanishing, two brahmins took the eight precepts for one day and night. Of the two, one made the aspiration, 'May I be born as a god!' The other made the aspiration, 'May I become a king!' Then they went back to their homes.

"When one of them came home, his wife called him to eat, and the husband said to her, 'I have taken the precept from the Buddha's Dharma of not eating food in the afternoon, so I do not want any.'

"The wife said, 'You are a wandering ascetic (parivrājaka). Since we have the moral discipline of our own Dharma, why have you taken the precepts of another teacher? If you will not eat with me, I will tell the other wandering ascetics what you have said, and have you driven out, so that they will not allow you to gather or talk with them.'

"When she said this, the husband could not bear it; in fear and alarm he ate food with his wife at the wrong time.

"Those two men lived out whatever their lifespans allowed, and each of them died. The one who had aspired to be a king, because he had kept the precepts, was born into a royal family. The one who had aspired to be born as a god, because he had broken the precepts, was born as a nāga.

"At that time, a keeper of the orchard of the one who had been born as king brought him all kinds of fruit every day. Then at a later time, the keeper found in a spring an apple with fine color and fragrance, and he thought, 'Whenever I bring fruit and go back and forth, the gatekeeper always stops me and will not let me pass freely. I will give this apple to the gatekeeper.' So he gave it to the king's gatekeeper.

"The gatekeeper took the fruit and thought, 'Whenever I go to make a report or a request, the chamberlain always stops me, and I cannot go in with dignity. I will give this apple to the chamberlain.' So he gave it to the chamberlain. The chamberlain took it and offered it to the queen. The queen took it and offered it to the king.

"The king ate the apple and found it exceedingly sweet and especially fragrant, and he asked the queen, 'Where was this apple found?' The queen told him in detail how it had been obtained, and tracing it from one to the next they came at last to the orchard keeper. The king summoned the orchard keeper and said to him, 'If there is fruit like this in my orchard, why do you

give it to others instead of offering it to me?' The orchard keeper explained in detail how he had first found it.

"Then the king said to the orchard keeper, 'From today on, always offer me apples like this one.'

"The orchard keeper replied, 'This apple did not grow on a fruit tree. I found it in a spring, so from now on I will not be able to find any; there will be none to be had.'

"To this the king said, 'If you do not find one from now on, I will have your body cut to pieces.'

"The orchard keeper went back to his place and grieved and wept. A nāga heard the loud sound of his weeping, and the nāga transformed himself into a man and asked him, 'Why are you unhappy and weeping?' The orchard keeper told the nāga in detail what had happened.

"The nāga vanished, and before long he filled a golden bowl with fine fruits and gave it to the man, saying, 'Take this fruit and offer it to the king, and give him this message as well: "The king and I are friends. In a former life we were both wandering ascetics, and we took the eight precepts for one day and night and each made an aspiration. Because the king kept the precepts he became a king, but because I broke the precepts I was born as a nāga. Now I wish to keep the precepts again and be freed from this body. Please give me the rite of the eight precepts for one day and night. If you do not grant it, I will turn the king's country into an ocean."' So he sent this message.

"Then the orchard keeper took the fruit and offered it to the king, and he also told the king the whole message the nāga had sent. The king became unhappy. Why was that? At that time no buddha was dwelling in the world, and since the sublime Dharma had vanished, not even a text of the eight precepts for one day and night could be found. Fearing that if he did not accomplish this the nāga would do him harm, he fell to brooding and sat there unhappy.

"Then the king said to his chief minister, 'A nāga is asking me for the text of the eight precepts. I will not allow you to fail to find it.'

"The minister said, 'Since there is no Dharma in the world, where am I to find it?'

"The king said to the minister, 'If you do not find it, you will be killed.'

"Most unhappy, the minister went off and reached his home. That minister had an aged and decrepit father.

"His father looked at him and said, 'Before, my son, you used to talk with a smile and a bright face. Why today, unlike before, do you speak with a dark and unsmiling face?' The minister told his father in detail what had happened.

"His father said, 'In my house there is a pillar from which light always shines. Look and see what is inside it.' So he took the pillar out and split it open, and from inside it there came forth the Sūtra of the Twelve Links of Dependent Origination and the text of the eight precepts for one day and night. The minister offered them to the king.

"When the king received them he was delighted, overjoyed and thrilled. He placed the text of the eight precepts in a golden casket and sent it to the nāga. When the nāga received it he was overjoyed, and he presented the king with many precious things as well. He kept the eight precepts for one day and night and urged others to keep them too. Then, when he died, he was born as a god. The king likewise kept the precepts, and when he died he was born as a god in the same abode.

"Those two came before me last night in the first watch of the night. When I taught them the Dharma as suited them, they attained the fruit of stream-entry and became completely free of the three lower realms. They will enjoy the pleasures of gods and humans and in the end will attain even nirvāṇa."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, all the large assembly rejoiced and were delighted.

This concludes the third chapter, The Wandering Ascetic Keeps the Precepts.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time in that land a son was born to a certain householder. The boy was well formed and lovely to look at, and not long after he was born he could speak. The boy asked his father and mother, "Is the Blessed One alive at present?"

"He is alive at present," they said.

"Then are the venerable Śāriputra, Ānanda and the others alive?" he asked.

"They too are alive," they said.

The boy's father and mother thought, "This child, who could speak as soon as he was born, is not human," and in amazement and wonder they asked the Blessed One about it. The Blessed One said, "This son of yours is endowed with excellent marks. Have no doubts." The boy's father and mother were delighted, overjoyed and thrilled, and went back home.

Then the boy said to his father and mother, "Please invite the Buddha and the Saṅgha of monks."

His father and mother said, "If we invite the Buddha and the Saṅgha, provisions will have to be prepared, and they are not to be had at a moment's notice."

The son said, "Sweep and sprinkle the inside of the house and spread out seats. Arrange three high seats and spread them out as well. Food with a hundred flavors will come of itself. My parents from my former life are now living in the land of Vārāṇasī; summon them too."

His father and mother did as their son had said: they sent a man mounted on an elephant, who summoned his former parents and brought them. "Of the three high seats that have been set out," he said, "invite the Buddha to sit on one; let my parents from my former life sit on one; and let the parents who gave birth to my present body sit on one."

Then the Buddha came with his retinue of monks and sat on the seats that had been spread out, each in order. Everyone was filled and satisfied with fine food. Then the Blessed One taught the Dharma, and the boy's two sets of parents and everyone in the household, great and small, heard the Dharma and rejoiced greatly, and all of them attained the first fruit. Later, when the boy had grown up, he went forth, and by making diligent effort he attained arhatship.

Then Ānanda said to the Blessed One, "What good did this monk do in the past, that he was born into a great and high family, could speak from infancy, and after going forth swiftly attained the higher knowledges?"

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "In a former life this man was the son of a householder in the land of Vārāṇasī. When the householder died, he fell on hard times and became destitute. Though he had met with the Buddha, the Blessed One, dwelling in the world, he had no wealth with which to make offerings. Unhappy at this, he agreed to work for hire for a man of great and high family, and when a year had passed he had earned about a thousand gold

coins.

"Then the man of great and high family asked him, 'Will you not take a wife?'

"'I do not want one,' he said.

"He asked again, 'Then what will you do with this gold?'

"He said, 'I must offer a meal of alms to the Buddha and the noble Saṅgha.'

"The man of great and high family said, 'If you want to invite the Buddha and the noble Saṅgha, I will put in gold and lay out the food and other provisions, so invite them to my house.'

"The poor man said, 'I will do so,' and food was laid out and he invited the Buddha and the noble Saṅgha. Through that cause and that condition, when he died he was born into the household of this householder, and now too, having invited the Buddha and heard the Dharma, he has attained awakening."

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "The poor man of former times is this monk, the householder's son."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, all the large assembly rejoiced and were delighted.

This concludes the fourth chapter, Selling Himself to Make Offerings.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time, in that same land, about five hundred merchants who were going to the ocean to fetch jewels discussed among themselves: "Let us take as our captain someone wise and knowledgeable among men." Having agreed on this, they took as their leader a layman who kept the five precepts, and set out on the ocean.

When they reached the middle of the ocean, the god of the ocean transformed himself into a rākṣasa, with a form most hideous, blue-black, with fangs jutting upward and flames blazing on his head. He came up to them and said, "Give me this ship!" And he asked the merchants this:

"Is there anything in the world more terrifying than I am?"

The layman said, "There is something far more terrifying than you."

The god of the ocean said, "Who is like that?"

The layman said, "In the world there are fools, full of delusion, who heedlessly commit nonvirtuous actions: killing, taking what is not given, sexual misconduct, lying, idle talk, slander, harsh speech, attachment, great hatred, and wrong views. When they die they are born in hell, and there they experience all kinds of suffering. The guardians of hell lead them away: some are hacked and chopped with weapons; some are pulled this way and that by chariots and torn limb from limb; some are pounded with pestles; some are bound with ropes; some are made to climb mountains of swords; some are boiled in chariots of fire, in boiling copper cauldrons, in molten metal and in vile filth. They experience such dreadful sufferings of all kinds for hundreds of thousands of years. That is far more terrifying than you."

As soon as the god of the ocean heard this, he vanished.

As they went on again over the ocean, the god of the ocean transformed himself into a man extremely emaciated and wretched, nothing but sinews and bones held together, and saying, "Give me this ship!" he asked this: "Is there anyone in the world more emaciated and wretched than I am?"

The layman said, "There are those far more wretched and emaciated than you."

The god of the ocean said, "Who is like that?"

The layman said, "Those who are foolish and deluded, by nature stingy and miserly, envious out of desire, and who know nothing of giving, are born as hungry ghosts when they die. Their bodies are as big as mountains, but their throats are as narrow as a needle. Their hair is matted, they are black and emaciated, and for hundreds of thousands of years they do not hear even the word 'water.' They are far more emaciated than you."

As soon as he had said this, the god vanished.

Then, as they went on and on, the god of the ocean transformed himself into a man of extremely fine appearance and said, "Give me this ship!" And he asked the merchants, "Is there anyone among the people of the world as handsome and beautiful as I am?"

The layman said, "There are those a hundred times, a thousand times more handsome than you."

The god of the ocean said, "Who is more handsome than I?"

The layman said, "In the world, the wise and intelligent who practice the ten virtues to perfection, whose actions of body, speech and mind are completely pure, who have deep faith in the Three Jewels, and who are minded to make offerings with whatever they have, are born as gods in the higher realms when they die. Their appearance is lovely, most attractive and most beautiful. They surpass you a hundredfold, a thousandfold. If you were compared with them, it would be like comparing a blind monkey with the goddess of good fortune."

Then the god of the ocean scooped up a double handful of water and asked the layman, "Is there more water in this double handful, or is there more water in the ocean?"

The layman said, "There is more water in the double handful; the water of the ocean is not much."

The god of the ocean said, "Are these words you have spoken true?"

The layman said, "These words are true, not false."

"How is it evident that they are true?"

He said, "The water of the ocean is plentiful, but without doubt there will be a time when it dries up. When the eon draws near its destruction by fire, two suns rise and dry up all the springs and ponds. When three suns rise, all the streams dry up. When four suns rise, all the rivers dry up. When five suns rise, even the great ocean shrinks from what it was before. When six suns rise, it shrinks by two-thirds. When seven suns rise, even the great ocean dries up, and even Mount Meru burns and blazes all the way down to its vajra foundation. But if someone with a mind of deep faith offers even a double handful of water to the Buddha, or presents it to the Saṅgha, or presents it to his father and mother, or gives it to the poor and destitute, or gives it to wild animals, that merit will not be exhausted even in many eons. Therefore you should know that the water of the ocean is little and the water in a double handful is much."

Then the god of the ocean was overjoyed. He presented the layman with many precious things, and he also sent supreme jewels to the Buddha and the Saṅgha. The layman and the merchants, satisfied with jewels, returned safely to their own land.

Then that layman and the five hundred or so merchants came to where the Buddha was and bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet. Each of them brought jewels, and they offered to the Buddha and the Saṅgha the gifts the

god of the ocean had sent as well. They knelt with their knees on the ground, joined their palms, and said to the Blessed One, "We too wish to go forth in the Teacher's doctrine."

When the Blessed One said, "Laymen, welcome!" their hair and beards fell away of themselves, and they became monks wearing Dharma robes. The Blessed One taught them the Dharma as suited them, and later, all their desires exhausted, they became arhats.

That large assembly rejoiced at what the Blessed One had said and were delighted.

This concludes the fifth chapter, The Questions of the God of the Ocean.

Fascicle Two.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying in the Bamboo Grove at Kalandakanivāpa.

At that time in that land there was a very wealthy great minister who had no son. At that time on the bank of the river Gaṅgā there was a shrine of a god called Maṇibhadra, and everyone bowed down and made offerings to it. That great minister also went to the shrine and made this request: "I have no son. I have heard, god, that you possess immeasurable qualities. If you, the protector of all beings, are able to fulfill the wishes of others, then please protect me too. If you grant me a son, I will cover your image, god, with gold and silver, and anoint the shrine where you dwell with incense and perfumes.

But if there is no clear sign, I will tear down your shrine, god, and smear your body with filth and excrement."

When the god heard this, he thought: "This minister is wealthy, powerful and mighty, so a being of mere lowly kind will not become his son. My power is small, and I cannot fulfill his wish. If I do not do as he wishes, he will certainly insult me in some ugly way." Having thought this, the god who guarded the shrine appealed to Maṇibhadra. Maṇibhadra too lacked such power, so he went to where Vaiśravaṇa was and appealed to Vaiśravaṇa. Vaiśravaṇa also thought, "By my power alone I cannot bring it about that he has a son." So Vaiśravaṇa went to where Śakra was and made this appeal: "My minister, who is called Maṇibhadra, has said this to me: 'A minister in Rājagṛha is asking me for a son. He has vowed that if I do as he wishes, he will make offerings and pay honor, but if I do not do as he wishes, he will tear down the shrine and do ugly things. If he does without fail as he has vowed, then, Śakra, lord of the

gods, please bring it about that he has a son.'"

Śakra said, "This is extremely difficult indeed, yet I now see a way." At that time there was a son of the gods who had been parted from the five qualities and was close to the end of his life. Śakra said to him, "You are certain to die. When you die, be born as the son of that minister."

The son of the gods replied, "I long to go forth and practice the sacred Dharma. If I am born into a great and high family, it will be hard to go forth. If I become one of an ordinary family, it will be easy."

Śakra spoke again: "Divine one, be born there. If you long to go forth, I too will help you."

That son of the gods passed away from there and was born into that minister's family, in the womb of his wife. Later, when the time of birth came, a son was born who was well formed and beautiful to behold. They showed him to a soothsayer, and the soothsayer, having looked at him, asked, "Where did you first obtain this boy?" They said, "We asked for him from the god of the river Gaṅgā." And so they gave the boy the name Gaṅgādatta.

Later, when he had grown up, he said to his father and mother, "I ask to go forth."

His parents told him, "We are wealthy and powerful like this and possess great riches. You are our only son. You must uphold our family line and support your parents, so we do not permit it."

Because what he had hoped for did not come about, the boy was deeply unhappy, and he thought, "If I do away with this body and am born into an ordinary family, and then ask to go forth, it may be easier than this." Having thought this, he went out, and leapt from a high cliff. But though he leapt from the cliff and fell to the ground, he was neither hurt nor injured. Then he went to the bank of a great river and leapt into the water, but the water tossed him about and he came back out again, unharmed. He ate deadly poison, but the poison could not overcome him and did him no harm.

Then he thought again: "If I do something that breaks the king's law, the king may well have me killed." Just then the king's wives and palace women came out of the palace and went to bathe in a pool in the pleasure garden. They took off their clothes and ornaments and laid them on the trees. Gaṅgādatta, passing by, saw the clothes and ornaments laid on the trees in this way. He went into the pleasure garden, gathered the queens' clothes and ornaments

into his arms, and came out at the gate. The gatekeeper seized him and delivered him to King Ajātaśatru.

When the king heard what had happened, he was furious. He took up a bow and arrow, and the king himself, with his own hand, shot at the boy. But the arrow he shot did not go to the boy; it turned back and fell in front of the king. This happened three times, and the king was frightened. He threw down the bow and said to the boy, "Are you a god, a nāga, a hungry ghost, a yakṣa, or what are you?"

The boy replied, "I have one request. If you grant it, I will tell you properly."

The king said, "I will do so."

The boy said, "I am neither a god nor a nāga. I am the son of a minister of Rājagṛha. I longed to go forth, but my father and mother would not permit it. So, thinking that I would kill myself so that this body of mine might be reborn elsewhere, I leapt from a high cliff, and I leapt into water, and I even ate deadly poison, yet I could not die. Then I thought that if I did something against the king's law I would be put to death. But even when Your Majesty was about to put me to death, I did not die, as you have seen. Now that things have come to this, may Your Majesty take pity on me and allow me to go forth."

The king declared, "I allow you to go forth." He took the boy and came before the Blessed One, and told the Blessed One in detail all that had happened. Then the Blessed One too allowed him to go forth, saying, "Let robes be upon your body," and he became a monk. The Blessed One taught him the Dharma in a way suited to him, and his mind was liberated. He became an arhat, endowed with the three knowledges, the six superknowledges and the eight liberations.

Then King Ajātaśatru said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, what root of virtue did this young boy accomplish in the past, such that though he leapt from a cliff he did not die, though he leapt into the water he came to no harm, though he ate deadly poison he did not die, and though an arrow was shot at him he was not wounded? And having met the Blessed One, he has been freed from the extreme of saṃsāra."

The Blessed One spoke to the king as follows: "Long ago in the past, countless eons ago, in the land called Vārāṇasī, there was a king called Brahmadatta. That king went out with his queens and the women of the palace to amuse

himself in the pleasure garden. In that pleasure garden the palace women sang, and outside the wall a man took up the refrain in a loud voice. The king heard this, and when he heard it he grew angry and commanded, 'Seize that man and kill him!'

At that time a minister was coming in from outside, and he saw the man who had been taken captive. He asked the attendants, "What wrong has this man done, that he has been seized?" They told him in detail why he had been seized, and the minister said to them, "Wait for now, and do not kill him. I will speak to the king." He went into the palace and said this to the king: "The man who is being led away to be executed has done nothing that deserves death. Singing, or taking up a refrain, is not something seen in visible form. It is a rash and improper act, but it is not doing wrong to the queens. It would be right for Your Majesty to have compassion for his life and let him go." The king declared, "Let him go without killing him."

That man then entered the minister's service. Later, when many years had passed, he thought: "The wound dealt by desire is sharper than a sword. That I came to such misery was also because of desire." Having thought this, he asked the minister, "Will you allow me to go forth and to meditate on the path of liberation?" The minister told him, "If you meditate on the path of liberation, I will not stand in your way. But when you have become liberated, come back and meet me again."

Then the man went to a solitary place and brought the ultimate meaning to mind. By applying diligence he became a pratyekabuddha. Then he went back to the city and came to where the great minister was. The great minister was overjoyed, and offered him alms and the four kinds of requisites for living without interruption. Then the pratyekabuddha rose into the sky above, and displayed the eighteen kinds of miracles: water streaming from his body, fire blazing forth, great rays of light shining out, and so on. When the great minister saw such things, boundless delight arose in him, and he made this vow: "This man was able to live through my kindness. Wherever I am born, may I be powerful and wealthy and long lived, a hundred times, a thousand times more exalted than others, and may my wisdom and merit also become equal to his." So he made his aspiration.

The Blessed One said to the king: "The minister who at that time, on that occasion, saved a man's life and enabled him to attain the fruit was this one. By that cause and that condition, wherever he was born, his life was never cut

short, and now, having met me, he has attained the supreme fruit."

The whole great assembly rejoiced at what the Blessed One had spoken and was delighted.

This is the sixth chapter, the chapter on the son of the gods called Gaṅgādatta.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time the chief queen of King Prasenajit, who was called Mallikā, gave birth to a daughter, and they gave the girl the name Vajrā. Her face was extremely ugly; the skin of her body was very rough, hard like a tiger's hide, and her hair too was coarse and bristling like a horse's mane. The king was displeased with the girl because she was ugly, and had her raised within the palace in a place where no one could see her.

Though the girl was as ugly as this, she had been born to the chief queen, and so, ugly as she was, she was raised where no one could see her. Later, when she had grown up and was of an age to be given in marriage, the king, deeply displeased, said this to a minister: "Find a man who was formerly of high lineage, belonging to the vaiśya class, but who has now fallen on hard times and has no wealth or possessions, and bring him to me." So that minister found a poor and destitute son of the vaiśya class, of high lineage but fallen on hard times, and presented him to the king.

The king took him in secret to a solitary place where there was no one else, and said, "I have a daughter whose face is ugly. She is of an age to be given in marriage, but no match has been found for her. You are of a great and high lineage, though you are poor and have nothing at all. I will give her to you as your wife; take her."

Then the young man set his knee on the ground and replied, "I will do as the king commands. Even if the great king were to give me a bitch, I would accept her. How much more so when you give me a princess of the royal line! As you command, I will accept her."

So the king gave his daughter as wife to the poor man. He had a house and so forth made for her, built it with seven successive gates, and gave this order to the man: "Whenever you go anywhere, close the gates yourself and take the key with you. Keep the gates firmly shut, so that no other person outside will ever see this very ugly daughter of mine." Having given this order, he gave him wealth, possessions and all the requisites he could need, as much as he

wanted, and made him a minister.

Since he now possessed precious jewels and many possessions, at a later time he took part in feasting with others of great and high families. At the feasts husbands, wives, sons and daughters all gathered to enjoy themselves. All the others came accompanied by their wives, but only that minister's wife did not come, so his companions grew suspicious. They doubted, thinking, "Either this man's wife is exceedingly beautiful and fair of form, or else she is so very ugly that she must not be seen by others, and that is why he has not brought her." So they conferred about looking at his wife, and, in agreement, secretly made a plan: "Let us make this man drunk with liquor, and once he has lost his wits, steal the key, and send about five men to look at his wife."

At that time the man's wife thought, "What evil did I commit in the past, that my husband hates me, and I have been put in such a dark hole as this, where I cannot see even the sun and moon, nor see any other person?" She was deeply unhappy, and then she thought this: "The Buddha, the Blessed One, dwells in the world, and it is said that he acts as protector and refuge for those sentient beings tormented by suffering, and liberates them. I bow down to the Blessed One from afar. If only, out of compassion, he would come before me in person, and show me his face, even for a little while, how good that would be!"

Knowing that the girl's intention was utterly pure and that she was full of devotion, the Blessed One went to her house. Before the girl he manifested his head, marked by its sapphire blue hair, the fruit of his former deeds, and let her see it. When the girl saw the Blessed One's sapphire blue hair, she was all the more delighted and overjoyed, and her intention became utterly pure. Because her intention was so pure, the girl's own hair too became very soft and the color of sapphire. Then the Blessed One showed his face before her in person, and when the girl saw it, the instant she saw it she was so delighted and overjoyed that her face too became fair and beautiful, and its ugliness and coarseness vanished. The Blessed One then showed his body down to the waist, and made it shine with a radiant light like the color of gold. When the girl saw this, she was all the more delighted in the Buddha, and was filled with joy and gladness. Because she was so delighted and overjoyed, all her ugliness vanished, and she became so exceedingly beautiful and lovely that, like a daughter of the gods, she had no equal in the world.

Out of compassion for the girl, the Blessed One showed his complete body. The girl gazed at it without blinking, and was even more delighted and

overjoyed than before. All the features of her body became surpassingly fair, without equal in the world, and not the slightest trace of the habitual tendencies of her ugliness remained. The Blessed One taught her the Dharma in a way suited to her. All her evil was exhausted, and she attained the fruit of stream-entry. Then the Blessed One departed.

Right after that, the five men opened the gates and came in, and they saw that the man's wife was exceedingly beautiful and fair beyond compare. They said to one another, "This man's wife is so very fair and beautiful, and that is why he does not bring her." Having seen his wife, they shut the gates again and came back to where the others were, and, without the man noticing, tied the key back on his body.

When the man had sobered up from his drunkenness, he returned home with the others. He saw that his wife was exceedingly fair and beautiful in form, a woman very rare among human beings, and he was overjoyed. He said to his wife, "Who are you?" and his wife said, "I am your wife." Her husband said, "You were very ugly. How is it that you have become so fair and beautiful?" His wife said, "Because I saw the Buddha, my body has become like this," and she told him the whole story in detail. His wife said further, "In my heart I now wish to meet my father, the king. Please tell the king that I say this."

Her husband told the king just that, and the king declared, "Do not say such things, husband. Go quickly, shut her in, and do not let her come out."

The husband replied, "Through the blessing of the Blessed One's compassion, the king's daughter has become as fair and beautiful as a goddess."

The king said to the husband, "If it has truly come about like that, bring her here quickly." Having said this, he had a chariot adorned and welcomed his daughter into the palace. When the king saw that his daughter had become so fair and beautiful, he was overjoyed, and the king, the queen, the husband and the daughter together went to where the Blessed One was. They bowed down to the Buddha and sat down to one side.

Then King Prasenajit set his right knee on the ground and said this to the Blessed One: "What merit did this girl make in the past, that she was born into a great and high family with many possessions and riches? And what evil deed did she commit, that her form was so very ugly and her skin and hair were like an animal's?"

The Blessed One declared: "Great king, your daughter's being fair and beautiful, and her being ugly, came about from the merit and the evil deeds she did in former lives. Long ago in the past, in the land called Vārāṇasī, there lived a householder of that land who was very rich, possessing measureless wealth and riches. That householder, who had no anger in him, used to make offerings and present all that was in his house to a certain pratyekabuddha. That pratyekabuddha's body was very rough, poor, ugly and gaunt. The householder had a small daughter, and day after day, whenever she saw the pratyekabuddha coming, the girl gave rise to a reproachful attitude. Scorning and reviling him, she would say reproachfully, 'How ugly he is, with his ugly face and the rough skin of his body!'

"The pratyekabuddha always came to that house and accepted offerings. When a long time had passed, he resolved to pass into nirvāṇa. For the sake of his patron he rose into the sky above, and displayed many kinds of miracles: fire blazed from his body and water streamed from it; he vanished in the east and appeared in the west, vanished in the west and appeared in the east, vanished in the south and appeared in the north, vanished in the north and appeared in the south; he lay down and sat in empty space, and so on. He let all the people of the house see these miracles, then came down from the sky and went into the house. The householder was all the more delighted and overjoyed. The girl too was filled with deep remorse, and she said this to the pratyekabuddha: 'I confess the reproachful wrongs I committed again and again before, so that they may not become actual evil for me.' And the pratyekabuddha accepted her confession."

The Blessed One declared: "Great king, the girl at that time, on that occasion, is this daughter of the king now. Because at that time, with a nonvirtuous mind, she committed the verbal wrong of reviling the noble pratyekabuddha, from then on she always experienced an ugly body. But later, because she saw the miracles and felt remorse, she afterwards came to have a very fair form and to be endowed with intelligence. Because she made offerings to the pratyekabuddha, wherever she was born she was of a great family with wealth and riches, and in the end she has also attained liberation.

Therefore, great king, all who belong to the family of sentient beings should guard with the utmost care against faults of body and speech, and should never scorn or revile others."

At that time King Prasenajit and his retinue, and the whole great assembly, having heard the Blessed One teach the fruits of karmic maturation, came to possess faith with utterly pure intention. Because their intention was so utterly pure, some attained the fruits from the first fruit up to the fourth. Some generated the mind set on unsurpassed awakening. Some came to abide on the ground of non-returning. That whole assembly rejoiced in what the Blessed One had spoken and was delighted.

This is the seventh chapter, the chapter on Vajrā, daughter of King Prasenajit.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada, together with a saṅgha of twelve hundred and fifty monks.

At that time, in that city, the wife of a certain householder gave birth to a son, and they named him Golden Treasure. He was well formed, fair and exceedingly beautiful, without equal in the world. Because of his former deeds, the boy was born with both hands clenched into fists. The boy's father and mother were greatly amazed, and thinking it auspicious, they opened the boy's two fists and looked. In each of the boy's palms there was a gold coin. The parents were overjoyed and took both gold coins, but in the place where they had been taken, there were more coins again, and they took them again and again. Though the parents went on taking gold coins from his palms in this way until a whole storehouse was full, the coins in the boy's hands never ran out.

Later, when the boy had grown up, he said to his parents, "I am going forth," and his parents said, "We allow it, as you wish." Then the boy Golden Treasure went to where the Blessed One was, bowed his head at his feet, and said this to the Buddha: "Blessed One, out of compassion for me, will the Teacher allow me to go forth?" The Blessed One declared, "Boy Golden Treasure, I allow you to go forth." Having been permitted by the Buddha in this way, the boy Golden Treasure shaved his hair and beard, put on the robes, and became a novice.

Later, when he had reached the full number of years and was ready for full ordination, he made his request to the Saṅgha with faith, and asked for full ordination. He then bowed down in turn to the fully ordained Saṅgha, and as he bowed down to each one in order, wherever his two hands touched the ground there was a gold coin. In the same way, at every bow he made in turn, there appeared a gold coin. Having received full ordination, he cultivated diligence and became an arhat.

Ānanda said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, what merit did this monk Golden Treasure make in the past, that from the time he was first born until now he has held gold coins? Please, Blessed One, explain it."

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "Listen always, hold it well in mind, and I shall explain it to you." And Ānanda replied, "I wish to hear it just so."

The Blessed One declared: "Long ago in the past, ninety-one eons ago, a buddha called Kanakamuni came into the world, and the benefit he brought to sentient beings through the sacred Dharma was beyond telling and beyond measure. While that buddha was traveling through the land together with the Saṅgha, householders of great and high families, possessed of riches and wealth, set out food of many kinds and made offerings to the Buddha and to his close disciples, the noble Saṅgha. At that time there was a poor man who had no possessions at all, who always gathered firewood in the mountains and sold it. Later, as the price of firewood he had sold, he obtained two coins. That poor man saw the Buddha and the Saṅgha, who had been invited to the king's palace, as they were going, and was overjoyed. He offered the two coins he had to the Buddha and the Saṅgha, and the Blessed One, out of compassion, accepted the two coins."

The Blessed One said to Ānanda: "Because at that time that poor man offered two coins to the Buddha and the Saṅgha, for ninety-one eons he always held gold coins in his hands, and his wealth, jewels and the means of living became inexhaustible. The poor man at that time, on that occasion, is this monk Golden Treasure. Even if this man had not attained the fruit of an arhat, the future fruits of that maturation would still be beyond measure. Therefore, Ānanda, all sentient beings should exert themselves in the deed of giving."

At that time Ānanda and the great assembly, having heard what the Buddha had spoken, came to have faith and devotion. Some attained the fruit of stream-entry; some attained once-returning, non-returning and arhatship. Some generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Some came to abide on the ground of non-returning. The whole assembly was delighted with what the Buddha had spoken.

This is the eighth chapter, the chapter on Golden Treasure.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada, together with a saṅgha of twelve hundred and fifty monks.

At that time, in that land, the wife of a householder of a great and high family gave birth to a son who was well formed, lovely to behold, fair and beautiful. As soon as he was born, divine flowers fell like rain from the sky and filled the whole house, and so the boy was named Divine Flower. Later, when the boy had grown up, he went to where the Buddha was. When he arrived and saw the Buddha's complexion, and his major marks and excellent minor marks beyond compare, great joy arose in him, and he thought:

"Born into this world, I have met the Lord of the Noble Ones, so I will invite the Buddha and the saṅgha of noble monks." Having thought this, he said this to the Buddha: "Blessed One, I will prepare some poor alms at my house tomorrow at midday. Will you, together with the noble Saṅgha, come to receive alms?" Knowing that his intention was pure, the Buddha consented to come.

Then Divine Flower went back home, and the next day the Buddha and the Saṅgha came to his house. Divine Flower magically produced many jeweled seats inside a divine mansion, adorned with ornaments, and he invited the Buddha and the Saṅgha to be seated on those seats in order. Then Divine Flower thought of the many kinds of food that were needed, and through his merit they appeared just as he had thought, and he served alms to the Buddha and the Saṅgha. When the begging bowls had been taken away, the Buddha taught Divine Flower much Dharma at length, and all the people of Divine Flower's household attained the fruit of stream-entry.

Then Divine Flower asked his father and mother to let him go forth and go into the Buddha's presence as a disciple, and his parents allowed it. The boy went to where the Buddha was, and when he arrived he bowed his head at the Buddha's feet and asked to go forth in the Buddha's teaching. The Blessed One declared, "Welcome, monk!" and his hair and beard fell away of themselves, and he was clad in saffron robes. Following the Buddha's instructions, he practiced earnestly and became an arhat.

When Ānanda saw that this had come about, he went to where the Buddha was, and when he arrived he set his knee on the ground and said this to the Blessed One: "What merit did this monk Divine Flower make in the past, that divine flowers fall of themselves for him, and jeweled seats and many kinds of food appear by magic just as he wishes? Please, Blessed One, explain it."

The Blessed One said to Ānanda: "If you wish to hear, listen well. Long ago in the past, a buddha called Kanakamuni came into the world and brought vast

benefit to sentient beings. At that time, while a great saṅgha was traveling through the villages, householders of great and high families made offerings to them. At that time there was a poor man who had no possessions at all, and a mind of great joy toward the Saṅgha arose in him. Thinking, 'I have nothing at all to offer,' he gathered many kinds of flowers from the meadows and grassy marshes and scattered them over the Saṅgha, and with pure intention he swept the place and went away."

The Blessed One said to Ānanda: "The poor man at that time, on that occasion, who scattered flowers, is this monk Divine Flower. Because long ago in the past, with the faith of pure intention, he gathered flowers, scattered them over the Saṅgha and made an aspiration, for ninety-one eons, wherever he was born, he was well formed and fair and lovely to behold, and food, drink, seats and so forth came to him and were his just as he wished, exactly as he thought of them. Through that merit he has now attained even the fruit. Therefore, Ānanda, let no sentient being despise a small gift, thinking it has no merit. Just as for Divine Flower, everything will come and be accomplished."

Then Ānanda and the great assembly rejoiced in what the Blessed One had spoken and were delighted.

This is the ninth chapter, the chapter on Divine Flower.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time the wife of a certain householder gave birth to a son. When the boy was born, the seven kinds of precious substances fell like rain from the sky and filled his whole house. Then they called a soothsayer and had him examine the boy's marks, and he told the householder, "The boy's marks are excellent." The householder was overjoyed and asked the soothsayer to name the boy. The soothsayer asked, "What omens occurred when this boy was born?" The householder said, "When this boy was born, the seven kinds of precious substances fell like rain from the sky and filled the whole house." So the soothsayer named him for his merit, and gave the boy the name Divine Jewel.

Later, when he had grown up, he was very learned and of wide knowledge, and his skill in the arts was without equal. Having faith in going forth, he took leave of his father and mother with a parting bow and went to where the Buddha was. When he arrived he bowed his head at the Buddha's feet and said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I wish to go forth." The Blessed One granted it with the words "Welcome, monk!" and his hair and beard fell

away of themselves, and robes came to be upon his body. When the Blessed One taught him the Dharma, he became an arhat.

Ānanda said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, what merit did this monk Divine Jewel make in the past, that when he was first born jewels fell like rain from the sky, and clothing and food come to him spontaneously, so that he is never troubled by anything?"

The Buddha said to Ānanda: "Long ago in the past, a buddha called Kanakamuni came into the world, and the benefit he brought to sentient beings in the world cannot be fully told. At that time, while a great saṅgha was traveling through the villages, many householders living in the city invited the Saṅgha and made many kinds of offerings. At that time a poor man, out of faith, gave rise to a mind of rejoicing. But since he had no possessions or offerings at all, he scattered a handful of jewels made of white pebbles over the Saṅgha and made a great aspiration."

The Blessed One said to Ānanda: "The poor man at that time, on that occasion, who scattered a handful of jewels over the Saṅgha, is this monk Divine Jewel.

In a past time, merely by scattering a handful of jewels made of white pebbles over the Saṅgha with the faith of a pure intention, his merit was immeasurable for ninety-one eons: he had many precious jewels, clothing and food came to him spontaneously, and he was never in want of any enjoyment. Through nothing more than that faith of pure intention at that time, he met me when I came into the world, and he has attained the fruit, up to the very last."

Then the many in the assembly, having heard what the Buddha said, gave rise to faith of pure intention. Some attained the fruits, from the first fruit up to the fourth, and some generated the resolve to abide on the irreversible ground. All of that great assembly rejoiced at what the Blessed One had said, and were delighted.

This is the chapter of Divine Jewel, the tenth.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove, at Kalandakanivāpa. At that time, not long after the Blessed One had become fully and perfectly awakened, the five monks, Kauṇḍinya and the others, were the first to go forth. After them a thousand monks, the Kāśyapa brothers, Nadīkāśyapa and the others, went forth. Then others besides them were also made to go forth, and those abiding in the Dharma became many. The people of Rājagṛha felt boundless joy, and they praised

and extolled him, saying, "The coming of the Tathāgata into the world is wondrous and marvelous; he works the benefit of a great many ordinary people."

They also said this: "Those who first went forth, Kauṇḍinya and the followers of Nadīkāśyapa and the rest: what deeds did they share with the Tathāgata in the past, that they were the first of all to taste the nectar of the Dharma?"

When the monks heard them say this, they reported it in full to the Blessed One just as it had been said, and the Blessed One spoke to them as follows: "Long ago, in the past, I made a great vow for their sake, pledging, 'When I become fully and perfectly awakened, may I work for their benefit first of all.'"

Having heard this, the monks requested, "Out of your compassion, please explain in full how the Blessed One made that vow in the past."

The Blessed One said to the monks, "Listen closely and keep it in mind, and I shall explain it to you.

"Long ago, in the past, beyond immeasurable, countless, inestimable, inconceivable and inexpressible eons, there was a king called Kali in the land called Vārāṇasī. At that time, in that land, a sage called Patient One lived in a mountain dwelling with a following of five hundred disciples, and he cultivated patience.

"At that time the king, together with his queens, the women of his palace and his ministers, went to the mountain for pleasure. Being very weary, he fell asleep, and the palace women went on ahead, wandering about and looking at the sights and the flowers. They saw the sage Patient One sitting with his body upright, wholly absorbed in meditation. Faith in him arose in them, and they scattered all kinds of flowers over him. The queens then sat before him and listened to the Dharma.

"When the king awoke from his sleep, the queens were nowhere to be seen. He searched for them with four ministers, and when he saw the queens sitting before the sage, he said to the sage, 'Have you attained the four absorptions of the infinite sense sources?'

"He answered, 'I have not attained them.'

"The king said, 'Then have you attained the four immeasurables?'

"'I have not.'

"The king said, 'Then have you attained the four meditative concentrations?'

"He answered, 'Those too I have not attained.' At this the king grew angry. 'If you have not attained those qualities, you are just a base, common man. How can anyone trust you, sitting with women in a secluded and sheltered place? Who are you, always living here? What work do you do?'

"The sage said to the king, 'Here I cultivate patience.'

"Then the king drew his sword. 'If you say you cultivate patience, let me test whether you are patient or not!' He cut off both of the sage's hands and asked, 'Who are you?'

"He answered, 'I am the Patient One.'

"Then the king cut off both his feet, and still he said, 'I am the Patient One.'

"At that moment the place shook in six ways, and his five hundred or so disciples flew through the sky and arrived there. They said to their master, 'Experiencing such suffering, has your mind of patience not failed?'

"The sage said, 'My mind has not changed; it has not failed.'

"The king, alarmed and frightened, said to the sage, 'How could anyone believe that you are patient?'

"The sage said, 'The words I have spoken are not false. If they are true, then by that truth may the blood turn to milk, and may the severed limbs be restored and become just as they were before.' No sooner had he said this than the blood turned to milk, the limbs were restored, and they became just as they were before.

"When the king saw how patient he was, he was even more terrified, and he pleaded, 'Why did I harm the great sage? Out of compassion for me, please allow me to make amends.'

"The sage said, 'For the sake of women you took up a weapon and cut off my limbs. But my patience is like the earth, so later, when I become fully awakened, may I cut through your three poisons with the sword of wisdom.'

"At that time the nāgas and gods of that mountain, seeing that the king had harmed and injured the sage, each grew angry. They gathered clouds and brought down thunder, hail and thunderbolts, and were about to kill the king and his retinue. But the sage commanded them, 'Do not harm or injure him like this for my sake.'

"The king then made amends, and from then on he constantly invited the sage to the palace and made offerings to him.

"At that time about a thousand wandering ascetics who followed another teacher saw the king's faith and devotion toward the sage Patient One, and they became jealous. From a place where they could not be seen, they scattered dust, filth and defiling impurities over the sage.

"The thousand wandering ascetics who at that time scattered dirt over me are now the thousand monks, Nadīkāśyapa and the others. At that time I made a vow, pledging, 'By this unbroken cultivation of patience of mine, when I become fully awakened, may I wash away your dust and stains with the water of nectar, and may the filth of desire be completely purified.'

"Monks, if you wish to know who the sage Patient One was at that time, do not think it was anyone else: he is now I myself. King Kali and the four ministers are the group of five monks, Kauṇḍinya and the others. Because, while cultivating patience at that time, I pledged, 'I shall work for their benefit first,' after becoming fully awakened I first freed them completely from suffering."

The monks rejoiced at what the Buddha had said and were delighted.

This is the chapter on patience, the eleventh.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time Ānanda, having done his round for alms, sat in meditation in a grove, and this thought occurred to him: "The coming of the Buddha, the Blessed One, into the world is a great wonder, and he has established many sentient beings in perfect happiness. What roots of virtue did the group of five monks, Kauṇḍinya and the others, accumulate, that they entered as soon as the door of the Dharma was opened, that they were the first to hear as soon as the drum of the Dharma was beaten, and that they were the first to be sated with the nectar of the Dharma?"

When this thought had occurred to him, he rose from his seat and went to where the Buddha was. Arriving there, he put it to the Blessed One just as he had thought it.

The Blessed One said, "In the past, too, I gave the monks Kauṇḍinya and the others their fill of flesh and blood when they were hungry and thirsty, and made them happy. That is why, after I became fully and perfectly awakened, I established them first in liberation. It is not without cause and condition."

The venerable Ānanda said to the Blessed One, "Please explain how, in the past, you relieved them from hunger and thirst and made them happy. When

this great assembly has heard it, they will understand."

The Blessed One said, "Long ago, in the past, countless eons ago, here in Jambudvīpa there was a king called Maitrībala, who ruled over some eighty-four thousand minor kings of Jambudvīpa. That king had twenty thousand queens and ten thousand ministers. The king was endowed with loving-kindness and compassion; he practiced the four immeasurables and, being tender toward all beings, he governed by the ten virtues. He was honored by all. In his land there were no enemies, the harvests were rich, and the people enjoyed happiness and well-being.

"There were pretas that spread fevers, who stole and fed on the blood and vitality of human beings. But at that time all the people of the land guarded their body, speech and mind and abided in the ten virtues, so the savage pretas found nothing to eat. All of them went hungry and became powerless.

"At that time five yakṣas came before the king and said this: 'Our food depends on the vitality and blood of human beings; by it we sustain our bodies and our lives. But because the king has commanded it, everyone abides in the ten virtues, and we find neither food nor drink. We are exhausted and close to death. Will the king not have compassion on us too?'

"Out of compassion for them, the king cut five veins in five of the limbs of his body, and had each of the yakṣas hold out a vessel and drink its fill of the blood. Sated with blood, they were overjoyed, pleased and content. When they had had their fill of blood, he urged them, 'Practice the ten virtues as far as you are able.' And he said, 'Just as I have now drawn blood from my body and sated you and made you happy, so later, when I have become fully and perfectly awakened, may I remove your three poisons by the moral discipline, meditative absorption and wisdom of the Dharma body, and may I establish you, who are tormented by desire, in nirvāṇa, which is supreme happiness.'

"Ānanda, King Maitrībala at that time, on that occasion, is now I myself. Those five yakṣas are the five monks, Kauṇḍinya and the others. I made the aspiration that wherever I was born, I would liberate them first. That is why they were liberated as soon as I first taught the Dharma."

The venerable Ānanda and the great assembly rejoiced at what the Buddha had said and praised it highly.

This is the chapter on the generosity of King Maitrībala, the twelfth.

The third section.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Rājagṛha, at Kalandakanivāpa in the Bamboo Grove, together with a great Saṅgha of one thousand two hundred and fifty monks. At that time King Bimbisāra, having attained the first fruit, became even more intent than before on faith and on serving and honoring the Buddha, and he constantly offered the four kinds of requisites to the Blessed One and the Saṅgha of monks. Many people too, in harmony with him, took delight in virtue.

In that land the six teachers, Pūraṇa and the others, had appeared earlier. They taught wrong views falsely and led many beings astray, and those who were seen to have been corrupted trusted in those wrong views, so that the faction of the wicked grew numerous and widespread.

A younger brother of the king also trusted in the six teachers and was attached to wrong views. Taking what is not the path to be the path to liberation, he spent all the wealth he had in making offerings to them. Although the Buddha, the Blessed One, like the rising sun, made everything blaze with the light of wisdom, he was obstructed by wrong views and had no devotion toward him.

Because King Bimbisāra held him especially dear, he skillfully urged him to serve and honor the Buddha, but attached as he was to wrong views, he did not do as he was told. When the king urged him again and again, "Make offerings to the Buddha," he replied, "I have a teacher of my own. I will not serve and honor Gautama."

Yet since it was not proper to disregard the king's command, he arranged a great feast, declaring, "I shall give alms to whoever comes of their own accord without being invited." He set out the articles of offering, spread the seats, and sent an invitation to the six teachers. They arrived at once and sat at the head of the rows.

Since the Buddha and the Saṅgha did not come of their own accord, he went to where the king was and said this: "You have told me again and again to invite the ascetic Gautama. I have arranged the offering, and now that it is midday, why does he not come?"

The king said, "Even if you cannot go to invite him yourself, send a man to invite him, saying, 'It is midday.'"

So the king's younger brother sent someone to invite him, and the Blessed One came together with the noble Saṅgha and sat down in the order of the

rows. Through the Blessed One's power, the six teachers, who had been sitting at the head of the rows, found themselves at the very end. Ashamed and embarrassed, the six teachers rose and sat at the head of the rows, but without noticing it they ended up at the tail of the rows again. Three times in this way they went to the top of the rows, and still they found themselves sitting at the bottom. Powerless, they sat at the end of the rows in shame.

When the donor was about to pour water for the elder, the Blessed One said, "First pour it for your own teachers." The donor took the water vessel and poured water for the six teachers, but the mouth of the vessel was blocked and no water would come out. When he then offered it to the Buddha and the others in turn, the water came out, and they washed their hands.

When they had washed their hands, the donor took the alms food and asked for a dedicatory prayer. The Blessed One said this to the donor: "In the first place this was not done for our sake, so ask your own teachers to make the prayer." So the great donor went before the six teachers and asked them to make the prayer, but the six teachers' mouths were shut and they could not speak. They gestured with their hands, signaling, "Ask the Buddha." Then the Blessed One made the prayer in a voice like the voice of Brahmā.

When the prayer had been made, the donor was about to serve the alms food to the elder, but the Blessed One said, "First serve it, beginning with your own teachers." When the servers went to serve the six teachers, the dishes of food rose up into the sky above, and it was impossible to serve them. Then, when they set about serving the Buddha and the others instead, the food came into each one's hands. They served it in order, and when the Buddha and the Saṅgha had finished their meal and washed their mouths and hands, they sat on their seats again, and the donor requested a teaching of the Dharma.

Then too the Blessed One said, "Ask your own six teachers to teach." But the six teachers' mouths were shut, and they gestured with their hands, signaling, "Ask the Buddha." Then the Blessed One spoke in an exceedingly gentle and soft voice, analyzing and teaching the characteristics of phenomena to the great assembly. The great assembly was gladdened, and having heard what the Buddha said, all of them understood and comprehended it. The younger brother of Bimbisāra gained the pure Dharma eye with regard to phenomena. Others in the assembly attained from the first fruit up to the third, went forth, and exhausted the defilements. Some generated the resolve for unsurpassed awakening and came to abide on the irreversible ground. Since each was

fulfilled just as they had aspired, each of them knew and understood what is genuine. They had faith and devotion toward the Three Jewels and lost their faith in the six teachers, and no longer served and honored them.

Then the six teachers, utterly agitated and furious, went off to a secluded spot and fell to scheming.

Then Māra, the Evil One, thought: "For a long time I have tried to obstruct the ascetic Gautama, but I have not found an opening. Now I will obstruct him by any means."

With that thought, Māra the Evil One manifested himself in the form of Pūraṇa and went to where Maskarin Gośālīputra, Sañjayin Vairaṭṭīputra, Ajita Keśakambala, Kakuda Kātyāyana and Nirgrantha Jñātiputra were. On arriving, he set about displaying miracles before them: blazing fire, streaming water and flashing lightning. They asked, "Pūraṇa, have you attained so many qualities as these?"

He said, "I have."

Each of them thought to himself, "Apart from me alone, all of these display great magical power and great might."

Then later on the six teachers, Pūraṇa and the others, gathered in a meeting hall, and in the course of their talk they said things like this: "In former times kings, ministers, brahmins, wealthy householders, merchants and caravan leaders attended upon us, honored us and made offerings to us, and we received clothing, food, bedding and seats, medicine for illness, and requisites. But now they attend upon and honor this ascetic, the son of the Śākyas, and we no longer receive clothing, food, bedding and seats, medicine for illness, or requisites. So now we will challenge the ascetic Gautama in miracles of superhuman qualities. If the ascetic Gautama sets out to display one miracle of superhuman qualities, we will display two. If the ascetic Gautama displays two, we will display four. If the ascetic Gautama displays four, we will display eight. If the ascetic Gautama displays eight, we will display sixteen. If the ascetic Gautama displays sixteen, we will display thirty-two. However many miracles of superhuman qualities the ascetic Gautama displays, we will display double or triple that number of miracles of superhuman qualities."

Then the six teachers, Pūraṇa and the others, went to where King Bimbisāra was. Arriving before him, they said to King Bimbisāra, "May you be victorious and live long!" and then they said this:

"Your Majesty, we possess miraculous powers and profess to have knowledge, and the ascetic Gautama too professes that he himself possesses miraculous powers and has knowledge. Since it is right that one who professes knowledge should compete with another who professes knowledge in miracles of superhuman qualities, set us against him!"

At this King Bimbisāra laughed and said, "How foolish you are! The Buddha has great qualities and great magical power, and his miracles are unimpeded. For the likes of you to compete with him is like a firefly competing with the sun, or the water in a cow's hoofprint vying with the ocean, or a jackal competing with a lion, or an anthill competing with Mount Meru in height. The difference in greatness is plain to see. You holders of wrong views are utterly foolish!"

The six teachers spoke again: "The king has not yet seen the evidence that will come forth. If we compete in great miracles, it will become evident; after the contest it will be evident who wins."

The king said, "If you wish to compete, it is up to you to compete, but I fear you will be put to shame. If you do compete in miracles, let us see your miracles too."

The six teachers said, "Seven days from now we will compete in miracles. Have the place where the contest is to be held swept clean." So the six teachers spoke.

After they had gone back, King Bimbisāra went to where the Buddha was. Arriving there, he said this: "The six teachers say they will compete with the Blessed One in miracles. I tried to stop them but could not. May the Blessed One display the power of miracles, turn them back from wrong views, and establish them in virtue. And please let us see the display of miracles too."

The Blessed One said this to King Bimbisāra: "I myself know the time. Have a spacious place cleaned where the contest is to be held."

King Bimbisāra gave orders to many ministers. They swept a spacious and pleasant place, set up a lion throne, raised victory banners and pennants, and adorned it most beautifully. Since the time for the contest of miracles had thus been set, everyone hoped to see it on that day.

At that time the Tathāgata, together with the Saṅgha, left Rājagṛha and went to Vaiśālī. In Vaiśālī the Licchavis and many people welcomed the Tathāgata. Only then did the people of Rājagṛha learn that the Blessed One had gone to Vaiśālī. When they realized it, the six teachers proclaimed: "When we said,

'The ascetic Gautama cannot match us in miracles,' you did not believe us. He has fled from the time set for the contest of miracles and run off to Vaiśālī." The six teachers grew even more arrogant; each of them became elated, and they went off in pursuit of him.

At that time King Bimbisāra too had five hundred carriages made ready, and about a hundred and forty thousand of the retinue of the king and his ministers took provisions for the journey and went after the Blessed One to the land of Vaiśālī.

The six teachers also went to the land of Vaiśālī, and they said this to the Licchavis: "If you permit us to compete with the ascetic Gautama in miracles, we will hold a contest of miracles seven days from now."

Then the Licchavis went to where the Blessed One was and said this: "The great fools, the six teachers, think they have good qualities and say they will compete with the Tathāgata in miracles. May the Blessed One subdue them."

The Blessed One said, "I myself know the time."

Then the Licchavis, with the people of the land, arranged the requisites just as King Bimbisāra had. But on the day before the contest was to take place, the Blessed One, together with the Saṅgha, went to the land of Kauśāmbī. Udrayana, the king of Kauśāmbī, together with his ministers, welcomed the Tathāgata.

When the people of Vaiśālī came the next day to pay homage to the Tathāgata, they heard that he had gone to Kauśāmbī. The six teachers also heard that the Blessed One had gone, and they grew even more arrogant than before and again went to where the Blessed One was. At that time the Licchavis too had five hundred carriages made ready, and with a retinue of seventy thousand, together with Bimbisāra's retinue, they went to Kauśāmbī to watch the Buddha and the six teachers compete in miracles.

When the six teachers reached Kauśāmbī, they said the same things as before to King Udrayana: "This ascetic Gautama could not stand his ground and has fled from us. Let the king set a time for him to compete with us in miracles." Udrayana said this to the Buddha: "The six teachers say they will compete with the Blessed One in miracles. Do you know of this?"

The Blessed One said, "I myself know the time."

Then Udrayana made preparations and arrangements just as King Bimbisāra had, and the Blessed One, together with the Saṅgha of monks, went to the

land of Vargi. Śuncida, the king of Vargi, welcomed the Tathāgata together with many people. The people of Kauśāmbī only then heard that the Tathāgata had gone to the land of Vargi, and the six teachers again went after him. At that time King Udrayana, together with a retinue of eighty thousand and with King Bimbisāra and all the others, went to the land of Vargi.

Then the six teachers said to King Śuncida, "Let us compete with the ascetic Gautama in miracles." That king also made the same request, and the Blessed One said, "I myself know the time." That king too made the preparations and arrangements, and the Blessed One, together with the Saṅgha of monks, went to the land of Tikicaśiri. The king of the land of Tikicaśiri, called Indravami, welcomed the Tathāgata together with a large retinue.

At that time King Śuncida, with a retinue of fifty thousand, accompanied by King Bimbisāra and all the others, went to the land of Tikicaśiri. The six teachers too went to that land, and they clamored loudly to King Indravami, "Let us compete with the ascetic Gautama in miracles!" and he could not turn them away. Then Indravami went to where the Blessed One was and made the same request, and the Blessed One said, "I myself know the time."

Then that king too arranged the requisites, but when the time came, the Blessed One, together with the Saṅgha of monks, went to the land of Vārāṇasī. The king of that land, called Brahmadatta, welcomed the Tathāgata together with a large retinue. Only then did the people of Tikicaśiri learn that the Tathāgata had left, and the six teachers went after him. King Indravami, with a retinue of sixty thousand, accompanied by King Bimbisāra and all the other kings, went to that place. The six teachers went there after him too and made the same request to that king; that king made the same request in turn, and the Blessed One said, "I myself know the time."

Then that king too prepared and arranged the requisites, but the Blessed One, together with the Saṅgha of monks, went to the land of Kapilavastu. The Śākya clan of the land of Kapilavastu, each spreading the word to the next, all gathered together and welcomed the Tathāgata. The people of the land of Vārāṇasī only then realized that the Tathāgata had left, and the six teachers went after him. King Brahmadatta, with a retinue of eighty thousand, and all six kings, Bimbisāra and the others, together with their retinues, went after the Blessed One wherever he had gone.

When the six teachers arrived there too, they spread loose talk among the Śākya clan, saying, "When it was arranged that we compete with the ascetic

Gautama in miracles, he fled from our greater power." Then the Śākyas made the same request to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One said, "I myself know the time." Then the Śākyas too prepared and arranged the requisites, and the Blessed One, together with the Saṅgha of monks, went to the land of Śrāvastī.

At that time Prasenajit, the king of Śrāvastī, together with his retinue, welcomed the Tathāgata. The Śākyas only then realized that the Tathāgata had left, and the six teachers again went after him in pursuit. The Śākyas, with a retinue of ninety thousand, and the kings, King Bimbisāra and the others, with their retinues, filled the whole region of Śrāvastī.

When the six teachers arrived there too, they said this to King Prasenajit: "A time was set for us to compete with the ascetic Gautama in miracles, but when the time came, he slipped away and fled. Now a great assembly has gathered in the king's land, so, great king, let us compete!"

King Prasenajit laughed and admonished them, saying, "The wondrous qualities of the Blessed One are inconceivable. Why would base people like you, who know nothing at all, compete in miracles with the great king of Dharma?"

Yet the six teachers could not contain themselves and were puffed up with pride, so King Prasenajit went to where the Blessed One was and said this: "The six teachers are pressing again and again for a contest of miracles. May the Blessed One subdue them and show the distinctions of miracles."

The Blessed One said, "I myself know the time." King Prasenajit then gave orders to his ministers. They leveled and swept the place for the contest of miracles, set out an abundance of flowers and incense, set up a lion throne, and adorned it with pennants, victory banners and the like, and a great assembly gathered.

Then, on the first day of the first month of spring, the Blessed One went to the place of the contest of miracles. King Prasenajit set out articles of offering and food, and offered the Blessed One a tooth stick. When the Blessed One had used the tooth stick, he planted it in the ground. As soon as it was planted in the ground, it grew, with spreading branches and leaves, to a height of five hundred leagues. Its branches and leaves also spread out to cover five hundred leagues all around. At once flowers the size of chariot wheels grew on it, and its fruits became as large as jars holding five measures. Its roots, branches, leaves and all its parts turned into the seven precious substances,

shining and blazing in all kinds of colors, outshining even the light of the sun and moon. For whoever ate its fruit, the taste surpassed even that of nectar. Its fragrance pervaded everywhere, and all who were touched by its scent became happy and content. When a fragrant breeze touched its branches and leaves, there arose the most delightful sounds of the Dharma. All the people felt the greatest faith in the tree. Then, when the Blessed One taught the Dharma in harmony with the minds of all, very many attained the fruits and were reborn as gods.

The next day King Udrayana invited him and arranged an offering. At that time the Tathāgata emanated two mountains of jewels to his right and left. They were very high and beautiful, glittering with the colors of all kinds of jewels. All kinds of trees grew on those mountains, laden with flowers and fruit, and the sweetest sounds arose from them. On the summit of one mountain, fruits with a hundred flavors, soft and sweet, grew in abundance, and the many people ate them to their heart's content. On the summit of the other mountain grew grass, very sweet and soft, and he so arranged it that the beings born as animals ate it to their heart's content. Since the Blessed One taught them the Dharma in whatever way suited each, their minds were liberated, and because they generated the resolve for unsurpassed awakening, the number reborn as gods in the higher realms was very great.

The next day King Śuncida invited him and arranged an offering.

When the Blessed One rinsed his mouth, the rinsing water he let fall back onto the ground turned into a jewel pool. Its circumference was two hundred leagues, it was adorned with the seven precious substances, and it shimmered in many different colors. The water of that pool possessed the eight qualities, and the floor of the pool was spread with sand of the seven precious substances. It was filled with great lotuses of many kinds, each the size of a chariot wheel: blue lotuses, yellow, white and red ones, orange-red ones, butter-colored ones, and others. The fragrance of those lotuses spread everywhere and was delightful, and each excellent lotus shone with rays of light according to its own color. Their light illuminated all of heaven and earth, and the whole great assembly gazed at that jewel pool, filled with joy, and praised it. Then the Blessed One provided the necessities for the great assembly and taught the Dharma in many ways, so that they understood and realized it. Some generated the resolve for unsurpassed awakening; some attained the fruits and were reborn as gods in the higher realms; and those who generated meritorious karma were beyond measure.

The next day King Indravami set out the articles of offering and invited the Buddha. That day, on each side of the jewel pool, there were eight great channels, whose water flowed around and back into the pool itself. From the sound of the flowing water came the sound of the Dharma in its many forms: the five faculties, the five powers, the seven limbs of awakening, the noble eightfold path, the three doors of liberation, the six superknowledges, the six perfections, great compassion, great loving-kindness, the four immeasurables, and the rest. Having understood and realized that sound of the Dharma, very many attained the fruit of becoming buddhas, were reborn as gods in the higher realms, or generated meritorious karma.

The next day King Brahmadatta invited him and set out the articles of offering. That day, from the Blessed One's mouth there radiated rays of light the color of gold, which illuminated the whole of the great thousandfold world system. All the sentient beings touched by that light were freed of the three poisons and the five obscurations, and their bodies and minds were supremely blissful, just like monks in the third meditative concentration. The great assembly became devoted to the qualities of the Buddha, the Blessed One taught them the Dharma, and those who generated the resolve for unsurpassed awakening, who were reborn as gods in the higher realms, or who generated meritorious karma were countless.

The next day the Licchavis invited him and arranged the articles of offering. That day the Blessed One caused every member of that great assembly to know the thoughts of every other, and made each realize his own virtuous and non-virtuous actions as well. Each of them rejoiced and praised the qualities of the Buddha. Because they listened to the sacred Dharma from the Blessed One, they understood and realized it, and those who made aspirations to buddhahood, who attained the fruits, or who aspired to be reborn as gods in the higher realms were countless.

The next day the Śākya clan invited the Buddha. That day the Blessed One transformed each member of that assembly into a universal monarch, magically endowing each with the seven precious possessions and a thousand sons, and each saw himself honored by vassal kings and ministers. In every one of them arose wonder and marvelous delight, and in that delight the Blessed One analyzed and taught the Dharma, so that each one's mind was satisfied. Those who generated the resolve for unsurpassed awakening, some who attained the fruits, and those who were reborn as gods and humans

became countless.

The next day Śakra, that is, Indra, invited the Buddha and set out a lion throne. When the Blessed One sat upon it, Śakra made offerings on his left, and Brahmā, the king, made offerings on his right. As the great assembly sat there in silence, the Blessed One pressed the lion throne with his hand, and from the lion throne there came a great sound like the trumpeting of an elephant. Immediately five great rākṣasas appeared, dragged off the thrones of the six teachers, and smashed them. Vajrapāṇi, holding a vajra with fire blazing at its tip, brandished it over the heads of the six teachers. The six teachers, terrified, scattered and fled in shame, and some leapt into the water and died. Ninety thousand of the followers of the six teachers went for refuge to the Buddha and asked to go forth. When the Blessed One said, "Welcome!", their hair and beards fell away of themselves and they became monks. The Blessed One taught them the Dharma, each as suited him, and all their defilements were exhausted; freed from the afflictions, they became arhats.

Then the Blessed One radiated rays of light from the eighty thousand pores of his body and filled the whole of space. At the tip of each ray of light he emanated a great lotus, and upon each of those lotuses he emanated an emanated buddha with a retinue, teaching the sacred Dharma. He let the whole great assembly see such emanations, and an exceptional faith arose in them. To them the Blessed One taught the Dharma, each as suited him, and among them, from some who generated the resolve for unsurpassed awakening to some who attained the fruits, those who accumulated the merit to be reborn as gods and humans were countless.

The next day Brahmā, the king, invited the Buddha. The Blessed One manifested his body seated, majestic and radiant, so exceedingly tall that it reached up to the Brahmā gods, and with great rays of light he lit up and made bright all of heaven and earth. All of them saw him and heard his voice as well, and to them the Blessed One analyzed and taught the Dharma in its many forms, each as suited them. Of the great assembly, from those who generated the resolve for unsurpassed awakening to those who attained the fruits, those who generated the roots of virtue for rebirth as gods and humans were countless.

The next day the kings of the Four Great Kings invited him. At that time the Blessed One caused the whole great assembly to see the body of the Blessed One filling everything, from the realm of the Four Great Kings up to the Peak of

Existence. From those bodies four great rays of light emerged, and he caused the assembly to hear clearly and to see him teaching the sacred Dharma to each as suited them. An exceptional joy arose in that assembly, and because he taught them the Dharma, each as suited them, those who generated the resolve for unsurpassed awakening, those who attained the fruits, and those who generated the roots of virtue for rebirth as gods and humans were countless.

The next day the householder Anāthapiṇḍada invited the Buddha. That day the Blessed One entered the meditative absorption of loving-kindness and, while remaining seated on the lion throne like the color of gold, made his body invisible. He radiated great rays of light, and with an exceedingly gentle voice he analyzed and taught the sacred Dharma, letting the whole great assembly hear it. They generated the resolve for unsurpassed awakening and abided on the ground of non-regression. Some attained the fruits, and those who generated the merit for rebirth as gods and humans were countless.

The next day the householder Cinda invited the Buddha. That day the Blessed One entered the meditative absorption of loving-kindness and radiated rays of light the color of gold, filling the whole great thousandfold world system with light. In all the sentient beings touched by that light, every thought of the three poisons was pacified and a mind of compassion arose, so that all beings became as dear and loving to one another as fathers and mothers, or elder brothers, or younger brothers. After that he taught the Dharma in its many forms, and those who generated the resolve for unsurpassed awakening and abided on the ground of non-regression, those who attained the fruits, and those who generated the roots of virtue for rebirth as gods and humans were countless.

The next day King Śuncida invited the Buddha. That day the Blessed One sat on the lion throne and sent forth two rays of light from his navel. They rose about seven fathoms above his body, and at the top of each there was a lotus. On each lotus he emanated an emanated buddha, and from the navels of those emanated buddhas rays of light came forth, divided in two, and rose about seven fathoms; again there were lotuses, and upon the lotuses sat emanated buddhas. In the same way, step by step, he emanated others like them as far as the great thousandfold world. The whole great assembly, seeing such things, was filled with wonder, and the Blessed One taught them the Dharma, each as suited them. Those who generated the resolve for unsurpassed awakening, those who abided on the ground of non-regression,

those who attained the fruits, and those reborn as gods and humans were countless.

The next day King Udrayana invited the Buddha. King Udrayana scattered flowers over the Blessed One, and at once the scattered flowers became one thousand two hundred and fifty jeweled chariots, which lit up the whole great trichiliocosm, the three-thousandfold great thousandfold world system, and were seen by all. Then the Blessed One taught them the sacred Dharma, each as suited them, like giving medicine to the sick. Some generated the resolve for unsurpassed awakening and abided on the ground of non-regression, and those reborn as gods and humans were countless.

The next day King Bimbisāra invited the Buddha. Beforehand the Blessed One had said to the king, "King, prepare vessels for the food." When the time for the midday meal came, all the vessels filled by themselves with food of a hundred flavors in many varieties, enough for the whole great assembly, and when they had eaten it their bodies and minds were supremely at ease.

Then the Blessed One struck the ground with his hand, and in the eighteen hells immeasurable sentient beings were seen undergoing suffering, and each of them was saying, "What kind of evil did we commit in the past, that we must undergo suffering such as this?" He let the whole great assembly hear and see this, and in all of them a mind of tender compassion arose; they were so shaken and frightened that their hair stood on end. Then the Blessed One taught them the Dharma, each as suited them, and their minds were satisfied. Some generated the resolve for unsurpassed awakening, some abided on the ground of non-regression, and those who generated the roots of virtue for rebirth as gods and humans were countless. Those hell beings, through the condition of seeing the Buddha and hearing the Dharma, gave rise to a mind of deep faith, and when they died they were all reborn as gods and humans.

Then King Bimbisāra set both knees on the ground and said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, you who possess the thirty-two wondrous marks: the other marks of your body can be seen, but please show the assembly the mark of the wheel on the soles of the Tathāgata's feet." When he had asked this, the Blessed One stretched out his feet and showed the whole great assembly the mark of the wheel on his soles. The whole assembly saw the mark of the wheel on the underside of his feet, as clear as if it had been drawn, and could not tire of gazing at it. An exceptional joy arose in them, and again the king said to the Blessed One, "What merit did the Blessed One make in the past, that he came

to possess such a mark of the wheel?"

The Blessed One declared, "In times past I practiced the ten virtuous actions and also urged others to practice them; because of this I came to possess such a mark, so very clear."

Then the king again said to the Blessed One, "Please, out of your loving concern, teach how the Blessed One practiced the ten virtuous actions and how he urged others to practice the ten virtues."

The Blessed One said to the king, "Listen very attentively and keep it in mind, and I shall teach it."

"Long ago, countless and immeasurable eons in the past, here in Jambudvīpa there was a king called Rathanemi, who ruled over eighty-four thousand vassal kings. He had a hundred thousand cities and ten thousand great ministers. Although that king had twenty thousand queens, he did not have even a single son, and so the king was deeply unhappy. Thinking, 'I have no one to continue my line,' he was overwhelmed with grief. He made offerings to all the gods and spirits, and later, at another time, the chief queen, called Sulipala, became pregnant. From then on the queen became upright and wise, gentle and kind, and she delighted in establishing many beings in virtue. Later, when the months were complete, she gave birth to a baby boy, handsome in form and lovely to behold, excellent beyond the ordinary, with light shining from every pore of his body. The king, too, loved the boy so dearly that he gazed at him without ever tiring. He showed him to the soothsayers, and when the soothsayers examined his marks, good and bad, they rejoiced, saying, 'This boy is truly wondrous!' and they told the king, 'Judging by the marks of this boy, he will rule over the four continents.'

"The king, overjoyed, said to the soothsayers, 'Give the boy a name.' The soothsayers asked the king, 'When this boy entered his mother's womb, what wondrous omens occurred?' He answered, 'The boy's mother became exceptionally upright and kind, and she delighted in establishing others in virtue.' So the soothsayers named the boy Prajñāprabha, Light of Wisdom. He was consecrated as crown prince, and, endowed with a wise intelligence, he surpassed all others.

"Then, some time later, the great king died, and the ministers asked the prince to be consecrated as king. The prince told the ministers, 'I am not able to be king.' The ministers said, 'Now the great king has passed away, and apart from the prince there is no other king at all. If the prince will not be king now, whom

are we to set up as king?' The prince said, 'The people of this world practice improper and evil ways. If I carried out killing and punishment, my wrongdoing would be no small thing. But if all of you, the people of the land, are able to practice the ten virtuous actions, then I too am able to be king.' The ministers replied, 'This is good. Please ascend the throne and rule, and we shall decree that all the paths of the ten virtuous actions be practiced.' At once the prince ascended the throne, and all the people agreed to practice the paths of the ten virtuous actions and did as he commanded.

"At that time the king of the māras grew jealous, and in order to ruin the king's reign he wrote a forged letter and sent it to all the vassal kings: 'The decree issued earlier, "Practice virtue," has shown no sign of benefit even though virtue has been practiced; there is no benefit in it against my own afflictions. From now on, practice the ten non-virtues heedlessly, just as you please.' When this forged letter reached the hands of the vassal kings, they were astonished, thinking, 'Why would the great king urge us to commit evil deeds? This is not right.' Not believing it, they asked the king about it. When the king heard what they said, he was shaken and astonished. 'I gave no such command, so how could this have come about?' he thought in alarm, and the king went in person throughout all the lands to see whether the many people had changed from before or not.

"Then the king of the māras conjured by the roadside a man inside a great, fiercely blazing fire pit, crying out piteously in suffering, a sound the king was made to hear. The king went over to him and asked, 'Who are you, and what wrong have you done?' The man said, 'Because in the past I established these people in the ten virtuous actions, I must now undergo such unbearable suffering as this.' The king said, 'For one to undergo such suffering for urging others to do virtue is not in accord with the Dharma. If you undergo such suffering, then did those whom you urged to do virtue, and who did virtue, obtain the fruit of virtue?' He replied, 'They did obtain the fruit of virtue; only the one who urged them to do virtue undergoes suffering like this.' When the king heard this he was overjoyed and said, 'If others will obtain the fruit of virtue, then even if I must undergo suffering, so be it; I have no regret.' When the king of the māras heard this, he immediately made all of it vanish.

"Then the king went throughout all the lands and proclaimed the paths of the ten virtuous actions everywhere. All his subjects took delight in virtue by way of body, speech and mind, and all praised the king's qualities. At that time he came to possess the golden wheel and the seven precious possessions, and he

traveled throughout the four continents, devoting himself wholly to establishing beings in virtue.

"The great king of that time is now my father Śuddhodana. The prince's mother of that time is now my mother Māyā. King Prajñāprabha, who established many people in the ten virtues, was I myself. At that time too I myself practiced the ten virtues and established others in the ten virtues as well, and because of this the soles of my feet came to bear wheels with a thousand spokes."

Then King Bimbisāra again said to the Blessed One, "The six teachers, together with their intoxicated and corrupted followers, did not know their own measure. Attached to gain and fame, they gave rise to jealousy and challenged the Blessed One to a contest of miracles, saying, 'If the Blessed One performs one, we will perform two.' Yet although the Blessed One displayed inconceivable miracles, the six teachers could not display even a single miracle; ashamed and humiliated, they leapt into the water. I think that those who perished were utterly intoxicated and deluded."

The Blessed One declared, "Great king, it is not only now that these six teachers, wanting to compete with me for the sake of gain and fame, have thrown away their lives. In times past too, wanting to compete with me, they were parted even from body and life."

Then King Bimbisāra set both knees on the ground and said to the Blessed One, "Please tell us how, in times past, the Blessed One competed with the six teachers."

The Blessed One said to the king, "Great king, keep this constantly in mind. In times past, immeasurable and countless eons ago, here in Jambudvīpa there was a king called Mahāśakuli, who ruled over five hundred vassal kings. Although that king had five hundred queens, he had not a single son to continue his line, and so the king thought, 'I am old and frail, and I have not even one son to continue my line. If, after I have passed away, the vassal kings will not heed one another and lead out their armies, beings will die without having done any wrong, and the realm too will fall into turmoil.' Thinking this, his mind was tormented with grief and he sank into despondency.

"At that time Śakra, lord of the gods, that is, Indra, saw from afar that the king was unhappy and despondent. He came down from the sky, transformed himself into a physician, went to the king and asked, 'King, why are you so

dejected and unhappy?' The king told him everything as before. The conjured physician said to the king, 'King, do not grieve. For your sake I shall go to the snow mountains, gather many kinds of medicines from the snow mountains, and have the queens eat them, and as soon as they have eaten them all the queens will become pregnant.' When the king heard him say this he thought, 'These words dispel my grief,' and he said to the physician, 'If you can do this, that will be excellent.'

"Then the conjured physician went to the snow mountains, gathered many kinds of medicines, carried them back as a load, and returned to the king's palace. He boiled the medicines in milk and gave them to the chief queen. But the chief queen, finding the medicine foul-smelling and having no faith in it, would not drink it, and the conjured physician went back to the abode of the gods. The other, lesser queens drank that medicine, and not long after they had drunk it, each of them became pregnant. They told the chief queen so, and the chief queen, regretful and unhappy, asked, 'Is any of that medicine left?' They said, 'It is used up.' When she asked, 'Then are there at least some dregs of the medicine?' they said, 'There are dregs of the medicine.' Then the chief queen boiled the dregs of the medicine in milk and drank it, and not long after she became pregnant.

"When their months were complete, the other queens who had drunk the medicine earlier each gave birth to sons, every one of them fine and lovely to behold. The king was overjoyed and thought only of when the chief queen would give birth to her son. The chief queen too, when her months were complete, gave birth to a boy, but he was ugly in appearance, like a block of wood. The king and queen were unhappy and named the boy Stump.

"Then they raised him, and when he had grown up all his elder brothers took wives; only Prince Stump did not take a wife. At another time a hostile king led out his army and drew near. The five hundred princes too marshaled their troops and went out to attack the enemy army, but they were defeated in battle and came fleeing back to the palace. Prince Stump said to his elder brothers, 'Why have you fled in such terror?' His elder brothers said, 'We went out with the army to attack the enemy army, but we were defeated in battle and, struck down by the enemy army, we fled.' Prince Stump said, 'An enemy of that size cannot get the better of us. Bring the bow and conch of our grandfather that are now in the shrine, and I will go out to attack them.'

"That prince's grandfather had been a universal monarch. Many people together, with great effort, lifted the bow of the universal monarch and presented it to the prince. The prince took the bow and drew it, and the sound of the twanging bowstring roared like thunder and could be heard for forty leagues. Then the prince, carrying the conch and the bow, went out alone to attack the enemy. First he blew the conch, and the sound of the conch rang out like a falling thunderbolt; merely hearing it, the enemy army was terrified and all of them scattered.

"Then the prince returned, and only now did the king and queen come to love him, and they thought of taking a wife for the prince. At that time a king called Liśipaca had a daughter, said to be rarely fine in all the world. Hearing of her, the king sent messengers to ask for the girl as a bride. Showing them a handsome one among the princes, they said, 'This is the bridegroom,' and that king agreed to give his daughter. Then the king, overjoyed, arranged the preparations for welcoming the bride, and he sent Prince Stump himself to welcome his wife, instructing him, 'Do not meet your wife by day; meet her by night,' and sent him off.

"Then at another time the girl met with the other sisters-in-law, and each of them spoke of her husband's good qualities. The wife of Prince Stump also praised her husband: 'My husband is brave and his strength is equal to a wrestler's, and the flesh of his body is very soft.' The sisters-in-law said, 'Say no such thing! Your husband is extremely ugly; he is like a tree stump, so if you were to see him by day you would be horrified.' When Stump's wife heard her sisters-in-law say this, she kept it in mind. At night she lit a lamp, and after her husband had fallen asleep she brought out the lamp and looked. Seeing him to be extremely ugly, she was horrified and frightened, and at once she fled back to her parents' home."

"Prince Stump only noticed it when dawn came, and, unhappy, he took his bow and conch and set off to his wife's country to seek his wife. Having arrived in that country, he stayed with a minister, and while he was staying there, at another time, the kings of six vassal states, having heard that King Liśipaca had a fair daughter, each came with an army to ask for the girl.

"At that, King Liśipaca was unhappy. He gathered his ministers and took counsel: 'If I give this girl to one king, the others will be displeased and bear a grudge. What can be done so that these enemies will be no more?' One minister said, 'Cut this girl into pieces and give a piece to each, and they will

be satisfied.' Some ministers said, 'It would be fitting to issue this decree: "Whoever is able to turn back these armies, to him the girl will be given as wife, and half the country too will be given as a reward."' The king heeded that counsel and issued the decree.

"Then King Stump took his bow and conch and went outside the city to where the enemies were. He blew the conch and merely twanged the bowstring, and all the enemy armies were so terrified that they could not even stir to battle. Then he went into their armies, cut off the heads of all six kings, took their diadems, and gathered those armies into his own following. King Liśipaca was overjoyed. He gave him the girl as his wife and made him a great king, uniting the realms of the six kings into one. Then, with his troops, and accompanied by his wife, he returned to his own country.

"When the king heard that his son had returned, he went out to welcome him and gave the kingdom to the prince, but the prince would not accept it and handed it back to his father. He lived with his wife as before, and he asked his wife, 'Why did you abandon me in the night and flee?' She said, 'You are so very ugly that I thought you were not human, and I was afraid and fled.' Then the prince took a mirror, and looking into the mirror he saw that his own appearance was extremely ugly. He grew so weary of it that he did not even wish to look at his body, and he went into a grove and wept.

"Śakra, lord of the gods, saw him from afar, came to him and asked, 'Why are you weeping?' The king told him what had happened, and Śakra cheered him. He also gave him a precious jewel and said, 'Always wear this jewel on the crown of your head, and you will become fine and handsome like me.' So he instructed him, and as soon as the prince wore the jewel on the crown of his head, he felt that his body had become better than before. He went back into the palace, took his bow and conch, and was going off to amuse himself, when his wife, not recognizing him, said, 'Who are you? Do not touch these, lest my husband come and harm you.' He said to his wife, 'I am your husband.' But his wife did not believe it and said, 'My husband is extremely ugly. You are extremely handsome, so how can you be my husband?' As soon as the prince untied the jewel from the crown of his head, she saw him ugly again and was overjoyed. When she asked, 'Why has this happened?' the prince told her in detail why it had come about. From then on husband and wife loved each other, and the prince's name, Stump, was changed after him, and he was named Prince Sulanśan.

"Then, at another time, that prince thought, 'Now I will set out with my troops and build a palace.' Having thought this, he went to a place where the ground was broad and level and gave the command, 'Build a palace here.' Four nāga kings, transforming themselves into men, asked, 'If you build a palace here, what will you build it from?' Prince Sulanśan said, 'It shall be made of earth.' The four nāga kings said, 'Why not build it of jewels?' The king said, 'If a great palace must be built, where could one find so many jewels?' The nāga king said, 'We will offer them.' They conjured a spring on each of its four sides and said, 'If you draw from the spring on the eastern side and build with it, everything will turn to beryl. If you draw from the spring on the southern side and build with it, everything will turn to gold. If you draw from the spring on the western side and build with it, everything will turn to silver. If you draw from the spring on the northern side and build with it, everything will turn to crystal.' The prince drew from the springs just as they had said, and it turned out just so.

"Then he made a palace wall four hundred leagues in circumference, and within it he built a palace forty leagues across. The multistoried houses along the streets, the gardens and the bathing pools were also made of the four kinds of jewels. In excellence he made it like a palace of the gods. As soon as it was finished, the seven precious possessions also appeared, and he ruled over the four continents and made virtue flourish.

"Great king, King Mahāśakuli at that time is now my father, King Śuddhodana. The queen at that time is now my mother Māyā. The ugly prince Stump is now I myself. His wife was Prajāpatī. That wife's father was Kāśyapa. The six kings who led out armies wanting the girl are these six teachers. At that time too they contended with me over a beauty, and I killed them all and gathered their troops into my following. Because of this, down to the present they are jealous over gain and fame, and though they wanted to compete with me they had no miracles; since things did not turn out as they had planned, they died in the water. In this way their following of nine hundred thousand was gathered into my following and became my close disciples."

Then King Bimbisāra said to the Blessed One, "What merit did King Stump make in the past, that he came to have such great might and strength and yet was so extremely ugly?"

The Blessed One said to the king, "There is a cause and there are conditions for it, and I shall explain them."

"Long ago, countless, immeasurable eons in the past, here in Jambudvīpa, in the land called Vārāṇasī, there lived a pratyekabuddha called Sage Mountain. That pratyekabuddha suffered from a wind disorder, and for the wind disorder he needed to drink sesame oil as medicine. So he went to the house of an oil presser and begged for sesame oil. The oil presser grew angry with him and reviled and abused him, saying, 'Look at this one, with a head like a stump of wood and arms and legs like sticks of kindling! He is unfit to do any work, and he cannot even earn a single coin; he lives by begging alone!' Nevertheless, he gave him the dregs of the oil.

Having received the dregs of the oil, the pratyekabuddha came out to the door, and as he was leaving he met the oil presser's wife at the doorway. A feeling of faith in the pratyekabuddha arose in her, and she asked, 'Sir, where have you come from, and what will you do with these oil dregs?' The pratyekabuddha told her plainly just what had happened. The wife then called the pratyekabuddha back, led him into the house, took his alms bowl, filled the bowl with sesame oil, and offered it to him. Then she said to her husband, 'Offering the dregs of the oil to this man was a grave wrong on your part. Confess the fault of your words!' At her urging, the man too felt remorse and made confession, and then husband and wife, of one mind, said to the pratyekabuddha, 'Venerable one, from now on, whenever you need oil, always come to us.'

From then on the pratyekabuddha always took his oil from their house. And to repay their kindness he displayed miracles before them: rising up into the sky above, he let water stream down and fire blaze, and displayed many kinds of miracles. When the husband and wife who had offered the oil saw such miracles, they rejoiced all the more, and faith arose in them.

The man said to his wife, 'Whatever merit there is in your having offered the oil, let it be shared with me, and let us be husband and wife.' The wife replied, 'You spoke harsh words to this great being and offered him the dregs of the oil without any faith, so wherever you are born you will come out extremely ugly. How could I be your wife?' The husband said, 'I am always toiling away, doing nothing but the work of pressing oil. Why will you not dedicate the fruit of the giving together with me? I will not hear of it; you must be my wife.' The wife said, 'If I do become your wife, since you are so very ugly, I will abandon you and run away in the night.' The husband said, 'Even if you run away, I will chase after you, catch you, and bring you back.' So the husband and wife spoke to each other, and they made confession to the pratyekabuddha with

their whole body and life.

Then the pratyekabuddha said to the husband and wife, 'Because you two have given me oil, my illness is cured. So, husband and wife, say what you wish for, and it will be accomplished just so.' When he had said this, the husband and wife were overjoyed. Kneeling on the ground, they made this aspiration: 'Wherever we two are born, whether as gods or as humans, may all be accomplished as we wish.' Such was the aspiration they made.

Great king, the oil presser of that time was Prince Stump. His wife was none other than Stump's wife. Because at that time he spoke harsh words to the pratyekabuddha, saying he was like a stump, and gave him the dregs of the oil in anger, he became extremely ugly in all his births. Because he later made confession and offered fine oil, in all his births he afterward became fair and handsome. Because he offered the oil, in all his births he was endowed with might and strength and was victorious everywhere. Through that merit he became a wheel-turning king (cakravartin), ruling the four continents and enjoying the five sense pleasures as he wished. The ripening of virtuous and nonvirtuous karma never comes to nothing. Therefore, be diligent in guarding the actions of body, speech, and mind."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, King Bimbisāra and the other kings, the ministers, the fourfold assembly, and the gods, nāgas, and others who heard it attained various results. Some attained the fruit of stream-entry. Some attained the fruits of once-returner, non-returner, and arhat. Some produced roots of virtue for becoming pratyekabuddhas. Some generated the mind set on unsurpassed awakening and came to abide on the irreversible ground. The whole assembly rejoiced at what the Blessed One had said and was delighted.

This was the thirteenth chapter, on the subduing of the six teachers.

Fascicle Four.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Rājagṛha, on the mountain Vulture Peak. At that time the body of the Blessed One was seized by a chill ailment. The physician Jīvaka compounded thirty-two kinds of medicine with ghee, and each day the Blessed One took thirty-two measures of the medicine.

The wicked Devadatta, his mind filled with jealousy, had proclaimed, "I am the Buddha's equal." When he heard that the Blessed One was taking medicine, he

wanted medicine too, so as to be like the Buddha, and he ordered the physician Jīvaka, "Prepare the medicine that is given to the Blessed One for me as well, and give it to me." So Jīvaka prepared the medicine and gave it to Devadatta, instructing him, "Take four measures of the medicine each day." Devadatta asked, "How many measures does the Blessed One take each day now?" Jīvaka answered, "The Blessed One now takes thirty-two measures each day." Devadatta commanded, "Then give me thirty-two measures each day as well." Jīvaka said, "Your body is not like the body of the Tathāgata. If you consume a large amount, you will not digest it, and without doubt it will later turn into illness." Devadatta said, "I have the digestive heat to digest however much I eat. What difference is there between me and the Buddha?" And so, just like the Buddha, he took thirty-two measures of the medicine in a single day. The medicine did not digest; stabbing pains shot through all his channels, he was in torment, and in extreme suffering he cried out and wailed.

Then the Blessed One, moved by loving compassion for him, stretched out his hand from afar and stroked Devadatta's head. At once all the medicine was digested, and he was freed from the suffering of his illness. Devadatta recognized that it had been the hand of the Blessed One, and he said, "Prince Siddhārtha has studied medicine too as one of his skills, and he poses as a learned physician as well. I want none of it."

At that time Ānanda heard him say this and was deeply displeased. Kneeling on the ground, he said to the Blessed One, "This Devadatta has no gratitude for kindness. Even though the Blessed One, moved by loving compassion for him, completely cured his illness, he has turned around and, with an unwholesome mind, spoken uncalled-for words, and he constantly reviles the Blessed One."

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "It is not only now that Devadatta has given rise to an unwholesome mind toward me and intends to harm me. In times long past, too, he gave rise to an evil mind toward me and killed me."

Ānanda said to the Blessed One, "Please explain what Devadatta did in times past."

The Blessed One said, "Long ago, countless, immeasurable eons in the past, here in Jambudvīpa, in the land called Vārāṇasī, there was a king called Brahmadatta who was wrathful, fierce, and pitiless, given to great attachment and aversion, who oppressed people with evil deeds and delighted in the work of killing.

At that time the king, in a dream, saw a wild beast whose body hair was like gold, a beast from the tips of whose hairs a golden light streamed out, making everything to its right and left appear golden in color. As soon as he had dreamed this he awoke, and he thought, 'Such a thing as I have seen in my dream must surely exist. I will have the hunters search for its skin.' So he gathered the hunters and commanded them, 'In my dream I saw a wild beast the color of gold, from the tips of whose hairs a golden color, as it were, streamed out. Such a creature surely exists in this land, so search for it everywhere. Flay its skin and present it to me, and I will make your children and grandchildren happy and comfortable for seven generations to come. But if you do not search wholeheartedly, or you are lazy about it and do not find it, I will wipe you out, root and lineage.'

The hunters were deeply dismayed. They all gathered in a secluded place and took counsel together, saying, 'No one has ever seen, from ancient times on, the beast the king dreamed of. If we do not find it, then since the king's decrees are harsh, we will be killed.' Having taken counsel, they grew even more dismayed, and they said further, 'In these forests there are many venomous snakes and savage beasts. We cannot all travel long roads, staking our lives and not sparing them, to get this done. So let us send one capable man from among us to search. If that man sees it, he can then report to us. That would be best.' Having said this, they spoke to one man: 'Go and search everywhere, at the risk of your life. If you find it, we will collect wealth from our common funds and give you a great deal. And even if you do not come back, we will give it to your son and your wife.'

The man thought, 'For the sake of so many people, it is worthwhile even if I lose my body and life.' So he prepared provisions for the journey and set out to search everywhere through the fearsome mountain forests. After a long time had passed he was utterly exhausted. In the hot season of summer, he came to a place where the burning sand was knee-deep, and he collapsed from fatigue. Tormented by thirst and on the brink of death, he cried, 'Is there anyone with compassion who can be a refuge for my wretched body and life?'

At that time, on that mountain, there lived a wild beast called Kunta, the hair of whose body was the color of gold, and from the tips of whose hairs a golden light streamed out. From afar he heard the words the man had spoken, and a mind of deep tender love arose in him. He plunged his body into a place where there was a cool spring, came to the man, and held him close in his embrace. When the man had revived a little, Kunta led him to the water's edge, washed

him, gathered fruits, and had him eat.

When the man had recovered, he thought, 'This beast is exactly the one the king wants. When I was about to lose my life, he became the refuge of my life. How could I conceive the intention of killing him without having repaid even a little of his kindness? Yet if I do not get him, the hunters, together with their relatives, will all be caught up in punishment.' As he sat there unhappy, the beast asked him, 'Why are you so unhappy?' He shed tears and told him everything in detail.

Kunta said, 'Do not be unhappy about this. This skin of mine is very easy to obtain. When I reflect, though I have given up countless bodies in former lives, I never did a deed by which my body turned into merit. With the skin of this body I will save their lives.' Having said this, he felt great joy and said, 'Flay my skin without taking my life, and take it away. I give it to you without any regret.'

Then the hunter slowly flayed off the skin, and Kunta made this aspiration: 'By this merit of having let my skin be flayed and given away, and of having saved the precious lives of many people, which I dedicate to all sentient beings, may I become fully and perfectly awakened in unsurpassed awakening, free all sentient beings from the suffering of saṃsāra, and establish them in the bliss of nirvāṇa.' Such was the aspiration he made.

At that moment the great trichiliocosm, the world system of a billion worlds, shook in six ways, and all the palaces of the gods rocked and trembled. The gods, alarmed, looked down and saw that the bodhisattva had made a gift of the skin of his body. They descended from the sky, came to where Kunta was, strewed divine flowers over him in offering, and shed tears that fell like rain.

After the skin had been flayed off and the hunter had gone, blood oozed from all over that raw flesh. Eighty thousand flies, ants, and other creatures gathered on his body, and all of them fed on him. For fear that they would flee, he did not move his body at all. Having made the gift of his body, he died right there. The flies and insects that had eaten the bodhisattva's flesh also, when they passed away, were all reborn as gods in the higher realms.

Then the hunter took the skin and presented it to the king. The king was overjoyed and said, "There is nothing to equal the softness of this!" He spread it out as the mat on which he always slept, and he slept on it.

"Ānanda, understand it in this way. The wild beast Kunta of that time and that occasion is I myself now. King Brahmadatta was Devadatta. The eighty thousand insects were the eighty thousand sons of the gods who attained the fruit when I first became fully awakened and turned the wheel of Dharma. Devadatta killed me at that time too, and down to the present he still thinks, with an evil mind, of killing me."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Ānanda and the great assembly became intent on wholesome qualities. Some attained the fruit of stream-entry, some that of once-returner, some those of non-returner and arhat. Some produced roots of virtue for becoming pratyekabuddhas. Some generated the mind set on unsurpassed awakening and came to abide on the irreversible ground. They rejoiced at what the Blessed One had said and were delighted.

This was the fourteenth chapter, on the wild beast Kunta's gift of his body.

The merit of anyone who goes forth is great indeed. Whether one permits one's son, or daughter, or any of one's servants to go forth, or goes forth oneself, the merit of that is immeasurable. The merit of one who practices giving is such that one will enjoy wealth for up to ten lifetimes; but compared with being reborn a thousand times over as a god in the six levels of heaven, the merit of letting a single person go forth, or of going forth oneself, is supremely greater than the former. Why is that? The merit of giving has an end where it is exhausted, but the merit of going forth is immeasurable and endless.

Moreover, through the merit of guarding moral discipline one may become a sage endowed with the five superknowledges and enjoy the pleasures of the higher realms up to the world of Brahmā; but the merit of going forth in the teaching of the Buddha is inconceivable, and the merit does not run out until nirvāṇa.

Even if someone were to build a stūpa of the seven precious substances so tall that it reached the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, the merit of it would not match the merit of going forth. Why is that? A stūpa of the seven precious substances can be destroyed by wicked fools, but the merit of going forth cannot be destroyed. When one seeks the wholesome Dharma, apart from the Dharma of the Buddha there is no other Dharma superior to it.

For example, suppose a skilled physician opened the eyes of a hundred blind people and made them all see at once; and further, suppose that when a

hundred people were about to have their eyes gouged out, a person of power freed them from having their eyes put out. The merit of these two people would be immeasurable; nevertheless, it would not match the merit of letting another go forth or of going forth oneself. Why is that? The giving of eyes to those people by these two persons only lets them see worldly benefit and happiness, and the nature of the eye of flesh is a perishable nature. But when one lets another go forth or goes forth oneself, then, as one person teaches and leads another, the realm of sentient beings will come, until the end of the eon, to have the unsurpassed eye of wisdom, and the nature of the eye of wisdom is not to perish throughout the eon. Through that merit, one experiences among gods and humans, as one wishes, pleasures and enjoyments that never run out and have no end, and in the end one also becomes fully awakened. Why is that? The Dharma of going forth does away with the retinue of Māra and keeps up the lineage of the Buddha. It does away with evil, unwholesome qualities and gives rise to wholesome qualities. It does away with the stain of wrongdoing and gives rise to deeds of unsurpassed merit. Therefore the Blessed One has said, "The merit of going forth is loftier than Mount Meru, deeper than the ocean, and vaster than the sky."

If anyone obstructs and hinders another's going forth, so that it does not happen as that person intended, that very grave wrongdoing is like a person who goes into a dark place and sees nothing at all. The ripening of that person's evil is just like that: he falls into the hell of utter darkness, the great black darkness where nothing can be seen. Just as all the rivers and streams flow down into the ocean, so it is with the ripening of that person's evil: all faults gather in his body. Just as Mount Meru, when the fire at the end of the eon arises, is burned up without remainder, so he too is burned up by the fire of hell without remainder; it is just like that.

If one permits another to go forth, or goes forth oneself, the merit of that is very great. Going forth becomes the cause of nirvāṇa: with the utterly pure water of the sūtras one washes away all the stains of the afflictions and completely clears away the suffering of saṃsāra. With the feet of the Vinaya one walks upon the utterly pure ground of moral discipline; with the eye of the Abhidharma one sees the virtue and evil of the world; and one travels as one wishes on the noble eightfold path and reaches the city of nirvāṇa. Therefore, whether old or young, if one goes forth, or permits another to go forth, or goes forth oneself, the merit of that is supremely great.

At that time the Blessed One was staying at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove at Kalandakanivāpa. At that time in Rājagṛha there was a householder called Śrījāta, who was a hundred years old. He heard that the qualities of going forth were immeasurable in this way, and he thought, "Why should I not go forth in the teaching of the Buddha?" Having thought this, he told his wife, his sons, and his servants, "I am going forth."

Because the man was decrepit with age, everyone in his household was weary of him, and thinking, "He is of no use," when they heard him say, "I am going forth," they were glad and said, "It is high time you went, and quickly!"

So the householder left his home and went to the Bamboo Grove to request ordination from the Blessed One. When he arrived at the Bamboo Grove he asked the monks, "Where is the Buddha, the Blessed One, the one of great compassion, who works extensively for the benefit and welfare of gods and humans?" The monks said, "The Buddha, the Blessed One, is traveling about for the benefit of many beings and has gone elsewhere." The householder then asked the monks, "Who is foremost in learning and wisdom among the retinue of the Buddha, the great Teacher?" The monks pointed him out, saying, "It is the venerable Śāriputra."

Leaning on his staff, the old man went to where Śāriputra was. When he arrived, he set down his staff, bowed, and said, "Venerable one, please let me go forth." The venerable Śāriputra examined him and thought, "This householder is old, so he will fall short in the three activities, study, meditative concentration, and the work of the Saṅgha, and will not be able to manage them." Having thought this, he said, "Go back. You are decrepit with age, and your time has passed. It is not proper for you to go forth." So he told him.

Then he went in turn to Mahākāśyapa, Upāli, Aniruddha, and all the other arhats and made his request. Every one of them asked him, "Have you not already asked someone before?" "Earlier I asked the venerable Śāriputra." "Then what did he say?" "He said, 'You are decrepit with age and your time has passed, so it is not proper for you to go forth.'" Then those monks said, "If even Śāriputra, foremost in learning and wisdom, did not permit it, we too are of the same view and do not permit it. For example, when a skilled physician, expert in the healing art, examines a patient and gives him up without treating him, the other, lesser physicians will not treat him either, because they understand that he has the signs of certain death. Since even Śāriputra, who is endowed with intelligence, did not permit it, the other monks too are of the

same view and do not permit it." So they told him.

Since the monks would not permit him to go forth, the householder left the Bamboo Grove, sat down on the threshold of the gate, raised a loud cry, and sat there lamenting: "Since I was first born I have committed no great wrong, so why will they not let me go forth? Even people like Upāli, who comes from the barbers, and the sweeper who throws away filth, and Aṅgulimāla, who killed countless people, and Asika, and other such wicked bandits have gone forth. What fault do I have, that they will not let me go forth?"

Then the Blessed One went to him. When he revealed his form, it shone forth brilliantly with rays of light; adorned with the major and minor marks, he appeared like the banner of the seven precious substances of Śakra, lord of the gods. He said to the householder Śrījāta, "Why are you weeping?"

At that time, when the householder heard the Buddha's voice, which was like the voice of Brahmā, he was overjoyed, delighted, and elated, as glad as a child who sees its mother. Touching the five points of his body to the ground, he bowed to the Buddha and said, "Among sentient beings, even base people who kill, who commit robbery, who tell lies, and who slander others go forth. What real sin do I alone have, that I am not permitted to go forth in the teaching of the Buddha? Everyone in my household too has grown weary of me because I am decrepit with age, and they say I am of no use. So if I am not permitted to go forth in the Buddha's teaching, even if I go back home they will surely not let me into the house. I have nowhere at all to go, and this very day I shall certainly lose my life."

Then the Blessed One said to the householder Śrījāta, "Who is it that, raising his hand to the sky, declares with certainty, 'This one may go forth; this one may not go forth'?"

The householder said, "Blessed One, it was Śāriputra, foremost in learning in the retinue of the king who turns the wheel of Dharma, the greatest after the Buddha, the caravan leader of the world, who would not permit me to go forth in the teaching."

Then the Blessed One, with great compassion, just as parents speak gentle words to a deeply devoted son, encouraged the householder Śrījāta and said, "Do not grieve. I will let you go forth. It was not Śāriputra who practiced hardships with diligence for three countless eons and made merit for a hundred eons. Nor was it Śāriputra who, in all his lives, practiced what is so very hard to do, giving away as gifts his head cut off, his eyes torn out, his

bones, his marrow, his flesh, his blood, his skin, his feet, his hands, his ears, and his nose cut off. It was not Śāriputra who gave his body to a tigress, leapt into a fire pit, had a thousand iron nails driven into his body, and had a thousand lamps set into his body. It was not Śāriputra who performed acts of giving of lands, cities, wives, sons, male servants, female servants, elephants, horses, and the seven precious substances. It was not Śāriputra who, in the first countless eon, served eighty-eight thousand buddhas; in the middle countless eon, served ninety-nine thousand buddhas; and in the last countless eon, served one hundred thousand buddhas, and having gone forth, brought the perfection of moral discipline to completion. Since Śāriputra is not master of the Dharma, why does he say, 'This one is unfit to go forth'? I alone am master of the Dharma. Upheld by the six perfections and wearing the armor of patience, I sat on the vajra seat at the foot of the tree of awakening, subdued the hosts of Māra, and became fully awakened. There is no one equal to me."

"Therefore, follow after me, and I will let you go forth." When the Blessed One had encouraged him in this way by various kinds of skillful means, all his grief subsided, great joy arose in his mind, and he went to the monastery following after the Buddha.

Then the Blessed One said to Mahāmaudgalyāyana, "Let this householder go forth." Why was that? Sentient beings are trained by the one with whom their karma accords. Those whose karma accords with the Buddha are not trained by anyone else, and those whose karma accords with another are not trained by the Buddha either. Those whose karma accords with Śāriputra are not trained by Maudgalyāyana, Kāśyapa, Aniruddha, Nabun, or any of the other close disciples. In the same way, whoever's karma accords with a particular one is not trained by anyone else.

At that time Maudgalyāyana too thought, "This householder is decrepit with age and will not be able to learn recitation, practice meditative concentration, or do the work of the Saṅgha; he will fall short in the three activities." Yet since the Blessed One, the king of Dharma, had said, "Let him go forth," he thought, "It would not be proper to refuse," and so he let him go forth and gave him full ordination.

In his former lives this man had produced the cause for becoming liberated. Caught by the hook of the Dharma, just as a fish that has taken the hook is certain to be drawn out, he had produced the cause of liberation and had also gathered a store of virtue. So he applied himself with diligence day and night,

trained in reading and recitation, and came to understand and realize the sūtras, the Vinaya, and the Abhidharma extensively. But because he was decrepit with age, he was unable to properly perform the services, the acts of respect, the receiving and seeing off, the speaking courteously to his elders, and the bowing.

Thereupon some young monks who had gone forth earlier and so held higher seniority thought, "This old monk is proud of his recitation, his reading, and his learning, and he shows us no respect," and they harassed him constantly. Then the old monk thought, "When I lived at home I was tormented by my wife and sons. I thought that once I had gone forth I would be free of such things. Now once again I am tormented by these young monks. What wrong did I do in the past, that I am afflicted by suffering like this? Now I might as well die."

Having thought this, he went to the bank of a great river that flowed beside that grove. He took off his Dharma robes and hung them on the branch of a tree, knelt on the ground, shed tears, and made this vow: "I am not forsaking the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha; I am giving up this body alone. By the merit of the giving I have practiced, the moral discipline I have guarded, the diligence I have undertaken, and the sūtras I have recited, when I have parted from this body, may I be born into a family that is powerful and rich, endowed with wealth, and with a harmonious household; may no one obstruct my entering into wholesome Dharma; may I always meet with the Three Jewels; may I go forth and apply myself to the Dharma; may I meet a learned teacher; and may he show me how to pass into nirvāṇa." Such was the vow he made. Then, where the water flowed fiercely, deep and swirling in eddies, he made ready to leap boldly in.

At that moment Maudgalyāyana, wondering, "What is my old disciple doing now?", looked with his divine eye and saw that his disciple was leaping into the water. Before he reached the water, Maudgalyāyana caught him up by the power of his miraculous ability, set him down on the riverbank, and asked, "Son of the Dharma, what are you doing?"

The old man was now ashamed and embarrassed, and he thought, "How shall I answer? If I tell a lie and deceive my teacher, then because I have deceived my teacher I shall carry, in all my lives, the fault of being without the faculty of the tongue. And even if I tell a lie, my teacher has superknowledge, so he will see through it. In the world, one who has learned wisdom and is by nature honest and free of guile will be honored by the gods. One who has learned

wisdom but has some guile is not fit to be a teacher of others, though he will be honored by humans. One who has no learning but also no guile and is honest, though he cannot work for the benefit of others, will work for his own benefit. One who is a dull fool, full of delusion, and has guile as well is a vicious enemy to all; whatever he says, people say, 'This is a lie; it is a deception.' Even when he speaks a true word, no one believes him. Therefore it would be wrong and unseemly for me to lie to my teacher and deceive him; I will speak the truth." Having thought this, he said to his teacher, "Weary of the household, I went forth from home into homelessness. If I may tell the truth, I have now become unhappy again, and I thought to kill myself."

When Maudgalyāyana heard him say this, he thought, "Unless I frighten him with the terrors of birth and death, his going forth will come to nothing." Having thought this, he said to him, "Hold fast to the hem of my Dharma robe and do not let go." Then he rose up into the sky above, as easily as the wind blows away a feather, as easily as one carrying a single hair in one's hand by miraculous power, and so he went. And again, just as a hawk carries off a sparrow chick, he rose into the sky by Maudgalyāyana's miraculous power, and in the time it takes a man to bend his outstretched arm or stretch out his bent arm, he reached the shore of the ocean.

On that ocean shore lay the corpse of a woman who had just died, very lovely and fair, finely adorned, and endowed with every fine feature. A snake was entering its mouth and coming out through its nose, entering through its eyes and coming out through its ears. Maudgalyāyana examined it closely.

Then the monk Śrījāta asked, "Who is this woman, endowed with such fine features?" Maudgalyāyana said, "When the time comes, I will show you," and they went on again. There a woman had set up a great copper cauldron, poured water into it, and kindled a great fire beneath it. When the water boiled, she took off her clothes and went into it. At once all her hair and body hair came away, her flesh was cooked, and her bones too came apart, and the boiling water cast the bones out. When the wind blew upon those bones again, at once she became a person once more, and Śrījāta saw her take the flesh out of the cauldron and eat it.

The monk Śrījāta was terrified, and his hair stood on end. He asked, "Master, who is this who eats her own flesh?" Maudgalyāyana said, "When the time comes, I will show you."

Going on further, he heard a great tree being devoured by a multitude of worms, so many that between its leaves and branches there was not even a needle point's worth of empty space, and from it came the sound of loud weeping and wailing, resounding everywhere like the sound of the hells. He asked, "Who is this, with such a dreadful sound?" Maudgalyāyana said, "When the time comes, I will show you."

Then again he saw a man surrounded in a ring by many hungry ghosts with human bodies and the heads of beasts of prey. They held bows and arrows in their hands, and all of them shot arrows like blazing fire at that man, so that he was one single mass of flame. He asked, "Who is this, who undergoes such unbearable suffering and yet has no place to flee?" The master told him, "Wait a while. When the time comes, I will show you."

Then, going on further, after a long while, at the foot of a great mountain swords and sharp weapons had been planted with their edges pointing upward. A man ran down from the summit of the mountain and, as he went, he was pierced and slashed by the swords and weapons; yet the swords and weapons stayed planted in the ground, and he kept running like that without respite. Seeing this, Śrījāta asked, "Who is this?" The master told him, "When the time comes, I will show you."

Then, going on again, there was a great mountain of bones, seven hundred yojanas high, which blocked out even the sun and darkened the ocean with its shadow. Maudgalyāyana climbed it and went back and forth upon a single rib bone. Seeing that he himself had gone along following behind, Śrījāta thought, "Lest I become separated from the master, I shall ask about those things I saw before." So he said, "Master, please explain to me those things I saw before."

Maudgalyāyana replied, "Now the time has come, and I shall explain them to you. If you wish to know about the woman you saw first, she was the wife of a man of Rājagṛha called Great Sarphak. Because she was beautiful, her husband loved her exceedingly. At that time, when Sarphak was setting out onto the great ocean, he could not bear to leave his wife behind, so he took her with him and went out to sea with about five hundred merchants. Then his wife would constantly bind three sticks together at the top to make something like a spear stand, set a mirror on it, and look into the mirror; seeing how beautiful she was, she conceived intense attachment. Then a great turtle from the ocean crushed the ship, the ship broke apart, and all the five hundred or so merchants died. By the very nature of the ocean, a corpse does not remain in

it overnight: the water cast her out and she came to the ocean shore. When beings die, they are born wherever they are attached."

Then the question was put, "In that case, who would delight to be born in the hells, that so many come to be born in the hells?"

He said, "Those beings who steal the wealth of the Three Jewels, or steal their parents' possessions, or commit the grave misdeed of taking human life, fall into the great Blazing Hell. Such a person, seized by a wind disorder or a cold disease, longs in his mind for fire. As soon as he thinks of going into the fire, he dies and goes to the Blazing Hell.

"Those who steal the lamps or jewels offered to the Buddha, or steal the lamps or firewood of the Saṅgha, or tear down the dwellings of the Saṅgha, or tear down a hall where the Dharma is taught, or snatch other people's clothing in the cold of winter, or, having the power to do so, strip the clothes from male or female servants or other people out in the freezing wind and pour water over them, or strip and seize others' clothes, fall through this wrongdoing into the Chabdrom Hell. Such a person, tormented by a fever, constantly thinks of a cool and cold place, and because he longs for cold, as soon as he dies he is born in that hell. The Utpala, Padma, Kumuda and Puṇḍarīka hells are just the same. When beings undergo suffering in the cold hells, the flesh of their bodies cracks and splits into mouthful-sized pieces like grain bursting as it is roasted, and their heads and bones too crack and split into a hundred thousand fragments.

"Those beings who are miserly, who cut off others' livelihood and abandon them to hunger, and who do not give food at the proper time, fall into the realm of the hungry ghosts. Such a person is struck by an illness in which food will not stay down and he is nauseated. When his nurses or friends prepare many kinds of food and earnestly show them to him, saying, 'This one is sweet, this one is sour, this one is delicious, this one is easy to digest,' the sick man feels nauseated and thinks, 'Will there ever come a time when my eyes do not have to see this food?' As soon as he dies at that time, he falls among the hungry ghosts.

"Those beings who are dull and deluded, who have no faith in the Three Jewels, and who denigrate the noble ones are born in the animal realm. When such a person is tormented by illness, he writhes and cannot lie down, cannot lie down even for a moment, and he does not want to hear pleasing talk of virtue. His nurse, knowing that he will certainly die, urges him, 'Listen to the

Dharma! Take up the moral precepts! Look upon the sacred images and the Saṅgha, and make offerings to them!' But he has no faith and is displeased, and when he is urged insistently he grows angry and says, 'What harm would there be if I went somewhere I would never even hear the names of the Three Jewels and of virtue?' As soon as he dies, he is born in the animal realm."

"As for those who strive in virtue that is a cause for birth as gods and humans, they are not severely tormented even by illness, and when they die their minds are not disturbed. When their nurses and friends realize that they are dying, they urge them, saying, 'Do you wish to hear the sacred Dharma? Do you wish to see the sacred images? Do you wish to listen to sūtras or verses from the monks? Would you be glad to take up the moral precepts? Would you have the faith to offer your possessions to the Buddha and the Saṅgha?' If the person answers that he has faith in all of these, they speak further to the sick person: 'Moreover, if you make offerings to an image of the Buddha, you will attain awakening. If you venerate the Dharma and offer your possessions to it, then wherever you are born, in every place, you will be endowed with understanding, and you will grasp and realize the characteristics of the Dharma. If you make a gift of your possessions to the Saṅgha, then wherever you are born you will be endowed with jewels and great wealth, just as you wish.' The sick person is overjoyed, delighted and content, and makes the aspiration, 'In all my births may I meet the Three Jewels and hear the Dharma, and having heard it, may I grasp and realize it.' When he dies, he is born among humans.

"Whoever has developed vast virtue that becomes a cause for birth as a god, a person who practices generosity, whose moral discipline is pure, who delights in listening to the Dharma, and who practices the ten virtues, when he dies he lies at ease and sees images of the Buddha, the palaces of the gods and the daughters of the gods, and hears the music of the gods. His complexion is very fine, he raises his hands upward, and when he dies at that time he is born in the abode of the gods.

"The wife of the householder Sarphak was attached to her own body, so as soon as she died she was reborn as a snake in that very woman's body, and when she dies from that snake's body she will undergo the immeasurable sufferings of the great hells."

The monk asked the master again, "Who is that woman who eats her own flesh?"

Maudgalyāyana said, "In Śrāvastī there was a laywoman who had a maidservant. That laywoman invited a monk of pure moral discipline to receive her offerings for the three months of the summer rains. She made a dwelling for him in a secluded spot and housed him there, and every day she prepared all kinds of food with a hundred flavors and fine fragrance, and at the midday mealtime she sent the maidservant to bring it to him. When the maidservant had gone to a lonely place, she ate the delicious food and offered the leftovers to the monk. Later the laywoman saw that the maidservant had a fine complexion and had put on flesh, and she asked her, 'Have you not been making leftovers of the food offered to the monk?' The maidservant said, 'My lady, I too have at least a little faith in my heart. Since I hold no wrong views, why would I make leftovers of the food offered to the monk? I eat only the leftovers the monk has not finished. If I have eaten it, then wherever I am born, may I eat my own flesh!' Because of that cause and that condition, she first undergoes this terrible ripening, and then she will go on to undergo immeasurable suffering in the great hells."

The monk asked, "Who is that great tree, devoured by many worms, from which a great and dreadful sound resounds?"

He said, "That is the monk called Lita, who was the Saṅgha's administrator. He made use of the Saṅgha's property, ate its flowers and fruit, and gave its drinks to the side of the householders. Because of this, he undergoes this terrible ripening, and as soon as he dies he will be born in the great hells. The worms devouring the tree are the people who received what that monk gave them."

The monk asked again, "Who is that man surrounded by many people, struck with arrows until his body is one mass of flame?"

Maudgalyāyana said, "That was a man who went hunting and killed many wild animals, and so he has come to experience suffering like this. Then, when he passes from that life, he will be born in the great hells, and the time of his release from them will be very hard to reach."

The monk asked again, "Who is that who runs on the great mountain onto the points of swords and weapons?"

Maudgalyāyana said, "That was a very brave minister of a king, who would at times charge onto the points of sharp weapons, swords, spears and javelins. Then, when he passes from that life, he will undergo suffering for a long time in the great hells."

The monk asked again, "Whose is that great mountain of bones?"

Maudgalyāyana said, "If you wish to know, those are the bones of your own former bodies."

When the monk heard this, he was terrified. All his hair stood on end and sweat broke out on him, and he said to the master, "Before my heart bursts, please explain the causes and conditions of my past karma."

Maudgalyāyana said, "Birth and death in saṃsāra have no end and no limit, and good and evil karma do not perish and come to nothing, so one will certainly experience the ripening of whatever karma one has done.

"Long ago, in times past, here in Jambudvīpa there was a king called Dharmodgata. He delighted in generosity and moral discipline, was devoted to listening to the Dharma, had a mind of great compassion, was by nature not fierce, and did not take the lives of living beings. He bore the marks of a king and ruled according to the sacred Dharma. When he was about twenty years old, on one occasion, while he was playing chess with someone, a man committed a grave offense. The ministers asked him, 'A man has committed a grave offense against the law. What should be done?' The king was absorbed in the chess game, and so he ordered, 'Deal with it according to the law.' The ministers applied the law, it came to execution, and they killed the man. When the king had finished playing chess, he said to the ministers, 'Where is the man who committed the offense? I shall judge his case.' The ministers said, 'We applied the law and have put him to death.' When the king heard them say this, he fainted and fell to the ground. The ministers sprinkled him with water, he got up again, and, shedding tears, he said this:

"The palace grounds, the elephants, the horses, the seven precious things and all the rest will be left behind here, and I alone shall go on to undergo the sufferings of the hells. Even before I became king, kings ruled from this palace and dwelt in it, and if I die before long, others will likewise rule from it. Since I have killed a man, I am a king of ignoble kind. Where will I go in all my births? Now I no longer want to be king." Having said this, the king gave up the royal office and lived in the mountains, guarding himself.

When that king died, he was born as a sea monster in the great ocean, with a body seven hundred yojanas long. Whether king or minister, whoever gains power and might and takes the lives of living beings, or does deeds against others' wishes, or does deeds that harm living beings, is for the most part born

as a sea monster as soon as he dies, and many worms live in its body. Because its body itches, it rubs and scrapes itself against a mountain of crystal, and the blood of the many worms that die turns the ocean red for about a hundred krośas. Through that evil karma, when those worms pass from that life, they fall into the great hells.

When that sea monster falls asleep, it wakes only once in a hundred years. Tormented by hunger and thirst, it opens its mouth, and the ocean water pouring into its mouth is like a great river flowing into the sea. At that time about five hundred merchants had set out on the ocean to fetch jewels, and they met the sea monster with its mouth gaping. Their ship sped very swiftly toward the mouth of the sea monster, which wanted to devour it. The merchants cried out loudly and wept, and said to one another, "We are certainly going to die. Let each of you call to mind whatever he relies upon." When this was said, some of them recited the names of the Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha. Others called out the names of the gods of the world, of mountains and rivers, of asuras, of father and mother, wife, son, daughter, brothers and kinsfolk, and said, "After seeing it this last time today, we shall never see Jambudvīpa again."

Then, when they were on the very point of going into the sea monster's mouth, all of them at once cried out, "Homage to the Buddha!" As soon as the sea monster heard the sound of the words "Homage to the Buddha," it closed its mouth, the inflow of water was cut off, and those merchants were saved from death. The sea monster died right there of hunger and was born as a worm in Rājagṛha. The sea monster's corpse was cast up on the ocean shore, scorched by the sun and soaked by the rain, and when its flesh was gone, its bones became this mountain.

"Śrījāta, understand it this way: at that time, on that occasion, you were King Dharmodgata. Through the condition of having killed a man, you were born as a sea monster in the great ocean. Now that you have once again obtained a human body, if you do not turn your back on saṃsāra, then as soon as you pass from this life you will go to the hells, and it will be very hard to be freed."

The monk Śrījāta saw his own former body, and when he heard this explanation he was terrified of saṃsāra. He gradually brought to mind the Dharma he had been diligently practicing and settled his mind in one-pointedness. By seeing his former body he came to understand the truth of impermanence, realized what it is to turn one's back on saṃsāra, exhausted

all the defilements of the afflictions, and became an arhat.

Maudgalyāyana too was overjoyed and said, "Son of the Dharma, you have accomplished everything to be done. Coming here before, you came through my power. Now you will go back by your own power." Having said this, Maudgalyāyana rose into the sky above, and the monk Śrījāta came along behind the master, like a fledgling following its parent bird, and they came to where the Bamboo Grove was.

At that time, since the young monks did not know that he was an arhat, they ridiculed Śrījāta as before, yet his deportment did not waver and he said nothing at all. The Blessed One, knowing how things stood, so that the young monks would not come to harm through this, and in order to make the elder monk's qualities known, told the monk Śrījāta in the midst of a great assembly, "Come here," and asked, "Did you go to the ocean shore?"

Śrījāta replied, "I went to the ocean shore."

"Tell what you saw on the ocean shore," the Blessed One said, and the monk related in detail everything he had seen. The Blessed One gave his approval, saying, "Excellent, excellent! Śrījāta, what you saw is true. Now that you have completely abandoned the suffering of saṃsāra and attained the bliss of nirvāṇa, you have become an object of veneration for the world with its gods and humans. Monk, you have fully completed all that was to be done."

When the young monks heard the Blessed One say this, they were filled with deep remorse and unhappiness, and they said, "Lacking wisdom, we have harmed and ridiculed such a learned and wise noble one. The ripening of this misdeed will come upon us." The young monks went to where the monk Śrījāta was, prostrated with the five points of the body touching the ground, and said this: "Holy beings are born together with compassion, and you, venerable one, were born together with great compassion. So, out of kindness toward us, we confess to you."

The monk replied, "I hold no displeasure even toward my own body. May you be purified."

Then the monk Śrījāta, recognizing that those young monks were deeply remorseful and had minds full of respect, taught them the sacred Dharma. Having heard the Dharma of turning one's back on saṃsāra, they practiced with diligence and effort, exhausted all the defilements of the afflictions, and became arhats.

Then the householder Śrījāta too became very famous in Rājagṛha. Everyone was amazed and said, "Even an old householder who knew nothing at all went forth in the Buddha's teaching, became an arhat, and teaches such sacred Dharma as this!" At that time most of the people living in Rājagṛha gave rise to minds of pure intention. Some gave permission for their sons, daughters, male servants, female servants and others to go forth, and some requested to go forth themselves. All of them were overjoyed and rejoiced.

Therefore the qualities of going forth are immeasurable and beyond counting. If even someone like Śrījāta, going forth at a hundred years of age, came to possess such great qualities, what need is there to speak of a young person in the prime of youth who goes forth finding the great, supreme and excellent fruit? Those who strive in the Dharma should go forth.

This is the fifteenth chapter, In Praise of the Qualities of Going Forth.

The fifth section.

Those who guard moral discipline would rather lose body and life than ever let their moral discipline decline. Why is that? Moral discipline is the root of entering awakening, the supreme undefiled thing, the path that leads in bliss to nirvāṇa. The merit of guarding moral discipline purely is immeasurable and beyond reckoning. Just as the great ocean is immeasurable and boundless, so too the merit of guarding moral discipline is immeasurable and boundless.

Just as the ocean is the abode of asuras, turtles, sea monsters and great creatures belonging to the class of water beings, so too is moral discipline: many great beings who abide in the three vehicles dwell in it.

Just as in the great ocean there are many jewels such as gold, silver and beryl, so too in the ocean of moral discipline there are many jewels: the ground of impermanence, the thirty-seven factors of awakening, meditative concentration, samādhi and the rest.

Just as the floor of the great ocean is vajra and its shore is encircled by a band of vajra, so that although the four great rivers flow into it, it neither diminishes nor overflows, so too is the ocean of moral discipline: the Vinaya, like vajra, forms its floor, the band of the Abhidharma encircles its shore, and although the four collections of sūtras flow into it like rivers, it neither increases nor diminishes.

If one asks why the ocean does not overflow, it is because the fire of the Avīci hell dries the ocean up; that is why the waters of the ocean do not overflow.

Because the rivers flow into it constantly, it does not diminish. So too the ocean of moral discipline does not swell, because of heedfulness, and does not diminish, because it is endowed with good qualities. Therefore one should understand that the qualities of whoever guards moral discipline are exceedingly many.

After the Blessed One had passed into nirvāṇa, in a country called Anta there lived a monk who lived on almsfood, who delighted in dwelling in the wilderness and was endowed with fine deportment. A monk who lives on almsfood is praised by all the buddhas, and does not live among the crowd. Why is that? A monk who lives on almsfood has few desires and is content. He hoards nothing, eats a single meal a day, lives without a roof, keeps only the three robes, and practices the like. He is venerable; he is foremost. A monk living in the midst of the Saṅgha who has many desires, is not content, is miserly and is attached to everything does not win great renown.

That almsfood monk was endowed with good qualities and conduct. He had attained the fruit of a monk and abided in the six superknowledges, the three knowledges and the eight liberations, and because his deportment was beautiful in every respect, he became renowned everywhere.

At that time, in the country called Anta, there lived a layman endowed with good qualities, who had great faith in the Three Jewels and guarded the five precepts: not taking life, not taking what is not given, not engaging in sexual misconduct, not telling lies, and not drinking liquor, the intoxicating drink. That layman thought, "I will come to experience the merit of providing that almsfood monk with his sustenance for a whole lifetime." He thought further, "If I invite him to my house, he will be troubled on the road by cold and heat, and that will become an obstacle to his meditation; and later, when I experience the ripening, I would obtain it only by thinking about it and striving for it. If I deliver his sustenance to his dwelling, then later I will obtain the ripening as well without needing to strive for it." Having thought this, the layman, with a mind of faith, set out all kinds of food with a hundred flavors, fine fragrance and color, and had it delivered every day.

To judge whether monks are good or bad is difficult, in four ways, just as it is difficult to judge whether a mango is ripe or unripe. Some monks have very beautiful deportment, walk with slow steps and look no further than a yoke's length ahead, yet inwardly they are full of desire, anger and delusion, practice what is not Dharma, and have corrupted moral discipline. They are like a

mango that is ripe outside but unripe inside. Some monks are coarse in outward deportment and lack fine deportment, yet inwardly they possess the conduct and qualities of a renunciant and are endowed with meditative concentration, samādhi and wisdom. They are like a mango that is ripe inside but unripe outside. Some monks are coarse in deportment, commit misdeeds and have corrupted moral discipline, and inwardly too they are full of desire, anger, delusion, miserliness and jealousy. They are like a mango that is unripe both outside and inside. Some monks have beautiful deportment and are endowed with moral discipline, and inwardly too they possess the qualities of a renunciant, moral discipline, samādhi and wisdom. They are like a mango that is ripe both outside and inside. The almsfood monk, endowed with both the outer and the inner, was like this; because his qualities and conduct were complete, everyone served and honored him.

At that time in that country there was a householder with great faith in the Three Jewels who had a young son. He thought, "Let this son of mine go forth, and I shall seek out a learned teacher for him." Why is that? Because by relying on a virtuous friend, virtue increases.

"Relying on an evil companion gives rise to evil qualities. For example, although the nature of the wind does not change, if it comes from a grove of sandalwood or a grove of campaka trees, that wind carries a sweet fragrance. If it comes from the direction of a putrid, filthy charnel ground, that wind too is foul. Likewise, if a new garment is put into a vessel of incense, the garment too smells of incense; if it is put among foul, rotting things, the garment too becomes foul. If one relies on a virtuous friend, virtue grows and increases; if one relies on an evil companion, evil arises and increases. Therefore I shall offer this son of mine to this venerable monk, and let him go forth."

Having thought this, he went to where the monk was and said this: "I have faith that this son of mine should go forth. Venerable one, please consider him with kindness and let him go forth. If you do not permit it, I will take him back home again."

Then the monk examined with the eye of miraculous power and saw that if this boy went forth, he would guard moral discipline purely and the Buddha's Dharma would flourish. So he let him go forth and made him a novice.

At that time the layman who provided the monk's sustenance had a householder friend. That householder prepared a seasonal feast and invited the layman, his wife, his sons, his daughters, his male servants, his female

servants and all the people of his household. The next day, when they were to go as guests, the layman thought, "If all of us go to be guests, who will guard this house? If I insist on leaving someone behind, he will miss the occasion and lose his share." So he said, "Whoever is willing to stay, I will repay the kindness and reward him as soon as we return from the feast."

The layman had a daughter, and she said this to her parents: "Let all the people of the household go to be guests; I will guard the house."

Her father said, "Excellent, excellent! If you guard the house, you are no different from your mother, and I have no fear that anything will be lost or that any mishap will occur." Then all the people of the household went off to be guests, and the daughter barred the doors securely and stayed alone in the house.

That day the layman was so busy that he forgot to send the almsfood. Then the monk thought, "The sun is nearly past noon. The householder has many affairs and may perhaps have forgotten. It is not right to go without eating; I shall send for it." So he sent the novice to fetch the almsfood.

The master instructed the novice, "Restrain your deportment well, and receive almsfood in the village as the Blessed One taught. Just as bees do no harm to the color and fragrance of flowers, receive almsfood from the house without becoming attached. Guard your senses, without attachment to forms, sounds, smells, tastes and textures. If you guard moral discipline, you will certainly attain the fruit. Someone like Devadatta, though he could recite many sūtras from memory, did wrong, corrupted his moral discipline, and was born in the Avīci hell. Kokālika, having slandered others and corrupted his moral discipline, was likewise born in hell. Someone like Cūḍapanthaka, though he knew no more than a single verse, became an arhat because he guarded moral discipline. Moral discipline leads in through the gate to nirvāṇa and becomes the cause of supreme bliss.

"For example, in the brahmins' religion a feast is held for three or four months, and to it they invite learned brahmins who are endowed with knowledge, guard moral discipline and practice pure conduct, but not everyone. Whoever comes to the feast has a seal stamped in keule on his wrist. There was a brahmin who had good qualities but was greedy by nature, and because he was attached to honey and sweet things, he licked off the seal that had been stamped on his wrist until it could no longer be seen. The next day, when they gathered for the feast and the gatekeeper checked the seals, that wandering

ascetic had none, so the gatekeeper would not let him in. When asked, 'Where is your seal?' he said, 'It was sweet, so I licked it off.' In this way, because that wandering ascetic was attached to a tiny bit of sweetness, he lost the four months' feast, with its food of fine color and fragrance, its many kinds of sweet scents, and its many precious benefits.

"You too, do not let the seal of moral discipline be broken for the sake of attachment to some trifle like that. Otherwise you would lose the delicious taste of the five sense pleasures of gods and humans, the undefiled state, the thirty-seven factors of awakening, the bliss of nirvāṇa, and the immeasurable jewels of the Dharma. Do not break the moral discipline of the buddhas of the three times, and do not disgrace the Three Jewels, your master, or the lineage of the Saṅgha."

When he had been instructed in this way, the novice bowed his head at his master's feet and went to the layman's house. When he arrived there, he knocked on the door, and the girl called out, "Who is it?"

The novice said, "I have come to receive my master's almsfood."

The girl was overjoyed, thinking, "Now my hope is fulfilled," and she opened the door. When the novice had come inside, the girl, who was no more than sixteen years old, finely featured, lovely to look at and beautiful, thought, "I will seduce him with desire." She made many kinds of enticements in front of the novice and, burning with desire, pressed herself upon him.

The novice thought, "Has a wind disorder arisen in this girl, or is she mad? Or else is this girl tormented by desire, and is she going to burn up my moral discipline with the fire of desire?" Having thought this, he kept his deportment tightly restrained and remained there without even his complexion changing.

The girl prostrated with the five points of the body touching the ground and said this to the novice: "What I have always hoped for has come about today. There is something I have to tell you; I have always kept it in mind, but I never found the chance."

"If you too have always been thinking of me, then please fulfill my hope. Inside this house there are jewels, gold, silver, and many storehouses, like the treasure of Vaiśravaṇa, yet there is no master. Please become master of the house and all it holds. I will be your servant and attend you with respect and service. Do not go against this; please fulfill my hope."

The novice thought, "What evil deed have I done, that I have met with such a circumstance as this? Better that I lose my body and my life than break the moral discipline laid down by the buddhas of the three times. In former times, monks who had gone into a prostitute's house would rather leap into a pit of fire than break their moral discipline. Again, monks who had been robbed by bandits and tied up with grass, though they were buffeted by the wind, scorched by the sun, and eaten by many insects, would not cut the grass and leave, in order to keep their moral discipline. A monk who saw that a goose had made a jewel disappear endured suffering, yet would not say a word, in order to keep his moral discipline. When a ship was wrecked, a monk clung to a plank, yet in order to keep his moral discipline he gave that plank to a fellow monk senior in rank, and died in the ocean. Were those alone the ones who kept moral discipline as close disciples of the Buddha, and not we? Is the Tathāgata the Teacher of those alone, and not our Teacher? For example, when campaka flowers are pressed together with sesame, the sweet fragrance of the campaka comes to pervade the sesame oil. Am I not the same? Since I am fully held in the care of a spiritual friend, why should I now commit evil, unwholesome deeds? Better that I lose my body and my life. Never shall I break my moral discipline and bring disgrace upon the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha, upon my parents, my teacher, and the line of my masters."

He thought further, "If I run away, this girl, tormented by desire and without any shame or embarrassment, will catch me outside and slander me, and if the villagers see it, they will denounce me. I shall surely give up my life in this very house." Having thought this, he said to the girl, "Shut the doors tightly. I have a small task to do inside a room; when I have done it, I will meet with you."

When he had told her this and the girl had gone out to shut the door, the novice went into a room and bolted the door tightly. Finding a razor inside, he was overjoyed. He took off the robes he wore on his body and hung them on the clothes rail. Joining his palms and facing toward the place in the city of Kuśinagara where the Buddha passed into nirvāṇa, he knelt with his knees on the ground and made this vow: "I do not abandon the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha. I do not abandon my preceptor and my teacher. I do not abandon moral discipline. It is in order to keep moral discipline that I abandon this body. Wherever I am born, may I go forth in the teaching of the Buddha, may I lead a perfectly pure holy life, may I exhaust the defilements, and may I attain the fruit." Having made this aspiration, he cut his own throat and died.

He was covered in blood, and his body too turned red with blood.

At that time the girl thought, "He is taking a long time," and she went to the door and called, but he said nothing at all. When the girl opened the door and looked, she saw that he was already dead. Since things had not turned out as she intended, her desirous mind subsided. Tormented by great unhappiness, the girl tore her hair, scratched her face with her nails, and rolled on the ground, weeping.

When the girl's parents came back from the feast, they knocked on the door and called, but the girl said nothing at all, so they sent a man inside to open the door. When they saw the girl in such a state, they said to her, "What is wrong with you? Has someone made sport of you and brought disgrace upon your family?" When they asked this, the girl said nothing, but thought, "If I speak honestly, it will be deeply shameful. But if I say that the novice made sport of me, then, by slandering a noble one, a being falls into hell and comes to experience much suffering. I shall speak honestly, without deceit." Having thought this, she said, "While I was here alone guarding the house, that novice came to collect his teacher's alms. Burning with the fire of my desire, I pressed the novice to destroy the moral discipline he had kept, but his mind could not be changed. The novice found a way, went into a room, and gave up his life. With this impure body of mine I have defiled a perfectly pure vessel, and on top of that I have committed a grave wrong. That is why I am unhappy."

When she had said this, the girl's parents, hearing it, were amazed. Why was that? Because they understood that this is how things are by the very nature of affliction. They told the girl, "All phenomena are impermanent; do not grieve." Then they went into the room and looked, and seeing the novice's remains stained with blood like red sandalwood, they prostrated and praised him, saying, "Excellent! In order to keep the moral discipline of the Buddha, you did not regard even your body and your life!"

At that time, by the king's law of the land, if a monk died in a householder's house, a thousand gold coins had to be offered to the court. So that layman took a thousand gold coins and went to the palace, and petitioned, "Great king, a fault has occurred on my part. Please accept these coins." The king said to him, "In my realm, the one who has faith in the Three Jewels, who has devotion for the true Dharma and so is upright by nature, and whose conduct is well disciplined, is you alone. What fault could have occurred on your part?" The layman reproached his daughter and praised the virtue of how the novice

had kept his moral discipline, and reported in full everything that had happened.

The king said, "The novice simply disregarded his body and his life in order to keep his moral discipline. You have committed no fault, so take the coins and go back home. I too will come to your house to make an offering to that novice." Having said this, he had the golden drum beaten and gave the command: "Let the whole retinue assemble and come along in attendance. We are going to the house of that layman."

Then the king went to that house. Seeing the novice's remains stained with blood like red sandalwood, he prostrated and praised his virtues. The remains were placed on a chariot adorned with all kinds of jewels and taken to a level, pleasant place where everyone could see, and there they were cremated with fragrant wood and offerings were made.

That girl, moreover, was exceedingly beautiful, of a beauty rare in the world. The king had the girl too placed on a high spot where everyone could see her, and let the whole great assembly have a good look at her. Then he declared to the many people, "Who that is not free of desire would not become attached to a girl as fair of form, as lovely and as beautiful as this? Yet this novice, who had not even attained the fruit, and who had a body subject to birth and destruction, dared to give up his body and his life for the sake of moral discipline. That is a great wonder!" Having proclaimed this, he invited the novice's teacher as well and had him teach the true Dharma to the great assembly. When all who had gathered in that assembly heard the Dharma taught, some asked to go forth and keep moral discipline, and some generated the mind set on unsurpassed awakening. All of them rejoiced and were delighted.

This is the sixteenth chapter, on the novice who kept his moral discipline.

At that time the Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada, together with a great saṅgha of monks, and was teaching the Dharma.

At that time in that land there was a great householder, rich and very wealthy, with gold, silver, the seven kinds of precious things, elephants, horses, cattle, sheep, male and female slaves, a great many workers, and a great many storehouses. He had no son, but he had five daughters, all of them lovely in appearance and endowed with intelligence. At that time, while the householder's wife was pregnant, the householder died.

At that time, under the king's law of the land, when there was no son, the king took all the wealth there was. The king accordingly ordered a minister to count all the man's property and livestock and whatever goods there were, and to take them for the crown. The daughters thought, "Whether what is in our mother's womb is male or female is not yet certain. If she gives birth to a girl, the king will simply take the property and livestock. But if a boy is born, he is the rightful heir." Having thought this, they petitioned the king: "Since our father has died and there is no son, the king is taking the property and livestock. Please leave it be for now, until what is in our mother's womb is known for certain. If it is a girl, it will be easy to take it then; but if it is a boy, he is the rightful heir." King Prasenajit, being upright and governing by the Dharma, did as the daughters requested.

Not long after that, when the nine months were complete, a boy was born. He had no ears, no eyes, no nose, no tongue, and no hands or feet; he was just a lump of flesh with only a male organ. So he was given the name Majibila. Then the daughters reported to the king that a boy had been born. The king thought, "It is not by having eyes, ears, nose, tongue, hands, feet and so forth that one becomes an heir; whoever has a male organ becomes the heir. This son too has a male organ, so he becomes his father's heir." Having thought this, he told the daughters, "All the property, livestock and goods belong to your brother. I will not take them."

At that time the eldest daughter was given in marriage to a man of matching family and lineage. That daughter showed respect to her husband: she spread his seat, made his bed, swept up, prepared his food, greeted him and saw him off, bowed to him, spoke gently to him and so on. In every task she was to do, she honored her husband just as servant women do the work of their mistress. So the husband said to his wife, "Being husband and wife is not something for us alone; it is the same for everyone. Why is it that you alone behave like this?"

The wife said, "My father had countless possessions and livestock. After he died, though there were five daughters, it was decided that the king would take all the wealth. But when my mother's months were complete, a brother was born from her womb. He had no eyes, no ears, nose, tongue, feet or hands; yet because he had only a male organ, he became the heir. Therefore, whatever faculties one may have, they cannot match the single mark of a male. That is why I honor you."

When the householder heard what his wife said, he was amazed. Together with his wife he went to where the Blessed One was, and when he arrived he said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, why is it that this householder's son, who has no eyes, ears, nose, tongue, hands or feet, became the master of the wealth in a very rich household as soon as he was born?"

The Blessed One said to the householder, "It is good that you have asked about these things. Listen very well and keep it in mind, and I will explain it to you." The householder replied, "I shall do so."

The Blessed One said, "In times long past, a householder had two sons. One was called Generosity and the other was called Moral Discipline. From the time they were small, the two brothers had a strong sense of conscience and shame, spoke the truth, always delighted in giving, and were protectors of the poor and destitute. Because they had such great faith and were so virtuous, the people of the land praised them, and the king appointed them as judges, to examine who was guilty and who was not."

At that time, under the king's law of the land, whenever one of the people lent something to another, they would come before the judge and appoint him as witness, and no other proof was required.

At that time a merchant who was going to sea borrowed a great deal of wealth from the judge's younger brother, called Moral Discipline, and used it for whatever he needed. Moral Discipline had an only son, who was still young and small. Moral Discipline took the son with him, and taking along the goods that were to be lent, went to his elder brother and said, "This merchant is borrowing this much wealth from me as a loan, and has undertaken to repay it whenever he comes back from the sea. Should I die, he has undertaken to repay it to my son. Elder brother, please take note of this." The elder brother said, "I shall do so."

Not long after that, the householder Moral Discipline died. The merchant's ship was wrecked at sea, and the merchant alone clung to a plank and made his way back to his own country. At that time the householder's son thought, "The merchant's ship was wrecked, his wealth was lost, and he has come back alone. Though he owes me this much in goods, he has nothing."

Then the merchant again borrowed from others, set out to sea once more, found many precious jewels, and came safely back home. He thought, "This householder's son did not press me for the debt before. Since he was very young, has he perhaps forgotten and does not remember? Or did he not press

me for the debt because I had nothing? I will test him." Having thought this, he mounted a fine horse, put on costly, splendid clothes, and went to the market.

The householder's son saw the merchant wearing fine clothes and riding a fine horse, and thought, "This man has become prosperous; I will press him for the debt." Having thought this, he sent a man with the message, "Will you not now repay what you owe?" The merchant replied, "I shall do so."

Then the merchant thought, "I borrowed a great deal of wealth from this householder, so even if I hand over everything I have, it will not be enough to repay it. I shall devise a scheme." Having thought this, the merchant took a precious jewel and went to the judge's wife and said to her, "My lady, please understand. Some time ago I borrowed a little wealth from the householder Moral Discipline, and now the householder's son is pressing me for the debt. Please accept this precious jewel worth ten thousand taels, and ask the judge that when the two of us come to put the question to him, he say, 'I did not see it.'"

The wife said, "This husband of mine is extremely upright and does not lie, so it will certainly not work. Still, I will ask him." She took the jewel, and when her husband came back in the evening she told him in full what the merchant had asked.

The husband said, "I live by conscience and shame. Because I do not lie, the king made me a judge. If I were to tell a lie, I would no longer be of true lineage."

The next day the merchant came again, and the wife told him the whole of what had been said and gave the jewel back. The merchant then offered another precious jewel, worth twenty thousand taels, and said, "By saying a single word over a small matter, you will gain thirty thousand taels. The other party is a mere nobody; even if he were to become king, he would not get so much as a single coin."

She thought, "This is reasonable," and out of attachment to the precious jewels she agreed to carry out what the merchant had entrusted to her. In the evening, when her husband came back, she said, "If what I asked you yesterday seems acceptable, please do it." The husband said, "That is not right. It is because I do not lie that I was made a judge. If I were to tell a lie, in this life no one in the world would trust me, and in later lives too I would experience suffering for countless eons." So he told her.

At that time that householder had a son who could not walk, who could only crawl. The householder's wife said to the householder, "Since I became your wife, I would not expect you to refuse me even if I asked something that put your life at stake. Yet if you twist your words and turn me down over a small matter like this, I cannot go on living. If things do not go as I have asked, I will kill our son, and after that I will die too."

When the husband heard her say this, he thought, "Like a man who is choking, who can neither spit it out nor swallow it down: I have only this one son, and if he dies there will be no heir to the wealth. Yet if I do as the woman says, everyone in the world will talk and will not trust me, and in the future I will experience much suffering." Having thought this, he unwillingly agreed to do as his wife said. The wife was overjoyed and said to the merchant, "My husband has given his consent. Go ahead with it."

The merchant too was overjoyed and went back home. He adorned a great elephant with all kinds of jewels, put on costly clothes, mounted the elephant, and came to the market. When the householder's son saw this he was pleased, thinking, "Now this man has great wealth; I will press him for the debt." Having thought this, he went up to him, stepped forward, and said, "Householder, do you recall? Pay me the debts you owe." The householder pretended to be startled and said, "I do not remember owing you any debt. What debt have you seen me owe?"

The householder's son said, "In such and such a year and month you borrowed wealth from my father, and you took the wealth from my own hand; the judge knows it too. Why do you deny it?" The merchant said, "I do not remember borrowing any wealth of yours. If there is a witness, let us go before the witness and settle it." So they went before the judge, and the son said, "This man once borrowed this much wealth from my father, and you, uncle, saw it. Did this man not borrow wealth from my father?" The uncle said, "I am not certain." The nephew, startled, said, "The wealth he borrowed from me at that time: do you not remember, uncle, that you handed it over to this man with your own hand?" The uncle said, "There was no such thing."

Then the boy grew angry with his uncle and said, "Because you were upright, the king made you judge over everyone, and all the people of the land call you upright. If you treat even me, your own nephew, like this, what need is there to speak of others being wronged and cut off from a fair hearing? Whether this is true or false will become plain in time."

The Blessed One said to the householder, "If you wish to know who that judge was at that time, do not think it was anyone else. He is this Majibila, whose faculties are incomplete. Because he told a lie at that time, he was born in a great hell and experienced all kinds of suffering. When he was freed from hell, for five hundred lifetimes he was born as a lump of flesh with no faculties at all. Yet because at that time he delighted in giving, he was always born into wealthy households and became master of the wealth. Wholesome deeds and evil deeds, even after a long time has passed, do not vanish or perish. Therefore, all of you, be diligent, restrain body, speech and mind, and do no evil."

When the great assembly heard what the Blessed One had said, some attained anything from the first fruit to the fourth fruit, and some generated the mind set on unsurpassed awakening. They rejoiced and were delighted.

This is the seventeenth chapter, on the householder without faculties.

At that time the Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada, teaching the Dharma to the saṅgha of monks.

At that time in that land the wife of a householder gave birth to a daughter who surpassed other girls, fair of face, lovely to behold, and beautiful. When she was first born, she came out wrapped in soft white cloth. Her parents were amazed at this and showed her to a reader of signs. The reader of signs examined her and saw that she was endowed with great merit, and she was named Śuklā, the White One. As the girl Śuklā grew, the cloth also grew to the size of her body.

Later, when the girl had grown up, many people of the land asked for her as a wife. Her parents, intending to have the ornaments for sending their daughter off as a bride beaten out, engaged a smith and weighed out gold and silver. When the girl saw the gold and silver being weighed, she asked her parents, "What is this for?" They said, "This is to beat out the ornaments for sending you off as a bride." The girl said, "I have faith in going forth; I do not wish to go off as a bride."

Her parents, going along with their daughter's wishes, at once brought out cloth and set about sewing Dharma robes. The girl asked, "What is this cloth for?" They said, "We are sewing your Dharma robes." The girl said, "I already have Dharma robes to wear; there is no need to sew them. Take me to where the Blessed One is staying." Her parents said, "We will take you to where the

Blessed One is staying," and they took her into the Blessed One's presence. When they arrived where the Buddha was, she bowed her head to the Blessed One and asked to go forth. The Blessed One said, "Welcome!" At that, her hair and the down on her face fell away of themselves, and the white cloth she wore on her body turned into the five robes. She was entrusted to the nun Prajāpatī. That nun applied herself with diligence and before long became an arhat.

Ānanda asked the Blessed One, "What merit did the nun Śuklā accumulate in the past, that she was born into a householder's family, had cloth on her body, and, after going forth, before long became an arhat?"

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "In times long past, a buddha called Merit Protector appeared in the world. When he went about with his attendants for the benefit of beings, all the people of the land made abundant offerings. At that time a certain monk, for the benefit of many beings, urged all the people of the land to listen to the Dharma from the Buddha and to make gifts.

"At that time this woman was called Ke, and she was utterly poor. She and her husband had only a single length of cloth between them for clothing. When the husband went out to seek a living, he wore the cloth, and the wife stayed naked inside the grass. When the wife went out to seek a living, she wore the cloth, and the husband stayed naked in the heap of grass.

"Later the monk who worked for the benefit of all came to their door and met the woman. He said, 'Go and pay homage to the Buddha. Make an offering.' He praised the virtues of giving and explained the karmic ripening of stinginess. He spoke at length about how rare it is for a buddha to appear in the world, how rare it is to hear the Dharma, and how rare it is to obtain a human body, and he urged her, 'Go and listen to the Dharma.' The woman said, 'Reverend, wait a little; I shall come back.' She went inside the house and said to her husband, 'At the door there is a monk who tells us, "Go and pay homage to the Buddha, listen to the Dharma, and make gifts." Because we did not give in our former lives, we have become poor like this. What shall we make into provisions for our next life now?'

"The husband said, 'It would be fitting to give to him, but we are poor and have nothing. What could we give?' The wife said, 'Because we did not give in our former lives, we have become poor like this. If we do not give now as well, where will we go in our next life? I am going to make a gift; please allow it.' The husband thought, 'She seems to have some hidden wealth,' and said,

'Make a gift.' Then the wife said, 'I wish to give this cloth.'

"The husband said, 'We two, husband and wife, have nothing but this cloth. With it we go out to seek a living and keep ourselves alive. If we give it away, are we both just to sit at home?' The wife said, 'For anyone who is born there is death. Even if we do not give this, we will die; and if we give it, we will die. If we are content to give and then die, there is hope for the next life. So it is better to die having given. You too, gladly let the gift be made.' Having told him this, the wife went outside and said to the monk, 'Reverend, please look away for a moment. I am going to make a gift.'"

"When she had said this, the monk told her, 'If you are going to make a gift, give it with your own hand, in person. I shall recite the verses of dedication for the gift.' The woman said, 'This cloth is all I have on my body. If I come out, I have no other clothing, and it is not fitting that you should see this filthy, stained body of a woman. I shall offer it from inside.' So she took off the cloth inside and offered it to the monk. The monk recited the verses of dedication, took the cloth, and went to where the Buddha was.

"When he arrived, the Blessed One said to the monk, 'Bring the cloth that the woman offered.' The monk offered the cloth to the Buddha, and the Blessed One accepted it with his own hand. Because the cloth was old and soiled with dirt, the king's retinue scoffed at his taking soiled cloth into his hand. The Blessed One, knowing the thoughts of the great assembly, said, 'As I see it, in this whole assembly there is no gift purer than this.' The great assembly was amazed.

"Then the king's queen was overjoyed. She took off the clothes and ornaments she wore on her body and sent them to the woman. The king too took off his clothes and ornaments and sent them to her husband, with the command, 'Let the husband and wife both come into the assembly.' The buddha Merit Protector taught the Dharma to the great assembly, and most of them attained liberation."

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "The poor woman at that time was this nun Śuklā. Because at that time she gave the cloth with sincere intention, for ninety-one eons, wherever she was born, she was always born together with cloth, never in want, and prosperous just as she wished. Because she heard the true Dharma from that buddha and made the aspiration to be liberated, she has met me here and become an arhat. Therefore you too should be diligent in listening to the Dharma and in giving." When the Blessed One had

spoken thus, the great assembly rejoiced at what he had said and were delighted.

This is the eighteenth chapter, on the poor woman who offered cloth.

At that time the venerable Mahākātyāyana was staying in the land of Avanti. In that land a wealthy householder, stingy and without compassion, had an old slave woman. Though the slave woman did all the menial work, she had no clothing to cover her body and never tasted food in her mouth, and she was constantly beaten and abused. The old woman could bear it no longer, and thinking, "I will go and throw away my life," she took a pitcher and went to fetch water, and on the bank of the water she cried out loudly and wept.

Kātyāyana came there and asked, "Old woman, why are you so unhappy?" "Noble one, on top of being old, my work is heavy, and I have nothing to wear and nothing to eat. I am so poor and destitute that I wonder why I do not die, and so I am unhappy and weep." Kātyāyana said, "Old woman, why do you not sell your poverty?" The old woman said, "How can poverty be sold? Who would buy poverty?" Kātyāyana told her three times, "Poverty can be sold." Thinking, "I will ask how this poverty can be sold," she asked, "How can poverty be sold?" Kātyāyana said, "If you truly wish to sell your poverty, do as I instruct you." She replied, "Noble one, I will do so."

Kātyāyana said, "First bathe, and after you have washed, make a gift." The old woman said, "I do not have even the makings of a patch; what could I give? This pitcher belongs to my mistress; I have no right to it." Kātyāyana said, "Fill this alms bowl with clean water and offer it to me. I shall recite the verses of dedication for the gift." Kātyāyana took the water, recited the verses of dedication, gave her the precepts, had her recite the Buddha's name, and praised his many kinds of virtues. Then he asked, "Old woman, do you have a place to stay?" The old woman said, "I have no place to stay. I sleep right where I grind grain, pound with the pestle, and do my work. Sometimes I sleep on the dung heap."

Kātyāyana said, "Do not feel regret or unhappiness at doing menial work; do your work diligently. After your mistress has gone to sleep, quietly open your mistress's door, spread clean grass in a clean corner of the doorway or the passage, and sit there. Without thinking of anything else, keep the Buddha in mind and recollect him."

Then the old woman did as she had been taught, and before long, one night while she was sitting there, she died and was born as a god in the Heaven of

the Thirty-Three. Her mistress rose early in the morning, and seeing that the slave woman had died inside the house, she grew angry and cursed, "If this old woman was not allowed inside the house, why has she died here?" She tied a grass rope to her feet, dragged her off, and had her taken to the charnel ground.

At that time there was a son of the gods who was surrounded by five hundred daughters of the gods and who delighted in play. A goddess had passed away, and the old woman was born in that goddess's place. Among those born as gods, those of sharp faculties know through what condition they have been born as gods, while those of dull faculties do not know. The old woman did not know why she had been born a god, and was simply attached to pleasure.

At that time Śāriputra, who was staying in the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, asked her, "Do you know through what condition you were born as a god?" She said, "I do not know." Śāriputra had her look with the divine eye, and made her see how she had become a god. Then she, together with some five hundred daughters of the gods, came down to the charnel ground, strewed divine flowers over the bones, and made offerings of incense. The light of the gods lit up the whole city with a great radiance. Her mistress and the others were astonished, and many people went to look. Seeing many gods making offerings to the old woman's bones, they said to the gods, "Why are you making offerings to these bones? Even when she was alive, everyone shunned her because she was filthy; how much more so the bones of one who has died!"

Then the daughters of the gods told at length how she had been reborn as a god, and went to where Kātyāyana was. Kātyāyana gave those daughters of the gods an extensive talk on the sublime Dharma, on generosity, moral discipline, rebirth in the higher realms, and so on, and taught them the teaching on impurity and the teaching on renunciation. Thereupon those daughters of the gods became free of dust and free of stain, their Dharma eye with regard to phenomena became pure, and they went back to the abode of the gods. The great assembly, too, having heard the Dharma taught, each attained the fruits, from the first fruit up to the fourth; they rejoiced and were delighted.

This is the nineteenth chapter, on the poor servant woman who sold her poverty to Kātyāyana.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time there lived in that land a householder who was very rich, of great wealth, his storehouses filled with jewels. He took a wife from a family of equal standing, and his wife bore a son whose color was like gold. A reader of marks examined him and gave him the name Golden God.

When the boy was born, a well appeared of itself in the boy's house, its water square and level, eight cubits across, and eight cubits deep as well. When water was drawn from that well, things came forth according to people's wishes: for one who wanted clothes, clothes came forth; for one who wanted food and drink, food and drink came forth; for one who wanted gold, silver, and jewels, gold, silver, and jewels came forth. Whatever anyone wanted, all of it came forth just as they wished.

The boy was nurtured and grew up, and he mastered the fields of knowledge. The householder was overjoyed and thought, "I will look for a wife for the boy." Intending to find for him a wife who, like the boy, was golden in color, fine and beautiful, surpassing the ordinary, he searched every land for a bride.

At that time, in the land of Campā, a very rich householder had a daughter called Golden Light. That girl too was golden in color and most radiant, her skin very fine and her bones very slender. When she was first born, a well had likewise appeared of itself at her home, eight cubits across and the same in depth, and from that well too there came forth of themselves whatever things were wished for: jewels of every kind, clothes, food, drink, and so on. That householder too thought, "This fine daughter of mine I will give to a young man like her, whose body is golden in color, most radiant, fine, and beautiful." The two who had these thoughts met; the boy heard about the girl and the girl heard about the boy, and the two householders agreed to make a marriage alliance.

Having agreed to hold the wedding feast, they brought the girl to Śrāvastī, to the house of Golden God. Golden God invited the Buddha and the Saṅgha, and the Blessed One came with the Saṅgha for the meal. He taught the sublime Dharma at length to Golden God and his wife, and Golden God and his wife, together with the householder and his wife, having heard the Dharma from the Blessed One, had all their blazing evil and non-virtue of two hundred thousand eons pacified. With purified minds they realized the Dharma and attained the fruit of stream-entry.

Then the Blessed One returned to the monastery, and Golden God and Golden Light, husband and wife, asked their parents for leave to go forth, and their parents granted it. The two of them went to where the Buddha was, and when they arrived they bowed their heads at the Buddha's feet and said, "We two wish to go forth." The Blessed One said, "Welcome!" Their hair and beards fell away of themselves, and they became monastics wearing saffron robes. Golden God entered the Saṅgha of monks, and Golden Light was entrusted to Prajāpatī. Before long both became arhats and came to possess every quality: the three knowledges, the six superknowledges, the eight liberations, and so on.

Then the monks were filled with doubt, and the venerable Ānanda said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, what deeds did the monks Golden God and Golden Light do in the past, that from the moment they were first born they possessed such jewels and great wealth, and even from a well all their hopes were completely fulfilled?"

The Blessed One said, "Ninety-one eons ago, in the past, a buddha called Vipaśyin came into the world. After he passed into nirvāṇa, the monks who had entered his teaching wandered through the towns and the countryside working for the welfare of sentient beings, and all the householders of great and high families supplied them with robes and alms food without fail.

"At that time a poor householder and his wife thought, 'When our parents were alive, we had jewels and wealth, and our storehouses were completely full, yet we never met the noble Saṅgha. Now that we are destitute like this and own nothing at all, sleeping on a heap of straw and possessing not even a measure or a handful of grain, the noble Saṅgha has come, and all the rich householders are offering robes and alms food, while we have nothing at all to offer.' Thinking this, they were deeply unhappy and wept.

"The tears of the weeping husband fell onto his wife's hand, and the wife said to her husband, 'Why are you weeping?'

"'Do you not know? The noble Saṅgha has come to this town, and all the rich householders are making offerings to them, while we alone have nothing at all to offer. If we make no offering now, where will we go in our next life? That is why I am unhappy.'

"The wife said, 'Go and search in our old storehouse. It may be that a little something is left. If you find a few things, we will offer them.' When he searched the old storehouse, he found a single gold coin left there. The wife,

for her part, had one mirror. The husband and wife bought a new vase, filled the vase with clean water, put the one gold coin inside it, covered its mouth with the mirror, and, carrying the water vase, offered it to the Saṅgha.

The Saṅgha accepted it. Some of them drank that water, some washed their hands and faces, and some washed their alms bowls. When the householder and his wife saw the Saṅgha use it in this way, they were overjoyed and delighted, and went back home. Not long afterward, struck by illness, husband and wife both died and were reborn as gods in the Heaven of the Thirty-Three.

"Ānanda, the poor husband and wife who at that time offered the water vase are Golden God and his wife. Because long ago they offered a vase full of water, one gold coin, and one mirror, in all their births they have been fine and beautiful, their complexion always radiant with the color of gold. So it has been for ninety-one eons. Because at that time they made the offering with a mind of the deepest faith, now in this life they have reached the end of saṃsāra and become arhats. Therefore, Ānanda, there is no deed belonging to the side of merit that one may leave undone. By giving a little, that poor man gained a measureless heap of merit such as this."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, Ānanda and the great assembly resolved to gather the accumulation of merit that comes from giving; they rejoiced and were delighted.

This is the twentieth chapter, on Golden God.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time in that land a rich householder took a wife from a family of equal standing, but because he had no son he was very unhappy, and he prayed to all the gods. After some time his wife became pregnant, and when her months were complete she bore a son. The boy was most beautiful and lovely, and his parents, relatives, and friends were all delighted and held a birth feast. They gathered on the bank of a river and ate the birth feast there.

While they were eating the birth feast on the riverbank, everyone wanted to look at the boy, so one person took him on his lap and then gave him onto another's lap. As he was passed in this way from one to the next, someone was careless, the boy slipped, fell into the water, and was carried off by the river. Through the power of the boy's merit, since his karma was not yet exhausted, he did not die: a fish swallowed him, and he stayed alive in the fish's belly.

At the lower end of that river there was another village, and in that village too there was a rich householder who had no son. A servant of that householder was fishing on the bank of the river and caught the very fish that held the child. When he cut open its belly, a boy came out of the belly, and the servant took him and offered him to his mistress. The householder's wife took the boy and looked at him, and saw that he was a fine boy endowed with the marks. She was overjoyed, thinking, "This is the sign that our prayers to all the gods have been answered," and she gave him to a nurse to rear.

Then the householder of the upper village heard that the householder of the lower village had found a son inside a fish. Thinking, "Without a doubt this is my son who fell into the water," he went to him and said, "This is my son, so give him back!"

The other replied, "This is not your son. Because I had no son, I prayed to all the gods, and this is a son given by the gods. I found him in the belly of a fish."

The two householders quarreled and appealed to the king for judgment. The boy's father said, "He is my son; he is the one who fell into the water at the riverbank." The other householder said, "I found the boy in the belly of a fish I caught; he is not your son." The king weighed the case of the two of them and decreed, "Raise this boy jointly, the two of you. When he is grown, each of you take a wife for your son, and whatever sons are born of the two wives, each of you take your own."

Then the two householders, just as the king had decreed in judgment, raised the boy jointly and saw that he lacked for nothing. When the boy had grown up, he said to his two sets of parents, "As soon as I was born I fell into the water, was swallowed by a fish, and underwent all sorts of suffering, yet I did not die. So please permit me to go forth." Because the boy's two sets of parents loved their son so dearly, they could not refuse him and gave him leave to go forth.

The boy went to where the Buddha was, and when he arrived he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and said, "I wish to go forth in the Buddha's teaching." The Blessed One said, "Welcome!" His hair and beard fell away of themselves, and he became a monk. He was given the name Two Families. When the Blessed One taught the sublime Dharma to the monk Two Families, he reached the end of suffering and became an arhat on the spot.

At this the monks felt doubt, and the venerable Ānanda said to the Blessed One, "What root of virtue did this monk Two Families accumulate in the past, that though he fell into the water and lay in a fish's belly, he did not die?"

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "Listen well. Long ago a buddha called Vipaśyin came into the world and taught the Dharma to many people. At that time a householder came into that assembly, and when he heard the Blessed One teach at length on the merit of practicing generosity, the virtues of keeping moral discipline, and so on, he was overjoyed and delighted. Faith arose in him with a pure intention, and he took from that buddha three precepts of training, beginning with abstaining from killing, and offered him one coin. Because of that, wherever he was born he was endowed with wealth and jewels and never knew want.

"Ānanda, the householder at that time is this monk Two Families. Because he offered one coin to the Buddha, for ninety-one eons he has been endowed with great wealth, and in this present life too he has been endowed with riches and possessions in the homes of his two sets of parents. Because he took the precept of not killing, though he fell into the water and went into a fish's belly, he still did not die. Because he went for refuge to the Three Jewels, he has met me and become an arhat."

Then Ānanda and the great assembly rejoiced at what the Blessed One had taught and were delighted.

This is the twenty-first chapter, on Two Families.

The sixth section.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Vaiśālī, in the Mango Grove. At that time the Blessed One spoke these words to the venerable Ānanda: "One who has attained the four bases of miraculous power can remain in the world for an eon. I too have thoroughly cultivated the four bases of miraculous power; so now it would be fitting for the Tathāgata to remain in the world for as long as his lifespan lasts." He said this three times, but Ānanda, deceived by Māra, though he heard the Blessed One's words, stayed silent and said nothing.

Then the Blessed One said to Ānanda, "Go to a secluded place and reflect deeply." Ānanda rose from his seat and went into a grove. After Ānanda had gone, the king of the māras, the Evil One, came and spoke these words to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, you have dwelt in the world for a long time. You

have tamed beings fit to be tamed, as many as the sands of the river Ganges, and accomplished the aim of turning them back from saṃsāra. Now that you are old in years, it is fitting that you pass into nirvāṇa."

Then the Blessed One took up a little earth, placed it on his fingernail, and said to Māra the Evil One, "Is there more earth in the great earth, or more earth on my fingernail?"

Māra the Evil One replied, "The earth of the great earth is vast indeed, while the earth on your fingernail is not much."

The Blessed One said, "The beings I have tamed are like the earth on my fingernail. Those not tamed are like the great earth." Then the Blessed One said to Māra the Evil One, "Three months from now I shall pass completely into nirvāṇa." When Māra the Evil One heard this, he was overjoyed and delighted, and went away.

At that time Ānanda had fallen asleep in the grove, and he dreamed of a great tree that covered the whole expanse of space, its branches, leaves, flowers, and fruit in full abundance, serving the benefit of all beings, a tree endowed with qualities of every kind, too many to describe. Then, not long after, a great wind rose, and its branches and leaves all broke and were scattered like dust, so that it vanished from its place of great strength, and all beings grieved deeply. Having dreamed this, he awoke uneasy and afraid, and thought, "I dreamed of a great tree endowed with every quality, serving the benefit of all gods and humans, and not long after a great wind scattered it and destroyed it. The Blessed One, like a great tree, is the refuge of all. Can it be that the Blessed One intends to pass into nirvāṇa?" Thinking this, he was terrified, and he came to where the Blessed One was, bowed his head at his feet, and spoke these words to the Blessed One: "While I was in the grove I dreamed a dream like this. Can it be that the Blessed One intends to pass into nirvāṇa?"

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "It is just so. It is as you have said: three months from now I shall pass into nirvāṇa. Whoever has attained the four bases of miraculous power can remain for an eon. I too have thoroughly cultivated the four bases of miraculous power, and I asked you whether it would now be fitting for the Tathāgata to remain for as long as his lifespan lasts. Though I asked you three times, you could not answer. After you had gone, the king of the māras, the Evil One, came and entreated me to pass into nirvāṇa, and I agreed to it."

When Ānanda heard the Blessed One say this, he was deeply unhappy and tormented by grief, so that his body could not bear it. The attendants told one another, and all of them, tormented by grief, went to where the Blessed One was. Then the Blessed One said to Ānanda and the attendants, "Who is there that is called permanent? Nothing at all is permanent. For your sake I have done everything that was to be done, and I have finished teaching the teaching. So do not grieve, but apply yourselves earnestly with diligence."

Then, when the venerable Śāriputra heard that the Blessed One was to pass into nirvāṇa, he was grief-stricken and said, "The Tathāgata's passing into nirvāṇa is far too soon! The whole world with its gods will be left blind and without a protector." And he spoke these words to the Blessed One: "I cannot bear to see the Blessed One pass into nirvāṇa. By whatever means, let me pass into nirvāṇa first." He asked this three times.

The Blessed One said, "If you know that the time has come, all noble ones, being at peace, pass into nirvāṇa."

Śāriputra, having received the Blessed One's word of permission, put on his patched robe, circumambulated the Blessed One about a hundred times, and praised him in many kinds of verse. Then, holding the Buddha's feet and hands, he touched his head to the ground three times, joined his palms, and said, "Even now, at the very last, I behold the Blessed One." With reverence he bowed and took his leave, and with his attendant, the novice Cunda, he went to Rājagṛha, the place where he had been born.

When they had arrived, he instructed the novice Cunda: "Go to all the towns, the market towns, the king's palace, the ministers' residences, and the homes of patrons and friends, and tell them that I bid them farewell." Then the novice Cunda, as his teacher had instructed, went everywhere and announced, "My preceptor Śāriputra has come here and is about to pass into nirvāṇa. If you wish to see him, all of you come!" Then King Ajātaśatru, the householders of great and high families, and the patrons, hearing the novice's announcement, were all unhappy and tormented by grief, and all with one voice spoke these words:

"The venerable Śāriputra, the great chief of the Dharma, who has become the spiritual friend of so many beings, is now to pass into nirvāṇa: this is far, far too soon!" Saying this, they quickly came to where Śāriputra was, bowed, and spoke these words: "Venerable Śāriputra, great chief of the Dharma, spiritual friend of so many beings, you are giving up your life entirely and passing into

nirvāṇa, and so we and many other beings will be left without protector or ally."

Then Śāriputra said to the great assembly, "All things are impermanent. What is born ends in death; what comes together ends in separation. Since the three realms are filled with suffering, who could be happy in them? Through your past roots of virtue you have indeed met with a buddha who has come into the world; yet to hear the sūtras and the Dharma is very hard, and to gain a human body is also very hard. So strive in deeds that become an accumulation of merit and bring liberation from saṃsāra." With many kinds of skillful means he taught the great assembly at length, as one gives medicine to the sick. When he had taught the Dharma to the great assembly, some attained the fruits from the first fruit up to the third; some went forth and became arhats; and some vowed to attain the state of a pratyekabuddha. Having heard the Dharma taught, they bowed and each went his own way.

Then, in the last part of that night, Śāriputra set his body and mind upright and, with mind one-pointed, entered the first meditative concentration. Emerging from the first concentration, he entered the second concentration. Emerging from the second concentration, he entered the third concentration. Emerging from the third concentration, he entered the fourth concentration. Emerging from the fourth concentration, he entered the absorption of the sphere of infinite space. Emerging from the absorption of the sphere of infinite space, he entered the absorption of the sphere of infinite consciousness. Emerging from the absorption of the sphere of infinite consciousness, he entered the absorption of the sphere of nothingness. Emerging from the absorption of the sphere of nothingness, he entered the absorption of the sphere of neither perception nor non-perception. Emerging from the absorption of the sphere of neither perception nor non-perception, he entered the absorption of cessation. Emerging from the absorption of cessation, he passed into nirvāṇa.

At that time Śakra, lord of the gods (Indra), knowing that Śāriputra had passed into nirvāṇa, came to that place with many hundreds of thousands of gods in his retinue, each carrying offerings such as flowers and incense. They filled the sky above without any gap, shed tears like rain, and strewed flowers until they lay knee-deep, and they said, "The wisdom of the venerable Śāriputra was as deep and wide as the ocean; endowed with reasoning intellect, his eloquence was like a spring. Possessed of moral discipline, absorption, and wisdom, this great chief of the Dharma turned the wheel of Dharma far and wide after the

Tathāgata. That he should pass into nirvāṇa today is far too soon!"

All the people living inside and outside that city, hearing that Śāriputra had passed into nirvāṇa, came carrying ghee, fragrant oil, incense, flowers, and articles of offering. Tormented by grief beyond what their bodies could bear, they made offerings, each with the articles he had brought.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, commanded Viśvakarman, "Prepare a chariot adorned with many jewels; Śāriputra's body is to be laid on it." Then the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, the king, the ministers, and all the people of the land, with music playing, bore it to a pleasant, level place. Śakra, lord of the gods, commanded the yakṣas, "Fetch ox-head sandalwood from the shore of the ocean." The yakṣas brought sandalwood from the shore of the ocean and piled it up, laid the body on it, sprinkled it with ghee and oil, and set it alight. All that assembly bowed and went back.

After the fire had died down, the novice Cunda took his teacher's relics, his alms bowl, and his three robes, and went to where the Buddha was. He bowed his head at his feet, set his kneecaps on the ground, and said, "My teacher has passed into nirvāṇa. These are his relics, his robes, and his alms bowl."

When Ānanda heard what the novice said, he was deeply tormented by grief and spoke these words to the Blessed One: "If even Śāriputra, the great chief and master of the Dharma, has passed into nirvāṇa, with whom shall we take our stand, and in whom shall we take refuge?"

The Blessed One said, "Although Śāriputra has passed into nirvāṇa, his moral discipline, absorption, wisdom, liberation, and the vision of the wisdom of liberation, his Dharma body, have not passed into nirvāṇa. It is not only now that Śāriputra, unable to bear seeing me pass into nirvāṇa, has passed into nirvāṇa before me. In times long past too, unable to bear my death, he died before me."

Ānanda joined his palms and said to the Blessed One, "Please explain in full the matter of how, in a former life too, he died first and the Blessed One passed away afterward."

The Blessed One spoke these words to Ānanda: "Long ago, before countless, measureless, inconceivable eons had passed, in a great land here in Jambudvīpa there arose a king called Candraprabha, who ruled over Jambudvīpa, over eighty-four thousand vassal kings, and over eight hundred thousand cities in sixty thousand provinces. That king had twenty thousand

queens. The senior queen was called Flower Giver, and the middle queen was called Great Eyes. That king had some five hundred princes. The king's eldest son, the regent, was called Excellent Discipline. The palace where the king lived was called Good Life; that palace measured four hundred yojanas square and was made of gold, silver, beryl, and crystal. In its pleasure garden there were four rows of trees of gold, silver, beryl, and crystal.

Some had branches of gold and leaves of silver; some had branches of silver and leaves of gold; some had branches of beryl and leaves of crystal; some had branches of crystal and leaves of beryl. The jewel ponds too were made of gold, silver, beryl, and crystal, and the floors of the ponds were spread with sand of the four kinds of jewels. Around the king's palace alone, for forty yojanas in every direction, the land was filled to overflowing with gold, silver, beryl, and crystal. The people who lived in that land were happy and content; the harvests were good, their wealth was abundant, and they possessed countless precious jewels.

At that time, as the king dwelt in his palace, this thought kept arising in him: "Those in the world who are powerful and great are honored by everyone." No sooner had he thought this than the finest enjoyments of the five sense pleasures came to him just as he wished. "That I have attained such a supreme result has come from the accumulation of merit I produced in the past. Farmers, for example, hope that if they sow much seed in spring, they will gather much in autumn. I am just the same: because I produced an accumulation of merit in the past, all this has now come to me. If I do not plant seed now, there will be nothing to hope for later." With this thought he said to his ministers, "Now, in order to give away all my jewels and wealth, pile them up at the city gates and at the crossroads of the marketplace, and let whatever I possess be given to beings as they wish. Further, I decree that all the treasuries of the eighty-four thousand vassal kingdoms be given to the multitude of beings." Having commanded this, he raised a golden banner and beat a golden drum, and had it proclaimed far and wide in every direction, so that all heard and knew.

Then the śramaṇas and brahmins dwelling in that land, the poor and destitute, the helpless, the old, and all who lacked means gathered like clouds. To those who wanted clothes he gave clothes; to those who wanted food, food; to those who wanted gold, silver, and jewels, gold, silver, and jewels; and to the sick, medicines and whatever else they needed for their illnesses, just as they wished. At that time all the beings living in Jambudvīpa, through the king's

kindness, were happy and content; they sang songs, danced, and praised him in verse. The king's good name was proclaimed to the farthest borders, and there was no one who did not obey his command.

At that time, in the borderlands of the country, a minor king called Bhīmasena grew jealous of King Candraprabha. He could not lie down in comfort and could not sleep, and he thought, "So long as I have not done away with King Candraprabha, my name will never become renowned. I will summon the wandering ascetics who live in the regions of my land and find a way to have them accomplish this." With this thought he summoned the wandering ascetics who lived in his land, prepared food of a hundred flavors of every kind, and honored them respectfully for three months. Then he spoke these words to the wandering ascetics: "I am overcome with grief and have no peace day or night. You are practitioners of Dharma and worthy of offerings, so think of a way to rid me of my grief."

The brahmins said, "Tell us, O king, why you are distressed. We will do whatever we can so that the king is no longer distressed."

The king said, "King Candraprabha's virtues are renowned everywhere, and everyone serves and honors him, while I alone have no renown for virtue. I would be glad to have that king done away with. Tell me what means you have."

When the brahmins heard this command, they said these words to one another: "This King Candraprabha is endowed with compassion. His kindness pervades all beings, and to the poor and destitute he is like a father and mother. Even if it costs us our lives, none of us could harm him." So they said, and without regard even for their livelihood they went their separate ways.

When King Bhīmasena heard what they had said, he was all the more displeased, and he issued this decree: "Whoever cuts off King Candraprabha's head for my sake and brings it here, to him I will give half my kingdom and my daughter for a wife." When he had issued this decree, a brahmin called Raudrākṣa, up on a rocky mountain, heard it. He came to where that king was, overjoyed, and said, "I can accomplish what the king intends."

The king said, "If you are to accomplish this, on what day will you go?"

The brahmin said, "Give me provisions for the road, and I will set out seven days from now." For seven days the brahmin performed mantras to protect his body; then he took his leave of the king, set out on the road, and went.

At that time all kinds of evil omens appeared in King Candraprabha's land. The whole earth cracked, lightning flashed, stars fell, and day and night the land was shrouded in darkness; thunder roared, hail fell, and thunderbolts struck. Many birds cried pitifully in the sky and fell from the sky of their own accord. Tigers, leopards, wolves, beasts of prey, wild game, and other animals ran and leapt about, uttering harsh cries. The eighty-four thousand vassal kings dreamed that the great king's golden banner broke and his golden drum split. The minister called Mahācandra dreamed that a hungry ghost snatched away the king's golden diadem. All of them were overcome with grief beyond what their bodies could bear.

At that time the god who guarded the city gates realized that the brahmin was coming to beg for the king's head. He confused and bewildered him and would not let him in through the city gates, so that though the brahmin circled the city many times, he could not get inside.

Then a god of the Pure Abodes, knowing that if King Candraprabha gave away his head he would bring the perfection of generosity to completion, informed the king in a dream: "Great king, you have vowed to give gifts without going against anyone's wishes. Now a beggar has come to the city gate, and he has no way to get inside." Thus he informed him.

When the king awoke he was amazed, and he commanded the minister Mahācandra, "Go, and whoever comes to the city gates, do not stop him; let him in."

When Mahācandra came to the city gates, the god who guarded the city gates revealed his body and said to Mahācandra, "A brahmin has come from another land. With an evil mind he has come to beg the king for his head, and so I have not let him in."

The minister said, "If that is true, it is a great omen of harm. Even so, the king's command must not be broken." So he ordered, and then the god who guarded the city let the brahmin in.

The minister Mahācandra thought, "This brahmin will certainly beg for the king's head. I will have five hundred heads made from each one of the seven precious substances, and with these heads I will ransom the king's head." With this thought he had them made.

Then the brahmin came to the king's palace and said in a loud voice, "I have come from the borderlands of the country. From far away I heard of the great

quality of the great king, that he gives away everything and does not go against the wishes of others, and so I have come here from a long road, wanting what I need."

When the king heard him say this, he was overjoyed and delighted. He paid homage to him and asked, "Are you not weary?" Then he said, "Whatever wealth you want, whether land, or a kingdom, or a city, or a wife, or a son, or a daughter, or jewels, or a vehicle, or an elephant, or a horse, or the seven precious substances, or a palace, or a male servant, or a female servant, or laborers, I will give you whatever you want."

The brahmin said, "A gift of external possessions brings much merit of giving, yet it does not become a great gift. The giving of the flesh and blood of one's own body is the highest merit, and so I have come this long road to ask for the king's head. If you will not go against my wish, please give it."

When the king heard him say this, he became incomparably joyful.

The brahmin said, "If you will give me your head, please declare when you will give it."

The king said, "Seven days from now I will give you my head."

Then the minister Mahācandra brought the heads made of the seven precious substances, and, prostrating himself on the ground before the brahmin, he said, "The king's head is flesh, blood and bone. It is impure; what would you do with it? Exchange that head for these heads of the seven precious substances. With these heads of the seven precious substances you will be rich for your whole life."

The brahmin said, "I do not need these. I need the king's head. Fulfill my hope!"

Although Mahācandra entreated him by every kind of means, the brahmin would not agree. Overwhelmed by sorrow, Mahācandra fainted, his heart burst into seven pieces, and he died.

At that time the king sent a minister mounted on an elephant that could travel a hundred thousand leagues to inform all the vassal kings: "Seven days from now King Candraprabha will make the gift of his head to a brahmin. All who wish to see it, come quickly!"

Then all of the eighty thousand vassal kings arrived at once. They came before the king, prostrated themselves on the ground, and said, "By the king's

kindness all the beings of Jambudvīpa are happy and at ease. Since there is no harm, it is not right to abandon all beings for the sake of one man. Out of compassion for us, we beg you not to make the gift of your head."

The ten thousand ministers also prostrated themselves on the ground and begged, "Out of compassion for us, do not make the gift of your head."

The twenty thousand queens also prostrated themselves on the ground and said to the king, "Think of us with compassion, and do not give your head, we beg you."

The five hundred princes also wept and said, "We have no protector and no refuge. Think of us with compassion, and do not make the gift of your head. Consider that we too are still learning by following you."

Then the great king said to the great ministers, the queens and the princes:

"From beginningless time this body has circled in saṃsāra. For a long time, while dwelling in the hells, it died many times even in a single day, and so this body was wasted. In the hells of the river of ash, the iron couches, the boiling water, the vomit, the chariots of fire, the fire pits and the rest, it experienced suffering for a long time. Boiled and burned and so on, this body was wasted countless times, yet there was not even a little merit.

"When I was born in the animal realm, we devoured and chewed one another; I was killed by others and eaten by all; I died and rotted and decayed, countless times. So too this body was wasted, yet it did not become merit.

"When I was born in the realm of hungry ghosts, my body blazed with fire, and no sooner had a wheel cut off my head than I revived again; this I experienced countless times. So the body was wasted, yet it did not become merit.

"When I was born as a human, for the sake of wealth and women, with eyes glaring in anger and fury, we harmed and killed one another, and came to the battlefront and killed one another. So the body was wasted, and through attachment, aversion and delusion I cast away countless bodies, yet it did not become merit.

"I shall give this body away. This body of mine is an aggregate of all kinds of impurity. Before long it will perish and fall apart. Since it is impermanent, if this filthy head can serve a beneficial aim, why should I not give it? I will give this head of mine to that brahmin, and with that merit I will accomplish unsurpassed awakening. When I am fully awakened as a buddha I will be endowed with perfect qualities, and by my skill in means I will free you too

from suffering."

"Through this giving that I make I shall become fully awakened. Do not hinder or obstruct my mind set on unsurpassed awakening."

When the vassal kings, the ministers, the queens and the princes heard him speak these words, they sat without saying anything.

Then the great king said to the brahmin, "Now the time has come to take my head. Take it!"

The brahmin replied, "Right now the king is surrounded by a large retinue of ministers and others. I alone do not have the power to cut off the king's head; it would not be borne. If you wish to give it to me, please go to the pleasure grove at the back."

Then the king commanded the vassal kings and the princes, "If you honor and serve me, do not make any trouble to harm this brahmin." Having so commanded, the king went together with the brahmin to the pleasure grove.

Then the brahmin said to the king, "The king is young, and in stature he is equal to a mighty wrestler. When the pain becomes unbearable, you may well regret it. So tie the king's head to a tree; only then will I kill you."

Then the king tied his head to a tree whose branches were firm and which was covered all over with leaves. He set his knees on the ground and said to the brahmin, "Cut off my head, then place it back in my hands, and take it from my hands. Through this merit of giving you my head, I do not wish to be Māra or Brahmā. It is not for the sake of wishing to be Śakra, or a wheel-turning king, or for the pleasures and enjoyments of the three realms. I wish for unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, in order to protect many beings and establish them in the bliss of nirvāṇa."

At that moment, as the brahmin raised his sword to strike, the deity of the tree became deeply displeased and thought, "Why should this man do the deed of killing?" The deity struck the brahmin a single slap beside his ear, and he lost control of his hands and feet and fell to the ground.

Then the king looked up at the deity of the tree and said, "In times past I made gifts of as many as nine hundred and ninety-nine heads at this tree. Now with this head the gifts will reach a full thousand, and the perfection of generosity will be completely fulfilled. Do not hinder my mind set on unsurpassed awakening."

Then, when the deity of the tree heard what the king said, it restored the brahmin to his senses. The brahmin got up, took his sword, and cut off the king's head. As the head fell into his hands, the great earth shook in six ways. The palaces of the gods also trembled and swayed, and the gods became uneasy and were filled with amazement. When they all saw that the bodhisattva had made the gift of his head for the sake of all beings, they all gathered and assembled, and, crying "How wondrous!", with tears falling like rain they wept and said, "By making the gift of his head, King Candraprabha has completely fulfilled the perfection of generosity."

This became known everywhere, and when King Bhīmasena heard it, he was displeased; he fainted, his heart burst, and he died.

At that time, as the brahmin was going away carrying the king's head, the vassal kings, the ministers, the queens and the princes threw themselves on the ground and wailed. Some vomited blood and died. Some fainted, unconscious of anything at all. Some tore out all their hair. Some ripped all their clothes. Some scratched their faces all over with both their hands, wailing and rolling on the ground.

Then the brahmin, thinking, "The king's head is ugly and stinking," did not want it, and he threw it on the ground and went away. Some brahmins reviled him, saying, "You are utterly wicked! If you had no need of it in the first place, why did you ask for it?" As the brahmin set out on the road, everyone he met reviled him and would not give him food, and he became utterly wretched. On the road he heard the news that Bhīmasena too had died. Since things had not turned out as he had first hoped, he was crushed by sorrow; his heart burst into seven pieces, he vomited blood, and he died.

When King Bhīmasena and the brahmin died, they were both reborn in the Avīci hell. Those who died tormented by grief for King Candraprabha were reborn as gods in the higher realms.

"Ānanda, King Candraprabha at that time, on that occasion, is now myself. King Bhīmasena is Māra the Evil One. The brahmin at that time is now Devadatta. The tree goddess at that time is now Maudgalyāyana. The minister Mahācandra at that time is Śāriputra. At that time too, unable to bear seeing me die, he died first. In this present time too, unable to bear seeing me pass into nirvāṇa, he has passed into nirvāṇa first."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Ānanda and the rest of the assembly praised him with one voice, saying, "The qualities of the

Tathāgata are wondrous and marvelous!" Through earnest application to meditation, some attained the fruits of the ascetic life, and some attained unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. They rejoiced and delighted in what the Blessed One had said.

This is the twenty-second chapter, on King Candraprabha's gift of his head.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time King Prasenajit had a minister called Mṛga, who was very rich and had great wealth. He had seven sons.

Six of the sons had taken wives, but among them the one youngest son had not taken a wife, and his father thought, "I am old and frail. For this one son who has not taken a wife, I shall seek out an excellent, fine woman."

At that time the householder had a brahmin who was his close friend. Meeting him, he talked it over with him: "My youngest son has not yet taken a wife, and I do not know whom to ask. You travel through all lands; have you seen any girl who is good and beautiful, intelligent, and blessed with long life and good fortune? You must find one who will please this son of mine."

The brahmin said, "I shall do so," and as he wandered everywhere searching, in a land called Śirititа he saw five hundred girls together who, while at play, were picking fine flowers and making garlands to offer to the Buddha. The brahmin followed after them, watching where the girls went. As the girls were wading across a small stream, all the others took off their shoes, but one girl crossed the water without taking off her shoes. Then, going on and on, they crossed a great river; the other girls took off their clothes and entered the water, but that girl alone crossed the water without even taking off her clothes. Then they went into a grove; the other girls climbed up into the trees and picked flowers, while that girl alone gathered them on the ground, yet she found more than the others.

Then the brahmin went up to the girl and said, "If I ask you about something I wonder about, give me a good answer."

The girl said, "If you have a doubt, ask."

The brahmin asked, "Girl, when you crossed the water, the other girls took off their shoes to cross. You alone crossed the water without taking off your shoes. What other thought did you have?"

The girl said, "Your doubt is nothing very remarkable. When I walk on dry ground, my eyes can see what lies beneath my feet, so if I notice a thorn, or a stone, or a potsherd, or anything unpleasant, I step around it as I go. But the eyes cannot see what is at the bottom of the water. I did not take off my shoes for fear that if I stepped on thorns, or snakes, or venomous insects, my feet would be harmed."

The brahmin said, "Then why did you go into the water with your clothes on?"

The girl said, "A woman's body has good marks and bad ones. If one takes off one's clothes and goes into the water, others will see. If the marks are good, they will say nothing; but if the marks are bad, one will be mocked. So I did not take off my clothes."

The brahmin said, "Then why did you alone not climb the trees?"

The girl said, "If I climbed a tree, and a branch broke or I fell, my body would be harmed. So I did not climb the tree."

This girl was the daughter of Balamitra, the younger brother of King Prasenajit. The king's brother had once committed an offense, and so he was banished from that country and came to this one, where he took a woman called Divine Boundary as his wife; and this girl was born from her.

The brahmin said, "Girl, you are very wise and intelligent indeed. Do you have a father and mother?"

The girl said, "I do."

"Then let us go together to your house," he said, and when they reached her door the girl went inside and said to her parents, "At the door there is a brahmin who says he wishes to meet Father."

The girl's father came out to the door. They asked each other, "Are you well?" Then the brahmin asked, "Is that girl just now your daughter?"

He said, "She is my daughter."

"Then does she have a husband?"

He said, "She has no husband."

The brahmin said, "Do you know the minister called Mṛga in Śrāvastī?"

He said, "He is my friend."

The brahmin said, "That minister's youngest son is handsome in appearance and upright in mind. I ask for your daughter as his wife."

He said, "That family is great and high. If he wants my daughter, I shall do just as you think best."

When he had said this, the brahmin, since a companion was going back to Śrāvastī, sent a letter by way of that brahmin. When the letter arrived through the brahmin, horses, chariots and so on to welcome the bride were made ready, and then they set out for the land of Śiritita. As they drew near, they sent a man ahead to announce them, and the father too prepared a feast for sending off his daughter as a bride, and sent his daughter off as a bride.

When they had received the girl and were setting out for Śrāvastī, the girl's mother said to her daughter in front of many people, "From today on, always wear fine clothes and eat delicious food. Look in the mirror every single day without fail."

The girl said, "I shall do so."

Her father-in-law was displeased, and thought, "For anyone who is born, happiness and sorrow are impermanent. How could one always get fine clothes and delicious food? And to tell her always to look in the mirror is not proper either." With this thought, they took leave of one another and parted.

They all set out together on the road, returning to their own country. Along the way there was a fine, cool house, and those of them who had gone ahead stopped and settled in that house. When the new bride arrived there later, she said to her father-in-law, "It is not right to stay beneath this. Please go out onto the open ground quickly." As the bride had said, he came out onto the open ground. Some servants were unwilling to go and stayed on beneath the house. Before long an ox and a horse came there and rubbed against a pillar; the house collapsed, and those who were beneath the house perished.

The father-in-law thought, "It is this daughter-in-law who has saved me from losing my life," and he felt special affection for his daughter-in-law.

Then, going on and on, they stopped in a hollow that had grass and water. The daughter-in-law came later and said, "It is not right to stay in this hollow. Move quickly!" No sooner had they moved somewhere else than a violent downpour fell, and a great flood came into the hollow where they had first camped.

The father-in-law thought, "Twice now my daughter-in-law has saved me from losing my life." Setting out, they went on and reached their own country. Then

the relatives arrived, spoke words of rejoicing, held a great feast, and made merry and celebrated for a whole day. After all the guests had dispersed, he called his daughters-in-law together and addressed them as follows.

"I am old in years and weary of affairs. Since I must hand over the household's wealth and goods to you, my daughters-in-law, which of you will keep the keys of the storehouse?"

When he asked this, all six of the elder daughters-in-law replied, "We cannot." The youngest among them replied, "I can."

Then the householder handed over all the keys of the storehouse, and the daughter-in-law managed it accordingly. In the morning she rose early, swept the whole house and sprinkled it with water. Then she cooked the food, and first served the meal to her father-in-law, her mother-in-law and the rest in order of seniority. After that she served the meal to the servants and the laborers. When she had set each of them to their work, only then did she herself eat. Because she always did things this way, her father-in-law thought, "This daughter-in-law of mine is not like the others; she is no ordinary person. Why, then, does the girl not do as her mother instructed?" With this thought he said to her, "When you set out from home, your mother said, 'Always wear fine clothes and eat delicious food; always look in the mirror.' What did those words mean?"

The daughter-in-law set both knees on the ground and replied, "When my mother instructed me to wear fine clothes, she meant: 'Always take care of the outer garments that are kept for wearing, and do not let them grow old. When guests or outsiders come, do not be poorly dressed.' When she said, 'Always eat delicious food,' she did not mean delicious and tasty food. She meant: 'If you eat later than everyone, then because you are hungry, all food is delicious.' When she said, 'Always look in the mirror,' she did not mean looking into a mirror of bronze or iron. She meant: 'Rise early and do your duties well: sweeping inside and out, sprinkling water, laying out the seats and cushions, and so on.' That is what my mother's instructions were."

At this he felt still greater affection for that daughter-in-law, and he entrusted all the work of the household to her, and everyone became happy and content.

At that time some birds were eating rice on an island in the ocean, and they flew off carrying ears of rice. When they came directly above the king's palace, some ears of rice slipped from them and fell right above the palace. Someone offered those ears of rice to the king. The king thought, "Such fine rice as this

will surely be fit for medicine; it should be kept for seed," and he divided it among all the ministers, portion by portion, and commanded, "Sow it!"

At that time the householder too received a little of it. He came back home and told his daughter-in-law, "Sow this rice." The daughter-in-law, as she had been told, sent other servants, had a field plowed thoroughly and sowed it, and it grew well accordingly and yielded a great deal of rice. In the fields sown by others, because the work had not been done well, not a single one grew.

At that time the king's queen was struck by an illness, and the physicians examined her and determined, "If she is given rice from the island in the ocean, she will recover from this sickness." The king remembered that he had had the rice from the island in the ocean sown by each of them, and asked, "Was the rice from the island in the ocean that I had sown planted or not?" Some ministers said, "The rice that was sown did not grow." Some said, "Mice ate all the rice, and there is none."

At that time the householder went back home and asked his daughter-in-law, "Did the rice I had you sow earlier grow or not? The king's queen has been struck by an illness, and it is needed as medicine."

The daughter-in-law replied, "The rice that was sown has done very well. There is not merely medicine for one person; there is enough to restore the people of a whole country."

The householder offered a portion of that rice to the king, and the king had the queen treated with that rice as medicine. The queen recovered, and the king was overjoyed and gave him many rewards.

At that time the king of Śirititа and the king of the land of Śrāvastī were displeased with each other and were never at peace. At that time the king of Śirititа thought, "I shall find out whether or not the king of Śrāvastī has wise ministers, learned and intelligent." He sent a messenger to the land of Śrāvastī, and with that messenger he sent a mare and her offspring, the two alike as mother and young, of one coat color and indistinguishable, the mare and her foal paired together, with the message, "Distinguish which is the mother and which is the young."

The king and the ministers looked, but not one of them could distinguish them.

Then the householder came home, and his daughter-in-law asked, "What news have you heard?" He told his daughter-in-law in detail, "This is the talk going around."

The daughter-in-law replied, "This is very easy to discern. Take the mare and her young and give them some good grass together. The one that is the mother will push the grass toward the young one with her lips and feed it."

The householder told the king what his daughter-in-law had said. The king gave them grass and watched, and it happened just so; he recognized the mother and the young, and said to the messenger, "This is the mother, and this is the young." The messenger said, "It is just as you say; there is no mistake."

Then the messenger went to his own country and reported this in detail to his king.

Then the king sent another messenger, sending two snakes alike and equal in thickness and length, with the command, "Distinguish which of these two snakes is male and which is female."

King Prasenajit and the ministers gathered and examined them, but not one of them could tell.

Then the householder asked his daughter-in-law at home, and the daughter-in-law explained: "Spread out a soft cloth and place the snakes on it. The one that is female will lie without moving at all. The one that is male will be the sort that cannot bear it and will not stay still. How can this be seen? The one that is female delights in what is soft and light. The one that is male, being by nature irritable, cannot bear softness and will not lie still. By this one will know."

The householder told the king accordingly, and when they did as the daughter-in-law had said, they distinguished clearly which was the male and which was the female. They told the messenger, "This is the male, and this is the female," and he said, "Just so; there is no mistake."

Then the king was overjoyed and gave him many precious jewels as a reward.

Then he also sent a log about a fathom long, equal in thickness throughout, without any distinguishing features, with no knots and no marks of axe or adze, with the command, "Distinguish which is the top and which is the bottom of this log."

The king and the ministers gathered and examined it, but not one of them could tell. The householder again asked his daughter-in-law, and she said, "This is very easy. If you want to know the top and bottom of this log, put it in the water. The root will sink downward, while the top will rise up."

The householder told the king accordingly, and when they did as the daughter-in-law had said, they recognized the top and the bottom, and they told the messenger, "This is the top, and this is the root." The messenger said, "Just so; it is true."

Then the king was overjoyed and gave him many rewards. The messenger went back to his own country and reported in detail to his king, and that king sent the messenger with many jewels, saying, "That great king has wise and intelligent ministers. Offer him these, and from now on let us be at peace."

King Prasenajit was overjoyed that things had turned out this way, and he said to the householder, "How did you work these things out and know them?"

The householder replied, "It was not I who worked this out. I have an intelligent daughter-in-law, and it was she who worked it out."

When the king heard him say this, he was overjoyed and declared, "From now on the householder's daughter-in-law shall be as a sister to me."

Later the householder's daughter-in-law became pregnant, and when nine months were complete, thirty-two eggs came forth, and from within each egg came forth a boy, handsome in appearance and lovely to behold. When the boys grew up, their courage was unequaled; each one of them was a match for a thousand men. Their father and mother loved those boys dearly, and all the people of the land held them in awe. Later each took a wife from a great and high family of matching lineage in that land.

At that time Divine Boundary, having a mind of faith, invited the Buddha and the Saṅgha. When the Blessed One taught the Dharma, all the people of the whole household attained the fruit of stream-entry; only the youngest of the boys did not attain the fruit.

That boy rode out on an elephant to play outside the city. Outside that city flowed a great river, and over it there was a bridge. As the boy came onto the bridge, the son of a chief minister, sitting in a chariot, was coming in from outside, and they met on the bridge. Both were proud of their noble birth, and neither would give way to the other. Divine Boundary's son became angry, and still mounted on his elephant, he threw the chief minister's son, chariot and all, off the bridge.

The minister's son, injured in his body, hands and feet, came home weeping and said to his father and mother, "Though I did nothing wrong, Divine Boundary's son did me this harm, and my whole body is hurt."

The chief minister was very displeased and thought, "Those sons are extremely powerful, and on top of that they are close to the king through their mother, so it is hard to contend with them. Even so, I shall devise a trick against them." With this thought he had thirty-two staffs made of the seven precious substances, placed a sharp-edged sword inside each staff, and gave one to each of the thirty-two boys, saying, "You have reached the prime of youth, and it is the time for play. I have had these staffs made for you to play with. Carry them and enjoy yourselves." The boys were delighted, took the staffs, and each carried one.

By the king's law, no one was permitted to carry weapons when meeting the king. As they sat attending on the king carrying the staffs, the minister slandered them to the king, saying, "Those thirty-two sons of Divine Boundary are young and in their prime. In strength each of them is a match for a thousand men, and they are intending to do the king some harm."

Even so, the king did not believe it of them, and the minister said again, "What I said before is true; it is not a lie, it is always so. In each of these staffs that the boys carry in their hands there is a sword, so it is evident that they mean to do harm."

When, as the minister had said, they examined the boys' staffs, the weapons were there. They called them one by one, had them seized by strongmen, and killed them all. They cut off the boys' heads, put the thirty-two heads of the boys into a box, sealed it well, and sent it to the king's sister.

At that time the boys' mother had invited the Buddha and the Saṅgha, and when the box sent by the king arrived, she thought that inside it there might be some contribution for making offerings, and she was about to open the box. The Blessed One said, "Do not open the box for now. Open it after the meal has been served."

Then, after the meal had been served, the Blessed One taught the Dharma to the boys' mother: "This body is impermanent, suffering, empty and without self. It has no essence and does not last long. It is bound and fettered by the afflictions and tormented by suffering. Through sorrow at being parted from what one loves, this body is wasted, and that is of no benefit. Whoever is learned and wise will understand this point."

Divine Boundary understood the point and attained the fruit of once-returning. Overjoyed and delighted, she joined her palms and said to the Blessed One,

"Blessed One, out of compassion for me, please grant these four requests of mine. Of my four requests, the first is to provide sick monks with medicine for their illness, food and drink as they wish; the second is to supply food and drink as they wish to those who attend on sick monks; the third is to provide the requisites for visiting monks; and the fourth is to provide provisions and requisites for monks setting out on a journey."

"Why is this? Sick monks who lack the medicine they need for their illness, and food and drink, are hard to cure, and it may even cost them their lives. The monks who attend the sick, for want of food, also go for alms. But almsgoing has its fixed time, and if they are late or do not obtain what is wanted, the sick monk grows angry and becomes hard to care for; so I wish to offer food to them as well. Monks who come from far away do not know the country and have no friends, so they go for alms. When they go for alms, if they are harassed by dogs or by ruffians, anger arises and their patience is impaired; so I wish to offer food to them as well. Monks setting out on a journey, even when they have companions, may lack provisions and be parted from their companions; there are many beasts of prey or savage bandits on the road, and if they go on alone, that too may endanger their bodies. So I wish to provide for their needs as well."

Then the Blessed One, having heard the four requests Divine Boundary had made, praised her, saying, "Excellent, excellent! The vast merit of these four requests you have made is no different from making offerings to the Buddha." Having declared this, he returned with the Saṅgha to the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta.

After the Blessed One had gone, she opened the casket and looked inside. She saw that it held the heads of her thirty-two sons, yet because she was free of desire, she did not become distressed. She said, "Alas! For anyone who is born, life also comes to an end, and it is not long in coming. Now, in which of the five realms will they experience suffering?"

When the relatives on the mother's side of the thirty-two boys heard what had happened, they were deeply displeased, and anger arose in them. They said, "Though they pleased him so, the great king has killed every one of them. We will go and make war on him." They gathered a military force and surrounded the king's palace. The king was terrified and fled to where the Buddha was. Hearing of this, they surrounded the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta with their army as well.

Then Ānanda heard that King Prasenajit had killed the thirty-two sons of Divine Boundary and that those belonging to their mother's family had come to take revenge. He set his knee on the ground, joined his palms, and said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, through what cause and what condition were these thirty-two men killed by the king all at once?"

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "It is not only now that the thirty-two sons of Divine Boundary have been killed by the king all at once. I shall explain to you in detail why these thirty-two men lost their lives all at once. Listen well and keep it in mind." Ānanda replied, "I shall do so. I wish to hear it."

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "In times long past, these thirty-two men were fond of one another, friends and intimates. By common agreement they stole a cow belonging to someone else. At that time there lived in that country a poor old woman with no children at all. The men who had stolen the cow led it to that old woman's house and were about to slaughter it there, and the old woman, delighted, gathered firewood and the like and prepared the things for cooking the meat. When the men were about to kill the cow there, the cow understood that it was to be killed and made a resolve, saying, 'Because you are now killing me, in the future, even if you should attain the fruit, I will not let you go: may I come to kill you!' As soon as it had made this vow, the men killed the cow. Some boiled the meat and some roasted it, and they ate it. The old woman too was sated with the cow's meat and greatly delighted, and she said, 'Guests like these have come before, but none has ever been of more help than today's.'

"The cow of that time was King Prasenajit. The cow thieves of that time are these thirty-two sons of Divine Boundary. The old woman, the mistress of the house, at that time is their mother. By that karmic maturation, for five hundred lifetimes they were always killed. And the old woman of that time, merely through rejoicing and being glad, was always their mother and was tormented by that much grief. Now, having met me, she has attained the fruit."

Again Ānanda joined his palms and said to the Blessed One, "What merit did they make, that they came to be of a great and high family, possessed of wealth, brave and endowed with strength?"

The Blessed One said, "In times long past, when the buddha Kāśyapa had appeared in the world, there was an old woman with great faith in the Three Jewels. She would buy a great deal of incense, mix it with butter, and continually anoint a stupa with it. On one occasion, as she was anointing the

stupa, thirty-two men arrived there and helped the old woman anoint it. The old woman said to those thirty-two men, 'By the merit of helping me anoint the stupa, wherever you are born, may you have fine fortune and be endowed with power and strength!' They too, greatly delighted, did the work of anointing the stupa and said, 'Through this old woman we have brought about meritorious deeds.' And they made this aspiration: 'Wherever we are born, may we be of high and mighty family, rich, and possessed of wealth; may this old woman always be our mother and we her sons; may we never be parted from the Buddha and from hearing the Dharma; and may we quickly attain the fruit!' The old woman too said, 'May it be so!' And so for five hundred lifetimes they were of high and mighty family.

"The old woman of that time is now the mother of these boys. The thirty-two men of that time are these boys."

Then, when the soldiers heard what the Buddha had said, their angry minds were all pacified, and they said, "Let the great king be forgiven. This is the karmic maturation of these men's former deeds: merely from killing a cow it has come to this. This King Prasenajit is our lord.

Why should we bear a grudge against him and think of harming him?" Having said this, they threw down their weapons, went before the king, and confessed their offense, and the king for his part let them go without bringing any charge.

Then the Blessed One, taking this account of what had happened in the past, taught the sublime Dharma at length to the fourfold assembly. He taught that it is right to make diligent effort in virtuous actions and not right to commit nonvirtuous actions, and he also taught the Four Noble Truths at length. When the great assembly heard this, all of them attained the fruit, and they rejoiced in what the Blessed One had said and were delighted.

This is the chapter on the seven sons of the minister Mṛga, the twenty-third.

Fascicle seven.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time the king of that country was called Prasenajit. To its south lay a country called Golden Land, whose king was called Kapphiṇa. That king's son was called Mahākapphiṇa. When his father the king died, the son, as crown prince, ascended the throne. He was by nature upright of mind and clear of intellect,

brave, and possessed of great might and prowess. He had thirty-six thousand battalions of troops, and wherever those troops descended, like a great wind, there was no foe they could not overcome. He had no dealings with the kings of the Middle Country.

Later some merchants went to Golden Land and presented that king with four bolts of fine, soft cloth. The king accepted them and asked the merchants, "Where does such a fine treasure come from?" The merchants replied, "It comes from the Middle Country." The king said, "What is this place called the Middle Country? What is the name of the Middle Country?" The merchants replied, "The Middle Country is called Rājagṛha, and it is also called Śrāvastī; and there are many other names of countries there besides." The king said, "Why do those kings not come to pay homage to me and offer tribute?" The merchants replied, "Those kings each hold their own kingdoms and manage the affairs of their own lands, so they do not come here."

The king thought, "By my might and majesty I have subdued everything under heaven. Why then do these kings not come to pay homage to me and offer tribute? Now I shall bring them down by my might and majesty." And he said to the merchants, "Among the kings of the Middle Country, which king is the greatest?" The merchants said, "Among them the king of Śrāvastī is the greatest."

Then that king sent an envoy to Śrāvastī with this message for King Prasenajit: "My might and majesty hold sway over all that belongs to Jambudvīpa, so why do you not even exchange envoys with me? Now I have sent an envoy to you. When you hear my name, if you are lying down, you should sit up. If you are sitting, you should rise. If you are eating, you should spit the food out without taking time to swallow. If you hear it in the midst of bathing, you should tie up your hair at once. If you are staying still, you should run. Within seven days from now, come here to meet me. If you do not, I shall lead my army and wipe out your country."

When King Prasenajit heard this message, he was displeased and alarmed. He went to where the Blessed One was and told him all of it in full. The Blessed One said, "Your Majesty, tell that envoy, 'Among kings I am not great; there is a king greater than I.'" So King Prasenajit, as the Blessed One had instructed, ordered him, "In this world there is a king of magic who dwells not far from here. Go there yourself and do just as your king's message says." And the envoy set out from the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta.

At that time the Blessed One transformed himself into a wheel-turning monarch, emanated Maudgalyāyana as his great minister, and sat endowed with the seven precious things. He also transformed the park into jewels: outside the park there was a moat of jewels in seven tiers, and between the moats were dense trees of the seven kinds of jewels, with countless lotuses of every color shimmering and glittering. Within the park, in a palace made of various jewels, he conjured a king of exceedingly great majesty seated there.

The envoy came to the conjured palace, and at the mere sight of the great king he was seized with terror. He thought, "My king's majesty and merit cannot match this. Nevertheless, I shall present the letter he sent," and he presented the letter. The king of magic took the letter and placed it under the sole of his foot, and said to the envoy, "I am a great king who holds sway over the four continents. Why should I obey that foolish king of yours? Go back quickly and tell him that I have commanded as follows: 'As soon as your envoy returns and you hear my command, if you hear it while lying down, you should rise. If you hear it while sitting, you should stand. If you hear it while walking, you should run. If within seven days from now you do not come here to pay homage, and so break my command, you will be dealt with according to the law.'"

The envoy went back as he had been commanded, and on reaching his own country he told the king of Golden Land in full all that he had seen and the message he had been sent with. When the king heard that message, he became remorseful and thought, "I shall go to the great king together with all the vassal kings under my rule. But it is not proper to go unannounced; I shall consult him once more." So he first sent an envoy ahead, saying, "When I come to pay homage to the great king, since there are three hundred sixty thousand vassal kings under my rule, should they all come, or should only half of them come? Please give your command."

The great king replied, ordering him, "Come with half of your vassal kings." So the king of Golden Land, together with eighteen thousand vassal kings, arrived in Śrāvastī before the conjured king and paid homage to him, and he thought this:

"This great king surpasses me in appearance, but in might and strength he is no match for me." As he thought this, the king of magic said to his precious minister, "Give your bow to the king of Golden Land." The king took it, but when he tried to lift it, he could not. Then the king of magic took it, strung the

bow with his little finger, and said to the king of Golden Land, "Draw this bow." When the king of Golden Land took it, he could not so much as move the bowstring. Then the king of magic took it and drew it, and merely by the twang of the bowstring the great thousandfold world system quaked and shook.

Then he took up an arrow and shot it, and the moment it was shot it became five arrows. From the tips of those arrows came countless rays of light, and on each there appeared a lotus as large as a chariot wheel, and on each lotus there was a wheel-turning monarch endowed with the seven precious things. Those rays of light illuminated the great trichiliocosm, and there was no being of the five realms whom they did not benefit.

In the abodes of the gods, that light was seen and the voice teaching the Dharma resounded, and their bodies and minds were wholly purified. Some attained the fruits from stream-entry up to arhatship. Some generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Some came to dwell on the ground of irreversibility.

The beings of the human realm who saw the Buddha's light and heard the Dharma he taught were overjoyed and delighted. Some attained stream-entry, once-returning or non-returning, and some went forth and attained the fruit of arhatship. Countless beings generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening and came to dwell on the ground of irreversibility.

Those of the realm of hungry ghosts were touched by the Buddha's light and heard the Dharma, and so all were sated with food. Free of torment in body and mind, they were content, and in all of them a compassionate mind arose. They paid honor to the Buddha, were freed from the state of hungry ghosts, and were born as gods and humans.

The beings in the animal realm, by seeing the Buddha's light, had their minds of desire and anger wholly pacified, and those blinded by delusion were awakened. All of them rejoiced in the Buddha and had faith in him, and so they were freed from the animal state and were born as gods and humans.

For the hell beings, when the Buddha's light touched them, the cold became warm and the heat became cool. Their torment of suffering was cut off, and because they were overjoyed in body and mind, they had faith in the Buddha, escaped from hell, and were born as gods and humans.

At that time King Mahākapphiṇa and the vassal kings of Golden Land, having seen such miracles, were filled with nothing but the deepest faith, and through

that faith they became free of dust and free of stain, and the Dharma eye regarding phenomena was purified in them; the minds of the eighteen thousand vassal kings were satisfied.

At once the Buddha withdrew his miraculous display and showed himself once more in his own Buddha form, seated and surrounded in front and behind by the Saṅgha of monks. Then the king of Golden Land asked the Blessed One for permission to go forth, and when the Blessed One said, "Welcome!" his hair and beard fell away of themselves, and he became a monk wearing saffron robes. By taking the Dharma to heart he exhausted the defilements and became an arhat.

Then Ānanda said to the Blessed One, "What merit did this king of Golden Land make in the past, that he is of such great and high family, eminent in noble qualities, and that upon meeting the Buddha, the Blessed One, he exhausted the defilements at once?"

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "The fruits of beings' actions ripen in accordance with their conduct. In times long past, the buddha Kāśyapa appeared in the world. After that buddha had passed into nirvāṇa, a certain householder built a stupa, made a dwelling for the Saṅgha, and provided the four requisites for living. After a long time had passed, the stupa fell into ruin, and the requisites for living, seats, clothing and food, were also cut off.

"Then that householder's son, who was a monk, taught the Dharma to many people, restored the stupa once more, and provided requisites such as clothing, bedding, food and drink, and seats. In harmony of mind with those people, he provided the requisites for living, and they made this aspiration: 'In the future may we be mighty and rich and long-lived, may we meet a buddha who has appeared in the world, and having heard the Dharma, may our fruit not be an ordinary one!'

"Ānanda, the householder's son, the monk of that time, is Mahākapphiṇa, king of the country of Golden Land. Those who, when he taught the Dharma, restored the stupa and supplied the requisites for living, are the eighteen thousand vassal kings."

When the Blessed One had said this, many in the assembly generated the irreversible mind, and they rejoiced and were delighted.

This is the chapter on Mahākapphiṇa, the twenty-fourth.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. King Prasenajit had died, and the crown prince Vaiḍūrya had ascended the throne. Because he did not rule in accordance with the Dharma, countless people were trampled under the hooves of elephants and killed.

At that time some women of great and noble family, seeing such things, lost all delight in household life, and all of them went forth and became nuns. Of those who went forth, some were of the Śākya clan and some of the royal caste; incomparably graceful and lovely to behold, some five hundred women of great family gave up all their possessions and went forth. All the people of the country rejoiced in them and provided for their livelihood.

Those nuns said to one another, "Though we have gone forth, we have not tasted the nectar of the Dharma. Since it will not do unless we pacify desire, anger and delusion, let us go to Upanandā of the group of six and listen to the Dharma." Having said this, they went to where she was, and when they arrived they bowed and said, "Though we have gone forth, we have not tasted the nectar of the Dharma. Please teach us."

The nun of the group of six thought, "If I could turn these women back from the Dharma and from moral discipline and get hold of their robes and alms bowls, how fine that would be!" And she said this to them: "You are of great and high family. You lack nothing: the seven precious things, elephants, horses, menservants and maidservants, workers, fields, and the requisites for living. Why then have you given all of these up and entered the order of nuns, so as to take on the training of the Buddha, afflicted like this and bound up with suffering? You would do better to go back home, and, with husbands, sons and daughters, delight together as you please, enjoy yourselves and know happiness in this life as well, and give gifts as you wish. That would be good." Thus she advised them.

When those nuns heard this advice they were displeased, and they left at once. Then those nuns went to where the nun Utpalavarṇā was. When they arrived, they bowed to Utpalavarṇā, asked after her health in the proper manner, and said, "While we were living in our homes, we were deceived by household affairs. Now, though we have gone forth, we have fallen under the power of desire and cannot free ourselves from the afflictions. Out of compassion for us, please teach us the sublime Dharma."

Utpalavarṇā said, "Ask about whatever you wish, any matter at all, past, future or present, and I shall explain it." The nuns replied, "Leave aside the past and the future for now, and teach us about the present. Please resolve our doubts."

Utpalavarṇā said, "Desire is like fire: it burns up mountains and valleys. It is like a spread of grass: it keeps spreading. Under the power of desire people harm and injure one another. Through it one falls for a long time into the three lower realms, with no time of release. Those who live in a household are attached to those they love, and they experience without cease the sufferings of separation from what they desire, of birth, aging, sickness and death, and of harassment by the king's laws. Body and mind are tormented, as though one had died and come back to life again. One is trapped by the household, and its bonds are tighter even than a prison.

"I too was born into a family of wandering ascetics (parivrājakas). Since my parents were of great and respected family, they gave me in marriage to a man of a great family of wandering ascetics, a man of great learning and versed in the Vedas of the wise. I became his wife, and he had a son by me.

"Later, after my parents-in-law had died, I became pregnant, and I said to my husband, 'I am with child, and my months are nearly full. If I give birth here it will be unclean and unpleasant, so I shall go to my parents' home to give birth.' He said to me, 'Very well.' So husband and wife set out together, taking our son as well, for my parents' home. When we had gone about halfway, my womb became uneasy, and in the middle of the night I gave birth to a son at the foot of a tree.

"My husband, who was sleeping apart, was bitten by a snake in the night. When I called to him in the night, he made no sound at all. When I looked at dawn, I found that my husband had been bitten by a venomous snake and had died, and his body was falling apart. Then I fainted and fell to the ground. My elder son, seeing that his father had been killed by the snake, cried out and wept, and at the sound of his weeping I came back to my senses. Carrying the elder son on my back and holding the little one in my lap, I went on, weeping. The road was deserted, I met no one at all, and I found no companion.

"On the way there was a great river. Because the river was wide and deep, I could not carry both children at once. I left the elder son on the near bank, carried the little one across to the far bank, and was coming back to fetch the elder son. But the boy, seeing his mother coming, went into the water and was swept away by the current. I went after him, but my strength was small and I

could not catch him, and the current carried him off.

"Then, as I went back to the far bank, I found that the little son had been eaten by a wolf; only a little blood could be seen on the ground. There I fainted again, and when after a long while I came to, I set off along the road. As I went on I met a wandering ascetic who was close to my parents, a friend of theirs. That ascetic asked me, 'What has gone wrong, that you have become so afflicted?' I told him in full the story of what had happened. The ascetic wept, and when I asked him for news of my parents, he said, 'Recently a fire broke out in your parents' home, and your parents and everyone in the household were burned to death.' When I heard him say this, I fainted and fell to the ground.

"Then that ascetic lifted me up and took me to his home, where he loved and cherished me like a daughter. Later another wandering ascetic took me as his wife, and as I enjoyed the pleasures of love with him, I became pregnant. When my months were full and the birth was near, my husband was invited to someone else's home for beer, and while he was away I gave birth. I had shut the door tight and was giving birth when my husband, drunk on beer, knocked at the door. Since no one opened it, he became furious, broke down the door, came in, and beat me. When I said, 'I have given birth to a son,' he killed the child, fried it in butter, and made me eat it. I could not bring myself to eat my child's flesh, and when I did not eat it he beat me again and forced me to eat it. After I had eaten it, and my husband had sobered up, I thought to myself, 'I have no merit and my karma is evil.' I left my husband and fled to the country of Vārāṇasī.

"I was sitting at the foot of a tree outside Vārāṇasī. A young householder of that town, whose wife had recently died, had buried his wife's bones outside the city, and because he was attached to his wife, he was sitting by the bones, weeping. He came over to me and asked, 'What are you doing here all alone?'

"I told him my story just as it had happened, and that householder said, 'I will take you to my pleasure garden and make you my wife.' And I said, 'Very well.' Not long after we had come together as husband and wife, my husband was struck by illness and died.

"At that time, according to the custom of that country, husband and wife were united in life, and when the husband died, the wife too was put into the grave alive together with her husband. So I too was put into the grave there. In the night grave robbers came and dug open the grave, and the chief of the grave

robbers, seeing that I was beautiful, made me his wife as well. Not long afterward, as the grave robber went out on his raids, he was killed by the king, and his fellow thieves brought back his bones and put me into the grave with him once again.

"I had been in the grave for three days when a wolf dug the grave open, and I got out of the grave. And I thought, 'What evil did I do in the past, that I have died many times like this and come back to life again? I once heard that a son of the Śākya clan has attained full awakening, that he is called the Buddha, and that he is renowned as knowing all of the past and the future. Now I shall go to him for refuge.' So I went toward the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, and from afar I saw the Tathāgata, like a tree in full flower, or like the moon among the stars.

"At that time the Blessed One, knowing by his unobstructed wisdom that the time had come to tame me, rose and came to meet me. Since I was naked, I was ashamed; I covered my breasts with my hands and sat down on the ground. Then the Blessed One said to Ānanda, 'Give this woman clothing to wear.' I put on the clothing, bowed my head at the Blessed One's feet, and said, 'Out of compassion for me, please grant me the going forth.' The Blessed One said to Ānanda, 'Entrust this woman to Prajāpatī and have her ordained.'

"Then Prajāpatī ordained me and taught me the Dharma of the Four Truths. As soon as I heard it, I strove with earnest diligence and attained the fruit of arhatship, and I came to understand all matters, past, future and present."

Those nuns said, "Tell us what evil deed you did in the past, that you experienced such a ripening." The nun Utpalavarṇā said, "Listen attentively, and I shall explain it to you.

"Long ago in the past, a very wealthy householder who had no son took another wife. Because he loved that wife dearly, before long she became pregnant, and when her months were full she gave birth to a boy, and husband and wife loved the child and held him dear. Then the senior wife thought, 'I am of a great and noble family, but since I have no son, I have no one to carry on my line. If this boy grows up, he will carry on the line and become master of the wealth and property. He will give me nothing, and I will be miserable.' Jealousy arose in her, and she resolved to kill him. She stuck a needle into the crown of the little boy's head, so that not even a wound could be seen.

"Not long after, the boy died. The junior wife fainted, and she accused the senior wife: 'You killed my son!' The senior wife denied it and swore this oath: 'If I killed your son, then in all my births may my husband be killed by a venomous snake! If I have a son, may he be swept away by the water and eaten by a wolf! May my body be put alive into the grave again and again, and may I eat my own child's flesh! May my parents' home catch fire and all be burned!' So she said. The senior wife who swore that oath at that time was I, and I have experienced every one of those things in my own body."

Those nuns said, "What merit did you make, that you saw the Buddha, that the Buddha came to meet you and ordained you, and that you have reached the end of saṃsāra?"

Utpalavarṇā said, "Long ago, here in Vārāṇasī, at the place called Ṛṣipatana, there lived many pratyekabuddhas, śrāvakas, and non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) endowed with the five clairvoyances. At that time some pratyekabuddhas went into the town for alms. A householder's wife saw them and was overjoyed; she offered them alms and paid them honor. Then that pratyekabuddha rose into the sky and displayed miracles: flames blazing from his body, water streaming from it, walking, lying down and sitting. And the householder's wife made the aspiration, 'In the future may I too attain such a state!' The householder's wife who made that aspiration at that time was I. For that reason, when I met the Tathāgata, my mind was liberated and I attained the fruit of arhatship. Yet although I have attained arhatship in this way, a hot iron spike pierces me from the crown of my head and comes out at the soles of my feet; such harm always befalls me."

Then some five hundred nuns of great and high family, hearing these words, shuddered in body and mind. They understood desires to be like a heap of glowing embers, their minds of desire were utterly exhausted, and they understood the suffering of household life to be worse even than a prison. All their stains exhausted, they entered meditative absorption at one and the same time and became arhats.

With one voice those nuns said to the nun Utpalavarṇā, "We were utterly overcome and trapped by desire, but through the Dharma you taught, we have reached the end of saṃsāra."

Then the Blessed One praised her, saying, "The nun Utpalavarṇā has taught well. Teaching the Dharma is one person teaching another. Having attained the fruit, they are true children of the Buddha." When he had said this, the

great assembly rejoiced and was delighted.

This is called the chapter on the nun Utpalavarṇā, the twenty-fifth.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove at Kalandakanivāpa. At that time the venerable Ānanda rose from his seat, arranged his robe, set his knee on the ground, joined his palms, and said this to the Blessed One:

"Please explain for what cause and for what condition these five monks, Kauṇḍinya and the others, were the first to taste the nectar of the Dharma as soon as the Blessed One had turned the wheel of Dharma in the world."

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "In the past too these five monks were the first to eat my flesh and were made happy by it, and so here too they were the first to taste the flavor of the Dharma and were liberated."

Ānanda said to the Blessed One, "Please explain what these five monks did in the past."

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "Long ago, before immeasurable, countless, inconceivable eons had passed, there arose here in Jambudvīpa a king called Shudolagarni, who held sway over some eighty-four thousand minor kingdoms of Jambudvīpa. At that time a soothsayer foretold that no rain would fall in that land for twelve years. When the king heard this, he was stricken with grief and despondent, and he thought, 'If a great famine like this comes, how will food for so many years be found for all these many people?' He gathered all the minor kings and ministers, and after they had deliberated, they reckoned up how much grain there was in the granaries and how many people there now were, and proclaimed by the sounding of a bell: 'Even if we reckon one handful for each person over the twelve years, it will not last twelve years.'

"After that the famine grew ever more severe, and many died. The king thought, 'What can I do so that the people may live?' With his queens and the palace retinue he went to stroll in the pleasure grove, and when they reached a resting place and the queens and all the many people had fallen asleep, he rose from his bed, bowed to the four directions, and made this vow: 'A famine has come upon this land, and all are without food. Because of this hunger I give up this body. After I die, may I be born as a great fish, and may all eat my flesh and be satisfied.' Having made this aspiration, he climbed a tree and from the top of the tree threw his body over a precipice. Dying there, he was born miraculously in a great river as a great fish five hundred yojanas long.

"At that time in that land five carpenters were on the riverbank gathering timber, and they saw the great fish. The fish spoke to them in human speech, saying: 'If you are hungry, cut my flesh and eat as much as you like. When you are satisfied, carry home as much as you can bear. Because you were the first to eat my flesh and be satisfied, later, when I have become fully awakened, you will be the first to taste the food of the Dharma. Tell the people of the land that all who are hungry should take my flesh as they please.'

"Then the five men cut the flesh, ate it, and told the people of the land, and as one told another, all the people of Jambudvīpa gathered, cut its flesh, and ate. When one flank was nearly consumed, the fish turned the other flank over of its own accord, and when the upper side was nearly finished, the underside likewise grew back. In this way, turning over top and bottom, it was cut and eaten by all for twelve years. Because all felt compassion for it, all those who had eaten its flesh were reborn, when they died, as gods in the heavens.

"Ānanda, the king who became the fish at that time, on that occasion, is I myself now. The five carpenters who first cut and ate my flesh are the five monks, Kauṇḍinya and the others. The many people who later ate my flesh are the eighty thousand sons of the gods and my disciples who have been liberated. Because at that time I gave first to those five men and saved their lives, here too I taught them the Dharma first, and with the limbs of the Dharma body I quenched the fire of the three poisons."

Ānanda and the great assembly rejoiced at what the Blessed One had said, and were delighted.

This is the chapter on Shudolagarni, the twenty-sixth.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time, as the Blessed One was going for alms with Ānanda, some children were sitting by the roadside playing, making pretend houses, storehouses and jewels out of earth. Among them one boy saw the Buddha coming from afar and was overjoyed. Thinking to make a gift, he took a handful of the earth he had called the granary and tried to offer it to the Buddha, but the boy was too small and could not reach. He said to a friend, "You crouch down on the ground. I will stand on top of you and pour it into the bowl." His friend said, "I will do so," and the boy climbed onto his friend's shoulders and offered the handful of earth to the Buddha. The Buddha lowered his bowl and accepted the earth that was offered. Having accepted it, he gave it to Ānanda and said, "Make this earth into clay and

plaster the vihāra with it."

"Ānanda, this small child has just now offered this to me with a joyful mind. Because it has been accepted and plastered on the temple, through that merit, a hundred years after I have passed into nirvāṇa, he will become a king named Aśoka. The other boy will become his minister. He will rule over Jambudvīpa, proclaim the qualities of the Three Jewels throughout all lands, and make vast offerings to the relics. He will build eighty-four thousand stupas in Jambudvīpa all at once."

Ānanda, glad and delighted, said this to the Blessed One: "What merit did the Tathāgata make in the past, that so many stupas will be built even for his relics?"

The Blessed One said, "Listen attentively and hold it well in mind, and I shall explain it to you. Long ago, countless eons in the past, there was here in Jambudvīpa a king named Prasenajit, who held sway over some eighty-four thousand minor kingdoms. At that time a buddha named Puṣya appeared in the world. That king, together with his ministers, prepared the four kinds of requisites and offered them to the Buddha and the Saṅgha of monks."

"At that time the king and the people of his land were always meeting the Buddha, bowing to him and serving him, but the other minor kings did not make merit at all. So that the minor kings of the borderlands and their peoples might make merit, the king thought, 'I will have images of the Buddha painted and give them to the minor kings.' He gathered many painters and commanded them, 'Paint images of the Buddha.' The painters went into the Buddha's presence and looked at his marks as they painted, but whenever they painted one mark, another came out unlike him, and the painters could not paint the image. Then the Buddha himself mixed the pigments and painted an image, and showed it to those painters. Eighty-four thousand images endowed with the marks were painted, and the king sent one image to each minor king, commanding, 'Let the king and all the people of the land worship this image with flowers, incense and every kind of offering, and bow down to it.' When those minor kings and their peoples saw the image of the Tathāgata, they were overjoyed, glad and delighted, and served it with honor.

"King Prasenajit of that time is I myself now. Through the merit of having painted eighty-four thousand images of the Tathāgata in this way and distributing them to all the minor kings and their peoples, wherever I was born I was born in the heavens as Śakra, lord of the gods. I gained a beautiful form,

the thirty-two major marks and the eighty excellent minor marks, and I have become fully awakened. And after I have passed into nirvāṇa, some eighty-four thousand stupas will be built for my relics."

When the Blessed One had said this, Ānanda and the great assembly were delighted and rejoiced.

This is the chapter on King Aśoka, the twenty-seventh.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time the monks had entered the summer retreat each in their own place, and when the retreat was over, they came to where the Blessed One was. Because the Blessed One had not met those monks for a long time, he regarded them with loving affection, raised his hand marked with the thousand-spoked wheel, and asked the monks with courtesy, "Have you not been ill? Have you not been troubled in seeking alms?"

When the monk Ānanda saw that the Tathāgata, endowed with such great qualities, was showing courtesy to the monks, he was amazed and said this to the Blessed One: "The Blessed One is the lord of the world, of immeasurable qualities and inconceivable wisdom. Why then do you humble yourself and show courtesy to the monks?"

The Blessed One said this to Ānanda: "Long ago, countless, immeasurable, inconceivable eons in the past, there lived here in Jambudvīpa, in the land of Vārāṇasī, a householder skilled in earning a livelihood. He turned all the wealth he had into gold, made a golden vase, and hid it under the ground. In the same way, without ever enjoying his wealth, he turned all of it into gold, and after a long time the golden vases he had amassed one after another came to seven, and he hid them all under the ground. Later that householder was struck by illness and died, and because of his attachment to the golden vases he was born as a venomous snake and guarded that gold. After a long time had passed, that city no longer remained at peace, and it became deserted. That snake too, after many years, died, and was born again in that same body, lying coiled around the golden vases.

"In this way many tens of thousands of years went by, and in the last of those births he grew weary of that body and thought, 'Because of my attachment to this gold I have come to experience such an ugly body as this. What if I now offered it to a field of merit?' He went near the road, hid his body in a clump of grass, and thought, 'If people come, I will call to them.'

"Then the venomous snake saw a man coming along the road, and the snake called to him. The man heard the sound of someone calling and looked all around, but seeing nothing, he took to the road again and went on his way. The snake called again, saying, 'Hey! Come closer to me.'

"The man said, 'What do you want, calling me? You are extremely venomous, and you will kill me.'

"The snake said, 'If I meant to harm you, I could harm you even if you did not come near me.'

"At this the man was frightened and drew near to the snake. The snake said, 'I have a golden vase here. Can I entrust you with making merit for me? If you will not do it, I will harm you.'

"The man said, 'I can do it.' The snake led the man to the golden vases, handed him one golden vase, and said this: 'Take this gold and offer a feast to the Saṅgha. On the day the feast is offered I too will come, so come and fetch me.'

"Then the man carried the gold to the Saṅgha, offered the gold to the monk in charge of arrangements, and said, 'This is the gold of a venomous snake. Please offer a feast to the Saṅgha with this gold.' With that gold the feast was prepared. Then, having reckoned the day on which the feast would be offered, on that day the man took a basket and went to where the venomous snake was. The venomous snake saw the man coming and was overjoyed.

"The man put the snake into the basket and carried it off, and on the road he met another man. That man asked him three times, 'Where have you come from?' but the man carrying the snake said nothing at all. The snake grew angry and venom welled up in it, and it thought, 'What is wrong with this man, that when someone asks him three times he does not even give an answer?' Again it grew angry and venom welled up, but it checked itself and thought again, 'This man is making merit for my sake. If I remember the kindness of what he is doing for me and repay it with gratitude, no venom will arise. Even if this man, who is acting for my benefit, does something wrong, I should bear it patiently.'

"When they came to a lonely place, the snake said, 'Put me down on the ground for a while,' and, humbling itself before the man, it said, 'Now I regret my fault and confess it.' The man picked it up again, and when he reached the dwelling of the Saṅgha, it was the time of the Saṅgha's midday meal. The man

scattered flowers over the Saṅgha, and the snake watched the flowers being scattered with a mind of faith. Then, when the Saṅgha had finished their meal and washed their hands and mouths, they taught the Dharma to the snake. The snake was overjoyed and offered the other six golden vases to the Saṅgha as well. Having done this meritorious deed, it then passed away. When it died, through that merit it was born as a god in the Heaven of the Thirty-Three.

"Ānanda, the man who carried the venomous snake as his load at that time is I myself. That venomous snake is Śāriputra. In time past, too, when I carried the snake as my load, the snake reviled me, and yet I humbled myself toward it; and so now too I humble myself toward the monks."

Ānanda and the others rejoiced at what the Buddha had said, and were delighted.

This is the chapter on the golden vase, the twenty-eighth.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove at Kalandakanivāpa, together with countless monks. At that time there lived in that land a brahmin who was extremely poor and destitute and owned nothing at all. In his great want the brahmin asked everyone, "What can I do to come to have wealth in this very life?"

A man said to him, "Do you not know? The one called the Buddha, the Blessed One, has now come into the world, and he acts for the benefit of all sentient beings. His disciples, the four noble ones, Mahākāśyapa, Maudgalyāyana, Śāriputra, Aniruddha and the rest, are also always acting for the benefit of the poor and destitute. If you offer food to those noble ones with a mind of faith, those noble ones will grant you whatever you wish in this very life."

When the brahmin heard what the man said, he was overjoyed. He wandered everywhere, begging and working for hire, and when he had gained a little wealth he came back home, prepared food, invited the Saṅgha of noble ones, and offered them the meal, hoping for benefit in this very world. At that time the brahmin's wife, who was called Bliss, offered the meal to the Saṅgha and then took the precepts for a single day and night.

At that time King Prasenajit had gone out for a stroll, and on the road back he saw a prisoner who had committed a crime, tied to a tree beside the road. When the prisoner saw the king passing, he wept and begged for some food, and the king said, "I will give you some." But when he had gone back to the palace, he forgot, and only around midnight that night did he remember about

giving food to the prisoner. He arranged to have food taken to him, but not a single person in the palace dared to go. To take food at midnight, out of fear of spirits, grahas and rākṣasas on the road, no one could go, for it meant staking one's life.

Then the king thought of that man's suffering and how he was tormented by hunger, and he felt great compassion for him. He proclaimed, "If anyone in this land of mine can take food to that prisoner, I will give him a thousand ounces of gold." But even so, no one was able to go.

At that time Bliss, the brahmin's wife, heard the news, and thought, "I have heard that whatever worldly person has taken the eight precepts for a single day and night is not overpowered by spirits, grahas and the like, and that no graha at all can harm them. So I will go wherever the king sends me." And she came forward. Then the king said to Bliss, "Take this food and give it to the prisoner who is at such-and-such a place, and I will give you a thousand ounces of gold." So he promised.

Then Bliss took the food as the king had commanded, and keeping her moral discipline in mind, she set out on the road. As she went along, outside the city she met a rākṣasī who haunted the road. That rākṣasī had just given birth to five hundred children and was tormented by hunger and thirst. Seeing Bliss coming, she set about devouring her, but because the laywoman's moral discipline was unimpaired, when the rākṣasī looked at her she grew afraid and said, "Laywoman, I beg a little of the food you are carrying." The laywoman gave her a small amount, and though what she gave was little, through the laywoman's power it multiplied into much, and the rākṣasī, mother and children, were fully satisfied.

Then the rākṣasī asked the laywoman, "What is your name?" and she said, "I am Bliss." "In that case, since you have saved me, mother and children, from starvation, there is a vase full of gold here where I live; take it on your way back. As you go on, my younger sister Alampa is also by the road, and you will meet her. Give her this message from me: 'Are you well? I too have safely given birth to five hundred children.'"

Then the laywoman set out on the road, and as she went along, before long she met Alampa. She gave Alampa her elder sister's message and told her the news that five hundred children had been safely born. Alampa was glad and said, "Laywoman, it is good of you to bring my elder sister's message and such pleasant news. Here where I live there is a vase full of gold; take it on your

way back. Our brother is also by the road. If you meet him, give him the message of us two sisters, and tell him too the news of the birth of the five hundred children." So she instructed her, and the laywoman went on.

Then, before very long, she met the two sisters' brother. She gave him the message of the two women and the news that five hundred children had been safely born, and he too was overjoyed. He instructed her, "It is good of you to bring the news and message of my two sisters. Here where I stay there is a vase full of gold; take it on your way back."

Then the laywoman went on her way and came to the prisoner. She delivered the food, and on the way back she found the three vases of gold. The king too gave her a thousand ounces of gold as a reward, and so the poor brahmin and his wife became extremely rich in that land, with great wealth. They made merit all the more, and their treasures grew abundant.

The king too, knowing that this had come about through merit, made the brahmin a minister, and he became extremely rich. With a mind of faith he set about making merit all the more: he invited the Buddha and the Saṅgha and made great offerings to them. When the Blessed One taught them the Dharma, their minds were set free and they attained the fruit of stream-entry. That great assembly, together with Ānanda and the others, rejoiced at what the Buddha had said, and were delighted.

This is the chapter on the brahmin woman Bliss, the twenty-ninth.

The eighth section.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Rājagṛha, on Vulture Peak, together with a great Saṅgha of twelve hundred and fifty monks. At that time the Blessed One said, "I need an attendant to serve me, the venerable Ājñātakauṇḍinya."

Then Ājñātakauṇḍinya rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, joined his palms toward the Blessed One, bowed, and said, "Blessed One, I will serve you as you wish and carry your robe and alms bowl."

The Blessed One said to Kauṇḍinya, "You too are old and frail, and you yourself need someone to serve you. Kauṇḍinya, sit down on your seat."

In the same way Kāśyapa, Śāriputra, Mahāmaudgalyāyana and the others, some five hundred disciples in all, said, "We will serve the Blessed One," but he did not accept a single one of them.

Then the venerable Aniruddha considered which monk should serve the Blessed One, and saw that the Blessed One's heart was pleased with Ānanda in this way: just as, when the rays of the sun come through the eastern window of a multistoried house, they shine on the western wall and rest there, so the Blessed One's heart was turned toward Ānanda and pleased with him. When all the disciples had understood this, the venerable Śāriputra and Mahāmaudgalyāyana went to where Ānanda was. Coming before him, they exchanged many kinds of pleasing and delightful talk with Ānanda, and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, Śāriputra and Maudgalyāyana said this to the venerable Ānanda: "Venerable Ānanda, are you willing to serve the Blessed One? The Blessed One too would be pleased for you to serve him, and if you serve the Tathāgata it will be of great benefit to you."

"Venerable Śāriputra, I am not willing to serve the Blessed One. Why is that? The Buddha, the Blessed One, is hard to attend upon and hard to bear. Just as a blazing fire is hard to tend and hard to bear, so too the Buddha, the Blessed One, is hard to attend upon, and therefore I am not willing to serve the Blessed One."

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana said this to Ānanda: "Ānanda, the Blessed One's heart is turned toward you and pleased with you in this way: just as, when the rays of the sun come through the eastern window of a multistoried house, they shine on the western wall and rest there, so the Blessed One's heart too is pleased for you, Ānanda, to serve him. So be willing! If you serve the Tathāgata, it will be of great benefit to you."

"Venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, if the Blessed One will grant me these three wishes, I am willing to serve the Blessed One. They are these: that the Blessed One not give me robes he no longer wears to use; that I not have to take the leftovers of food the Blessed One has not eaten; and that I be allowed to come before the Blessed One at any time, even when it is not the proper time. If these are granted, I am willing to serve the Blessed One."

Then the venerable Śāriputra and Mahāmaudgalyāyana, having made the venerable Ānanda willing to serve, went to where the Blessed One was. Coming before him, they said this to the Blessed One: "We have made the venerable Ānanda willing to serve the Blessed One, and he says, 'If the Blessed One grants me these three wishes, then I am willing to serve the Blessed One.'"

The Blessed One said, "Excellent! Maudgalyāyana, the monk Ānanda is wise. He sees that words of blame and reproach from his companions in the holy life could arise on account of these things, and so he asks this in order that his companions in the holy life will not say of him, 'The monk Ānanda serves the Teacher for the sake of clothing and food.' Maudgalyāyana, this is a wondrous and marvelous quality of the monk Ānanda.

"The monk Ānanda is wise: he knows the time and recognizes the right time. He knows the time in this way: he knows when it is the right time and when it is not the right time for the four assemblies to come to see the Blessed One; and further, when it is the right time and when it is not the right time for wandering non-Buddhist ascetics (tīrthikas) to come before the Blessed One; and further, that these wandering tīrthikas are bold enough to reply to what the Blessed One says, while those are not bold enough to reply; and that this food, hard or soft, will be agreeable and wholesome for the Blessed One, while that will not be agreeable and wholesome. Because he knows these things, Maudgalyāyana, this is a wondrous and marvelous quality of the monk Ānanda."

Then, when Śāriputra and Maudgalyāyana had made the venerable Ānanda willing to serve the Blessed One, and the Blessed One too had praised him, saying, "Ānanda is wise; he knows the time and recognizes the right time," a doubt arose in the monks, and they said this to the Blessed One:

"For what cause and for what condition did this monk Ānanda become so skilled in knowing the right time?"

The Blessed One said to Śāriputra, "Long ago, beyond immeasurable, countless eons in the past, there arose a great king who held sway over some eighty-four thousand minor kingdoms of Jambudvīpa. At that time, in a city called Barute, there lived a brahmin called Nyagrodha. He was learned and full of knowledge, and skilled in medicine, the treatises and the stars, and so he served as that king's teacher. The eighty-four thousand minor kings honored him as they honored the great king himself, and they heeded his instructions. That brahmin's wealth rivaled even that of Vaiśravaṇa, but because he had no son he was always unhappy. Brooding inwardly on how he might come to have a son, he made offerings and prayers to Brahmā, Śakra, Īśvara, the sun and moon, the stars, and all the gods of the mountains, the waters and the forests.

"When twelve years had passed, his chief wife became pregnant. Wise women know for certain, as soon as a woman becomes pregnant, whether the child is

a boy or a girl, and knowing that this one was a boy, they told the brahmin. When the brahmin heard what they said, he was overjoyed, glad and delighted, and he cared for his wife with still greater attention. Then, when nine months were complete, she gave birth to a baby boy, golden in color, with hair of deep blue, fine, beautiful and endowed with the marks. They held a birth feast, summoned a reader of signs, and after he had examined the marks they named the child Great Generosity.

"The boy gradually grew up, and they made separate residences for him for summer and winter, autumn and spring, and let him enjoy every pleasure. The boy was upright in mind and gifted with a wise intelligence, so that there was no art he did not know, the Vedas, the eighteen kinds of treatises and all the rest.

"Later Great Generosity said to his parents, 'I am going outside to stroll and see the sights.' His parents, saying, 'Our son is going out for a stroll,' had the streets swept, raised victory banners and pennants, scattered flowers, and laid out many furnishings such as burning incense. Great Generosity was seated on an elephant adorned with the seven kinds of precious things, and with bells ringing, drums beating, music and cymbals playing, surrounded by an entourage of some hundred thousand, he went out of the city. All the people of the land watched him without blinking from the upper floors of the houses on the left and right of the road, and proclaimed, 'His splendor and majesty are like those of Brahmā!'

"As he went along, Great Generosity heard beggars dressed in rags and carrying broken bowls calling out, 'We beg for a little something!' He asked them, 'Why are you so afflicted and miserable?' Some of them said, 'We have no father or mother, no brothers or sisters, no children and no kin or friends, and so we are miserable.' Some said, 'I have long been struck by illness and have not recovered, and so I am miserable.' Some said, 'Because I was careless I was robbed by bandits, and now I own nothing at all, so I go begging.' When Great Generosity heard them say this, he went on with tears streaming down.

"Then, a little farther on, he saw butchers killing animals, flaying their hides and chopping up the flesh. Great Generosity asked, 'Oh! What are these people doing?' They said, 'From the time of our fathers and grandfathers our family has done this work of killing, and if we did not do it we would not be able to live.' At this Great Generosity was astonished, and unable to bear the

sight, he went on.

"Then, going farther on, he saw farmers plowing a field, and in the furrows left by the plow many worms had come up, and many birds were pecking up the insects and eating them. When he asked them what they were doing, they said, 'We plow the fields, and in the furrows where the earth has been turned we sow seed, which later grows abundantly. By this we make a good living, and we also pay our dues to the king.'

"Great Generosity was astonished at this too, and going farther on he saw hunters who had spread bird nets and set snares to catch birds. The creatures caught in the nets and snares were flapping their bodies and struggling but could not get free; they cried out pitifully and were in great terror. Seeing this, he asked, 'What are you doing?' They said, 'We too live by this kind of killing work, which is our family's trade.' When Great Generosity heard them say this, he was deeply dejected.

"Going on farther still, he saw fishermen who had set fishing nets and caught a great many fish, which lay piled in heaps on the ground, still twitching. When he asked, 'What are these people doing?' they said, 'Our family has no other work. We live by catching fish like this.'

"Having seen all these things, Great Generosity thought, 'Because they are poor and destitute, these beings commit such blameworthy deeds as killing in order to clothe and feed themselves. As soon as they die they will fall into the three lower realms, going from darkness into darkness, with no time of liberation.' Thinking this, he came back home, and brooding on it day and night, he was unhappy. He went to his father and said, 'Father, I have a request to make of you; please grant it.' His father said, 'Son, whatever you ask, I will do as you say.'

"'Father, earlier, when I went out to stroll, I saw that many people, all of them afflicted for the sake of clothing and food, kill one another, lie, seize what is not theirs, and commit all sorts of unwholesome deeds. Seeing this, I resolved to practice giving toward them. So please permit me to dispense freely from your great storehouses for the sake of the destitute.'

"His father said, 'All the storehouses and the many jewels I have amassed were made for your sake alone, so why would I not heed what you say?'

"Then Great Generosity, having received his father's permission, proclaimed to all the people of the land, 'Great Generosity is holding a great distribution of

gifts. Let everyone gather and come!'

At that time the roads outside the city were filled with śramaṇas and brahmins, with the poor and destitute who had no protector, with the sick, and with others. They came from a hundred leagues away, from two hundred, three hundred, four hundred and five hundred, and from a thousand leagues away; some arrived from two thousand, three thousand, four thousand and five thousand leagues, and even from as far as ten thousand leagues. They gathered like clouds, and he gave to all of them as they wished: clothing to those who wanted clothing, food to those who wanted food, and jewels, gold, silver, vaiḍūrya, coral, mounts, carriages, palanquins, pleasure groves, fields, livestock and so on. He gave whatever they wished.

So he went on giving gifts, and when a long time had passed and a third of the storehouses had been used up, the keeper of the storehouses spoke to the brahmin: "Your son has been giving gifts from the storehouses, and one third is used up. Since no more than two thirds remain, please consider what we shall use for the gifts we exchange with others and for our trade goods."

The brahmin said, "Out of love for my son I cannot oppose him. Even if the storehouses are emptied, so be it."

Then again, after a long time had passed, when two thirds of the storehouses were used up and only about a third remained, the treasurer spoke to the brahmin again: "Two thirds of the storehouses are used up, and no more than about a third remains. What shall we use for sending gifts to one another and for our trade goods?"

The brahmin said, "My son is so very dear to me that I cannot oppose him; I dare not say anything. You do whatever is best for me, and make some excuse, as though you had no time to spare."

Having received the brahmin's permission, the keeper of the storehouses locked the doors of the storehouses and went off on business. After that, when beggars came to Great Generosity, at times the treasurer could not be found and the doors of the storehouses were not opened, and even when the treasurer did come, he did not give as they wished. So Great Generosity thought: "Since things have turned out like this, this is beyond the keeper of the storehouses; the instruction must have come from my parents. It is not right for a son to empty his parents' storehouses. What means can I use to obtain jewels as I wish, so as to be of benefit to many people?"

Having thought this, he asked people, "In this world, what work can one do to obtain jewels as one wishes, and to obtain great wealth and riches that will never run out?"

Some said, "If you plow many fields, you will have great wealth and riches."

Some said, "If you breed livestock and increase your herds, you will gain much wealth."

Some said, "If you trade on long journeys, you will gain much wealth."

Some said, "If you go out on the ocean and take precious gems, you will have many jewels."

When Great Generosity heard what they said, he declared, "Plowing fields, breeding livestock and going on long journeys to trade are not for me. Going out on the ocean alone is for me." Resolving to go out on the ocean, he said to his parents, "I shall take many jewels from the ocean and give gifts to the poor and destitute as they wish. Please permit me to go to the ocean to fetch jewels."

When his parents heard him say this, they were dismayed and said to their son, "In this world, the poor and destitute have no choice, so they set out staking their bodies and lives. What do you lack, that you think this way? If you want to give gifts, give away all the wealth there is in the house. You must not go to the ocean. In the ocean there are waves and great breakers and swirling whirlpools, sea monsters, venomous nāgas, rākṣasīs, those the color of mountain water, and many other exceedingly swift killers, so escape is hard. What do you lack, that you would stake your life? We will not listen to this. Stop thinking of it and stay here," they commanded.

When Great Generosity heard them command this, since he had not got his wish, he made a vow. He thought, "Until this wish of mine is fulfilled, I will lie face down on the ground before my parents and not get up." And he said, "Father and mother, please know this: until it comes about as I wish, I will not rise from lying face down here."

Then his parents were unhappy. They consulted with their relatives and friends, and told him too that there were many killers in the ocean. "In our ignorance we made offerings to all the gods for twelve years, and you, a god, were born as our son. Do not abandon us; eat your food!" For one day, two days, and on up to six days they counseled him with all manner of words, but he would not listen, and did not turn back from what he had said before.

His parents grew afraid and said further: "Ever since this son of ours was first born, he has never let go of anything he undertook until he had finished it. If we let him go to the ocean, he may yet come back; but if we do not let him go, then when seven days have passed it will be over with him at once. Now we must let him go." Thinking this, they went to their son, took him by the hand and said, "Son, get up and eat your food. We permit you to go as you wish."

Great Generosity then got up, ate food and drank drink. Then he went outside and proclaimed to many people, "I am going to the ocean to fetch jewels. Any of you who would like to go, come along with me. I will be the captain, and I will provide the supplies as well."

At that time about five hundred people agreed to go. Each of them prepared his supplies, they set a time for departure, and at the appointed time they set out on the road. As they set out, the young man's parents, the king, the princes, the ministers, and all the people of the land accompanied them and saw them off. His parents wept and bowed after him as he went.

After they had traveled many days' journey, they came into an empty wilderness, and at night on the road bandits attacked them and stole all their goods and wealth. Then, going on and on, they reached a city called Ngashupa. In that city he met a brahmin named Kapili, and going to that brahmin's house, Great Generosity asked the brahmin for three thousand gold coins.

At that time that brahmin had a daughter, golden in complexion, with dark blue-black hair, whom he would not give away even when the princes of some eighty-four thousand vassal kingdoms had all asked for her.

At that time Great Generosity went to that brahmin's door and asked, "Is the brahmin Kapili here?" As soon as the daughter, inside the house, heard Great Generosity's voice, she said to her parents, "This voice sounding at the outer door is my husband."

Then the brahmin came out to the door and met him, and thought of the young man, "This one is surely superior to others." When the young man asked for the gold, the brahmin agreed to give it, and holding the gold in one hand and leading his daughter by the other, he said, "Take this daughter as well; I give her to you as your wife."

Great Generosity said, "I am going to the great ocean to fetch jewels, and since there are very many obstacles in the ocean, there is no telling whether I

will come back or not. I cannot take your daughter as my wife."

The brahmin said, "If you come back safely, take this daughter as your wife."

And Great Generosity said, "If I come back, I shall do so."

Then the brahmin provided the three thousand gold coins and all the other supplies he needed besides, and after that they went to the shore of the ocean. There they fitted out a ship, went aboard, and moored it with seven ropes. Then from inside the ship he spoke these words: "In the ocean there are these obstacles: black winds, rākṣasas, swirling waves and breakers, venomous nāgas, mountains that look like the color of water, sea monsters, and many other fearsome obstacles. So if there is any one of you who does not have the heart to go, turn back from here, lest you regret it later. If you have no regard for body and life, and are not attached to parents, wives, brothers and sisters, relatives and friends, then let us go. If we get there safely, the seven kinds of jewels will make you rich down to the seventh generation of your descendants, and your wealth will never run out." When he had said this, he cut one rope.

In the same way, for seven days, he said this once each day and cut one mooring rope each day. Then, catching the wind and hoisting the sail, they sped away like an arrow.

Then the merchants reached the Isle of Jewels. Great Generosity, being widely learned, was extremely skilled at assessing jewels, so he showed the merchants which jewels were good and which were bad, which heavy and which light, down to the price each was worth. "Jewels of such a color are light but of great value. Jewels like these are heavy but of little value; do not take them. If you take too many, the ship will be heavy and sink. If you take too few, you will have suffered for nothing in coming here. So this much is right." Having shown them the proper measure in this and other ways, they loaded the jewels onto the ship, and, untouched by any harm, they prepared to set off back home.

But Great Generosity would not go aboard the ship, and said to the merchants, "I will not turn back until I obtain the precious wish-fulfilling jewel from the palace of the nāga king."

Then the merchants wept, and, despondent with grief, they said, "We merchants came as your servants, O man, our captain. If you now leave us here and do not go, we will not get back home either, and all of us will be left

wandering."

Great Generosity said, "Merchants, so that you come to no harm, I shall make an aspiration that you reach your own land." He took a bowl in his hand, made offerings to the four directions, and spoke these words: "I take jewels not only to benefit destitute beings, but so that by the merit of giving in this way I may attain buddhahood. If what I say is true, and it is to be accomplished as I aspire, may these merchants, together with their jewels, reach Jambudvīpa safely and without harm!" Having made this aspiration, he cut the rope, they hoisted the sail, and they went back safely to Jambudvīpa.

After they had gone, Great Generosity entered the water and went on. For seven days he sank no deeper than his knees. Then for another seven days he sank no deeper than his thighs. Then after another seven days he sank no deeper than his waist. For seven days the water reached his shoulders, and then for seven days he swam.

Then he reached the foot of a mountain, and clinging to the trees he climbed the mountain, reaching the summit in seven days. After he had spent seven days on the summit, in another seven days he went down to the water's edge. When he reached the water's edge, he saw that in the water there were golden lotuses, with venomous snakes coiled around the roots of the lotuses.

Then the bodhisattva sat down cross-legged and, with one-pointed mind, entered the samādhi of loving-kindness. He thought, "These venomous snakes too are experiencing such ugly bodies because of the condition of the aversion and jealousy they had in the past," and he generated an especially compassionate mind toward them. By this, all the venom of those venomous snakes was pacified, and the bodhisattva went on, stepping across the tops of the lotuses, and in seven days he had passed beyond those venomous snakes.

Then, going on further, he met rākṣasas, and the rākṣasas, sensing the smell of a human, searched everywhere. Then, as the bodhisattva regarded them with one-pointed loving mind, those rākṣasas asked him in gentle words, "Man, where have you come from, and where are you going?"

Great Generosity said to them, "I have come to seek the precious wish-fulfilling jewel."

Then those rākṣasas rejoiced greatly, thinking, "This is someone endowed with great merit." And they thought, "From here the nāga palace is still very far away. He will never get there and will suffer, so let us help him with our power

and carry him there." So they carried him through the sky, and having gone four hundred leagues, set him down on the ground again.

Great Generosity then went on, and before long he saw a silver citadel. Thinking it must be a dwelling of the nāgas, he approached it. Outside, that citadel was encircled by seven rings of moats, and the moats were filled with terrifying venomous snakes. When Great Generosity saw them, he thought, "Because of the karma of their great aversion in the past, these venomous snakes are experiencing such terrifying bodies." Toward them, as toward an only child, he had a mind of love and compassion, and since he generated such a mind of loving-kindness, the snakes' venom was pacified. Then, treading on them, he went to the nāga citadel.

Two nāgas were coiled around that citadel, with their heads resting against the citadel gate. When those two nāgas saw Great Generosity, they raised their heads and were about to release their venom, but because Great Generosity generated a mind of loving-kindness, their venom was pacified, and they lowered their heads and lay on the ground. Great Generosity stepped on the nāgas' heads and went inside the citadel, and there inside the citadel he saw a nāga sitting in a celestial palace made of the seven kinds of jewels.

When that nāga king saw the bodhisattva, he was startled, and thought, "This dwelling of mine is encircled by seven rings of moats, and the moats are filled with venomous snakes, so no one other than nāgas and yakṣas can manage to come here. Who could this be?" He rose from his seat and went to greet him, paid him homage with respect, seated him on a jeweled throne, and served him all kinds of food.

When he had eaten the food, the nāga king asked, "Why have you come here, and how did you get here?"

The bodhisattva said, "The people of Jambudvīpa are poor and destitute, and for the sake of wealth, food and clothing they harm and injure one another in all sorts of ways, so that as soon as they die they fall into the three lower realms. I feel compassion for them, and to become their protector I have braved hardship on a long road and come to ask you, great king, for the precious wish-fulfilling jewel. Through the merit of benefiting all sentient beings with the precious wish-fulfilling jewel, I wish to attain complete and perfect awakening. So please grant me the jewel, and do not go against my wish."

The nāga king said, "The precious wish-fulfilling jewel is extremely hard to come by. If you have come for this purpose, stay here for one month, accept my offerings, and teach me the Dharma, and then I will give you the precious wish-fulfilling jewel."

And the bodhisattva said, "I shall do so."

Then each day the nāga king prepared and offered all kinds of food with a hundred flavors, and honored the bodhisattva with music. And for one month the bodhisattva taught him the Dharma topics of the applications of mindfulness. When he said, "I shall go back now," the nāga king was delighted, and untying the precious wish-fulfilling jewel from the crest of his head, he presented it to him and said, "Great being, you who are so steadfast in your vow to benefit beings will certainly attain awakening. When you become fully awakened, may I become your foremost attendant."

Then he asked the nāga king, "What power does this precious jewel have?"

He replied, "This jewel rains down everything that is needed, like rain, throughout an area two thousand leagues around."

The bodhisattva thought, "This precious jewel has great power, yet it cannot accomplish the great aim I have in mind." Having thought this, he went on his way, escorted by the nāga king and his retinue.

Then, going on further, he saw in the distance a citadel of blue vaiḍūrya. When he reached that citadel, it too was encircled by seven rings of moats, and the moats were completely filled with venomous snakes. Because the bodhisattva generated a mind of compassion and loving-kindness toward those venomous snakes, their venom was pacified, and treading on those snakes he went on. When he reached the citadel gate, two nāgas were lying at the citadel gate, and as the bodhisattva, with a mind of compassion and loving-kindness, pacified the nāgas' venom, he stepped on their heads and went inside the citadel.

At that time a nāga king was sitting in that citadel, in a celestial palace made of the seven kinds of jewels. Seeing the bodhisattva from far off, he thought, "This dwelling of mine is encircled by seven rings of moats, and the moats are filled with venomous snakes, so no one other than nāgas and yakṣas can manage to come here. Who could such a man be, and where has he come from?" He was amazed, and he went to greet him, paid him homage with respect, and seated him on a jeweled seat. Then he prepared and offered all

kinds of food with a hundred flavors.

After the bodhisattva had eaten the food, the nāga king asked, "Why have you come here? What is your purpose?"

The bodhisattva said, "I have come to ask you, nāga king, for the precious wish-fulfilling jewel."

The nāga said, "The jewel is extremely hard to come by. If your wish is genuine, then, as I request, stay for two months, teach us the conduct of a bodhisattva, and accept our offerings, and then I will give you the jewel."

And Great Generosity said, "I shall do so."

Then for two months the nāga king prepared and offered all kinds of food with a hundred flavors, and honored him with all kinds of music. And for two months the bodhisattva taught them the Dharma discourse on the four bases of miraculous power. When he resolved to go back, the nāga king untied the precious wish-fulfilling jewel and presented it to him, saying, "Great being, you who are steadfast in your vow will certainly attain awakening. When you become fully awakened, I too shall be your attendant."

And he said, "May it be so."

When he asked, "How much power does this precious jewel have?" the answer was, "This precious jewel rains down whatever is wished for, like rain, throughout an area four thousand leagues around."

The bodhisattva in turn thought, "This jewel has great power, yet it cannot accomplish what I have in mind." And the nāga king escorted the bodhisattva outside the gate of his citadel.

Then, going on further, he saw in the distance a brilliantly shining citadel of gold. The bodhisattva went up to it, and when he arrived he saw that this citadel too was encircled by seven rings of moats, and that the moats were completely filled with venomous snakes. Once more the bodhisattva generated a mind of loving-kindness, so that the snakes' venom was pacified, and treading on them he went on. Around this citadel too two nāgas lay coiled, with their heads turned toward the outside of the gate. When they saw the bodhisattva, they raised their heads and released their venom, but because the bodhisattva generated a mind of compassion and loving-kindness, the venom was pacified, and stepping on their heads he went inside the citadel.

Inside that citadel, from his jeweled celestial palace, the nāga king saw the bodhisattva from far off and thought, "This dwelling of mine is encircled by seven rings of moats, and the moats are filled with venomous snakes, so no one apart from nāgas and yakṣas can manage to come here. Who is this man, and where has he come from?" Taking it as a marvel, he went out from afar to greet him, paid him homage with respect, and had him sit on a jeweled seat. Then he prepared and offered all kinds of food with a hundred flavors, and after he had eaten the food, he asked, "Who are you, and where have you come from?"

To this the bodhisattva replied, "I have come from Jambudvīpa. Because the beings of Jambudvīpa have little merit, they harm and kill one another in all sorts of ways for the sake of wealth, food and drink. Since they commit the ten unwholesome actions in full, as soon as they die they fall into the three lower realms and come to experience much suffering. I feel compassion for them, and in order to become their protector I have come to ask you, great king, for the precious wish-fulfilling jewel."

The nāga king said, "The precious wish-fulfilling jewel is not easy to come by. Man, if you have come placing your hope in me, stay four months here in my dwelling and accept my offerings, and then I will present you with the jewel."

And the bodhisattva said, "I shall do so."

Then for four months the nāga king prepared and offered all kinds of food with a hundred flavors, and honored him with music as well. The bodhisattva in turn explained and taught him Dharma discourses at length, so that the nāga king was overjoyed, and without depending on other nāgas or other yakṣas he himself provided all the requisites as the bodhisattva wished.

When four months had been spent in this way and the bodhisattva was preparing to leave, the nāga king untied the precious wish-fulfilling jewel from the crest on his head and presented it to the bodhisattva, and made this aspiration: "Great being, you who are steadfast in your vow will certainly attain awakening. When you become fully awakened, may I too become your foremost attendant and serve you with honor."

And the bodhisattva said, "May it be so."

He asked, "How much power does this precious jewel have?"

The nāga king said, "This precious jewel rains down jewels like rain throughout an area eight thousand leagues around; it rains down whatever is wished for."

At this the bodhisattva was at last delighted, and thought, "The expanse of Jambudvīpa is no more than seven thousand leagues. This precious jewel will fulfill my hope." Having thought this, he tied all three precious jewels he had obtained, the earlier ones and the later one, into the hem of his garment, and went to the citadel gate. The nāga king and his retinue escorted him, and then they went their separate ways.

When the bodhisattva had gone some distance, he took the precious jewels in his hand and made this aspiration: "If this jewel is truly a precious wish-fulfilling jewel, may I fly through the sky!" No sooner had he said this than he flew up into the sky, escaped the obstacles of the ocean, and reached the ocean shore. There, as he rested a little and recovered from his weariness, he fell asleep on the road.

At that time the lesser nāgas of the ocean conferred, saying, "In this ocean there are no more than these three precious jewels, and this man has carried off all three. Since these jewels have such virtues, we need them too, so let us steal them back." Having conferred in this way, while the bodhisattva lay asleep, the nāgas stole the precious wish-fulfilling jewels back.

When the bodhisattva woke and looked, the precious jewels were gone, and he thought, "The nāgas of the ocean have certainly stolen them. With whatever power I have, I will bail out the water of the ocean and dry it up." And he made a vow: "Until I get the jewels back, I will not go back empty-handed." He went to the ocean shore, took up a tortoise shell, and with both hands began bailing out the water of the ocean.

At that time the god of the ocean, knowing his intention, said to him, "This ocean is deep and wide, three hundred and thirty thousand leagues in extent. If even all the people of Jambudvīpa together could not dry up the ocean, what need is there to speak of you managing it alone? It is pointless."

The bodhisattva said, "If one person does a task with all his heart, there is nothing that cannot be accomplished. When I have found that jewel of mine, I intend to bring benefit and happiness to all beings, and by that merit I shall attain full awakening. If my mind does not lose heart in this, why should I not be able to dry up this ocean?"

At that time the god Viṣṇu and others saw from afar the bodhisattva, alone, bailing out the water of the ocean with body and mind in accord, undertaking hardships for the sake of many beings. Thinking, "We too shall help the bodhisattva," they passed the word from one to another, and all of them came

to the bodhisattva's side. Seeing the bodhisattva bailing out water with a vessel, all those gods took off their own divine garments and dipped them in the water. When they wrung them out once, the water of the ocean went down by forty leagues. When they dipped them again, a second time, it went down by eighty leagues.

When they dipped them a third time, it went down by a hundred and twenty leagues. At this those nāgas were terrified, and they came before the bodhisattva and said, "Here, take them! Do not dry up the water of the ocean!" And the bodhisattva let it be.

Then the nāgas said to the bodhisattva, "What do you need this precious jewel of yours for?"

"I need it to benefit sentient beings."

The nāgas said, "If you need it to benefit sentient beings, there are many sentient beings in the ocean as well. Why carry it away?"

He said, "Those who dwell in the ocean are sentient beings too, but they do not have the suffering of want. The sentient beings of Jambudvīpa harm and injure one another for the sake of wealth, and since they commit the ten unwholesome actions in full, when they die they are all born among the beings of hell. Out of compassion for them, I need this jewel."

At this the nāgas brought out the precious jewel and presented it back to him.

When the god of the ocean saw the bodhisattva's steadfast diligence, he thought, "This one will certainly attain awakening," and made this aspiration: "When he becomes fully awakened, may I too become his foremost attendant."

Then the bodhisattva, having got the jewel back, flew up into the sky above, and arriving at the place, asked, "Have the merchant companions who left earlier gone on? Did they arrive safely?" The merchant companions had indeed arrived safely, and they rejoiced in one another, and his companions regarded it as a wonder and a marvel.

Then he went to the door of the brahmin Kapili. When they heard that the bodhisattva had returned from the ocean, all of them came out to the door to welcome him, overjoyed, and held a great feast for him and his merchant companions. When the bodhisattva came into the house holding the jewel, all the storehouses of that brahmin became completely full.

Then the brahmin Kapili adorned his daughter with all kinds of jewels, sent for a jeweled water vessel, washed the bodhisattva's body and feet, and, taking his daughter by the hand, entrusted her to the bodhisattva. When the bodhisattva accepted her, the brahmin was overjoyed, and he adorned with jewels five hundred maidservants for his daughter and five hundred elephants as well, and with music sent them along to the bodhisattva.

Meanwhile, after they had been parted from their son, Great Generosity's parents wept constantly, so that both parents went blind. When the son returned from the ocean and met his parents, the son paid homage to them, and taking hold of his hand they recognized that it was their son. "Great Generosity, after you left us and went away, we even went blind. Having gone all the way to the ocean, what did you find?"

Great Generosity placed the precious jewel in his father's hand and said, "I found this." His father took it in his hand and held it, and said, "I already had plenty of stones like this in my treasury before. Why did you need to stake yourself on such hardship?"

Then the bodhisattva took the jewel back, and merely by his wiping his parents' eyes with it, both his parents' eyes saw even more clearly than before, like clouds swept away by a strong wind. Then both his parents rejoiced and said, "This truly is a precious jewel; it has made up for the hardship."

Then Great Generosity took the jewel and made this aspiration: "If you are truly the precious wish-fulfilling jewel, let a seat of the seven kinds of jewels appear beneath my parents, with a jeweled canopy spread above them!" No sooner had he made this aspiration than it came about just so, and all the storehouses of the king also became full.

Then the king had a messenger mount an elephant able to travel a hundred thousand leagues, and proclaim to all the people of Jambudvīpa: "Great Generosity has found the precious wish-fulfilling jewel in the ocean. Seven days from now, that jewel of virtues will rain down precious jewels and so on, clothing, food and all the requisites you need, like rain, so each of you take whatever you please."

When this had been proclaimed everywhere, Great Generosity bathed, put on fresh clothes, planted a banner upright on a level plain, fastened the precious wish-fulfilling jewel to the top of the banner, took a bowl in his hand and made this aspiration: "The people of Jambudvīpa are all poor and destitute, and they

must be helped. You are the precious wish-fulfilling jewel; if this is not false, rain down like rain, as they wish, all the various things that each of them needs!"

No sooner had he said this than a black wind arose from the four directions, and at once swept away all the filth. A light, gentle drizzle fell, so that no dust rose, and after that, first, all kinds of food and drink with a hundred flavors rained down like rain. Then grain rained down like rain. Then clothing rained down like rain. Then jewels rained down like rain, until Jambudvīpa was completely filled with heaps of precious jewels, and jewels became like gravel and potsherds.

When the bodhisattva had thus satisfied everyone, he admonished the people of Jambudvīpa with these words: "The beings of Jambudvīpa kill one another for the sake of clothing, food and wealth, and torment one another in all sorts of ways, and so they do nothing but evil, unwholesome deeds. When they die they fall into the three lower realms, and go from darkness into darkness. Out of compassion for them I disregarded the obstacles of the ocean and many hardships, and in order to make you happy I brought precious jewels from the ocean. Now none of you lacks anything at all; you are happy. So gather in your body, speech and mind and apply yourselves diligently to the path of the ten wholesome actions." In this way he taught and urged them by all kinds of skillful means.

Having taught and urged them in this way, he made them practice the path of the ten wholesome actions earnestly, so that when those people of Jambudvīpa died, they were born as gods in the higher realms.

"At that time, on that occasion, his father, the brahmin Nyagrodha, is now my father Śuddhodana. The one who was his mother is my mother, Lovely Goddess. Great Generosity was I. The nāga who dwelt in the silver palace is Śāriputra. The nāga who dwelt in the vaiḍūrya palace is Maudgalyāyana. The nāga who dwelt in the golden palace is Ānanda. The god of the ocean is Aniruddha. When this Ānanda was a nāga king, he too served me, and he was skilled in timing; even until now he is skilled in timing, and his three wishes too have been granted just as he desired."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, Ānanda was delighted and overjoyed, and setting his knees upon the ground he said, "For as long as I live I shall serve the Tathāgata."

When the Blessed One had said this, among the great assembly some attained the fruit of stream-entry and so on up to arhatship. Some became pratyekabuddhas. Some generated the mind set on unsurpassed awakening. Some attained the ground of non-returning, and rejoicing, they were delighted.

This is the thirtieth chapter, on Great Generosity's entering the ocean.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Rājagṛha, in the Nyagrodha grove. At that time, as the Blessed One sat surrounded by Brahmā, Śakra (Indra) and others, the whole great assembly marveled at the Blessed One's body, with its major and minor marks and its color like gold, and they praised and extolled it.

Since the Blessed One thus surpassed the entire assembly and had become the supreme and foremost of all, the monks were puzzled and asked the Blessed One about it. The Blessed One said, "It is not only now that I have surpassed the whole assembly and become supreme and foremost. In times long past as well I surpassed all these and became foremost."

Then the monks asked him to explain how he had become foremost in the past, and the Blessed One spoke as follows:

"Long ago, in times past, countless, measureless, inconceivable eons ago, there was here in Jambudvīpa a great king who ruled over eighty-four thousand vassal kings, and he had five hundred sons. Some time later his chief queen gave birth to a son. He was golden in color, his hair was like sapphire, on his palms he had the mark of a wheel with a thousand spokes, on the sole of his left foot there was the figure of a horse, and on the sole of his right foot the figure of an elephant. Such a meritorious son was born, and he was given the name Mirror Face.

"When the great king was struck by illness and drew near the time of his death, the ministers asked him, 'Among these sons, whom shall we install as regent? On whom shall we confer the royal empowerment?' The king commanded, 'Whoever has these ten qualities and marks of mine, make him king and empower him.' What are the ten? They are these: the color of his body is like gold and his hair is sapphire blue; the palms of both his hands bear the mark of the wheel; on the sole of his right foot there is the figure of an elephant; on the sole of his left foot there is the figure of a horse; when he puts on the royal garments they fit his body, neither too large nor too small; when he sits on the royal throne he is endowed with splendor and might; the vassal kings show him great reverence and service, and the queens and

palace women delight in him and bow to him; when he is led to the shrine of the gods, the gods bow to him in return; by the power of his virtues and merit he brings down a rain of the seven precious things and satisfies the minds of all; and he is born of the chief queen. These are the ten. 'If he has these qualities, confer the royal empowerment on him,' he commanded, and then impermanence became manifest and he passed away.

"Then the princes and ministers gathered, and they examined the princes from the eldest to the youngest to see which of them had the ten qualities. None of the other princes had a body the color of gold. Their hair was not sapphire blue. Their palms did not bear the mark of the wheel. The soles of their feet did not bear the figures of an elephant and a horse. The royal garments did not fit them. When they were placed on the royal throne, they rose up as if frightened. The vassal kings and ministers did not show them respect or bow to them, and the queens and palace women did not delight in them or bow to them. When they were led to the shrine of the gods, the gods did not bow to them. They were not able to bring down a rain of jewels. Nor were they sons of the chief queen. Of the five hundred princes, not a single one had even one of the marks.

"Only the youngest of the sons had a body the color of gold, hair the color of sapphire, and both hands bearing the mark of the wheel. On the soles of both his feet were the figures of an elephant and a horse. The garments fit his body. When he was placed on the royal throne, his splendor and majesty were great. All the vassal kings bowed to him with respect, and the queens and palace women also bowed to him with delight. When he came to the shrine of the gods, the gods bowed to him. As soon as he said, 'Let jewels fall!' they fell like rain. And he had been born of the chief queen among the queens of the palace. Since he possessed the marks in full, the vassal kings and ministers empowered him as king.

"On the fifteenth day of the month, when the sun first rose, a golden wheel with a thousand spokes, a full league across, came from the east. He knelt before it and said, 'If I possess the qualities and am to become king, may this wheel come close to me!' And it came close to him through the sky.

"The precious elephant came from Gandhamādana, the mountain of fragrance, its tail adorned with jewels. Mounted on it, the king flew through the sky and circled the four continents in half a day. When it went on foot, wherever its footprints fell turned to golden sand.

"The precious horse was blue in color, with a red tail and mane, and the seven precious things fell from it. Mounted on it, the king circled the four continents in about the time it takes to eat a single meal, without tiring or growing weary.

"The precious jewel shone with rays of light day and night, illuminating everything up to a hundred and twenty leagues with its light. It rained down the seven precious things like rain and gave them to all.

"The precious queen was virtuous and beautiful, and she gladdened the king's mind. The precious householder supplied the king with whatever he needed of the seven precious things, just as he wished, and made them inexhaustible. As for the precious minister, when the king divided the fourfold army, at a mere glance from him the hosts of the army assembled, endowed with skill and might.

"Possessing the seven precious things in this way, the king thought, 'Obtaining such means as these has come from my past merit, so I must act in such a way that the royal line is not cut off.' With this thought, he bathed in scented water, put on new and clean clothes, took a censer in his hand, knelt on the ground facing the east, and spoke these words: 'Noble beings who dwell in the east, please come, as I request!' When he had said this, some twenty thousand pratyekabuddhas came from the east to the king's palace. He made the same request toward the south, the west and the north, and from each of these, too, some twenty thousand pratyekabuddhas came to the king's palace. Then the king and his ministers prepared the four requisites and made offerings.

"Then the eighty-four thousand vassal kings asked leave to return to their own lands, and as they took their leave and bowed, the vassal kings asked for a share of the noble ones, saying, 'We too wish to make offerings and earn merit.' And the king and the ministers made offerings to forty thousand pratyekabuddhas, as they wished, for eighty-four thousand years. When they died, they were born as gods in the higher realms.

"Monks, King Mirror Face of that time is now I. That king's father is my father Śuddhodana. That queen is my mother, Lovely Goddess. The five hundred princes are the five hundred of the Śākya clan. At that time too I became the chief and supreme among all, and now that I have become a buddha, I have again become the supreme and foremost, endowed with the marks."

The great assembly rejoiced in what the Buddha had said and was delighted.

This is the thirty-first chapter, on King Mirror Face.

The ninth section.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time Devadatta, though he had gone forth, was attached to gain, and so he committed deeds of immediate retribution: he rolled down a boulder to crush the Buddha, he drove a splinter of wood into his foot, he let loose a mad elephant, he created a schism in the harmonious Saṅgha, and he killed a nun whose defilements were exhausted. Having done these unwholesome deeds, he was afraid of their ripening in his next life, and he went to the six non-Buddhist (tīrthika) teachers and questioned them. The six teachers taught him a doctrine of wrong view: that even if one does evil it does not become evil, and even if one does good it does not become merit. He put his faith in this and cut off his roots of virtue.

At that time Ānanda, out of affection for his brother, was deeply unhappy, and weeping he said to the Blessed One, "Deluded Devadatta has committed unwholesome and reprehensible deeds, and having cut off his roots of virtue, he brings disgrace even upon the Śākya clan."

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "It is not only in this life that Devadatta has cut off his roots of virtue for the sake of gain and fame. In times past too, for the sake of gain and fame, he committed deeds that cost him his body and his life."

At this the monks were puzzled, and Ānanda said to the Blessed One, "How was it that in times past too Devadatta committed deeds that cost him his body and his life for the sake of gain and fame?"

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "Ānanda, long ago, in times past, countless, measureless, inconceivable eons ago, here in Jambudvīpa, in the land of Vārāṇasī, there lived a brahmin called Hayi. He took a wife from a family of equal caste, and before long his wife became pregnant. When nine months had passed she gave birth to a boy. They held a great birth feast and named the boy Good Seeker, and entrusted him to a nurse to raise.

"Then she became pregnant again. Whereas before she had been gentle and kind, once she was pregnant she became fierce and wrathful. When nine months had passed she gave birth to a boy, and because the mother had thus changed from before, they named the boy Evil Seeker, and entrusted him to a

nurse to raise.

"Later, when the two boys had grown up, the two brothers went to the ocean to fetch jewels. Each of them found five hundred attendants and companions, and they set out on the road. Because the road was long, their provisions ran out seven days' journey short of their goal, and they were close to losing their lives. Good Seeker and his merchant companions were in desperate straits; they all looked about and called upon the gods, making offerings to them.

"Then in that empty wilderness they saw, far off, a fine tree, and they all went up to the tree. At the foot of the tree there was also a fine spring, and the merchants drank from the spring and said, 'This is the sign that our offerings to the gods have been accepted.' Then a god spoke to them in visible form and instructed them: 'Cut the branches of the tree, and everything you desire will come forth.'

"So they cut one branch, and delicious drinks came forth. Then they cut another branch, and all kinds of food with a hundred flavors came forth, and they all ate until they were satisfied. Then they cut another branch, and clothes of every kind came forth. Then they cut yet another branch, and all kinds of precious jewels came forth, and all their loads were filled.

"Then Evil Seeker and all his company also arrived there, and seeing that those who had come first had filled their loads with all kinds of jewels by cutting the branches, they thought, 'If these earlier ones got jewels enough even from the branches, then if we pull up the roots of this tree we shall get a great many jewels of every kind.' With this thought, they set about digging up the roots of the tree.

"Then Good Seeker was displeased and said, 'We were destitute and about to lose our lives, and this tree saved our lives, so do not cut this tree!' But Evil Seeker would not listen, and he cut the roots of the tree.

"Then Good Seeker, not wishing even to see this, went away with his loads. After he had gone, five hundred rākṣasas emerged from the roots of the tree and devoured Evil Seeker and all the merchants.

"Ānanda, at that time, on that occasion, Good Seeker is now I. His father is now my father Śuddhodana. His mother is now my mother, Lovely Goddess. Evil Seeker is now Devadatta. Ānanda, it is not only now that Devadatta does me harm: in all his lives he has harmed me for the sake of gain and fame. And although I have taught him the Dharma that would benefit him and have done

him good, Devadatta holds me as his enemy."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the great assembly rejoiced and was delighted.

This is the thirty-second chapter, on Good Seeker and Evil Seeker.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Rājagṛha, on Vulture Peak Mountain, together with a great Saṅgha of monks. At that time the venerable Ānanda saw that although Devadatta schemed by all kinds of means to harm the Tathāgata, the Tathāgata regarded Devadatta and Rāhula without any difference and always looked on him with compassion. He asked the Blessed One about this, and the Blessed One said to Ānanda, "It is not only in this present time that Devadatta has harmed me. In other lives too he has harbored malice toward me."

The monks were puzzled, and Ānanda said to the Blessed One, "How did Devadatta harm the Blessed One in other lives?" And the Blessed One said to Ānanda:

"Long ago, in times past, immeasurable, countless, measureless, inconceivable eons ago, there was here in Jambudvīpa a king called Jewel Armor, who ruled over five hundred vassal kings. Although he had some five hundred queens and palace women, he had no son. He prayed to all the gods, the gods of the sun and moon and the rest, but though many years passed he still had no son, and he grew unhappy. He thought, 'I do not have even a single son. When my life comes to an end, the five hundred vassal kings will not obey one another; they will all fall into conflict, and the land will be in turmoil.' With this thought he sank into gloom and sat with his cheek resting on his hand.

"At that time a god, knowing the king's thoughts, instructed him in a dream: 'In the grove outside the palace there are two sages, and one of them has a body the color of gold. Go to him and make your request, and he will be born as your son.' As soon as he had been told this, the king awoke from sleep and went to look for where the two sages were. Meeting the sage, he made this request: 'I have no one to carry on the royal line, so be born into my family and restore the line.' And the sage said, 'I shall do so.' The other sage also said, 'I too shall be born into your family,' and the king, overjoyed, said, 'May you also be born into my family!'

"Then the king returned home. Some time later the golden-colored sage died and was conceived in the womb of the chief queen. Being a knowledgeable

woman, she knew that she was with child, and knew it was a boy, and she said to the king, 'I am certainly carrying a son.' And the king provided for the queen's care. When nine months had passed she gave birth to a boy, golden in color, with hair of sapphire blue, endowed with the marks. The king, overjoyed, held a birth feast. The soothsayer read the marks, and the boy was given the name Good Purpose.

"Then another queen also became pregnant. The other sage, too, had died and was conceived in that queen's womb. Again a birth feast was held, and when the soothsayer had examined the marks, the boy was given the name Evil Purpose.

"Because the king loved his sons and held them dear, he made separate residences for them for summer, winter, autumn and spring. When the boys grew up, they became learned in all the treatises, the eighteen sciences and the rest.

"Later Good Purpose said to the king, 'I would like to go outside, to stroll and see the sights.' His parents, saying, 'Our son is going out for a stroll,' had the streets swept, raised victory banners and pennants, and scattered flowers. They set out the arrangements, with incense and fragrant smoke and the like, and seated Good Purpose on an elephant adorned with the seven precious things. With bells ringing, clay drums beating, and music and cymbals playing, surrounded by some hundreds of thousands of attendants, he went outside the city. All the people of the land, on the upper stories of the houses to the right and left of the road, gazed at him without blinking, and proclaimed, 'His majesty and splendor are like Brahmā's!'

"As he went on, he heard some beggars dressed in rags and holding broken bowls calling out, 'Give us a little!' Good Purpose asked them, 'Why are you so afflicted and miserable?' Some of them said, 'We are miserable because we have no parents, no brothers or sisters, no children and no kin or friends.' Some of them said, 'We have long been struck by illness and do not recover, and so we are miserable.' Some of them said, 'When we held a wedding we were plundered by robbers, and we have nothing at all left, so we go begging.' When Good Purpose heard them say this, he shed tears and went on.

"A little farther on he saw some butchers killing animals, flaying their hides and chopping up their flesh. Good Purpose asked, 'Oh! What are these men doing?' They said, 'Our fathers and forefathers, generation after generation, have done this work of slaughter. If we did not do it, we could not live.' At this

Good Purpose felt ashamed and, unable to bear the sight, went on.

"Then, going a little farther, he saw some farmers plowing a field. Behind the plow many worms appeared, and many birds and venomous snakes gathered and ate them. He asked, 'What are these men doing?' They said, 'We plow the field, and in the furrows where the soil has been broken up we sow seed. Later it grows abundantly, and by this we live and also pay the king's tax.'

"Good Purpose was ashamed at this too and went on a little farther. He saw hunters who had spread bird nets and set snares to catch birds, and creatures caught in the nets and snares, beating their bodies and struggling but unable to break free, crying out piteously, in great terror. He asked, 'What are you doing?' and they said, 'We too, generation after generation, live by doing this kind of killing work.' When Good Purpose heard them say this, he was deeply dismayed.

"Going on a little farther again, he saw fishermen who had set fishing nets and caught a great many fish, which they had heaped in piles on the open ground, still twitching. He asked, 'What are these men doing?' and they said, 'We too do no work other than that of our forebears, and so we live by catching fish like this.'

"Having seen such things, Good Purpose thought, 'Because these beings are poor and destitute, they commit such reprehensible deeds as killing for the sake of clothing and food. As soon as they die, they will fall into the three lower realms, going from darkness into darkness, with no time of liberation.' With this thought he returned home, and brooding over it day and night, he was unhappy. He went to his father and said to him, 'Father, I have a request to make of you; please grant it.' His father said, 'Son, what are you saying? I shall do whatever you say.'

"'Father, when I went outside for a stroll before, I saw many people all afflicted for the sake of clothing and food, killing one another, lying, using force against one another, and committing all kinds of unwholesome deeds. Since I wish to give to them, Father, please allow me to use the great treasury as I see fit for the needy and destitute.' His father said, 'All the jewels and the many treasuries I have amassed were gathered for your sake alone, so why should I not grant what you ask?'

"Then, having received his father's permission, Good Purpose announced to all the people of the land, 'Good Purpose is holding a great giving, so let everyone gather and come!' At that time renunciants and brahmins, the poor and

destitute, the helpless, the sick and others filled the roads outside the city. They came from a hundred, two hundred, three hundred, four hundred, five hundred, and a thousand leagues away; some came from two thousand, three thousand, four thousand, five thousand, and ten thousand leagues away. They gathered like clouds, and he gave to all of them whatever they wished: clothes to those who wanted clothes, food to those who wanted food; jewels, gold, silver, vaiḍūrya, coral, mounts, carriages, palanquins, pleasure gardens, fields, cattle and so on. He gave whatever they wished.

"He continued giving in this way, and after a long time had passed, a third of the treasury was exhausted. The treasurer said to the king, 'Since the prince has made gifts from the treasury, a third of it is exhausted, and only about two thirds remain. Please consider what we shall use for the gifts we exchange with others and for trade goods.' The king commanded, 'Because I love my son, I cannot refuse him. Even if the treasury becomes empty, it does not matter.'

"Then, after another long time had passed, two thirds of the treasury were exhausted and only about a third remained, and the treasurer again said to the king, 'Now about two thirds of the treasury are exhausted and only about a third remains. What shall we use for sending gifts to one another and for trade goods?' The king instructed him, 'My son is so very dear to me that I cannot refuse him and dare not speak to him. You find whatever means is best, and make the excuse that you are busy and have no time.'

"Having received the king's instruction, the treasurer locked the door of the treasury and went off on business. After that, when beggars went to Good Purpose, sometimes the treasurer could not be found and the treasury door would not be opened, and even when the treasurer did come, he would not give as was wished. So Good Purpose thought, 'This state of affairs is not something the treasurer could have decided on his own; it must have come from my father's instruction. Even so, it is not right for a son to empty his father's treasury. What means can I now find so as to obtain jewels as I wish and benefit many people?'

"With this thought he asked people, 'In the world, what work can one do to gain great wealth that never runs out?' Some said, 'If you plow fields on a large scale, you will have great wealth.' Some said, 'If you breed cattle and make a profit, you will gain great wealth.' Some said, 'If you trade for profit over long roads, you will gain great wealth.' Some said, 'If you go out on the ocean and

fetch precious jewels, you will have many jewels.'

"When Good Purpose heard what they said, he said, 'Plowing fields, breeding cattle and going on long roads as a trader are not for me. Only going out on the ocean is for me.' Resolving, 'I shall go out on the ocean,' he said to his parents, 'I shall fetch many jewels from the ocean and give to the poor and destitute as they wish. Please allow me to go to the ocean to fetch jewels.'

"When his parents heard him say this, they were alarmed and said to their son, 'In the world, the poor and destitute have no choice; they stake their bodies and lives and go. What do you lack? If you have such a mind to give, give away all the wealth there is in the house. But you must not go to the ocean. In the ocean there are waves, swirling whirlwinds, sea monsters, venomous nāgas, rākṣasīs, hidden rocks the color of the water, and many other fearsome obstacles, so that it is hard to come through safely. What do you lack, that you would stake your life? We will not listen to this, so stay here and do not think of it.'

"When Good Purpose heard them instruct him so, since things had not turned out as he had intended, he made a vow, thinking, 'Until this intention is fulfilled, I shall lie face down on the ground before my parents and not get up.' And he said, 'Father and Mother, please know this: until my intention is fulfilled, I shall not get up from lying face down here.'

"Then his parents, unhappy, consulted with their kin and friends, who spoke of the many fearsome obstacles in the ocean. 'We, in our bewilderment, worshipped all the gods for twelve years, and someone like you was born as our son. Do not abandon us; eat your food!' From one day, two days, up to six days they pleaded with him in all kinds of words, but he would not listen and did not turn back from what he had said before.

"His parents, alarmed, consulted together and said, 'From the time our son was first born until now, he has never given up anything he set out to do until he has carried it through. If we let him go to the ocean, he may perhaps come back. If we do not let him go, once seven days have passed he will die at once. So now we must let him go.' Having agreed on this, they went to their son, took him by the hand, and said, 'Son, get up and eat. We allow you to go as you wish.' Good Purpose got up, ate food and took drink.

"Then he went outside and proclaimed to the people, 'I am going to the ocean to fetch jewels. Whoever of you wishes to go, come along with me! I shall be the captain, and I shall provide the supplies.' At that time some five hundred

merchants of that land said, 'We too will go to the ocean to fetch jewels,' and they all gathered and set out.

"At that time there was in that land an old captain who had gone to the ocean many times before. The prince himself went to him and said, 'I need you to come as guide for the voyage to the ocean, so get ready.' The captain said, 'Besides being old and frail, I cannot see with my eyes, so I am not able to go.'

"Then the prince went to his father and said to the king, 'There is an old captain who has gone to the ocean many times before and knows the ocean well. Please command him to be my guide for the voyage to the ocean.' The king himself went to the blind captain and instructed him: 'The prince wants to go to the ocean. Though we gave him such counsel as that he must not go, he would not listen. You go as the prince's guide for the voyage to the ocean.' The captain replied, 'Besides being old and frail, both my eyes are blind; yet if the king commands, I shall not disobey his command.'

"When the king came back to the palace, he asked, 'Who is there who dares to go to the ocean with my son?' And Prince Evil Purpose said, 'I too will go, as my elder brother's servant.' The king thought, 'It is better for his younger brother to go than for others to go,' and he allowed the younger brother to go as well.

"Then the prince brought out three thousand gold coins. He spent a thousand coins on the ship's fittings and two thousand on supplies needed for the voyage, and set out. The king, the queens and all the others saw him off.

"Then they reached the ocean shore, boarded the ship and moored it with seven ropes. Waiting for the wind, he said to the merchants who were going, 'In the ocean there are all kinds of obstacles. Many have set out in the past, but very few have returned. If any of you has doubts about this, turn back. If, without regard for your body and life, and without attachment to your parents, children, wives, kin and friends, you reach the Isle of Jewels and return home safely, then down to the seventh generation of your children and grandchildren you will not be in want of wealth.' Having told them this, he cut one rope. In the same way, for seven days, he told them this once each day and cut one rope each time. Then, when the wind came from the right direction, they hoisted the sail and sped off swift as an arrow.

"When they reached the Isle of Jewels, the prince, being highly skilled in assessing jewels, showed them which jewels were good and which bad, and how many of each to take, and each of them searched for jewels on his own. He and the captain boarded a small boat, leaving most of the merchants there.

"As they went on, the captain asked, 'Now a white mountain should be appearing. Don't you see it?' The prince said, 'Something like that does appear.' He said, 'That is the silver mountain.' Going on again, he asked, 'Now a blue mountain should be appearing. Do you see it?' He said, 'Something like that does appear.' He said, 'That is the vaiḍūrya mountain.' Going on again, he asked, 'Now a yellow mountain should be appearing.' He said, 'Something like a yellow mountain does appear.' He said, 'That is the golden mountain.'

"Then they reached the foot of the golden mountain, and as they sat on the golden sand, the captain said, 'I am old and worn out, and now I cannot go any farther. I am going to die right here. Go on from here, and ahead you should come upon a fortress of the seven precious things. If the fortress gate is shut, there should be a vajra pestle by the gate. Strike the fortress gate with the vajra pestle, and five hundred goddesses will come out from within, each carrying jewels to offer you. Then one goddess will come before you carrying a blue jewel. That is the wish-fulfilling jewel. As soon as you obtain it, hold it tight and do not lose it. Take the jewels of the other maidens too. Restrain your senses well, and do not speak with them. I am exhausted, and when I die here, remember my kindness: bury my bones right here, and go on.' As soon as he had said this, he died.

"Then the young captain buried the bones in the golden sand and went on as he had been told, and before long he reached the fortress of the seven precious things. The gate was firmly shut, so he took up the vajra pestle beside it and struck the gate. The gate opened by itself, and the five hundred goddesses came out one after another, each carrying jewels, and offered them to him. One goddess from within, the first of them, held a blue jewel in her hand. He took it as he had been told, tied it into the hem of his robe, and turned back at once.

"While they were apart from Prince Good Purpose, Prince Evil Purpose told the merchants, 'Take plenty of jewels!' So the merchants took a great many, and because the jewels were so many the ship went under in some places and came up in others. Prince Good Purpose alone did not sink in the water, because he had the precious wish-fulfilling jewel. Prince Evil Purpose was terrified and said to Good Purpose, 'Save me too!' So Good Purpose took Evil Purpose with him and crossed the ocean.

"When they reached dry land, Evil Purpose said to his elder brother, 'We two brothers left our parents and went to the ocean to fetch jewels, but we had no

luck. To go home without jewels, empty-handed, is shameful.'

"Prince Good Purpose, who was straightforward by nature, said to his younger brother, 'I have obtained a jewel, so why be ashamed?'

"'Please show me what sort of jewel you found,' said the younger, and the elder untied the jewel and showed it to him. When the younger brother saw the jewel he thought, 'Even before, although we are both alike their sons, my parents loved my elder brother and did not love me. On top of that, we two went together to fetch jewels, and my elder brother has found a jewel while I have found nothing at all, so if I come home now my parents will love me even less. I will kill my elder brother while he is asleep and take the precious jewel away with me. If my parents ask, I will say, "My elder brother drowned in the ocean."'

"With this in mind he said to his elder brother, 'Since we two brothers are carrying jewels, it is not right for both of us to sleep at the same time. Let us sleep in turns and keep watch.' The elder brother said, 'Let us do so,' and the two brothers kept watch in turns.

"The elder brother kept watch first, and even when his watch had come round, the younger would not get up for a long while. Only after the elder brother had kept watch for a long time did the younger get up. The elder brother, having sat up so long, was drowsy, and after he had fallen asleep the younger took two long thorns from the grove. While his elder brother lay asleep he drove a thorn into each of his eyes, then took the jewel and fled.

"Good Purpose was startled and cried out, 'Robbers are here!' but no one answered. Then a tree goddess said, 'Your robber is Evil Purpose.'

"Then Good Purpose, unable to bear the pain in his eyes, crying aloud and crawling, went on and on until he came near the land of Lishiba, and there he met a cowherd tending some five hundred cattle. A bull among those cattle saw the blinded prince and licked the prince's eyes with its tongue. Then all the cattle gathered there, and the herdsman came there too. He saw a man rolling on the ground, and when he looked closely he saw thorns stuck in his eyes. He gently drew out the two thorns and led him to his home. Then he smeared the wounds with milk and oil, nursed him with food, and cared for him.

"Some time later, when the wounds had partly healed, the prince said, 'Now I will go,' but the cowherd would not let him go. Then, some time after that,

when the wounds had healed well, he said, 'Now I will go to the city,' and at last the cowherd escorted him to near the city. The prince said, 'Give me a musical instrument called a kima,' and the cowherd gave him a kima.

"Then the prince played music and sang songs and sweet verses. Everyone listened to him, and all of them brought him food and drink. Five hundred beggars, too, were kept alive by relying on the prince.

"Later a keeper of that king's pleasure garden came there. He heard the sweet music and was delighted, and he asked, 'If you played music in my pleasure garden and also guarded the pleasure garden, could you not do that?'

"'I am blind, so I cannot,' he said.

"The keeper said, 'Even though you cannot see, that is all right. Tie bells to a cord at the tops of the trees, and whenever you hear the cries of birds, just pull the cord. Let us go to my pleasure garden.' So the prince stayed in that garden and played music.

"At that time Evil Purpose came back, and the king asked him, 'Where are your elder brother and the other merchants?'

"He said, 'My elder brother Good Purpose and the other merchants found a great many precious jewels and sank in the water along with the ship. I know how to swim, so I alone escaped.'

"The king his father and the queen were both stunned and fell to the ground. The other people living in the land also heard this, were astounded, and were overwhelmed with grief. The king his father and the queen, their hearts tormented by grief, said, 'Evil Purpose, what harm would it have done if you had gone with your elder brother too?'

"When Prince Good Purpose had lived at home, he had raised a goose. The king said to it, 'Prince Good Purpose went to the ocean to fetch jewels, and they say he sank in the ocean and is lost. Go and look for him and search for him.' He wrote a letter and tied it around its neck, and it set off. The goose flew everywhere, searching and searching, until in that pleasure garden it heard the prince's voice. It alighted there, looked, and found the prince staying there. The prince, who knew the goose's call, untied the letter from its neck and had it read to him. Then he wrote a letter in reply and sent word in detail of how Evil Purpose had driven thorns into his eyes and fled.

"At that time the king of Lishiba had a daughter rare in all the world. The princess was strolling in the pleasure garden when she came upon Prince

Good Purpose. She saw Prince Good Purpose, his hair matted, his face full of tears, dressed in poor clothes and sitting at the foot of a tree, and she fell in love with him. Neither of them went anywhere, and she stayed beside him and talked with him.

"When the morning had passed, the king sent for his daughter. She said, 'Bring my meal here. I will not go there.' So the king sent her food, and the princess said to the prince, 'Let us two eat together.'

"The prince said, 'I am a blind beggar, so it is not fitting for me to eat with the king's daughter. If the king heard of it, I would be punished, so it is not fitting.'

"The princess said, 'If you will not eat with me, then I will not eat either.' She said this many times, and then they ate together. They talked pleasantly, and the princess grew so attached to him that she would not go anywhere else.

"Then, as the sun was about to set, the king sent word: 'Daughter, come back!' The princess sent back this reply: 'I am happy to be the wife of this keeper of the pleasure garden, and I want no one else at all. Father, my king, I beg you not to turn me from this intention.'

"When the king heard the message she sent, he could not bring himself to refuse his daughter, but he said, 'This is most astonishing. King Jewel Armor has asked for this girl as a bride, and before his prince has come back from the ocean she is happy to be the wife of a beggar like this. She disgraces my lineage, and I cannot even lift my head. This is astonishing indeed!' And he sent once more to call her, but the princess did not go back on her earlier words and would not come.

"Then the king, out of love for his daughter, could not refuse her. He welcomed the two of them, brought them into the palace, and joined them as husband and wife.

"After many days had passed, the princess was always going out during the day and coming back at night, and the prince grew suspicious. He said to his wife, 'You joined with me as husband and wife, saying you would be my wife, yet during the day you are always going off, and you come back only at night. Seeing how inconstant this is, I am sure you have your mind on someone else.'

"The princess swore, 'I think of you alone; I have not even a hair's breadth of any other thought. If the words I have spoken are true, by this speaking of the truth may one of your eyes see!' The moment she said this, one of his eyes could see.

"Then, as they talked of these things, she asked the prince, 'Where are your parents and your country?'

"The prince said to his wife, 'Have you heard of a king called Jewel Armor?'

"His wife said, 'I have heard of him.'

"'Well then, he is my father. Have you heard of one called Prince Good Purpose?'

"His wife said, 'I have heard of him.'

"'Well then, the one called Prince Good Purpose is I.'

"His wife was startled and asked, 'Then why have you come to such misery?' The prince told her in detail how it had all happened, and the princess said to the prince, 'That Prince Evil Purpose put out your eyes is something unheard of anywhere in the world. I wonder what you would do if you met him.'

"The prince said, 'Evil Purpose did wrong in putting out my eyes, but I bear him not the slightest ill will, nor do I hold a grudge.'

"His wife said, 'I find that very hard to believe. To say you bear no ill will toward one who did you such harm is not something that can be said.'

"The prince said, 'I have not even the tip of a hair of ill will toward Prince Evil Purpose. If these words of mine are true, by these words of truth may my other eye see too!' As he said this, the other eye too saw clearly.

"So the prince could see with both eyes, and his features and form far surpassed those of others. The princess was overjoyed and went to where her father the king was, and said, 'Father, my king, do you know Prince Good Purpose, the son of King Jewel Armor?'

"The king said, 'I know him.'

"'Then would the king wish to see him?'

"'Where is that prince now? I will look at him,' he said.

"The princess replied, 'He is none other than the one who is now my husband.'

"The king laughed at his daughter and said, 'Has this girl gone mad? Or has she lost her memory? What is wrong with her? That prince has not come back from the ocean, and she says a beggar is Prince Good Purpose!'

"The princess spoke again: 'If you do not believe it, please examine him.' So the king went to look, and it was indeed the prince. Laying himself face down

on the ground, he said, 'I was at fault in not recognizing you, and I regret it.'

"Then that king secretly sent Prince Good Purpose out onto a road and proclaimed that Good Purpose had only just come back from the ocean. With his ministers he welcomed Prince Good Purpose and brought him to the palace, and he proclaimed that only now had he given him his daughter as his wife.

"At that time the goose also went back to its own country with the letter. When the letter was read, they learned that Prince Good Purpose was alive, and Evil Purpose was put in prison. A messenger was sent to the king of Lishiba as well, with this message: 'I hear that my son Good Purpose came to your land and is living there in misery. You did wrong not to send me word before. Now escort him back with a great company of elephants and horses. If you do not escort him, I shall come myself.'

"At that time Prince Good Purpose remembered the kindness of the cowherd. Afterward he petitioned the king of Lishiba and gave the cowherd many rewards, elephants, horses, clothing, a house, fields, pasture, gold, silver, jewels, male servants, female servants, laborers and so on, and so made him happy and comfortable for the rest of his life.

"Then King Jewel Armor's messenger arrived there, and the king of Lishiba adorned five hundred elephants with jewels. He also sent five hundred attendants, five hundred young maidservants, and some five hundred chariots, and the king himself, together with his ministers and a retinue of many hundreds of thousands playing all kinds of music, escorted his daughter.

"The messenger went on ahead, and King Jewel Armor, together with the queen and his retinue, came out to welcome the prince. When they met the prince, he got down from his mount and bowed to his parents. They took him by the hands, asked after his health, and went to the palace with music playing.

"Then Prince Good Purpose said, 'Where is Evil Purpose?'

"'He is now in prison,' they said.

"Then he said, 'Release Prince Evil Purpose!'

"'He has done a great wrong, so it is not right to release him,' the king ordered.

"'If Prince Evil Purpose is not released, then I will not go into the palace either,' he said, and so Evil Purpose was released.

"Then Prince Evil Purpose too came to welcome his elder brother, bowing to him, so it is told. The two brothers embraced each other, and the elder came to love his younger brother even more than before, so that everyone held it a wonder.

"Then, when they had come into the palace, he gently asked, 'Where is the jewel?' and the younger said, 'I hid it in a hole I dug in the ground along the road I came by.'

"Then they sent people to fetch it, but they could not find it, until Evil Purpose went along with Good Purpose, and as soon as they reached the place Good Purpose saw it and found it. Then, having found the jewels, he came back to the palace and gave one to each of the five hundred vassal kings. Keeping only one for himself, he held it in his hand and made this aspiration: 'If this jewel is truly the precious wish-fulfilling jewel, may the throne on which my parents sit become a throne of the seven precious things, and may there also be a parasol of the seven precious things!' As soon as he had said this, it came about just so.

"Then he spoke again: 'From the king's treasury and the ministers' treasuries I formerly gave gifts. May every kind of loss be filled again!' And merely by his pointing the jewel in their direction, all the treasuries became completely full of jewels.

"Then a bell was sounded and it was proclaimed: 'Seven days from now Prince Good Purpose will bring down a rain of the seven precious things. Let everyone gather!' Prince Good Purpose washed his body with scented water and put on new, clean clothes. He fastened the precious wish-fulfilling jewel to the top of a victory banner, took a censer in his hand, bowed to the four directions, and said, 'If this jewel is truly the precious wish-fulfilling jewel, let it rain down for everyone whatever they wish, just as they wish!'

"As soon as he had said this, clouds rose up from the four directions, and the wind of the clouds swept away all that was unclean. First a fine drizzle fell and laid the dust. Then food of a hundred flavors, of every kind, rained down. Then garments rained down. Then the seven precious things rained down and filled the whole land. At that time everyone came to regard jewels and gold as all the same, and then the prince commanded them: 'Now that you have obtained all you need, just as you wished, you will no longer be in want or toil. Each of

you, restrain your body, speech and mind, and strive in the ten paths of virtuous action.' All of them did as they were commanded and devoted themselves to the ten virtues. Because they did no evil, when they passed from that life they were born as gods in the higher realms.

"Ānanda, the one who at that time, on that occasion, was King Jewel Armor is now my father, Śuddhodana. The king's queen is now my mother, Lovely Goddess. Prince Good Purpose is now I myself. The king of Lishiba is now Kāśyapa. The one who at that time became the prince's wife is now Prajāpatī. Prince Evil Purpose is now Devadatta. The people of Jambudvīpa whom my kindness reached then are the eighty thousand sons of the gods who came when I first attained buddhahood, and my close disciples who have received prophecies.

"Ānanda, if at that time, on that occasion, I gave rise to a mind of tender love for him even though he did me such great harm, then now that I have become fully awakened, my obscurations of the afflictions exhausted and great compassion pervading everything far and wide, what need is there to speak of my tender love for one who has done me some small harm?"

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, some of the great assembly attained stream-entry, the stage of non-return, and arhatship. Some became pratyekabuddhas, and some gave rise to the mind set on unsurpassed awakening. When he had spoken thus, all rejoiced and were delighted.

This is the chapter on Prince Good Purpose, the thirty-third.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada, together with a great Saṅgha of one thousand two hundred and fifty monks.

At that time there were in that land five hundred beggars who always lived by depending on the Buddha and the Saṅgha. Later those beggars thought, "Now we will go forth in the Buddha's teaching." They went to where the Buddha was and said to the Blessed One, "We have been kept alive by the compassion of the Buddha and the Saṅgha. Let us go forth!"

To this the Blessed One replied, "The Dharma I teach is utterly pure; in it there is no high or low, no rich or poor. It is like water: high and low, rich and poor, good and bad, it washes them all, and there is nothing that is not made clean when washed with water. It is like fire: among mountains and cliffs and between heaven and earth, there is nothing, great thing or small, that it does

not burn. Moreover, my Dharma is like space: men, women, boys, girls, the rich, the poor, whoever they may be, there is no one it does not take in. You are permitted to practice it as you wish."

When the five hundred beggars heard this, they were delighted, joyful and glad, and said, "We wish all the more to go forth under the Buddha." The moment the Blessed One said, "Welcome!" their hair and beards fell away of themselves, and they became monks wearing saffron robes and received full ordination. When the Blessed One taught them the Dharma, their bodies and minds were fully liberated, their defilements were exhausted, and they became arhats.

At that time the householders and merchants of that land, men of great and high family, heard that the Buddha had ordained beggars, and they looked down on this and scorned it. They said, "If we invite the Blessed One and the noble Saṅgha and make merit, how could we seat those low-caste beggars he has ordained on our cushions and let them touch our vessels?"

At that time Prince Jeta invited the Buddha and the Saṅgha to a meal and said to the Blessed One, "I invite the Buddha and the Saṅgha, but not the beggars who have newly entered."

The next day, when mealtime had come, the Buddha and the Saṅgha were invited and set out, and the Blessed One said to the beggar monks who had not been invited, "Since the patron has not invited you, go today to Uttarakuru, gather the rice that grows there without seed being sown or ground being plowed, and come to the patron's house to eat it."

As they had been told, those monks went by the miraculous power of arhats to Uttarakuru, filled their alms bowls with rice, and, with graceful bearing, came through the sky above like kings of the geese to the house of Prince Jeta. They sat down in order and ate the rice.

At that time Prince Jeta saw those monks come with graceful bearing through the sky above by miraculous power. He was filled with joy and amazed, and he said to the Blessed One, "From what quarter have these noble ones come, endowed with such splendor and such qualities, arriving with such graceful bearing?"

The Blessed One said to Prince Jeta, "If you wish to know about them, listen well, and I will explain it to you. These monks are the monks whom you, prince, did not invite. Because you did not invite them, each of them fetched

rice from Uttarakuru and is eating it."

When Prince Jeta heard him say this, he was deeply ashamed and regretful. "I was blinded by delusion and did not recognize the noble ones," he said, and then he said to the Blessed One, "The qualities of the Blessed One are inconceivable. These beggars were of the very lowest and meanest family in this land, yet here they have gained happiness in this world and have also found their lasting aim. The Blessed One came into the world for the sake of these aims alone. Further, Blessed One, what roots of virtue did these beggars guard in the past, and in what meritorious deeds did they exert themselves, that they have met the Blessed One and become liberated? And what evil did they do, that from birth they were born as beggars and became poor and destitute?"

The Blessed One said to Prince Jeta, "Long ago, beyond immeasurable, countless, inconceivable eons past, here in Jambudvīpa, at the place called Ṛṣipatana in the city called Vārāṇasī, there dwelt many pratyekabuddhas. Even when no buddha had come into the world, pratyekabuddhas lived there, and when there were no pratyekabuddhas on that mountain, sages with the five superknowledges lived there.

"At that time two thousand sages were living there. Later the soothsayers foretold, 'For twelve years no rain will fall.' At that time there was in that land a rich householder of great wealth called Harmonizer, and the sages went to him and said to the householder, 'Are there food and drink for us, these thousand sages who have gone forth, for twelve years?'

"He said, 'We have them, so I beg you noble ones to stay and not go elsewhere.'

"Then the other thousand sages also came and said to the householder Harmonizer, 'We need food and drink for twelve years.' The householder asked his treasurer, 'Is there enough to sustain these noble ones for twelve years?' The treasurer replied, 'There is enough.' So the householder appointed five hundred workers to provide for the two thousand sages and set them to preparing alms food.

"After a time the workers grew weary of the long labor of cooking the alms food, and they said, 'The reason we are always so miserable like this is these beggars.'

"At that time the householder appointed one worker to issue the invitation every day at mealtime. This inviter had a dog, and the dog always went along behind the inviter. One day the inviter forgot, and at mealtime the dog went to the sages and barked loudly. When the sages heard the dog barking, they knew that mealtime had come, and they went for alms.

"Some time later, after they had taken their meal, the sages said to the householder, 'Householder, the rain will come now, so have the farmers do the work of the fields.' The householder had the farmers do the work of the fields, and they sowed a great deal of barley, wheat and other grain. Some time later every kind of grain they had sown grew up as gourds. The householder was amazed and said to the sages, 'Will these not come to nothing?'

"The sages said, 'They will not come to nothing. The rain will fall in due season, and so on; do the work.'

"Not long afterward all the gourds had grown large. When they split them open and looked, whatever had been sown had grown within them, and every gourd was full of it. The householder was overjoyed and delighted, and all his granaries were filled.

"When the five hundred workers saw these things, regret arose in them. 'We reviled the noble ones with harsh words,' they said, and confessed it. And each of them made this aspiration: 'May we too meet noble ones in a future time and become liberated!'

"Because these five hundred beggars spoke harsh words, for five hundred lives they were always beggars. Because they confessed and made the aspiration, they have met me and reached the end of saṃsāra.

"Prince, you should understand it in this way. The one who at that time, on that occasion, was the rich householder Harmonizer was I. The treasurer was Prince Jeta. The man who gave the invitation each day was King Udrāyaṇa. The dog at that time was the householder Sweet Voice; by the power of that deed he has had a sweet voice in all his births. The five hundred men who were workers at that time are these five hundred arhats."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, some of the great assembly attained the first fruit, and some attained up to the fourth fruit. Some gave rise to the mind set on unsurpassed awakening. They rejoiced in what the Blessed One had said and were delighted.

This is the chapter on the householder Harmonizer, the thirty-fourth.

The tenth section.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. He was teaching the true Dharma to a great many people.

At that time all the people of the city were setting out to hear the Dharma. In that town a blind brahmin was sitting by the roadside, and as many people went past he asked, "Where are you going in such a hurry?"

The people said, "Have you not heard? A tathāgata has appeared in the world, and he is now staying in this land and teaching the Dharma. Since it is very hard to meet a tathāgata who has appeared in the world, we are going to hear the Dharma from the Buddha."

That brahmin was highly skilled in the eight kinds of voice; merely from someone's speaking, he could tell their fortune and how long they would live. What are the eight? A voice like a sparrow's, a voice like a crow's, an ambiguous voice, an elephant's voice, a drum's voice, a thunder voice, a bell's voice, and the voice of Brahmā. These are the eight.

One who speaks with a voice like a sparrow's is shameless and ungrateful. One who speaks with a voice like a crow's is angry and fierce, delights in killing, and is without compassion. The ambiguous voice is when a man speaks with a woman's voice or a woman speaks with a man's voice; such a person has no fortune, and is poor and base. One who speaks with a voice like an elephant's is upright by nature and intent on helping friends. One who speaks with a voice like a drum's is eloquent, quick-witted and learned, and becomes a king's support. One who speaks with a voice like thunder has a wise mind and is skilled in the Dharma. One who speaks with a bell's voice is rich and wealthy and owns many hundreds of thousands of gold coins. One who speaks with the voice of Brahmā has great merit and great fortune: if he stays in the household, he becomes a wheel-turning king, and if he goes forth, he will without doubt awaken as a buddha.

At that time the brahmin said to the people, "I am highly skilled in voices. If he is a true buddha, he must have the voice of Brahmā. Take me along with you, and I will go too." So they led the blind brahmin along, and as they came near that place he heard the voice of the Buddha speaking. The blind man was overjoyed and delighted, and faith arose in him. Both his eyes opened of themselves, and he saw the Buddha's golden-colored body, adorned with the thirty-two marks, shining brilliantly like the light of the sun. He bowed his head

at the feet of the Blessed One, and boundless joy arose in him. When the Blessed One taught him the Dharma and gladdened him, two hundred thousand evil, nonvirtuous deeds were exhausted. He attained the fruit of stream-entry, came to possess the eye of wisdom, and asked to go forth in the teaching. Then the Blessed One said, "Welcome!" and he became a monk. When he was taught the Dharma suited to him, he became an arhat.

The great assembly was full of wonder, and the venerable Ānanda rose from his seat, joined his palms, and said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, you work for the good of many beings, and among all those blinded within your compassion, your compassion has been especially great for this blind brahmin. This one blind brahmin has gained both the eye of flesh and the eye of wisdom."

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "It is not only at this time that I have given eyes to this blind brahmin. In a past time too I gave him eyes."

Ānanda said, "Blessed One, please explain fully what kind of eyes you gave him in that past time."

The Blessed One said, "Long ago, beyond immeasurable, countless, inconceivable eons past, here in Jambudvīpa, in the land called Pukalada, there was a king called Eye-Opener. Because that king could see for up to forty leagues unobstructed even by rocks and walls, he was named Eye-Opener, and he ruled over all the eighty-four thousand vassal kings of Jambudvīpa. That king had twenty thousand queens and palace women, and some five hundred princes. His regent was called Excellent Discipline.

"Because that king ruled in accordance with the Dharma and regarded all beings as if each were his only child, the winds and rains never failed their seasons, the harvests were good, and everyone was happy and content.

"Then one day, in a solitary place, the king thought, 'By the merit of a former life I have become a king of men. I possess precious jewels and great wealth, and everyone heeds my word, just as soft grass all lies down in one direction when the wind blows on it. If in this life I do not also produce the fruit for the next, I will come to suffering. Just as all farmers who sow much in spring have much to gather in autumn, so if I do not sow seed in the spring of this life, I will have no autumn harvest in the next. So it is not right for me to be lazy now. Let me sow seed abundantly in the field of merit!'

"Having thought this, he said to his ministers, 'Bring out all my treasuries, pile everything up at the city gates and at the crossroads where many people gather, and give it to many beings. And let the eighty-four thousand vassal kings also give from all their treasuries, as people wish.' Having so commanded, he raised a golden victory banner. A great bell was sounded and it was proclaimed: 'Let the śramaṇas and brahmins of Jambudvīpa, the poor and destitute, and all the old and the sick gather! Whatever each of them wants will all be given, just as they wish.'

"At that time all the subjects rejoiced in the king who acted according to the Dharma, and they praised him and spread his fame. But among the border vassal kings there was one called Dabarne who did not heed that king's commands and ruled contrary to the Dharma. That vassal king had a wise and intelligent minister called Lodara, and the minister said to the king, 'Your Majesty is short-tempered and fierce, and acting without forethought or reflection, you will come to regret it later. King Eye-Opener is greatly compassionate, and his kindness extends to all the people of Jambudvīpa. Since all the kings heed his commands, it is not right for Your Majesty alone to defy him. If you heed his commands, your children and grandchildren will be happy for generations.' But the king flew into a rage at the minister and would not heed his counsel. Then the minister, too, grew displeased and thought,

"The king acts against the Dharma and improperly, and when I gave him beneficial counsel he grew angry and would not listen. All his subjects are displeased with this king, so he must be done away with." Having thought this, he laid a plot, but the secret got out, and the king sent troops back to have him seized. The minister, sensing this, mounted a swift horse and fled. The army pursued him from behind, and when they caught up with him, the minister, being a skilled archer, at once shot fifteen men with arrows and killed them. Then, since the pursuers could not catch him again, the minister went on to the land of Eye-Opener. He bowed to King Eye-Opener and spoke with him, and the king, pleased, made him a minister as well.

Then he reported, "That king does not heed your commands." The king asked his ministers, "Is that king not under my authority?" and they answered, "Your Majesty has no authority over him." Then the minister mustered the armed forces and asked leave to bring that king down, and the king granted it. Then the finest of the troops were assembled, and they fixed the day on which they would march to the land of Dabarne.

At that time that king, too, heard that an army was coming to his land, and he was deeply distressed. He took it to heart and did not know what to do; he put on soiled clothes and shut himself in a dark chamber. At that time there was a wicked brahmin in that land, and he asked the king, "Why are you so unhappy that you grieve like this?" The king said, "Have you not heard? My minister Lodara fled and went to the land of King Eye-Opener, and they say he is leading an army back against my land. That is why I am unhappy. If he leads an army here, we too will be destroyed." The brahmin said, "Gather the ministers and let us take counsel."

Then the ministers and the brahmin assembled and deliberated, and the brahmin said, "I have heard that King Eye-Opener is attached to nothing at all apart from his own father and mother, and that he practices generosity. In this land there is a blind brahmin. Let us send him to that king to beg for one of his eyes. If he gives the eye, he will not lead the army here." Having so deliberated, they put it to the king, and the king said, "Let it be done so," and sent for the blind brahmin.

When the blind brahmin had come, the king spoke to him thus: "There is something I ask you to accomplish for me, and you must do it." The brahmin replied, "Since both my eyes are blind, what is there that I could accomplish?" The king commanded, "King Eye-Opener has arrayed his armed forces and is coming here. I am young, so even if I flee I may escape; but you, without eyes, have nowhere at all to flee. It is said that when that king makes a gift, he gives in accord with the other's wish. Go and ask him for his eyes. If he gives them, the army will not come. Go and ask him for his eyes!" The brahmin said, "If I cannot see, how am I to do it?" The king commanded, "Go! I will provide provisions for the road, a guide, and whatever other necessities you need. If you obtain the eyes, I will also give you a great reward." So commanded, he set out.

At that time various kinds of evil omens appeared in the land of King Eye-Opener. That is to say, the sky seemed to break apart and thunderbolts fell; stars fell and the sky grew dark; thunderbolts struck and the whole earth cracked open; birds uttered weeping cries in the sky and fell to the ground; and lions, tigers and wolves uttered piteous cries, came among the people and rolled on the ground. Such various evil omens appeared.

Then the blind brahmin by stages reached that land, came to the palace gate, and called out in a loud voice: "I have come here from another land. Your

virtues, O king, are renowned everywhere: I have heard that when a beggar comes you give him anything at all, never acting against the beggar's wish. Beset by hardship, I have come here to beg. Give me what I want!" When the king heard these words, he went out to receive him and spoke with words of good cheer: "Were you not wearied on the road? Were you not troubled? Did you come in comfort?" And he said, "Ask for whatever you need, a kingdom, or jewels, or horses, or vehicles, or clothes, or food, or drink, or medicine for sickness, whatever it may be, and I will give you all of it to your satisfaction." The brahmin said, "Giving external material things does not become supreme merit; but if one makes an inner gift, the fruit is great. Since I lost my eyes long ago I am always in darkness and bewildered. I ask for the king's eyes."

When he had said this, the king rejoiced greatly and told the brahmin, "I will give you my eyes." The brahmin said, "If the king is to grant them to me, when will he grant them?" He commanded, "Seven days from now I will give them," and had a bell rung in proclamation and announced it to the eighty-four thousand vassal kings: "Seven days from now King Eye-Opener will make the gift of his eyes to a brahmin. All who wish to see it, come!"

At that time the people of Jambudvīpa, hearing this proclamation, all came there swiftly. All eighty-four thousand vassal kings, too, with their own ministers, came before the king, threw themselves face down on the ground, shed tears, and said, "We, all the people of Jambudvīpa, live in reliance on the king. Why would you abandon us all for the sake of one man?" The ministers, the queens and the palace servants, too, struck their heads on the ground and lay face down on the earth, pleading, "Do not abandon us all for the sake of one brahmin!" and they wailed aloud. The five hundred princes also wept: "We have no protector! We have no refuge! Out of your compassion, please turn your mind back from making the gift of your eyes!"

The regent Excellent Discipline, too, said, "Royal father, please give my eyes as your gift. My death would be of little account, but if my father were to be without eyes, all the people of Jambudvīpa would be without a protector and without an ally." Then the king spoke thus to the vassal kings, the ministers, the queens and the princes:

"Through a long succession of births I have undergone every kind of birth in bodies like this one. The bones I have piled up are higher than Mount Meru. If the blood were gathered, it would be more than the four oceans. The mother's milk I have drunk is greater than the four great rivers, and the tears I have

wept at being parted from what I loved are equal to the ocean. As a being in the hells, too, the times I was burned, boiled and had my eyes torn out are past counting. In the realm of the hungry ghosts I underwent bodies of every kind, and countless times my body was set ablaze and burned up, body and eyes together. Born in the wombs of animals, killing one another and dying, I wasted countless bodies. When born among humans, the times I died before my time were many and the times I reached the full end of my life were few, for, attached to desires, people kill and harm one another. There too I squandered countless bodies and eyes. Even if I was born a god, it did not last long. In short, in the six destinies of the three realms, for the sake of attachment, aversion and delusion, I have wasted as many bodies as there are fine particles of dust, yet not once did I practice generosity, and never did I seek the awakening of a buddha. These eyes, utterly foul and filthy, will rot and perish soon enough. Now it is right to give, and not right to withhold. I shall give these eyes of flesh and gain the eye of a buddha, omniscience. When this aspiration of mine is fulfilled, I shall give you, too, the pure eye of the Dharma. Do not obstruct my mind set on unsurpassed awakening!" When he had commanded this, the whole assembly sat without saying a word.

Then he commanded the ministers, "Let one of you put out my eyes." They replied, "Even if our bodies were ground to dust, we would not dare to pull out a single hair of the king, let alone lay a hand on the king's eyes!" The king commanded again, "Then find a man with a dark complexion who glares out from under his brows." Such a fierce-looking man was found, and the king put a knife in his hand and commanded, "Put out my eyes!" He put out the king's eye and placed it in the king's hand.

With the eye placed in his hand, the king made this aspiration: "By this gift of my eye, may I attain complete and perfect awakening! If I am to attain complete and perfect awakening, may the blind brahmin see the instant he receives my eye!" The moment he had made this aspiration, the king's eye was set into the brahmin's eye socket, and at once he could see. He said to the king, "With the king's eye I have come to see. Seeing with this I am content; I do not need the other one." The king commanded, "I promised to give you both my eyes. If I kept one back, I would go against what I said before." And he put out the other eye as well, took it in his hand, and made the same aspiration as before. It was set into the brahmin's eye socket, and the brahmin came to see with both eyes.

At that moment heaven and earth all shook. All the palaces of the gods trembled and swayed. The gods were amazed, and all of them, seeing that a bodhisattva had made the gift of his eyes, came into the sky above, made offerings of divine flowers and incense, and praised him, saying, "Excellent! Excellent!" Śakra (Indra) too came there and spoke thus to the bodhisattva: "What karmic maturation do you seek from such an extremely difficult deed as this?" The bodhisattva said, "I do not seek the happiness of the three realms, such as that of the king of the māras, or Brahmā, or Śakra, or the Four Great Kings, or a universal monarch. Rather, by this merit I would attain full awakening, in order to establish all sentient beings in the bliss of nirvāṇa." Śakra said, "Since putting out your eyes like this was painful, did no regret or anger arise in your mind?" The king said, "There is no regret, and not the slightest trace of anger." Śakra said, "As I look at you, blood is dripping from both your eyes and your complexion is changing, so it is hard to believe you when you say you have no regret." The king said, "If it is true that I have no regret about this gift of my eyes, and that I shall attain unsurpassed awakening, then by this true speech may my two eyes see as before!" The moment he had spoken, his two eyes became even clearer than before, and then all the gods and humans were overjoyed and delighted.

Then the king said to the brahmin, "Through my gift of my eyes you have come to see. When I become a buddha, I shall give you the eye of the Dharma as well. Take these jewels too and go back home." The brahmin, having gained eyes and jewels, went back to his own land, and that king himself came out to meet him and, as soon as they met, asked, "Did you get the eyes?" The brahmin said, "I got the eyes, and as you see, I can see." The king said, "Then is he dead or not?" He said, "Just then the gods came there, and when he made an aspiration his two eyes became clearer than before." When King Dabarne heard him say this, he was stricken with terror, his heart burst, and he died.

"Ānanda, at that time, on that occasion, the king called Eye-Opener was I, as I am now. Dabarne was Devadatta. The brahmin who begged for the eyes is this present blind brahmin who has attained arhatship. Then too I gave him eyes, and now I have given him the eye of wisdom. For your sake, in all my births, I practiced austerities and attained complete awakening. You too, exert yourselves on the path that is to come."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, among the great assembly some attained the state of stream-enterer, once-returner, non-returner and arhat,

and some generated the mind set on unsurpassed awakening. Ānanda and the great assembly rejoiced in what the Blessed One had said and were delighted.

This is the chapter of King Eye-Opener, the thirty-fifth.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time King Prasenajit had a great minister, learned, intelligent, powerful and wealthy. His wife became pregnant and gave birth to a boy endowed with the marks, handsome in form and with features beyond compare. He summoned a soothsayer and showed him the child, and the soothsayer, his face bright with joy, said, "This boy bears the marks of merit. He will excel all others, and he will have a steady mind and a learned intellect." Hearing this, the boy's father asked, "What name should we give the boy?" The soothsayer asked, "Since this boy was conceived, has anything remarkable happened?" The minister said, "Before, this boy's mother was not gentle and mild by nature, but since this boy was conceived she has become exceptionally gentle and mild. She delights in speaking of others' good qualities and excellences, takes no pleasure in speaking of their faults, and has become loving and tender toward those stricken by misfortune." The soothsayer said, "This is the boy's virtue." And they named the boy Ahiṃsaka.

Then he was reared and grew up, and his strength reached the measure of a mighty wrestler. Alone he could overcome a thousand men; with a leap he could catch a bird flying in the sky; and in speed he was a match for a horse. Because of this they cherished and loved the boy all the more.

At that time there lived in that land a brahmin of learned intelligence, widely read and expert in the treatises, and some five hundred pupils were always studying under that brahmin. At that time the minister, too, took his son and entrusted him to the brahmin to be taught. The boy Ahiṃsaka was so diligent in study that what he learned in a single day surpassed what others learned in a year, and before long he had grasped and understood everything. The teacher, the brahmin, placed special confidence in him and was always in his company and sat together with him, so the other pupils too treated him with respect.

At that time the wife of the teacher, the brahmin, saw that the boy was handsome and fine of form, and more accomplished in his studies than the others, and she became attached to him. But although she held him in her mind, he was never apart from the pupils and kept company with them day

and night, so there was no chance to speak with him. Since things did not go as she wished, she was constantly tormented in her mind.

Some time later a patron arranged provisions for three months and invited the teacher and his pupils as his guests. At that time the teacher, the brahmin, consulted with his wife, saying, "The patron has invited me together with my pupils and arranged provisions for three months. Now, would it be right to appoint one of the pupils to the work here and leave him behind?" His wife was pleased and said to the brahmin, "The household affairs and the many tasks must be done by someone knowledgeable and capable, so it would be right to leave the boy Ahiṃsaka behind; he is reliable." So the brahmin commanded, "Ahiṃsaka, my boy, stay behind and look after the household affairs and duties. I am going, since the patron has invited me." And the boy Ahiṃsaka stayed behind, as his teacher had commanded.

At that time, after the teacher, the brahmin, had left with his pupils, the brahmin's wife was overjoyed. She adorned herself elaborately and spoke with the boy in seductive ways, but Ahiṃsaka held firm and his mind did not waver. Then, with desire arising in her, she spoke plainly: "I have been drawn to you, but until now there was no opportunity. Now the teacher has gone, and it was on purpose that you were left behind. Now we are alone and the moment has come: give in to my wishes!" Ahiṃsaka said, "I am a brahmin, and by the dharma of brahmins I may not lie with my teacher's wife. If I did such a thing I would be no brahmin. I would rather die; this I dare not do."

Since things had not gone as she hoped, the teacher's wife was ashamed and embarrassed, bore a grudge, and resolved to stir up trouble. When the teacher was about to return, she tore her clothes, scratched her face with her nails, smeared herself with dust, and lay on the ground saying nothing, as though struck dumb. Then the teacher, the brahmin, came back and entered the house, and seeing his wife lying like that he asked, "Why are you in such a state?" His wife shed tears and said, "It is not worth asking." The teacher, the brahmin, pressed her, saying, "Tell me what wrong has been done," and his wife wept and said, "That Ahiṃsaka you always praise kept trying to get me to lie with him after you had gone. When I refused, he tore my clothes and wounded my face. Is this the kind of pupil you have?"

When the brahmin heard this he was furious, and he said to his wife, "This Ahiṃsaka is strong enough to overcome a thousand men by himself, and he is the son of a great minister. Since his family is noble, even if he has done

wrong, it must be dealt with by cunning." So saying, he went to Ahiṃsaka, cheered him with pleasant words of every fitting kind, and asked him, "Were you not burdened by the great amount of work after I left?" Then he said this: "From first to last you have cared for me even to the extent of a cup of water, and I always remember your kindness. Now there is a single secret teaching that I have never taught before, and I will teach it to you. If you do accordingly, you will without doubt be reborn as the god Brahmā." The boy Ahiṃsaka knelt on the ground and asked him to teach it, and he said this to Ahiṃsaka: "For seven days keep the virtuous observances; then cut off the heads of a thousand men, take one finger from each, and make a garland for your body of the thousand fingers. Then you will see the god Brahmā face to face, and the instant you die you will be reborn as the god Brahmā." Thus he declared.

When the boy Ahiṃsaka heard his teacher teach this, doubt arose in him, and he said to the teacher, "It is not reasonable that one should be reborn as the god Brahmā by taking life."

The teacher said, "If you are my pupil, why do you not heed the instruction I have taught you? If you do not believe it, there is no need to look ashamed: do not stay here, go wherever you please!" So saying, he cast a secret mantra on him: he planted a sword in the ground and cast the mantra over it, and anger arose in the boy Ahiṃsaka. When the teacher knew he was enraged, he put the sword in his hand. Ahiṃsaka took up the sword, ran out of the gate, killed everyone he met, cut off their fingers and strung them as a garland for his body, so that everyone called him Aṅgulimāla, "Garland of Fingers."

He went on killing everywhere, and on the day the seven days were complete he had gathered nine hundred and ninety-nine fingers; with one more finger the number of those killed would reach a full thousand. But everyone had fled and hidden, so that not a single person was abroad, and though he searched everywhere he found no one. Since he had eaten no food for seven days, his mother, out of love for her son, sent people to take him food, but all were afraid and not one dared. Then the boy's mother herself took the food and went toward her son. When he saw his mother coming from afar, he ran at her, ready to kill her. His mother said to him, "Without any reverence, what perverse thought do you have, that you would commit an act of immediate retribution and kill your mother?" He replied to his mother, "As my teacher taught, I am to make up a full thousand fingers in seven days, and when the thousand fingers are complete I shall be reborn as the god Brahmā. The number of fingers is not complete, and I cannot fail to do it, so now I must kill

you." The boy's mother said to him, "If that is so, could you not cut off my finger without killing me?"

At that moment the Blessed One, seeing and knowing from afar that the time to tame him had come, emanated himself as a monk and went toward him. When Aṅgulimāla saw the monk, he let his mother be, leapt at the monk, and made ready to kill him. Seeing him come like this, the Buddha walked on at a leisurely pace, yet though Aṅgulimāla ran with all his might and strength, he could not catch up, and he called out from afar, "Monk, stop a moment!" From afar the Blessed One replied, "I am always still; it is you who are not still." Aṅgulimāla said, "How is it that you are still and I am not still?" The Blessed One declared, "My faculties are always at peace, and I have gained mastery of samādhi, so I am still. Your teacher taught you wrongly, and you believed in what is evil; your mind has been deceived and is not still, so day and night you do the work of killing and commit endless evil."

The moment he heard this, Aṅgulimāla understood and grasped it in his mind. He threw his sword on the ground and from afar bowed down, saying, "I go for refuge." Then the Blessed One went to him, transformed himself into the form of a buddha, and showed himself radiant with brilliant light, clearly adorned with the thirty-two marks. When Aṅgulimāla saw the Buddha's body with its light and its marks, he threw himself to the ground, confessed his wrongdoing and repented, and when the Blessed One taught him the Dharma, the pure Dharma eye arose in him with regard to phenomena. In faith he asked to go forth, and when the Blessed One said, "Welcome!" his hair and beard fell away of themselves and he became a monk. When the Blessed One taught him the Dharma suited to him, all the stains of his mind were exhausted and he became an arhat, and the Blessed One led him to the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta.

At that time there was no one among the people and other living creatures dwelling in that land who was not terrified at the mere mention of Aṅgulimāla's name, and pregnant women and pregnant animals were so frightened that they could not give birth. At that time a female elephant could not deliver her young, and the Blessed One said to Aṅgulimāla, "Go to the female elephant and speak these words of truth: 'From the time I was first born until now I have not killed a single person.'" Aṅgulimāla said to the Blessed One, "I have killed many people, so how could I say that I have not killed?" The Blessed One declared, "You are called one newly born from the noble Dharma." Then Aṅgulimāla adjusted his robes, went to the female elephant as the Blessed One had told him, and spoke those words, and she gave birth safely.

Aṅgulimāla then returned to his dwelling.

King Prasenajit set out with his armed forces to seize Aṅgulimāla, and the road the troops took passed by the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta. In the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta there was a monk, short of body and ugly, whose voice was exceedingly sweet. When the troops heard him chanting in the temple, they wanted to listen to him without ever tiring, and even the elephants and horses pricked up their ears and listened, unwilling to go on. The king was amazed and asked, "Why are the elephants, horses and the rest unwilling to go on?" They replied, "They will not go on because they want to listen to the sweet voice." The king said, "If even those born in the wombs of animals delight so much in listening to the Dharma, how much more should I, born among humans! I shall listen for a moment." He went to the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, got down from his elephant chariot, unbuckled his sword, set aside his parasol, and went into the presence of the Blessed One where he was staying. Having arrived, he bowed his head to the ground and said to the Blessed One, "Who is that monk with the sweet voice? I wish to see him, and I will also offer him forty thousand kārṣāpaṇas." The Blessed One said to the king, "First make the gift, and meet him afterward. If you meet him first, you will not want to give even a single kārṣāpaṇa." Then the king met the monk, and since he was so very ugly and exceedingly short, not even the thought of giving him a single kārṣāpaṇa arose. The king knelt on the ground and said this to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, what deeds did this monk do in the past, that his body is so ugly and short and yet his voice so exceedingly sweet? How did he come to receive such a karmic maturation?" The Blessed One declared, "Listen well and bear it in mind, and I shall explain.

"Long ago in the past, a buddha called Kāśyapa came into the world. After he had worked for the benefit of beings and passed into nirvāṇa, a king called Kṛkī gathered his relics and set about building a stūpa. Then four nāga kings, taking the form of men, came before the king and asked, 'Will this stūpa you are building for the relics be made of precious substances, or of earth?' The king said, 'A stūpa ought to be built of precious substances, but since there are not many precious substances, it will have to be made of earth. It must be built square, each side five yojanas, and twenty-five yojanas in height, visible from everywhere.' The four nāga kings said to the king, 'We four are nāga kings. Since the king is making a stūpa, we thought that we too would contribute precious substances.' When the king heard them say this, he was

overjoyed and delighted and said, 'It is excellent that you offer such help.' And the nāgas said this: 'Outside the four sides of the city there are four great springs. If you draw water from the spring on the eastern side and make bricks with it, they will all turn into blue beryl. If you draw water from the southern spring and make bricks, they will all turn into gold. If you draw water from the western spring and make bricks, they will all turn into silver. If you draw water from the northern spring and make bricks, they will all turn into white crystal.'

"When the king heard them say this, he was all the more overjoyed and delighted. He appointed a master builder for each of the four sides and had each build one side. When the master builders of three sides had finished their parts of the stūpa, the master builder of one side had been lazy, and his part was nowhere near finished. The king himself came to inspect the work on the stūpa and commanded the lazy one, 'Because you have not worked well, it is not finished; you shall be punished.' The man grew angry with the king and replied, 'A stūpa like this is far too big; it will never be finished!' Then, as the king urged them on, everyone worked diligently day and night, and all of it was finished at the same time.

"The stūpa was a wonder to behold, its precious substances glittering and its shape exceedingly fine, so that the master builder of that side who had been angry was also overjoyed. He regretted and confessed his earlier fault, hung a golden bell at the pinnacle of the stūpa, and made this aspiration: 'Wherever I am born, may my voice be exceedingly sweet, and may all beings who hear it delight in it! In a future time, may I meet the Buddha Śākyamuni and be fully liberated from saṃsāra!' Such was the aspiration he made.

"Great king, the master builder of that one side who at that time, on that occasion, was angry and said, 'The stūpa is far too big,' is this monk. Merely because at that time he said in anger, 'The stūpa is far too big,' he has always been short of body and ugly. Because afterward, with a joyful mind, he offered a golden bell, hung it on the stūpa, and made the aspiration, 'May I have a sweet voice and may I meet you,' for five hundred lifetimes his voice has been exceedingly sweet, and now, having met me here, he has attained liberation."

When the king heard him say this, he made ready to go back, and the Blessed One said, "Great king, where are you going?" The king said to the Blessed One, "In this land there is a savage enemy called Aṅgulimāla who has been killing people everywhere and doing harm beyond all measure, so we are going to march against him with an army." The Blessed One declared, "This Aṅgulimāla

now does not kill even an ant, so what need is there to speak of killing others?" The king wondered, "Has the Blessed One not tamed him by now?" and the Blessed One said this to the king: "This Aṅgulimāla has now gone forth and become an arhat. All the faults of his wrongdoing are exhausted, and he is now in his dwelling. If the king wishes to meet him, I shall have you meet him." So saying, he sent him to Aṅgulimāla's dwelling.

When the king reached the door of Aṅgulimāla's dwelling, he merely heard the sound of the monk Aṅgulimāla clearing his throat inside the dwelling, and remembering that he had formerly killed many people, he was so frightened and terrified that he fainted and fell to the ground. After a long while he got up again, went to where the Blessed One was, and asked the Blessed One what this meant. The Blessed One said this to the great king: "Great king, listen well. Long ago in the past, here in Jambudvīpa, in a land called Vārāṇasī, there was an exceedingly venomous bird. It ate nothing but venomous insects for food. Its body too was so venomous that one could not bear even to come near and touch it. Wherever it flew or went, all the beings beneath it fell to the ground in dread, and all were terrified. At that time that venomous bird went into a grove, perched in a tree, and let out a cry. At that time there was a king of elephants at the foot of that tree, and merely hearing the cry of the venomous bird, it fainted and fell to the ground. Great king, the venomous bird at that time, on that occasion, is the present Aṅgulimāla. That king of elephants was the king himself."

"Blessed One, this Aṅgulimāla, wrathful and fierce, killed so many beings, and the Blessed One has established him in virtue." The Blessed One declared, "Great king, it is not only now in the present time that the monk Aṅgulimāla killed many people and I tamed him. Long ago in the past, too, Aṅgulimāla killed all these people, and I tamed him, and he came to set his mind on virtue."

The king again asked, "Blessed One, please explain in detail how in the past, too, he killed these people, and the matter of his cruelty." The Blessed One declared:

"Long ago in the past, countless eons ago, here in Jambudvīpa, in the land called Vārāṇasī, there was a king called Balamadar. At that time the king went with his fourfold army to amuse himself in a forest. He came upon a deer and ran in pursuit of it, and so the king, alone and separated from his retinue, reached a dense thicket. Then, being weary, the king dismounted from his

horse and sat down. In that dense thicket there lived a lioness. Tormented by desire, she was roaming about, and in the forest she came upon the king sitting alone. Desire arose in the lioness all the more strongly; she approached the king, raised her tail, and pressed herself upon him. The king, recognizing that desire had arisen in her, thought, 'This is a fierce beast of prey, and she has the power to kill me. If I do not do as she wishes, it will cost me my life.' So, though afraid, he had intercourse with the lioness. After the lioness had gone away, his attendants also arrived, met the king, and escorted him back to the palace.

"The lioness then became pregnant, and when her months were complete a son was born. His body and form were in every way like a human's; only his feet were speckled. The lioness, remembering that he was the king's son, carried him on her back and brought him to the king. The king, knowing him to be his own son, raised him, and because his feet were speckled he named him Kalmāṣapāda, 'Speckled Feet.' Raised to full growth, he became exceedingly brave and bold. After the king passed away, he obtained the royal power and took two queens: one queen was of the kṣatriya caste, and one was of the brahmin caste.

"Later Kalmāṣapāda went to stroll in the pleasure grove, and he gave this instruction to the two queens: 'Whichever of you two queens comes quickly after me, whichever meets me first, with her I shall play and take my pleasure for a whole day. The one who comes later shall not be allowed to meet me.' After the king had gone, the two queens adorned themselves with ornaments, had their mounts made ready, and set out at the same time. Along the way there was a shrine of a god, and the queen of the brahmin caste got down from her mount and paid homage to it. Though she then went on quickly, she arrived late. So the king, as he had said before, did not keep her company.

"Then anger arose in that queen, and she was furious with the god: 'While I was paying homage to you I was delayed, and the king was not pleased with me. If you, god, truly had any power at all, why did you not act as my protector and refuge?' Utterly furious and enraged, she resolved in her mind to do it harm. When the king came back to the palace, the queen made this request of him: 'Grant me the authority to do whatever I please for one day.' The king gave the order, 'So be it, it is granted.' She turned out a great many people, demolished the god's shrine, and leveled the ground as well. Then the god who guarded that shrine was exceedingly displeased. Enraged, it resolved to do harm to the king, and it went to the palace, but the god who guarded the

palace did not let it in.

"At that time a sage was living on the mountain called Ṛṣipatana. King Kalmāṣapāda made offerings to that sage, so every day the sage flew through the sky and came to the palace. He did not want fine food; he ate only ordinary food and then went back. One day the god knew that the sage was not coming. Emanating itself in the body of the sage, it meant to go into the palace, but the god who guarded the palace recognized it and did not let it in. It called from the gate, 'They will not let me come inside!' The king heard this and commanded, 'The sage is calling from outside; let him in at once!' The god who guarded the palace, in keeping with the king's command, did not hold it back and let it in.

"When it had come inside and sat on the sage's seat, the king offered it food prepared just as the sage always ate. Then the emanated sage would not eat the food and spoke thus to the king: 'This food is extremely poor. I eat meat and fish.' The king replied, 'Great sage, until now you have eaten ordinary food, and so meat and fish were not prepared.' The emanated sage said, 'From now on I do not want this poor food. Prepare meat and fish!' And having said this, it left. Then the king, as the emanated sage had said, had meat and fish prepared, and the next day offered them to the true sage when he came.

"Anger arose in that sage, and he was furious with the king. The king said to the sage, 'Great sage, when you came yesterday, did you not command me to prepare food like this?' The sage said, 'Yesterday I was ill, so I abstained from food for the day and did not come. Who gave such a command? You have done this out of contempt for me. King, for twelve years may you eat nothing but human flesh!' And having said this, he went away.

"Then one day the king's cook had received no meat, and in that moment he could find no other meat. He came upon the corpse of a child and thought, 'This meat will do as well.' He cut off the head, hands and feet, cooked it, seasoned it with various spices, and served it to the king. The king ate that meat and found it far more delicious than the meat he had had before. He asked the cook, 'The meat until now had no flavor like this. This meat is especially delicious; what meat is it?' The cook was frightened, threw himself prostrate on the ground, and said to the king, 'If the king will not punish me, I will tell the truth.' The king commanded, 'Tell the truth, and I will not punish you.'

The cook said, "We were pressed for time and could find no other meat. I found the corpse of a small child who had died, cooked it and served it, and that is what Your Majesty has tasted." The king commanded, "This meat is especially delicious. From now on always prepare meat like this." The cook replied, "Before, I happened to find the corpse of a child who had died and cooked it; beyond that, none is to be found." The king commanded, "From now on, take them secretly, in a way that you can keep hidden and others do not notice. I have the authority." The cook, as the king had commanded, stole children secretly at night and killed them, and each following day he cooked them.

At that time most of the people of that city were wailing, and from one to another the cry went round, "A child is lost!" The ministers gathered and deliberated over why this was happening, and at night they set a watch at the crossroads of the streets. Watching, they caught the king's cook stealing small children and carrying them off. They bound him, led him before the king, and said, "Again and again, so many children have been lost!" The king said nothing at all. Though they petitioned him in this way three times, he said nothing, so they said, "We have now caught the one who keeps committing this crime. If his guilt is evident, a sentence ought to be passed; it is not fitting to say nothing." The king said, "I ordered it."

Then the ministers were displeased; they held it as a grievance and went their separate ways. When they had gone outside, they said to one another, "The king is an enemy who has eaten the children of all of us and of others. We cannot share one realm with a king who eats human flesh. An enemy who has become so harmful ought to be done away with." So, all agreeing in council, they plotted to kill the king.

Outside that city there was a pleasure grove, and in it a pond in which the king went to bathe every day. The ministers hid a body of troops in the pleasure grove, and when the king was bathing in the pond, the many troops surrounded and seized him to kill him. The king was frightened and said to the troops, "Why have you surrounded me and come to seize me?" The ministers said to the king, "One who is called a king is one who nourishes his many subjects. Because the king has eaten all his subjects' children, all the subjects have been left without security. Since this suffering is unbearable, we shall now kill you, king." The king said, "I was indeed at fault in acting this way, but from now on I will not do so. May I be released this time, or not?" The ministers said to him, "Even if black snow should fall from the sky, or a black snake grow

on your head, there will be no release. Make your final vow!"

Hearing the words the ministers had spoken, King Kalmāṣapāda thought, "Now I shall certainly be parted from life," and again he said to the ministers, "Since you are now determined to kill me, let me set my mind at ease for just a moment. Wait a little first." Then the ministers waited a short while and let him collect his mind, and the king made this resolve in his mind: "By the power of whatever virtue I have done until now, of having ruled the kingdom in accordance with the Dharma, and of all the merit there is in my having given to the sage, may I become a rākṣasa who flies through the sky!" So he dedicated it. As soon as he had spoken these words and made the dedication, he became a rākṣasa, rose up into the sky above, and said to the ministers, "Though you conspired by your power to kill me, by my merit I have survived. From now on you will have to endure it: I shall eat all your dear and cherished wives and children." Having said this, he flew off and landed on a mountain, and from then on he came among humans to eat people. Many people, terrified, were constantly fleeing and hiding.

Then the rākṣasa ate people, and gathering many rākṣasas about him, he came to have a large retinue and many servants. The rākṣasas of his retinue said to the rākṣasa Kalmāṣapāda, "Since we have become your retinue and servants, give us a great feast." The rākṣasa Kalmāṣapāda agreed to this, and resolving to kill five hundred kings for the feast, he went about seizing kings and put them in a rock cave. He found four hundred and ninety-nine, and while one king was still lacking, those kings in the rock cave said to one another, "Now we are lost, and there is no one to be our refuge. If Sutasoma, who is endowed with strength, came here, we might perhaps escape. Let us ask the rākṣasa to bring Sutasoma here." Having agreed on this, they said to the rākṣasa king, "King, when you hold your feast, a feast made by killing only us human kings will not be a fine one. There is one called Sutasoma who has great virtues. If you get him, then it will be a great feast." The rākṣasa king said, "As you please," and flew through the sky to go and seize Sutasoma.

At that time Sutasoma was going outside the city with young maidens to bathe, and on the way he met a brahmin who was begging. He undertook to give to him, and said to the brahmin, "I am going to bathe; when I come back I will give it to you." Having said this he went to bathe, and while he was bathing the rākṣasa king came and carried him off to the rock cave. Then Sutasoma was unhappy and wept, and Kalmāṣapāda said to him, "It is said that you are the best of men, with virtues surpassing others. A great being

fears nothing whatever, so why are you unhappy, weeping like a small child?"

Sutasoma said to the rākṣasa, "It is not that I am attached to my body, nor that I am unhappy from fear of a rākṣasa. From the very beginning I have never told a lie. But just now, on my way to bathe, I met a brahmin who was begging, and I told him, 'When I have bathed and come back, I will give you a gift.' I went to bathe, and you, king, have carried me off here. So I am unhappy, thinking that I have told a lie. It is not that I am attached to body and life. King, out of kindness to me, grant me a respite of seven days; when I have given the gift to that brahmin, I will come back again to die."

The rākṣasa said, "If I release you now, will you be able to come back?" He said, "Even if I do not come, you have the power to take me." Having said this, the rākṣasa let him go.

As soon as Sutasoma had returned home, he found the brahmin still there, and being overjoyed, he gave the brahmin a gift. The brahmin, knowing that before long Sutasoma would go to be parted from life, and that if he were attached to his realm on going back he would be unhappy, spoke these verses to him:

When the end of the eon arrives,
Even the sky and the rivers blaze fiercely;
Mount Meru the towering, and the oceans too,
All of them turn to ashes and dust.
Gods, nāgas and asuras
All perish and come to ruin;
When even heaven and earth cease to be,
How could a kingdom be permanent?
Of birth, aging, sickness and death,
The round of saṃsāra knows no ending.
When for a while one's desires are not fulfilled,
One is harmed by sorrow.
Desire is the greatest of faults;
The ill does not come from elsewhere.
Since the three realms are filled with suffering,
How could the rule of a land be relied upon?
What exists is from the very first nonexistent,
Coming about through causes and conditions.
Where there is flourishing, there is decline;
What is true will surely turn false.

Ordinary beings, from first to last,
All dwell within illusion.
Just as the three realms are empty,
So too is the rule of a land.
Consciousness has no form;
It dwells among four venomous snakes.
What is born of ignorance
One clings to as a place of bliss.
Form has no permanent self;
Mind has no permanent home.
When even body and mind are parted,
How could the rule of a land remain?

Then Sutasoma, having heard the verses spoken, rejoiced as he pondered their meaning in his mind. He installed the regent as king, took leave of the ministers, and made ready to go back as he had promised. The ministers said to him, "Do not fear King Kalmāṣapāda. We have considered it: if an iron house is built to protect the king and the king stays inside it, then however brave Kalmāṣapāda may be, he will be able to do nothing."

The king commanded the ministers and the many people, "Whoever is born a human being must have the conscience not to tell lies. If one tells a lie, there is no joy even in being alive. Better to die, as I first promised; I have no wish to live by telling a lie." So he spoke of the many kinds of good that come from having a conscience and the many faults of telling lies, and the ministers, overcome with grief, were left without words. All of them escorted the king, all of them wailed, and they fainted and collapsed.

While Sutasoma was on the road, the rākṣasa Kalmāṣapāda thought, "It is time for Sutasoma to come here." He came out onto the summit of the mountain and looked, and he saw Sutasoma far off on the road, coming to give up his life. Then, when he had come near, the rākṣasa looked and saw that he had a radiance even more joyful than before, and he said to the king, "What joy can there be for those who are facing the loss of their life? In giving up your living, do you not grudge even your life? What benefit did you find by going to your land, that you are so joyful?" So he asked.

Sutasoma said, "Great king, you were considerate and granted my life a long respite, so I did not go against what I had promised before. I also gave a great

gift, and I heard the sublime Dharma and took it to heart. My wishes are fulfilled, so even if I give up my life here, I am more joyful than if I lived."

King Kalmāṣapāda commanded, "Tell me too what Dharma you heard." Sutasoma recited the verses just as he had heard them, and besides that, with skillful means he also spoke at length of the evil and the wrongdoing of the act of killing, and of the ripening of nonvirtuous actions. He also taught at length the virtues of not taking life, vast merit, and the mind of loving-kindness. The rākṣasa Kalmāṣapāda was overjoyed and delighted; he bowed with the crown of his head, and as he had been taught, from then on he gave up taking life. He also sent the princes he had put in the rock cave back to their own lands. Then Sutasoma arrayed his troops, welcomed King Kalmāṣapāda, and installed him as king once more. Since the twelve years of the curse the sage had cast on him were now complete, from then on he no longer ate human flesh, and he ruled as king as before.

"Great king, Sutasoma at that time, on that occasion, is now myself. That King Kalmāṣapāda is now Aṅgulimāla. The people whom Kalmāṣapāda ate during those twelve years are the people Aṅgulimāla has killed. These people, wherever they were born, were always killed by Aṅgulimāla, and I, in all those births, established them in virtue. If, as I clearly remember, I was able to turn him back from killing in the past, when I was still an ordinary person, then now that I have become fully awakened, perfect in qualities and with wrongdoing completely exhausted, what need is there to mention my taming these?"

The king again said to the Blessed One, "What did these people do in the past, that in all their births they were always killed by Aṅgulimāla?" The Blessed One said to the king, "Great king, listen well, and I shall explain. Long ago in the past, countless eons ago, here in Jambudvīpa, in the land of Vārāṇasī, there was a king called Baladar. That king had two sons, handsome, beautiful to behold, and skilled. His youngest son thought, 'If my father passes away, my elder brother will become king.'"

"'Since I am the younger, I will not obtain the kingship. If, born a human being, I do not obtain the kingship, what good is it to live as a common man? I shall go into solitude and seek the path of a sage.' Thinking this, he went before the king and said to his father the king, 'I wish to seek the path of a sage in solitude. If you hold me dear, do not turn me back from this intention.' He asked again and again, and the king granted it as he wished, and he went off into solitude.

"Then, after many years had passed, his father the king passed away, and the elder brother ascended the throne. The elder brother, having taken the throne, was not long after struck by illness and passed away, and there was no one to continue the line. The ministers gathered and deliberated over what to do, and one minister said, 'The great king had a younger son who asked leave of the king and is now living on a mountain as a sage. Let us invite him and install him as king.' The ministers agreed, 'If there certainly is such a one, let us invite him now and install him as king,' and they went to the mountain to look for the prince.

"When they met the prince, they said, 'We have no king. You must be our king, so let us go.' The sage said, 'These words are frightening. Here in solitude I am perfectly happy and have no sorrow at all. Worldly people are by their nature untamed, and they even kill their kings. I cannot do it.' The ministers said, 'The royal line has been broken and there is no one to continue the line. You alone, sage, belong to the royal line. All the people of the land have been left without a protector, so out of compassion for the many beings, we beg you to come and be king.' The sage could not refuse, and as the ministers asked, he came back to the land and became king.

"That sage had from his youth not been touched by desire, but while ruling the realm he gradually became involved with women, and so his desire grew strong. Day and night he gave himself recklessly to desire, and he issued this decree: 'When any of my subjects who have daughters give them in marriage, they are to send them as brides only after they have first met with me.' So he decreed. And he behaved improperly with every lovely and attractive woman in the land.

"At that time a certain woman came out naked before a great gathering of people and urinated. Everyone laughed and reviled her: 'What is this shameless woman doing?' The woman said, 'What shame is there in a woman urinating in front of women? If you are not ashamed to urinate in front of one another, what shame is there for me in urinating among others who are just like women?' The many people said, 'What do you mean by saying this?' The woman said, 'In this land the king alone is a man; all the other people are surely women. If you were all men, it would not be right for the king to do such improper things.'

"Then the many people were ashamed and embarrassed, and they deliberated, 'What this woman says is true. Since this is not right, this king

must be done away with.' All agreeing in council, they resolved to kill the king when he went to bathe in the pleasure grove. Then they hid a body of troops in the pleasure grove, and when the king came to the pond, all of them turned against him, seized him and set about killing him. The king was frightened and said, 'Men, what are you doing?' The ministers said, 'The king has not acted in accordance with the Dharma. Intoxicated with desire, he has defiled the families of all the people of the land and brought them to disgrace. We can no longer bear it, so we will do away with you, and only then will we seek a wise king.'

"Hearing these words, the king was frightened and said to the ministers, 'It is true that I have done wrong until now, but if from now on I do not act this way, may I be let go?' The ministers said, 'Even if black snow should fall from the sky, or a black snake grow on your head, it will not be granted. Speak no more!' So they commanded. Hearing these words, the king thought, 'Now they will certainly kill me,' and in anger he said to the ministers, 'Before, I lived on the mountain, taking no delight in the world, but you forcibly made me king, and now you kill me. Wherever I am born, may I meet you, and may I kill you too!' So he vowed. But though he made this vow, they did not spare him, and they killed him.

"Great king, the king who was a sage, at that time, on that occasion, is now Aṅgulimāla. The many people who at that time agreed together and killed the king are these people who have been killed by Aṅgulimāla, and so they were always killed by Aṅgulimāla."

The king set his knees on the ground and said to the Blessed One, "Since this monk Aṅgulimāla killed so many people, will he experience the ripening of it even after attaining the fruit in this way?" The Blessed One declared, "Great king, when evil is done, its ripening is certainly experienced. Even now this monk, in his dwelling, has the fire of hell blazing from every pore of his body, and he is experiencing unbearable suffering."

Then the Blessed One, so that the great assembly would understand that when evil deeds are done their evil certainly ripens, said to a certain monk, "Monk, go and take a key, and put it into the keyhole of the door of the monk Aṅgulimāla." The monk, as he was told, took a key and put it into the keyhole of the door, and at once it melted. The monk was terrified, and he went back and came before the Blessed One and reported what had happened. The Blessed One said to that monk, "This is the ripening of evil deeds." When he

had said this, the king and the assembly came to have faith.

Then the venerable Ānanda said to the Blessed One:

"What good did the monk Aṅgulimāla do in the past, that he came to have strength equal to the strength of a great wrestler, great skill, and swiftness like a bird? What good did he do, that he met the Blessed One and came to be freed from saṃsāra? Out of compassion for the great assembly, please explain this."

The Blessed One declared, "Listen well. Long ago in the past, in the time of the Buddha Kāśyapa, there was a monk who did menial labor. He had loaded up a burden of grain and was on his way when he was caught on the road by rain. There was nowhere to take shelter, and the grain, together with its containers, was all soaked. At that time the monk wanted to go quickly, but because the load had soaked up water his going was slow and he could not hurry, and so he made this aspiration: 'In the future may I have strength equal to a thousand men, and a body light and swift like a bird in flight. In the future, when the Buddha Śākyamuni comes into the world, may I meet him and be freed from saṃsāra!' So he made his aspiration.

"Ānanda, do not think it was anyone else. The monk who did menial labor at that time is the present monk Aṅgulimāla. Because at that time he had gone forth, kept moral discipline, and done the work of the Saṅgha, then in accordance with his aspiration, wherever he was born he was handsome and had great strength and skill. Because he aspired to meet me, he has been freed from saṃsāra."

Then Ānanda, the monks, and the king's great retinue, having heard the Blessed One speak of the fruit of karmic ripening, all aroused diligence, and by bringing the Four Truths to mind, some became stream-enterers, some once-returners, some non-returners, and some arhats. Some generated the roots of virtue of a pratyekabuddha. Some set their minds on unsurpassed awakening and came to abide on the irreversible ground. All of them aspired to virtue of body, speech and mind, and they rejoiced and delighted in what the Blessed One had said.

This is the chapter on Ahiṃsaka Aṅgulimāla, the thirty-sixth.

Section eleven.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time there was in that land a woman called Upanandā, destitute and dependent on begging for her living. Seeing the king, the ministers and many people each making offerings to the Buddha and the Saṅgha, the woman thought, "What evil did I do in the past, that I have been born poor like this and of low birth? Now, though I have met a field of merit, I have no seed to sow." She was utterly dejected and filled with remorse. Begging for a whole day, from morning to night, she got no more than a single coin. Taking that one coin, she went to the house of an oil seller to buy some oil. The householder who sold oil said, "Buying oil with a single coin is far too little. What will you do with it?" Upanandā told him truthfully, and the oil seller, moved by compassion, gave her extra oil.

Upanandā, having obtained the oil, was overjoyed. She went to the vihāra, saying, "I shall offer it to the Blessed One," set up a lamp before the Buddha, and made this aspiration: "I am now destitute, and with this little lamp I make an offering to the Buddha. By this merit, in the future may I possess the lamp of wisdom and clear away the stain of darkness of all sentient beings." Having made this aspiration, she went back to her dwelling.

That night the other lamps burned out, but Upanandā's lamp alone burned until dawn. At that time it was Maudgalyāyana's turn to keep the time, and when dawn came he went to collect the oil vessels. One lamp was especially bright; its oil and wick were undiminished, as if it had just been newly lit. He thought, "There is no use in a lamp lit in the daytime; I shall put it out." He tried to put it out, but it did not go out. Then he tried to put it out by waving his hand, but it did not go out and was not diminished. Then he tried to put it out with his robe, and still it did not go out.

The Blessed One saw this and said to Maudgalyāyana, "Though you intend to put out this lamp, you will not put it out. It is not something a śrāvaka can move or shake. Even if you poured on it the waters of the four great oceans, or blew on it with a hurricane, it would not go out. For this lamp was offered by one who generated the great intention of accomplishing vast benefit for all people."

When the Blessed One had said this, Upanandā too came before the Blessed One and bowed her head at his feet. Then the Blessed One prophesied, "In the future, after two eons have passed, you will become fully awakened. Your name will be Light of the Lamp, and you will be endowed with the ten masteries." Then Upanandā, hearing the Blessed One's prophecy, was

overjoyed. Setting both knees on the ground, she asked to go forth, and the Blessed One granted her going forth.

The venerable Ānanda and Maudgalyāyana, seeing that the poor woman had received a prophecy and gone forth, set both knees on the ground, joined their palms, and said to the Blessed One, "What deed did this Upanandā do in the past, that for so long she has been destitute and unable even to find a livelihood? What did she do, that she has met the Blessed One and come to be honored by the fourfold assembly?"

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "Long ago in the past, the Buddha Kāśyapa came into the world. At that time the wife of a householder invited the Buddha together with the Saṅgha of monks, but a poor woman had invited him first, and he consented to go to her. That poor woman had attained the state of non-return. At that time the householder's wife, being powerful, rich, and of noble family, scorned the poor woman's earlier invitation and said:

"Why does the Blessed One not come to my invitation, which I made first, but go instead to the invitation of a beggar woman?" So she spoke harsh words, and because she scorned a noble one, for five hundred lifetimes she was born into poor and destitute families that depended on begging for their livelihood. Yet later that same day, because she made offerings to the Buddha and the Saṅgha with faith and rejoiced, she has now met the Buddha, gone forth, and received a prophecy."

At that time the many in the assembly were overjoyed at what the Buddha had said.

Then the king, the ministers, and many people heard that the poor woman had offered a lamp to the Buddha and had been prophesied to buddhahood. All of them honored her, and they prepared and presented to her, in full sufficiency, the four kinds of supreme and excellent requisites for living. Then all the youths and maidens of that land, both of high and of low birth, prepared lamps of fragrant scent and offered them to the Blessed One in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta. The many people who offered lamps filled the whole of the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta with lamplight, so that on every side it was like the stars appearing in the sky. They offered them day after day, and in this way they kept offering them without interruption for seven days and nights.

Then Ānanda, overjoyed and filled with wonder, praised him, saying, "So great are the qualities of the Blessed One!" and he said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, what deeds did you do in the past, that you have come to have such

immeasurable lamps as these?"

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "Long ago in the past, here in Jambudvīpa, there was a king called Pasili who ruled over some eighty-four thousand lesser kings. The king's queen bore a son whose body was the color of gold, who was endowed with the thirty-two major marks and the eighty excellent minor marks, and on the crown of whose head was a jewel of brilliant color that dazzled the eyes of anyone who looked at it. A sign reader was summoned to examine the child's good and bad features and give him a name. When the sign reader looked at him, he took the marks to be wondrous, raised his hands, and exclaimed, 'Excellent indeed!' He said, 'This prince has no equal among gods and humans in the world. If he stays in the household, he will become a wheel-turning king. If he goes forth, he will attain complete awakening.' Then the sign reader asked the king, 'When this prince was first born, what wondrous and marvelous omens appeared?' The king replied, 'When this prince was born, there was an exceedingly brilliant jewel on the crown of his head.' And so they named the prince Ratnaśikhin.

"Later, when he had grown up, he went forth, applied himself earnestly to awakening, attained perfect buddhahood, and worked for the benefit of countless sentient beings. At that time the king, his father, invited the Buddha together with the Saṅgha of monks for three months and served them a feast of offerings. Among them was a monk called Āryamitra, who had undertaken to be the patron providing lamp oil for those three months. Day after day he went begging through the villages and into the city, and asked merchants, householders, and many people for butter, sesame oil, lamp oil, and wicks.

"Now that king had a daughter called Muni. From the upper story of the palace she saw the monk going begging through the villages every day and toiling, and she felt compassion for him. She sent a man to ask him, 'Venerable one, what are you trying to accomplish, that you are always toiling like this?' The monk replied, 'I have undertaken to be the patron providing the lamps for the Buddha and the Saṅgha for three months. That is why I go begging through the villages and collect from the lay followers butter, sesame oil, wicks for the lamp oil, and the other things needed to set up the lamps.' When this message reached the princess, she was overjoyed, and she sent word to the monk Āryamitra: 'From now on you need not keep going about like this. I will provide the requisites for the lamp oil; come and take them.' The monk said he would do so, and from then on she always prepared the lamp oil, the sesame oil, and all the requisites for the lamps and had them brought to the monastery.

"In this way the monk Āryamitra offered lamps day after day, and because he generated the vast aspiration to benefit all, the Blessed One gave him a prophecy: that in the future, after countless eons had passed, he would attain complete awakening, and that his name would be Dīpaṃkara; and he was prophesied as endowed with the thirty epithets. When the king's daughter Muni heard that the monk Āryamitra had received a prophecy, she thought, 'It was I who provided the lamps offered to the Buddha. That monk did no more than encourage it, and yet he has received a prophecy, while I have not.' With this thought she went to where the Blessed One was and told him plainly just how it was. The Blessed One prophesied, 'Princess Muni, in the future, after ninety-one countless eons have passed, you will attain complete awakening, and your name will be Śākyamuni,' and he prophesied her as endowed with the ten epithets. When the king's daughter had thus heard her prophecy from the Buddha, great joy arose in her. She bowed her head at the Buddha's feet and asked to go forth. The Blessed One allowed her to go forth, and she applied herself to diligence without interruption."

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "The monk Āryamitra of that time and occasion was the past buddha Dīpaṃkara. The king's daughter Muni is I myself now. Because I offered lamps in the past, throughout countless eons I have enjoyed merit in the worlds of gods and humans, and my form has been finer and more excellent than that of others; and now that I have attained perfect buddhahood, I have come to have many lamps."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, among the many in the assembly some attained the fruits from the first fruit up to the fourth. Some generated roots of virtue toward becoming pratyekabuddhas. Some generated the aspiration for unsurpassed awakening. The venerable Ānanda and the many in the assembly rejoiced and delighted in what the Blessed One had said.

This is the thirty-seventh chapter, the chapter of the maiden Upanandā.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying in Rājagṛha, on Vulture Peak Mountain. At that time there lived in that land a householder called Śirici, who was extremely rich, possessed of great wealth, and whose treasuries were filled with the seven kinds of precious things. He took a wife from a family of equal rank, and some time later his wife became pregnant. When the months were complete she gave birth to a son, so lovely and handsome that he had no equal in the world. His parents loved him dearly and summoned a sign reader to examine his marks. When he looked at the marks,

the sign reader said, "This boy is endowed with the marks of merit, and he will make the family flourish." The boy's parents were all the more delighted, and they said to the sign reader, "Give the boy a name." The sign reader asked, "Since this child came to be, what omen or marvel has occurred?" They replied, "There has been nothing else, except that the boy's mother, who was not eloquent before, has become eloquent ever since this boy came to be." And so they named the boy Vaśicira.

He was nourished and raised, and when he had grown up he was intelligent and accomplished in many skills. One day, as he was going about playing with his young friends, he saw in the house of a low-caste family a girl who was lovely, graceful, and auspicious in bearing. He became attached to her and thought of taking her as his wife. He came back home and said to his parents, "Take that girl as a wife for me." His parents said, "We are of a noble family, and that girl is of a low and base caste. How could we take her as your wife?" The boy was very unhappy, and said to his parents once again, "Do not look at caste; take that very girl as my wife, because I love her. If you do not take her as my wife, I will die." His parents could not refuse their son, and so they sent someone to ask for the girl.

The girl's parents said, "You are of a noble family, and we are of a low and base caste, so we are not a fitting match for you. Why do you ask for our daughter?" Yet the boy remained attached to the girl, and once again he sent someone to ask for her. Then the girl's parents said, "If the man who would be my son-in-law has a variety of skills, knows every kind of song, dance, and entertainment, and knows everything that pleases the king, then we will make the match." Though he was ashamed to train in the work of music and the like, the boy strove at it, and before long he had trained until he had mastered all of it.

Some time later the king held a festival. He gathered all the most skillful performers, and they put on all kinds of entertainments, such as tree climbing, leaping, and rope walking. The householder's son also came there, climbed onto the rope, and performed the rope walk, running along the rope. But the king was distracted and did not see it, so he commanded, "Do it again now." The boy, though he was weary, performed the rope walk again, and when he had gone about halfway along the rope he fell from it. Terrified, he cried out, "I have no refuge!"

At that moment Maudgalyāyana came there and caught him before he hit the ground, and said to him, "Will you now go forth, so that you do not lose your body and life? Or will you fall to the ground and take the girl as your wife?" He replied, "If only my life is not lost, I do not want a wife." Then Maudgalyāyana conjured up level ground in the sky and set him down safely. The boy was freed from fear, and since he had been set down safely on the ground, he was overjoyed and followed Maudgalyāyana to where the Blessed One was. When he arrived, he bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One and made offerings to the Buddha.

The Blessed One then taught him at length: a talk on generosity, a talk on moral discipline, a talk on rebirth as a god in the heavens, on the impurity of sense desires, and that going forth is bliss. His mind was liberated, and he attained the first fruit. He asked the Blessed One for permission to go forth and asked to train in the sacred Dharma, and the Blessed One granted it. His hair and beard fell away of their own accord and he became a monk. Applying himself earnestly to the practice of a monk, he exhausted all defilements and became an arhat.

Then the venerable Ānanda said to the Blessed One, "Please explain what past karma connected this monk with that girl, so that he became attached to her to the point of risking his life; what root of virtue he generated toward Maudgalyāyana, so that his life was saved; and through what condition he finally became an arhat."

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "Long ago, immeasurable eons in the past, here in the land of Vārāṇasī, a son was born to a householder, lovely and good beyond compare. At that time a man came from the ocean to that householder's house and presented the householder with a single bird's egg. The householder took it in his hand, and before long the egg hatched and a single fledgling emerged. The householder gave the fledgling to his son, and as it grew up the two became attached to each other. Whenever the householder's son went off here and there to see the shows, he would sit on the bird's back, and the bird would carry him, flying through the sky. At nightfall he would come back home, and in this way they roamed about day after day.

"After a long time had passed, he heard one day that a festival was being held in the land of another king. The boy mounted the bird and went to that other land to see the shows. He left the bird on the top of a tree, and the boy went in

to watch the shows. On the way to the shows he met the king's daughter and became attached to her. He slept with the princess, and afterward the secret came out. The king had him seized and ordered him to be killed. The householder's son then said to the king, 'What need is there to kill me with a weapon? I ask to climb a tree myself and to die by throwing myself down from the treetop.' The king granted this, and the boy climbed the tree, mounted the bird, and flew away. In this way the bird saved his life.

"Ānanda, the householder's son of that time and occasion was Vaśicira. The king's daughter was this girl. The bird was Maudgalyāyana. In the past, too, he saved him when his life was about to end because of desire; and now again, when his life was about to be lost under the power of desire, Maudgalyāyana saved him."

"As for how this monk came to be intelligent and to attain the fruit free of defilement: long ago in the past, here in Vārāṇasī, a pratyekabuddha came begging alms from a householder. The householder offered him alms and asked him to teach the Dharma. Then the pratyekabuddha said, 'I am not able to teach the Dharma,' and he tossed his alms bowl into the sky and flew away after it. Then the householder thought, 'That person has great miraculous power, yet he cannot teach the sacred Dharma.' And he made this aspiration: 'In the future may I meet a noble one, and may I surpass this person, becoming tireless in teaching the sacred Dharma.' Because of that condition he is intelligent and has attained the fruit of an arhat."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the many in the assembly rejoiced. Some attained the fruit of stream-entry, of once-return, of non-return, and of arhatship. Some generated roots of virtue toward becoming pratyekabuddhas, and some generated the aspiration for awakening, and they rejoiced in what the Blessed One had said.

This is the thirty-eighth chapter, the chapter of Vaśicira.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time there lived in that land a brahmin called Piṇḍola. That brahmin's wife was very ugly and blind in both eyes. The blind woman had no sons but had seven daughters, and they were utterly destitute. The brahmin gave each of his daughters away in marriage, and later the sons-in-law would gather at the house. The brahmin's wife was an angry and fierce woman, and she grew furious when the daughters and sons-in-law came, so the daughters in turn abused their

mother.

At that time the fields were ripe for harvest, so the brahmin borrowed an ox from a neighbor and went off to the field, but because he did not guard it well, it was lost. Then Piṇḍola thought, "What wrong did I do in the past? When I come home my wife always scolds me, and my seven daughters and the sons-in-law give me no place to sit. Now I borrowed my neighbor's ox and it has been lost, and though I search for it I cannot find it. What am I to do?" He sat there, stricken with grief and despair, and from a distance he saw the Tathāgata seated at the foot of a tree, his senses all at peace, dwelling in bliss.

The brahmin, leaning his chin on his staff, gazed at him across the distance of an earshot, and thought again, "The ascetic Gautama lives in perfect bliss. He has no wife to scold him, no wicked daughters or sons-in-law to torment him, no fields ripe for harvest, and no need to borrow an ox. He has no sorrow."

The Blessed One, knowing his thoughts with his mind, said to him, "It is as you have thought. I have no faults or wrongdoing at all. I have no wicked wife, let alone one who abuses and scolds me. I have no seven daughters to harm me, and no sons-in-law. I have no fields ripe for harvest, and I have no sorrow over a lost ox. Would you like to go forth?"

The brahmin said to the Blessed One, "Now I regard my home as no better than a charnel ground, and I think of my wife and daughters as no better than enemies. If the Blessed One permits me to go forth, I will go forth." The Blessed One said, "Welcome!" and his hair and beard fell away of their own accord, and he became a monk. Then the Blessed One taught him the Dharma suited to him, and right there all his stains were exhausted and he became an arhat.

Then Ānanda said to the Blessed One, "Excellent! The Blessed One's work for the benefit of sentient beings is inconceivable. What good did this brahmin do in the past, that he is free of all fault and wrongdoing, and, as clean white cloth easily takes a dye, so he has come to achieve what is beneficial and virtuous?"

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "It is not only now that I have helped this brahmin and brought him to happiness. In the past too he was freed from all his troubles, and I brought him to happiness."

Ānanda said, "Please explain in detail how you brought this brahmin to happiness in the past."

The Blessed One said, "Listen very well and keep it in mind, and I shall explain it to you."

Ānanda replied, "So I wish to hear," and the Blessed One spoke to Ānanda as follows: "Long ago, countless and immeasurable eons in the past, there was a king called Sundara, who ruled according to the Dharma. At that time there lived in that land a brahmin called Daṇḍin, who was utterly destitute, without food or clothing. He borrowed an ox from a householder, and after working it during the day he led the ox to that householder's house. There the householder was eating his meal. Daṇḍin let the ox into the house, but the ox went out by another door and was lost. When the householder had eaten his meal and got up, he did not see the ox there, and he asked Daṇḍin, 'Where is the ox?' He replied, 'I let it into your house.' The householder said, 'You have lost my ox; give it back to me.' Daṇḍin said, 'I did not lose it.' Then the two of them said, 'Let us go together before the king, and he will determine which of us is right and which is wrong,' and the two of them set off.

"On the way another man's mare ran off, and that man called to Daṇḍin, 'Don't let the mare get away!' Daṇḍin picked up a stone and threw it, and it struck the horse on the leg and broke its leg."

The man said, "You have killed my horse, so give me a horse." "Why should I give you a horse?" He said, "Come along. Let us go before the king, and he will come to a judgment on us." So saying, they went on. Then Daṇḍin tried to run away. He leapt over a wall, and at its foot a weaver was sitting weaving; Daṇḍin fell on top of him, and the weaver died. The weaver's wife seized Daṇḍin and said, "You have killed my husband, so give me a husband." He said, "How can I give you a husband?" She said, "Come along. Let us go together before the king, and he will judge us." So they went on.

Partway along the road there was a deep river, and a carpenter was coming toward them through the water, carrying an adze in his mouth. Daṇḍin asked him, "How deep is the water?" As he answered, "The water is deep," the adze fell into the water and could not be found. The carpenter seized Daṇḍin and said, "You have made me drop my adze into the water." Daṇḍin said, "I did not make you drop it." "Come along. Let us go before the king, and he will judge us," he said, and they went on.

Daṇḍin, weary in body, went into a tavern and asked for beer. The woman who sold beer had given birth to a son, and the child had been laid down covered with a cloth. Daṇḍin sat down on top of him, and the child lost his life. She too

seized Daṇḍin and said, "You have killed my son, so give me a son." He said, "I did not kill him, so how can I give you a son?" She said, "Come along. Let us go before the king, and he will judge us." And they went on.

In another place a crow was sitting in a śakoṭaka tree. It saw Daṇḍin and asked, "Where are you going?" "I am not going; these people are taking me." "Where are they taking you?" "Before the king." "Then take a message from me to the king too. Say to him: 'In such and such a place a crow sits in a śakoṭaka tree. When I sit on top of other trees, my voice is not sweet, but when I come to the top of this tree my voice is wonderfully sweet. Why do I sound like that?'" Then, in yet another place, a snake saw him and, as before, said, "Present this message of mine: 'When I come out of my hole I am at ease, but when I go back in again I suffer. Why is it so?' Ask him that." As they went on, in another place a young married woman saw him and, as before, said, "Present my message too: 'When I am staying in my parents' house, I long for my in-laws' house; and when I am staying in my in-laws' house, I long for my parents' house. Why is that?' Ask him that."

So they went on, and when they came before the king, they bowed their heads at the king's feet and sat to one side. The king asked them, "Why have you come?" and they told him all about the dispute between Daṇḍin and the householder.

The king said to Daṇḍin, "Did you borrow the ox?" "I borrowed it." "Then did you give it back?" "I returned the ox where its owner could see it, but I did not hand it over with a word." The king declared, "Because Daṇḍin returned the ox but did not say so, cut out his tongue. And because the householder saw the ox arrive but did not tie it up, gouge out his eyes." The householder said, "Daṇḍin has, first, robbed me of my ox, and second, had my eyes gouged out. Rather than that, I would sooner let Daṇḍin win."

One man said, "Your Majesty, Daṇḍin killed my mare." The king asked Daṇḍin, "How did you kill the horse?" "I was walking along the road, and this man said, 'Don't let the mare get away!' I picked up a stone and threw it, and the horse died." The king said, "Because the horse's owner said, 'Don't let the mare get away,' cut out the horse owner's tongue. And because Daṇḍin threw the stone, cut off his hand." The man said, "First my horse was killed, and second my tongue would be cut out. Rather than that, I would sooner let Daṇḍin win."

The carpenter said, "Daṇḍin asked me how deep the water was, and the adze I was carrying in my mouth fell into the water." The king said, "Whatever goods

one carries, they should be carried on the shoulder; since he carried it in his mouth, knock out the carpenter's two front teeth. And because Daṇḍin asked whether the water was deep, cut out his tongue." The carpenter said, "First my adze was lost, and second my teeth would be broken. Rather than that, I would sooner let Daṇḍin win."

The woman who sold beer said, "Daṇḍin killed my son." Daṇḍin said, "I was weary, and went to ask for beer. I sat down on the seat without looking at it, and did not notice there was a child underneath, and the child died." The king said, "Beer seller, you were at fault for laying your child on the seat and covering him with a cloth so that he could not be seen. Daṇḍin, you were at fault for sitting down without checking the seat. Daṇḍin, become her husband and give her a son." The beer seller said, "First my son was killed, and second this man would become my husband. Rather than that, I would sooner let Daṇḍin win."

The weaver's wife said, "Daṇḍin killed my husband." Daṇḍin said, "I have many enemies and was afraid, so I leapt over a wall to flee, and I did not see there was a man on the other side, and he died." The king said, "Go, and take this very man as your husband." She said, "First my husband was killed, and second this man would become my husband. Rather than that, I would sooner let Daṇḍin win."

So each of them was given judgment, and Daṇḍin was granted land and freed from all his troubles.

That king also had two women disputing over one son. The king, being wise, examined the matter and commanded the two women, "Each of you take one of the child's hands and pull, and whoever wins him, take him as your son." The one who was not the child's mother had no compassion for the child and did not fear that he would be hurt, so she pulled with all her might. The one who was the child's mother loved the child and feared that he would be hurt, so although she was strong enough to win, she did not pull hard. The king examined this and said to the one who had pulled hard, "This is not your son; he is the other woman's son. Tell the truth." And so it turned out that he was the son of the one who had pulled gently, and she took the child away.

Then again two men, disputing over one bolt of cloth, came before the king, and the king examined the matter and gave judgment as before.

Then Daṇḍin said to the king, "When these people had seized me and were leading me here, a snake gave me this message: 'When I come out of my hole

I am at ease, but when I go back in again I suffer. Ask him why it is so.'" The king said, "Say this to that snake: 'When you come out of your hole you are at ease, because you are not angry and you are hungry. Once you have come out, you eat a great deal of food, and the birds harass you, so you become angry and swell up; and so when you go back in, you get stuck in the hole and suffer.' Tell him: 'If from now on you know the right measure of food and do not get angry, you will go in at ease, just as you come out.'"

Then Daṇḍin told him the young married woman's message, and the king said, "Say this to that young married woman: 'You have a lover at your parents' house. When you are staying in your in-laws' house, you long to go to your parents' house because you are attached to your lover. When you are staying in your parents' house, you grow tired of your lover and long to go to your in-laws' house because you are attached to your husband. Give up one place and hold well to the other, and you will be free of such trouble.'"

Then he told him the message of the crow sitting in the śakoṭaka tree in another place, and the king said, "Tell him: 'Your voice is sweet because there is gold under that tree. Under other trees there is no gold, so your voice is not sweet.'"

The king said to Daṇḍin, "Although you have done many wrongs, I release you. You are destitute; dig up the treasure of gold under that tree and take it." Daṇḍin delivered each of the messages as the king had instructed, dug the gold out from under the tree, and took it away. From then on his livelihood was established and he was troubled by nothing at all, and for the rest of his life he was rich and happy.

"Ānanda, do not think that King Sundara of that time and occasion was someone else. He was I myself now. The brahmin Daṇḍin of that time and occasion was the brahmin Piṇḍola. In the past too I freed him from suffering and gave him precious things and made him happy. Now that I have attained perfect buddhahood, I have again freed him from suffering and given him the inexhaustible treasure of the precious Dharma."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Ānanda and the many in the assembly rejoiced and delighted in what the Blessed One had said.

This is the thirty-ninth chapter, the chapter called the householder Daṇḍin.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time there lived

in that land a brahmin called Śincira, of noble family and wealthy, who had no son. He went to the six teachers and asked them, and the six teachers said, "You have no sign of a son." Then the brahmin went back home, put on soiled clothes, went into the room of mourning, and sat there unhappy, thinking, "I have no son, and if one day I die, the king will take possession of my house along with all my wealth and goods." With that thought he sat there in great unhappiness.

The brahmin's wife was a friend of a nun, and at that time the nun came to the brahmin's house. Seeing the brahmin so unhappy and tormented by grief, she asked his wife, "Why is your husband unhappy?" The brahmin's wife said, "We have no son. When we asked the six teachers, they told us, 'You have no sign of a son,' and so he is unhappy and grieving." Then the nun said, "The six teachers are not all-knowing, so how could they understand the causes and conditions of karma? The Tathāgata is dwelling in the world, who understands and knows all things and is unobstructed with regard to past and future. Why do you not ask him whether you will have a son or not?"

When the nun had left, the brahmin's wife told her husband this, and the brahmin rejoiced and understood. At once he put on new clothes and went to where the Blessed One was. When he arrived he bowed his head at the Buddha's feet and asked, "Blessed One, have I no sign of a son, no son of good fortune?" The Blessed One said, "Brahmin, you will have a son. He will be endowed with merit, and when he has grown up, he will delight in going forth." When the brahmin heard him say this, he was overjoyed and delighted, and said, "If only I have a son, then even if he goes forth, so be it; I will have no sorrow." He invited the Blessed One and the Saṅgha of monks to come for a meal, and the Blessed One consented by remaining silent.

The next day, when the time for the midday meal arrived, the Buddha went with the Saṅgha to the brahmin's house and sat on the seats laid out, and the brahmin and his wife respectfully served them alms food. When they had eaten, the Buddha and the Saṅgha set off back again. On the way there was a meadow, and in it a spring of very pure water. The Blessed One and the Saṅgha of monks rested there, and each of them drew water from the spring and washed their bowls, hands, and feet.

Then a monkey came there and took Ānanda's alms bowl. Ānanda, afraid it would break the bowl, would not give it, but the Blessed One said to Ānanda, "Give the alms bowl to the monkey." So Ānanda gave the bowl to the monkey,

and the monkey took honey from the top of a tree, filled the bowl, and offered it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One said, "Remove the impurities from the honey," and the monkey removed the insect carcasses and the like and offered it. The Blessed One accepted the bowl of honey and said, "Mix the honey with water and give it to me," and the monkey mixed it with water and offered it to the Blessed One.

The Blessed One accepted it and shared it out among the Saṅgha of monks as well, and when it had been given, all of them were fully satisfied. Then the monkey, seeing all this, was overjoyed, and as it leapt and danced it fell over a precipice and died. Immediately it was reborn as the son of a brahmin. That brahmin's wife became pregnant, and when the months were complete she gave birth to a fine, handsome boy. At the very moment of his birth, every vessel in the house was filled with honey. The brahmin husband and wife were overjoyed, summoned a diviner of marks, and had the boy's marks examined. The diviner asked, "When this boy was born, what omen or wonder occurred?" They said, "At the moment of his birth everything was filled with honey," and so the boy was named Supreme Honey.

The boy was raised and nourished, and when he had grown up he asked his father and mother for leave to go forth. Because his parents were attached to their son, they would not let him go. The boy asked again and again and said, "If my father and mother obstruct me, I can bear to die, but I cannot bear to live amid the bustle of the household." Then the boy's parents discussed it together: "Long ago the Blessed One too foretold that he would go forth. If we hinder him now, he may well lose his life. We should give our consent." Having decided this, they told him, "Son, we permit you to go forth as you wish."

Then the boy, delighted and overjoyed, went to where the Blessed One was, bowed his head at his feet, and asked to go forth. The Blessed One said, "Welcome!" and his hair and beard fell away of themselves, and he became a monk. Then, when the Dharma of the Four Noble Truths was taught to him in full, his mind was completely liberated; all his defilements were exhausted and he became an arhat. Whenever he went about with the other monks for the benefit of sentient beings, if they were thirsty or weary, he would toss his alms bowl into the sky and it would fill with honey of itself, and all of them drank it together.

Then Ānanda said to the Blessed One, "What merit did the monk Supreme Honey make in the past, that not long after going forth he attained arhatship

and the Dharma just as he had wished?"

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "Ānanda, do you remember when the brahmin Śincira offered alms? Do you remember how, when you had finished your meal and were resting on the meadow, a monkey took the alms bowl from you, filled it with honey and offered it to me, and how the monkey, delighted, leapt and danced, fell over a precipice and passed from that life?"

He replied, "I remember."

"Ānanda, the monkey who offered the honey at that time is this monk Supreme Honey. Because he saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, and offered honey with a joyful mind, he was born as that brahmin's son, with a handsome form, and after going forth he became free of defilements."

Then Ānanda placed his right knee on the ground and said to the Blessed One, "What wrong did this monk commit, that he was born among monkeys?"

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "Long ago in the past, when the Buddha Kāśyapa had come into the world, a young novice monk saw a monk leaping over a canal and said, 'You are so quick, you are just like a monkey.' The monk heard this and said to him, 'Do you know who I am?' He replied, 'You are a monk of the Buddha Kāśyapa; how could I not know?' That monk said, 'Do not mock me. I am not a monk in name only; I have attained the four fruits of a monk.' At these words the young monk was terrified, the hair of his body stood on end, he touched the ground with the five points of his body, and confessed. Because he confessed in this way, he was not reborn among the hell-beings. But because he had mocked an arhat, for five hundred lifetimes he was always born as a monkey. Because in the past he had also gone forth and kept moral discipline, he met me, and as though washed clean, all his suffering came to an end. Ānanda, the young monk of that time is now Supreme Honey."

Then Ānanda and the great assembly, having heard what the Buddha said, all said this: "One must not fail to guard the actions of body, speech and mind. Because this monk did not guard the action of his speech, such was the karmic ripening of his deed."

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "Ānanda, it is just as you say." Then he taught the Four Noble Truths in full, and with the actions of their body, speech and mind purified and free of every stain of mind, some attained stream-entry, once-returning, non-returning and arhatship. Some generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Some came to abide on the

irreversible ground. The great assembly rejoiced in what the Blessed One had said and were delighted.

This is the chapter of the brahmin Śincira, the fortieth.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove, at the Kalandakanivāpa. At that time, in the land of Kośala, there lived a householder named Damśincira, wealthy, powerful and of high family. He had no son, and so he made offerings to the gods, the nāgas and the rest, at the shrines of all the gods, and prayed for a son. Because the householder worshipped all the gods from his heart and prayed for a son, his wife later became pregnant, and when the months were complete a son was born, a fine, handsome boy, rare in the world. A diviner was summoned and examined his marks, and in accordance with the marks he named the boy Danbila. He was raised and nourished, and when he had grown up, his father died, and King Prasenajit installed the youth as king in his father's place. When he was thus consecrated king in his father's place, all his houses and dwellings turned into the seven kinds of precious things, all his many treasuries were filled to overflowing, and he came to have everything he could want.

At that time the king's son, named Vaiḍūrya, was stricken with a fever. A physician examined him and said, "As medicine, if his body is anointed with gośīrṣa sandalwood, he will live." So the king issued this proclamation to the people of the land: "Whoever among you has gośīrṣa sandalwood, offer it to the king! As a reward he will be given a thousand gold ounces." But although this was proclaimed everywhere, not a single person had any.

Then someone said to the king, "In the land of Kośala, in the house of the householder Danbila, there is a great deal of it." The king himself mounted a horse carriage and set out to ask for the sandalwood. When he reached the householder's gate, the gatekeepers at the householder's gate said, "King Prasenajit has come here and is now waiting outside." The householder was overjoyed, came out to the gate, and welcomed the king inside.

When the king went to the gate and looked, the gate itself was made of silver, and inside the gate a woman, lovely and beautiful, without equal in the world, sat on a silver seat spinning silver thread. Beside her ten fine young maidens attended on her. Seeing her, the king asked the householder, "Is this your wife?" He replied, "No, she is the slave woman who keeps the gate." "Then what are these fine young maidens for?" the king asked. He said, "They are the messengers who carry word between outside and inside."

Then he went inside through the next gate and looked. The gate was made of lapis lazuli (vaiḍūrya), and inside the gate sat a fine young maiden, more beautiful still than the first, with attendant maidens half again as many as before. Then he went on through yet another gate and looked. This gate was made of gold, and inside it sat a fine young maiden more beautiful by far than the one before, on a golden seat, weaving golden cloth. To her right and left were attendant maidens far more numerous than before. He asked the householder, "Is this one your wife?" and he replied, "This one is not either."

Then he went into the house and looked. The whole floor was made of lapis lazuli, so clear that it looked like the color of water. On the ceiling above were painted the forms of beasts of prey, makaras, fish and the like, and when they swayed as the wind stirred them, their reflections appeared on the floor. The king, thinking it was truly water, said, "Is there no water elsewhere? Why have you dug a pond inside the house?" Danbila said, "This is not water; it is lapis lazuli." And he took the bracelet off his arm and threw it down upon it.

Seeing this, the king entered the house, and in a chamber of the seven precious things a lapis lazuli throne was set out, and the king was invited to be seated. The householder's wife was also there, and tears came from her eyes. The king asked, "Why are tears coming from your eyes? Are you displeased that I have come?" The householder's wife replied, "We are glad that the king has graciously come here. But the king's clothing smells faintly of smoke, and so tears came from my eyes. It is not that I do not wish to see the king."

The king said, "Do you not even light a fire in your house?" She said, "There is no fire." "Then with what do you cook your food?" She said, "As for food, by merely thinking of it, food with a hundred flavors appears." The king said, "In the darkness of night, by what do you see?" She said, "It is lit by a precious jewel. Even when the doors are closed, the light of the precious jewel shines from the windows as if it were day."

Then Danbila placed both knees on the ground and said, "Why has the king troubled himself to come here?" The king said this: "My son Vaiḍūrya has been stricken with a fever, and the physician examined him and says that as medicine he must be anointed with gośīrṣa sandalwood. So I have come here to ask it of you." The householder was overjoyed and invited the king himself into his treasury, and showed him all his wealth, the seven precious things and the rest, and showed him also immeasurable heaps of sandalwood, saying, "Take whatever you wish." The king said, "I need no more than two ounces;

give me that." And the householder offered him whatever he wished.

Then, as the king was going back, he told the householder, "Go and meet the Buddha." The householder said, "What is this one called the Buddha like?" The king said, "Have you not heard? The son of Śuddhodana, king of the city of Kapilavastu, weary of old age, sickness and death, went forth, and by striving for awakening he became fully awakened. His body is adorned with the thirty-two major marks and the eighty excellent minor marks, and his bases of miraculous power and his wisdom are beyond compare. Because he has become the chief of gods and humans, he is called the Buddha."

When the householder heard him say this, he felt deep faith, and he asked the king, "Where is the Buddha staying now?" The king said, "He is staying now at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove." As soon as the king had left, the householder too went to where the Buddha was staying. When he arrived and beheld the Buddha's body, he saw that it surpassed by far that of every king. Delighted, joyful and glad, he bowed his head and asked after his health. The Blessed One taught him the Dharma as suited him, and the householder attained stream-entry. He placed both knees on the ground and asked the Blessed One for leave to go forth. The Blessed One said, "Welcome!" and his hair and beard fell away of themselves, and he became a monk. Then, when the Dharma of the Four Noble Truths was again taught to him as suited him, the stains of his mind were completely purified, and he became an arhat.

Then Ānanda and the great assembly said this to the Blessed One:

"What merit did the monk Danbila make, that he was born among humans and possessed the riches of a god, yet was not attached to the household, delighted in going forth, and at once attained the fruit?"

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "Listen very well. Long ago in the past, ninety-one eons ago, a buddha called Vipaśyin came into the world. After that buddha had passed into nirvāṇa, at the time when the Dharma was practiced before his image, about five hundred monks made this vow together: 'Let us seek a secluded place and meditate on the path of awakening.' They established a secluded dwelling in a grove where there was grass and a spring. Of one accord, those monks made this request of one monk: 'This dwelling of ours is far from the town, and if all of us go for alms everyone will be wearied. So that you may make merit, go and beg our alms and give them to us.' That monk said, 'I will do so,' and he went to the town constantly, taught the Dharma to many patrons, and begged alms.

"Among them, four men, their bodies at ease, meditated, and after ninety days they attained the fruit. Of one accord they said to the monk who begged the alms, 'Because of you we have been very much at ease, and we have attained the samādhi we hoped to attain. Tell us whatever you wish for, and we will fulfil your hope.' Then that monk too was overjoyed and said this. He made this aspiration: 'In the future, whether I am born as a god or a human, may I be wealthy and possessed of riches, and may everything I need arise of itself without my working for it. May I meet a noble teacher, hear the Dharma a hundred and a thousand times more than you, and with my mind completely purified, attain the fruit.'"

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "The one who was the monk at that time is the monk Danbila. Because he provided alms for his four monk companions, for ninety-one eons he was born among gods and humans into noble families, and was never born into a poor and needy family. And now, by merely seeing me, he has gained faith."

Then Ānanda and the monks, having heard what the Blessed One said, each set about striving with diligence, and they attained the fruits from the first fruit up to the fourth. Some generated the vast mind and came to abide on the irreversible ground. When the Blessed One had spoken thus, each of them rejoiced and was delighted.

This is the chapter called the householder Danbila, the forty-first.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time, in the land of Magadha, a son was born to a certain householder, fine and handsome and endowed with auspicious marks. When the boy was first born, a marvelous golden elephant calf appeared of itself in the treasury. When the boy's parents saw this they were overjoyed and showed him to a diviner of marks, and the diviner saw that the boy had the marks of merit. He asked, "When the boy was first born, what marvelous omen occurred?" The boy's parents said, "When this boy was born, a golden elephant calf appeared of itself in the treasury." So the boy was named Hastipāla.

As the boy grew, so too the golden elephant calf grew. When the boy went somewhere the elephant calf went too, always keeping him company, and even the elephant calf's urine and dung turned into gold.

When Hastipāla had grown up, he always played together with about five hundred sons of householders, and they were fond of one another. One day

the boys each talked about whatever marvels there were in their homes. Some said, "In my home the seats, cushions, beds and the rest are all made of the seven precious things." Some said, "My home, my pleasure garden and everything else are all jewels." Some said, "My treasury is always filled with the finest jewels." So each of them told of all the various wonders they had. Then Hastipāla too said, "When I was first born, a golden elephant calf appeared of itself, and just as I grew, the elephant calf grew likewise. I go wherever I please; riding the elephant, I go swiftly anywhere I wish, to watch shows and the like, and even its urine and dung turn into gold."

At that time Prince Ajātaśatru was also there, and hearing what Hastipāla said, he thought, "When I become king, I will seize that elephant." Later, when he had become king, he summoned Hastipāla and commanded him, "Bring your elephant!"

Then Hastipāla's parents said this to their son: "There is no one so wrathful, fierce and greedy as Ajātaśatru. He even killed his own father, so what need to speak of others? Now he means to seize your elephant, so you must give him the elephant." The son said, "No one at all can seize this elephant of mine." Then the two brothers mounted the elephant and came to the gate of the king's palace, and the gatekeepers informed the king. The king commanded, "Let the two brothers Hastipāla come inside without dismounting from the elephant." The two brothers Hastipāla came into the palace riding the elephant, and only then dismounted. Then they paid homage to the king and said, "May you be well." The king was overjoyed, had them sit on cushions spread out for them, and gave them food and drink. When they had talked thus, and afterwards said they would go back, he commanded Hastipāla, "Leave the golden elephant, and you go back."

Then Hastipāla, as the king commanded, left the elephant behind, and the two brothers went off on foot. They had barely reached the gate when, before long, the elephant sank into the ground right where it was and came up outside the gate beside Hastipāla. The two brothers Hastipāla mounted it again and went home, and Hastipāla thought this: "The king does not act according to the Dharma; he punishes even those who have done no wrong. If I do not give it to him, my life will be in danger because of this elephant. Now the Blessed One is in the world, working for the happiness and benefit of many beings. I will go to him, go forth from the household, and delight in the pure life." With this in mind he asked his parents for leave to go forth, and his parents gave him leave. He bowed to them in farewell, mounted the golden elephant, and went

to where the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta was. Coming into the presence of the Blessed One, he bowed his head at his feet and told in full all that had happened. The Blessed One said, "Welcome!" and his hair and beard fell away of themselves, and he became a monk. The Blessed One taught him the Dharma of the Four Noble Truths as suited him, and he became an arhat.

Wherever the monk Hastipāla stayed with his fellow monks, the golden elephant was always beside him. At that time all the people living in Śrāvastī began to gather to look at the golden elephant, and the practice of yoga was much disturbed by the commotion. Those monks told the Blessed One, and for that reason the Blessed One said this to the monk Hastipāla: "Because many people are looking at your elephant, there is no seclusion. Get rid of it quickly." Hastipāla replied, "I too have thought from the beginning of getting rid of it, but it will not go." The Blessed One said, "Say this to the elephant three times: 'For me, the realm of birth is exhausted; from now on I have no need of you.' Say this, and it will disappear." Hastipāla, just as the Blessed One had said, told the elephant three times, "I have no need of you," and the golden elephant sank into the ground.

The monks were amazed and said this to the Blessed One: "What root of virtue did this monk Hastipāla plant in the past, and in what kind of field of merit, that such a fruit has ripened for him?"

The Blessed One said this to Ānanda and the monks: "When any ordinary person plants even a small seed of virtue in the field of merit of the Three Jewels, he will obtain an immeasurable fruit. Long ago in the past, when the Buddha Kāśyapa had come into the world, the human lifespan was twenty thousand years. After that buddha had worked for the benefit of sentient beings and passed into nirvāṇa, many stūpas were built for his relics. At that time, inside one of the stūpas, there was also a stūpa of the elephant that served as the mount when the bodhisattva first descended from the abode of Tuṣita and entered his mother's womb. At that time the figure of the elephant had become a little damaged. A man came to pay homage there, and seeing the elephant a little damaged, he thought this: 'This is the mount the bodhisattva rode. Since it has become damaged like this, I will restore it.' So he mixed some clay and plastered it, painted it over with red pigment, and made this aspiration: 'In the future may I always be of a noble family and possess inexhaustible riches.' That was the aspiration he made. When that man died, he was born as a god in the heavens, and when he passed from among the gods he was born in the human world, always of a noble family,

possessed of riches, of excellent and handsome appearance, and always guarded by a golden elephant."

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "The man who restored the elephant at that time is now the monk Hastipāla. Ever since he restored the elephant then, he has had great riches among gods and humans. Because he showed reverence and honor to the Three Jewels, he has now met me, gone forth in the teaching, exhausted all the stains of his mind, and become an arhat."

When the venerable Ānanda and the great assembly heard what the Blessed One had said, all of them understood its meaning and took it to heart. Some attained stream-entry, once-returning, non-returning, and arhatship. Some generated the mind set on unsurpassed awakening and abode on the irreversible ground. The great assembly delighted in what the Blessed One had said and rejoiced.

This is the chapter of Hastipāla, the forty-second.

The twelfth fascicle.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time, when the Blessed One went for alms with Ānanda as his attendant, the robe the Blessed One was wearing had a small tear, and he intended this for the sake of training beings who were ready to be trained. When he had begged alms and was returning, a brahmin came, bowed his head to the Blessed One, and gazed at the Blessed One's marks, vivid and radiant. Seeing that the Blessed One's robe was a little torn, he thought to make an offering. He had a piece of white cotton cloth at home, and cutting a piece from it he offered it to the Blessed One, saying, "Please patch your robe with this piece of cloth." Out of love for him the Blessed One accepted it, and the brahmin was overjoyed, delighted and glad.

Out of love for him, the Blessed One gave him a prophecy: "Brahmin, in the future, when a hundred incalculable eons have passed, you will become fully awakened. Your name will be Excellent Higher Knowledge, and you will perfect the ten powers." When this prophecy had been given, the brahmin went away overjoyed.

At that time the merchants of noble family, the householders and others in that land thought this: "Why did the Blessed One give so very great a return for such a small gift?" With this in mind, each of them laid out white cotton

cloth, made all kinds of robes for the Tathāgata, and offered them to the Buddha.

Ānanda asked the Blessed One, "What root of virtue did the Blessed One make in the past, that everyone offers him so many robes?" The Blessed One said this: "Listen well and keep it in mind, and I will explain it to you. Long ago in the past, beyond immeasurable incalculable eons, a buddha called Vipaśyin came into the world, and he dwelt together with a retinue of ninety thousand. At that time the king was called Bandhumat. At that time a great minister invited the Buddha together with the Saṅgha to stay for three months, and the Blessed One consented. The minister went back home and prepared and arranged the provisions.

"At that time the king too thought to invite the Buddha and the Saṅgha. He went to where the Buddha was, and when he arrived he said this to the Blessed One: 'Venerable Blessed One, please accept my offerings for three months, together with the noble Saṅgha.' The Blessed One said this to the king: 'I have already agreed to go at the invitation of the great minister. By the rule of great beings it is not right to go against a consent already given.'

"Then the king went back to the palace and commanded the great minister: 'In this land there is no one greater than I. The Blessed One is staying in my land, and I wish to make offerings first. Although you invited him first, wait for now; after I have invited him, you may invite him.' The minister said this to the king: 'Your Majesty, if you will guarantee that my body and life will come to no harm, that the Tathāgata will remain forever, and that the king's realm will always be happy and prosperous with no misfortune arising, then I too will wait for now.' The king thought, 'That cannot be,' and commanded, 'Let the two of us invite him on alternate days.' So one day the king made the invitation, and the next day the minister made the invitation, and the wishes of both were fulfilled.

"At that time the great minister offered the Tathāgata a set of three robes, and to each of the ninety thousand monks of the Saṅgha he also made and offered a seven-panelled robe. Ānanda, do not think that the great minister who at that time made robes and offered them to the Buddha and the Saṅgha was someone else. He is now I myself. Because in all my lives I never wearied of making merit, I have experienced the ripening of all of it, and none of it has been wasted."

When Ānanda and the great assembly heard what the Blessed One said, they became diligent in doing meritorious deeds, and they were delighted and

rejoiced.

This is the chapter of the brahmin's offering of a patch, the forty-third.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time the monks, having come out of the summer rains retreat, went to where the Blessed One was. When they arrived they bowed to the Blessed One and asked after his health, saying, "Are you free of illness?" The Blessed One, with a mind of loving-kindness, gave them encouragement, and with a mind of great love and loving-kindness he said, "Monks, have you not been suffering?"

Ānanda said this to the Blessed One: "For how long has the Blessed One had this mind of love and loving-kindness toward the monks?" The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "If you wish to know, I will explain it to you. Long ago in the past, beyond inexpressible incalculable eons, two men who had done evil fell into hell. The hell guardians made them pull an iron cart, beat them with iron hammers, and made them run back and forth without respite. One of the men was weak, and unable to pull, he stopped. He was beaten with an iron hammer, died, and revived again. His companion, seeing such suffering, gave rise to a mind of loving-kindness and compassion, and said this to the hell guardian: 'I will pull this cart alone; let this man go.' The guardian, enraged, beat him with an iron hammer, and he died there and was born as a god in the Heaven of the Thirty-Three. Ānanda, the one who at that time, while in hell, gave rise to a mind of loving-kindness and compassion is now I myself. At that time, in hell, I first gave rise to a mind of compassion toward him, and from then until now I have held a mind of love and loving-kindness toward all sentient beings."

Ānanda and the great assembly rejoiced in what the Blessed One had said and were delighted.

This is the chapter of the Buddha's first generating a mind of loving-kindness, the forty-fourth.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada, together with a great Saṅgha of one thousand two hundred and fifty monks. At that time the Blessed One saw that the monks had become vain, attached to gain and fame, keeping many surplus possessions and hoarding without knowing contentment. Seeing this, the Blessed One spoke of these faults of attachment to gain to the monks.

"Whoever is attached to gain, as soon as the body breaks up and he passes from this life, falls into the three lower realms and experiences immeasurable suffering. Therefore, as I clearly remember, in times long past I fell through the power of desire and experienced much suffering."

Then Ānanda set his knee on the ground, joined his palms, and said to the Blessed One, "How was it that the Blessed One, in the past, fell through the power of attachment to desire?"

The Blessed One declared: "Long ago, countless, immeasurable, limitless, inconceivable and incalculable eons in the past, here in Jambudvīpa there was a king called Respectful, who ruled over the eighty-four thousand minor kingdoms of Jambudvīpa. He had twenty thousand queens and palace women, and ten thousand great ministers.

"At a certain time a swelling like an egg appeared on the crown of the king's head. It was clear and completely pure, and it gave him no pain. Little by little it grew larger and larger until it was the size of a gourd, and when it was cut open, out of it came a boy, beautiful to behold and endowed with the major marks, with dark blue hair and a body the color of gold. When the soothsayers examined him, they said, 'This boy has the marks of wondrous qualities. Without a doubt he will become a wheel-turning king and will rule over the four continents.' And they gave the boy the name Mūrdhaja, 'Born from the Crown.' When he had grown up, because he was endowed with good qualities, the king made him the minor king of one region.

"At a later time the great king was struck by illness. All the minor kings gathered, and although they nursed him and treated him, it did not help, and he passed away. Then the minor kings assembled and went to where Mūrdhaja was staying, and when they arrived they said, 'The great king has passed away. We beg you to become king.'

"Mūrdhaja said, 'If I have the merit and the power to become king, then let the Four Great Kings, Śakra (Indra), and the others make the request to me and come to empower me.' No sooner had he said this than the kings of the Four Great Kings descended, holding precious vases filled with scented water, and poured it on the crown of his head and empowered him. Śakra, lord of the gods, also descended, offered a jeweled diadem, placed it on his head, and praised his qualities.

"Then the minor kings begged him to go to the great central land, and Mūrdhaja again said, 'If I have the power to become king, then the land ought

to come to me; I will not go chasing after the land.' The moment he said this, the great land, with the royal palace, the pleasure gardens, the bathing pools and everything else that was needed, appeared right there. The golden wheel, the elephant, the precious horse, the precious woman, the precious minister, the precious householder and all the rest came together, and he became a wheel-turning king ruling over the four continents and governed in accordance with the Dharma.

"Then, seeing many people digging the earth and plowing fields, he asked the ministers, 'What are these people doing?' They said, 'All that has life lives by food, so these people plow fields to make their living.' Then the king said, 'If I have the power of merit by which I became king, let food of a hundred flavors exist of itself without any need for labor, and let everyone be satisfied and filled and be free of hunger and thirst.' The moment he had said this, food and drink came to exist.

"Then again, as he went out walking, he saw some people spinning thread and weaving, and asked, 'What are these people doing?' They said, 'Food now exists of itself, but there is no clothing to adorn the body, so these people are making clothes to wear.' Then the king again said, 'If I have the power by which I became king, let clothes to wear exist of themselves, and may all the poor and destitute also have enough clothing.' The moment he had said this, clothes to wear of every various color grew of themselves from all the trees, and though all the people wore them, they never ran out.

"Then again, as the king went out walking, he saw people carrying musical instruments and asked, 'What are these?' They said, 'Since there is enough food and clothing to wear, people make a great deal of music; these are instruments played for their own enjoyment and amusement.' The king said, 'If I have royal power, let music and all fine implements exist of themselves.' The moment he said this, many musical instruments hung from the branches of all the trees, and whenever anyone wished for music, they played by themselves, sweetly, so that merely hearing them made people rejoice.

"Through the king's merit and great power, the seven kinds of precious things fell like rain from the sky and filled the whole land. The king asked the ministers, 'Whose virtue is it that this has come about?' The ministers said, 'It has come about through the king's virtue and the merit of beings.' The king then said, 'If it is through the force of the merit of beings, let these precious things fall everywhere. If it is through my power alone, let them fall within the

palace.' Then the rain everywhere else ceased, and for seven days and nights it fell inside the palace alone.

"King Mūrdhaja enjoyed the five objects of desire in Jambudvīpa for eighty-four thousand years. Then, at a certain time, a yakṣa appeared at the palace gate and cried out in a loud voice:"

"'In the east there is the land called Pūrvavideha, the eastern continent. There too the happiness is incomparably excellent, so it is fitting that the great king should go there as well and enjoy himself.' When he said this, the king was glad to go there. The golden wheel rose into the sky, and the ministers, the seven precious things and the rest rose after it, and they went to the eastern continent of Pūrvavideha. All the minor kings who had not yet bowed to him now bowed, and in the continent of Videha he enjoyed the five objects of desire for eighty thousand years.

"Then the yakṣa again said, 'In the west there is the land called Aparagodānīya. There too is great happiness, so it is fitting that the great king should go there as well.' The king was glad to go there, and in western Godānīya he enjoyed happiness for ten thousand years.

"Then the yakṣa again said, 'In the north there is the land called Uttarakuru. The people who live there are prosperous, enjoy good harvests and possess every enjoyment, so it is fitting that the king should go to that land as well.' The king was glad to go, and in Uttarakuru he enjoyed the finest of the five objects of desire for eight thousand years.

"Then, at a later time, the yakṣa said, 'The abode of the god-kings of the realm of the Four Great Kings is so blissful that it is hard even to measure. It is fitting that the king should go there as well.' The king, together with his ministers and his fourfold army, rose into the sky and went. The Four Great Kings saw them from afar and, terrified, drew up their armies and came out, but there was nothing they could do, and they went back to their abodes. Mūrdhaja enjoyed the objects of desire there too for ten thousand years.

"Then he thought, 'I will go to the realm of the gods of the Thirty-Three.' With his retinue he rose up into the sky above and went toward the realm of the gods of the Thirty-Three. At that time some five hundred sages (ṛṣis) were living in a hollow of Mount Meru, the king of mountains. The urine and dung of the king's elephants and horses fell and struck the bodies of these sages, and they asked one another, 'What is this?' One wise and intelligent sage said to the other sages, 'They say that King Mūrdhaja has gone up to the realm of the

gods of the Thirty-Three. This is without doubt the filth of his elephants and horses.' At that the sages grew angry, and binding them with secret mantras and mudrās, they made Mūrdhaja and his great retinue unable to move.

"The king, knowing and understanding that this was so, made this solemn declaration: 'If I have merit and power, may those sages come before me and pay homage to me.' Through the blessing and the force of the greatness of the king's virtue, all five hundred sages came there, became his servants, and went along to the realm of the gods of the Thirty-Three.

"Before they had arrived, they saw from afar the gods' palace called Delightful, shining very brightly, clear and radiant. The gods' palace Delightful had one thousand one hundred and fifty great gates. The gods, in fear and alarm, shut the gates and fastened them with triple iron bars. Mūrdhaja arrived there with his army without any obstruction. The king blew his conch, drew his bow and twanged the bowstring, and all the eleven hundred and fifty gates of the gods' palace opened of themselves at once. Śakra came out to welcome him, led him into the gods' palace, and had him sit on half of Śakra's own seat. The lord of the gods and the lord of men were alike in form and appearance, so that those who saw the two lords could not tell them apart, except that they could be distinguished by the quickness or slowness of the gods.

"In the gods' palace the king enjoyed the finest of the five objects of desire while thirty-six lords of the gods succeeded one another. The last of these lords of the gods was the bodhisattva called Kāśyapa. At that time the king of the asuras led an army against the gods and fought with Śakra. Śakra could not prevail, and he fled back to his abode with his army. Then Mūrdhaja came out, blew his conch and twanged his bowstring, and at once the whole army of the asuras scattered.

"At that time Mūrdhaja thought, 'The strength of my might is equaled by no one. What need is there to sit sharing with Śakra? Since there are two of us, it would be good to kill him and rule by myself alone.' The moment this evil thought arose, he fell from the sky and dropped down before the gate of his own former palace, so exhausted that he was all but parted from life.

"Then people came and asked him, 'If worldly householders ask how King Mūrdhaja died, what should we tell them?' He said, 'If anyone asks that, tell them this: King Mūrdhaja passed from life through the power of desire. He ruled over the four continents for four hundred million years, and for four days

and nights precious things fell like rain as well. Though he went to two of the heavens, he did not know contentment, and so he fell from the sky and passed from life. Say that.'

"Therefore, monks, gain and fame are truly a great and grievous fault. By every means, renounce them far away, and in your minds strive earnestly for perfect awakening."

Then Ānanda said to the Blessed One, "What merit did that King Mūrdhaja make in the past, that he obtained so great a result?"

The Blessed One declared: "Long ago, countless and inconceivable eons in the past, a buddha called Puṣya came into the world and, together with his retinue, worked for the benefit of the world. At that time a brahmin's son was taking a wife. When worldly people take a wife according to custom, it is fitting to carry a handful of beans and scatter them.

"That young man took up beans and went off to scatter them, and on the way he met the Blessed One. His heart was glad, and he scattered the beans he held in his hand over the Blessed One. Four beans went into his alms bowl, and one bean stuck to the very top of his head. Through just that much cause and condition of merit he obtained great merit: because four beans went into the alms bowl, he came to rule over the four continents, and because one bean stuck to the crown of his head, he came to enjoy the riches of two levels of the heavens."

At that time, when the attendants heard what the Buddha had said, some attained the first fruit, and some the second, the third, and the fruit of an arhat. The great assembly rejoiced at what the Blessed One had said and were delighted.

This is the chapter of King Mūrdhaja, the forty-fifth.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time the householder Anāthapiṇḍada had a youngest daughter called Sumanā, lovely in form and beautiful to behold. Of all his children he loved this youngest daughter most dearly, and wherever he went he took her along.

At a certain time the householder went to pay homage to the Buddha, and the girl went along after him. When the girl saw the Buddha, an extraordinary joy arose in her, and she thought of anointing with perfume every place where the Buddha stayed. At that time the girl was holding a mango in her hand, and the

Blessed One said, "Give it here." At once the girl offered it into the Blessed One's hand. The Blessed One took the mango, wrote on it the names of many kinds of fine perfume, and gave it back into the girl's hand.

Then the girl, together with her father and mother, came home and went to the market, bought many various kinds of the perfumes the Blessed One wished for, and went back again to the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta. Every day she ground the perfumes and smeared them over every place.

At a certain time a prince of the land of Takṣaśilā had been sent on a mission to Rājagṛha, and as he was traveling back he came in due course to the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta. He saw the girl grinding perfume, became infatuated with her, and thought of taking her as his wife. He asked King Prasenajit for the girl, and the king said, "Whose daughter is she?" He said, "She is the daughter of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada." The king commanded, "In that case it is no use asking me. Ask the girl's own father and mother."

In due course the prince took leave of the king, and the king commanded, "Do so." The prince sent all his servants and retinue back to his own land and kept back only a single elephant. At a certain time he went to the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, carried off the girl Sumanā, set her on the elephant and fled. Anāthapiṇḍada pursued them but could not catch up, and the prince went back to his own land and made her his wife.

Then that wife became pregnant. Later, when her months were complete, she gave birth to ten eggs. When the eggs were broken open, out of each egg came a boy, beautiful to behold and handsome, finer than all others. When the boys had grown up, they were brave and very skilled, and they came to delight in killing wild animals. The boys' mother commanded them, "Do not kill wild animals like this." The sons said to their mother, "There is no joy like hunting wild animals. Since our mother will not allow us to kill them, it seems you must hate us."

The mother said, "I do not hate you. Nor is it for lack of love for you that your mother does not let you kill wild animals. It is this: through the evil of taking life, beings suffer in hell for many hundreds of thousands of years. They always come to have the heads of deer, the heads of sheep, the heads of hares and so forth, the heads of every kind of wild animal, and the guardians of hell kill them for countless years. Even if they wish to be freed from that, they are not freed from their evil karma."

The sons said, "If we are to do as you instruct, tell us: did you hear this instruction from someone else, or did you think of it and say it yourself?" She said, "I heard these words from the Buddha." The sons said, "Tell us who this one called the Buddha is."

"Have you not heard? The son of King Śuddhodana, his father, was handsome and fine of body and would have become a wheel-turning king. But not wishing for old age, sickness and death, he went forth, and by cultivating the path he accomplished what he had aspired to. He attained the unsurpassed fruit, and his body, sixteen cubits tall, is fully adorned with the major and minor marks. He possesses the three knowledges and the six superknowledges. His knowledge of what is past is without limit, and his knowledge of what is to come is also without limit; the three times are to him like a fruit placed in the palm of the hand."

When the sons heard this, they were overjoyed and said, "How near or far from here does that Buddha now dwell? May he be seen?" The mother said, "He is now staying at Śrāvastī, and he may be seen." The sons said, "Then we will go to see the Buddha," and when their mother gave her permission, the sons went together to Śrāvastī.

When they arrived there, their grandfather Anāthapiṇḍada saw them and was overjoyed and delighted. He took his grandsons and went to the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta to see the Tathāgata. When the boys saw that the Buddha's marks were a thousand times finer than what they had heard before, they were filled with joy.

Then the Blessed One taught them the Dharma in accordance with their dispositions, and all ten boys at once obtained the pure Dharma eye regarding phenomena. They asked the Buddha to let them go forth, and the Blessed One said, "Boys, have your father and mother given permission?" They said, "We have not yet asked them." He declared, "Until your father and mother have given permission, I do not permit you to go forth."

Then Anāthapiṇḍada said to the Blessed One:

"I am the grandfather of these boys, and I too have authority over my grandsons, so I give them permission to go forth." When he had said this, the Blessed One also gave his permission, and their hair and beards fell away of themselves and they became monks. Because they generated diligence on the path of a monk, all of them became arhats.

The ten monks delighted in one another exceedingly: when they went, they went together, and when they stayed, they stayed together, and all the people of the land were glad and rejoiced in them.

Then Ānanda said to the Blessed One, "What merit did these ten monks make, that they were born into a noble family, are fine in form and appearance, and, having met the Blessed One, have reached the end of suffering?"

The Blessed One declared to Ānanda: "Long ago, ninety-one eons in the past, a buddha called Protector of All came into the world. Having worked for the benefit of all beings, he passed into nirvāṇa, and his relics were widely distributed and countless stūpas were built. At that time one stūpa had fallen into ruin, and an old woman was repairing it. Ten travelers came there and saw her, and they said to the old woman, 'What work are you doing?' The old woman said, 'This is a stūpa, a support for an object of worship. Repairing it brings exceedingly great merit. Therefore, wishing for the fruit of virtue, I am repairing it.' The young men were overjoyed at what the old woman said and said, 'We too will help.' When the stūpa had been repaired, all ten young men made this aspiration: 'May we be born as the sons of this old woman.'

"Since then, for ninety-one eons, they have been born together among gods and humans and enjoyed happiness, and in three things they have surpassed other people. What are the three? They are fine and beautiful in form, they are honored by all, and they are always long-lived; and throughout all that time they have not fallen into the hells. Now, having met me, they have become free of all dust and stain and have become arhats. The old woman at that time was the girl Sumanā. The ten young men are these ten arhats."

When the Blessed One had said this, some in the great assembly attained stream-entry, once-returning, non-returning and arhatship. Some generated the mind set on unsurpassed awakening and came to abide on the ground of irreversibility. They rejoiced at what the Buddha had said and were delighted.

This is the chapter of the ten sons of the girl Sumanā, the forty-sixth.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time in that land there was a wandering ascetic called Upagupta, upright of mind and clear in thought, learned in the past, the future and the present. He went to where the Blessed One was and said to the Blessed One, "I will go forth." He said, "If, once I have gone forth, I am equal to Śāriputra in wisdom and eloquence, I will go forth; if I am not capable of that much, I will go back home." The Blessed

One declared, "You are not capable of that much," and so the wandering ascetic did not agree to go forth and went back home.

At a later time the Blessed One declared to the great assembly: "When a hundred years have passed after my nirvāṇa, this brahmin will go forth, will possess the six superknowledges and wisdom, and will work for the benefit of beings as numerous as the specks of dust."

Again, just as the Blessed One was passing into nirvāṇa, he declared to Ānanda: "After my nirvāṇa I entrust the whole Sūtra Piṭaka to you. Retain it, and spread it widely." After the Blessed One had passed into nirvāṇa, Ānanda retained the entire Piṭaka of the Dharma.

When Ānanda was about to give up his body, he instructed his attendant Yaśas: "After I have passed away, I entrust all the sūtras to you. Retain them." Having instructed him, he also said this: "In the land of Vārāṇasī there is a householder called Gupta who has a son called Upagupta. Ask for him and have him go forth. After you pass away, entrust the Dharma to him."

After Ānanda had passed away, Yaśas upheld the sacred Dharma and did much for the benefit of beings in the world. Then he went to the town of Vārāṇasī, made friends with that householder, went to his house again and again, and won his confidence. A son was born to the householder, and he was given the name Upagupta. While the boy was still small and had not yet gained his strength, Yaśas asked for him so as to have him go forth, but the householder said, "This is the only son I have, the one I longed for. I think of him as the one who will carry on the family, so it cannot be. If another one is born, then I will give him."

Later, at another time, another son was born, and he was given the name Nantan Kubata. Then Yaśas went there again and asked for the son, and the householder again said, "This elder son has to accomplish the work outside the house. Only if the younger son accomplishes the work inside the house will things go well." He would not give him, and said, "If yet another son comes later, then I will offer him."

Yaśas was one of the arhats possessing the three knowledges and was skilled in the faculties of beings. When he examined those two boys, it did not seem that they had the fortune to go forth, so he let them be without pressing.

Then another son was born to the householder, beautiful in form and lovely to behold. Again Yaśas went to the householder and asked for the son, and the

householder said, "The boy is still small and cannot yet even serve, and since I am poor I cannot spare him. Wait a while; when he has grown, I will give him."

Then, when the boy had grown up and become endowed with wisdom, his father also put wealth and goods into his hands and had him engage in trade.

At a certain time Yaśas himself went to him, taught him the Dharma, and had him apply his mind one-pointedly. He instructed him, "When a virtuous thought arises, set down a white pebble, and when a nonvirtuous thought arises, set down a black pebble, and from time to time count which are more."

Upagupta did as he had been instructed, setting down pebbles as virtuous and nonvirtuous thoughts arose, and counting them. At first the black pebbles were very many and the white very few. Then gradually the white and black became equal. Then, because he did not let go of this attention, there were no black pebbles, only white ones. His virtuous thought was perfected, and he attained the first fruit.

At that time a courtesan of that city sent a maidservant to buy flowers from Upagupta. Upagupta, being honest by nature, gave the maidservant flowers generously, so that she was in no way dissatisfied. The maidservant took the flowers and offered them to her mistress, who was greatly astonished and said to the maidservant, "The price of the flowers you bought before and the price of those bought today are the same. Why were there so few before, and why so many now? Were you cheating me before?"

The maidservant said, "The man who sells flowers today is wonderfully honest, and since he is without guile I got a great many. That man is handsome and beautiful in form, and if my lady were to see him she would be delighted." The courtesan sent for him, but Upagupta would not come there. Though she called him again and again, he would not go.

At that time the courtesan consorted with a prince. Coveting the prince's precious clothes, she secretly killed the prince and hid the body. Then the king searched the houses, and the prince's body was found in the courtesan's house. Her hands and feet were cut off, her ears and nose were cut off as well, and she was tied to a stake and set up in the charnel ground.

Even after all this was done she was still alive, and Upagupta went to her. The courtesan said, "When I was lovely before, you would not come. Now that I have become hideous, why do you come?" Upagupta said, "I have not come here out of desire for your beauty. I have come out of compassion for you."

Having said this, he taught her these four teachings on impermanence: "This body is impure, suffering, empty and without self. When examined one by one, it is not fit to be relied upon. Only fools steeped in delusion are attached to it." When the courtesan heard these teachings, she obtained the pure Dharma eye regarding phenomena. Upagupta attained the fruit of non-returning.

Then Yaśas asked the householder for the young man, saying, "I will have him go forth," and the householder offered him accordingly. Yaśas took him to the monastery and conferred the ten precepts upon him. Then, when he reached twenty years of age, he received full ordination. When he was fully ordained by the formal act consisting of a motion and three proclamations, he became an arhat. He possessed the three knowledges and the six superknowledges, and his speech and eloquence became inexhaustible.

He gathered many people and taught them the Dharma, and at that time Māra, the Evil One, rained down gold coins among the great assembly, so that all the people went after the coins and did not listen to the Dharma. On the following day he gathered a great assembly and taught the Dharma, and Māra, the Evil One, rained down garlands of flowers, so that everyone's mind was disturbed. On the following day he gathered a great assembly and taught the Dharma, and the king of the māras displayed a dark blue elephant from whose mouth came six tusks. On each tusk was a pool, in each pool were seven flowers, and in each flower were seven crystal maidens, and each of these maidens was playing a great deal of music. He showed the elephant walking slowly, its steps upon lotuses, and since all the people watched it, they had no interest in the Dharma.

On the following day he gathered the assembly and taught the Dharma, and the king of the māras conjured up an exceedingly beautiful and lovely young woman coming into the assembly. All the people gazed at her without blinking and forgot to listen to the Dharma. At once Yaśas transformed the conjured woman into a white skeleton. When the many people saw it, then at last everyone listened to the Dharma, and very many attained the fruits.

From the beginning those venerable ones had a dog. Every day, while the Dharma was being taught, it would lower its ears and listen, and when that dog died it was born in the sixth heaven of the gods and sat on the same seat as Māra, the Evil One. The king of the evil māras thought, "This god possesses great qualities and is my equal. I shall examine where he died and was born from to be born here." When he examined it, he saw that he had been born

from a dog, and he thought, "The monk has shamed me and humiliated me."

From afar he saw the venerable one absorbed in samādhi, and he placed a jeweled diadem on the venerable one's head. When the venerable one rose from samādhi and noticed there was a diadem on his head, he wondered who had placed it there, and on examining it he realized that Māra, the Evil One, had placed it there. By the power of his miraculous abilities he summoned Māra, the Evil One, to that place, transformed a dog's carcass into a garland for the head, and said to Māra, the Evil One, "In return for your giving me a diadem, I give you a garland. Accept it." Māra, the Evil One, took it, put on the garland, and went back.

When he reached his abode and examined it, he saw that the garland placed on his head was a dog's carcass. Not wanting it, he tried to throw it off, but though he exerted all the might and power he had, he could not throw it off. Then he went to Śakra and said, "Throw off this filth!" Śakra said, "Only the one who did this can throw it off. I do not have the power to throw it off." Māra, the Evil One, said to all the gods, up to Brahmā, the king, "Throw off this filth of mine!" but they said the same as before: "We do not have the power to throw it off." There being nothing he could do, he came back to the venerable one and said this:

"The Buddha, the Blessed One, truly possesses great qualities: his loving mind was never one-sided. You śrāvakas are terrifying.

How is this evident? Long ago I, with an army of eight hundred thousand pretas and more, surrounded the bodhisattva and assailed him in order to make him fall away from awakening, yet he still felt compassion and did not regard me as an enemy. I played only a small prank on you, and you have repaid it like this."

Upagupta said, "What you say is true. If you compare the Buddha with me, I am not fit to serve as a comparison even a hundredfold or a thousandfold. It is like comparing Mount Meru with a white mustard seed, or the great ocean with the water in a cow's hoofprint, or the lion king with a fox: the difference in greatness cannot even be measured. I was born at the end of a degenerate age and never saw the Tathāgata. I have heard that by your magical power you are able to transform yourself into the form of the Buddha. Show it so that I may see it; I wish to behold it."

Māra said, "I will transform myself to look like him, but you must not bow down to me."

He said, "I will not bow down."

Then Māra, the king, transformed himself into the form of the Buddha: a great body sixteen cubits tall, golden in color, adorned with the thirty-two major marks and the eighty excellent minor marks, its rays of light brilliant and blazing, a manifestation surpassing even the sun and the moon. Upagupta was overjoyed and was about to bow down, when Māra, the king, changed back into Māra's body and said to Upagupta, "Venerable one, since you agreed not to bow down, why are you bowing?"

Upagupta said, "I am bowing to the Buddha; I am not bowing to you."

Māra, the king, said, "Venerable one, out of kindness to me, please take away this dog's carcass!"

Upagupta said, "Give rise to a mind of compassion and become a refuge for all sentient beings, and the dog's carcass will turn into a garland of jewels. If a nonvirtuous, evil thought arises in you, it will turn back into nothing but a dog's carcass." When he had said this, Māra, the king, was frightened, and from then on he always gave rise to virtuous thoughts.

After the venerable Upagupta had attained the fruit, he trained sentient beings, and the number whom he brought to attain the four fruits was this: each person who attained a fruit made one counting stick four finger-widths long, and with such counting sticks a house sixty cubits high and sixty cubits wide on each side was entirely filled.

Then the whole multitude praised and extolled him, saying, "Your qualities are vast, and the number of sentient beings you have trained is beyond measure."

Upagupta said, "Even when I was an animal I trained sentient beings and brought them to attain the noble fruit; so what need is there to speak of training them in the present time?"

The great assembly said, "Please tell us how you trained sentient beings in the past."

Upagupta said, "Long ago, in times past, five hundred pratyekabuddhas lived here at Vārāṇasī, on the hill of Ṛṣipatana. At that time a monkey made offerings to them every day and watched their conduct. Later those pratyekabuddhas went elsewhere, and about five hundred wandering ascetics came to live there. Some of those wandering ascetics worshiped the sun and the moon, and some worshiped the god of fire (Agni). Those who worshiped

the sun and the moon stood on one foot facing the sun and the moon. The fire worshipers blew on the fire early every morning. Then the monkey, with one hand, took hold of those who were standing by the raised foot and pulled it down, and it put out the fire of those who were blowing on it; then it sat with its body upright and turned its mind to contemplation.

"Then those wandering ascetics said to one another, 'What this monkey means is, "You too should adopt conduct like this." Let each of us also straighten his body upright and examine the meaning.' As soon as they had done so, they understood and realized it in their minds, and they became pratyekabuddhas. The monkey at that time, on that occasion, is now I myself."

The assembly said, "Then why were you born in the body of a monkey?"

Upagupta said, "Ninety eons ago, in the past, the Buddha Vipaśyin came into the world, and his monks lived at Vārāṇasī, on the hill of Ṛṣipatana. At that time a monk who had attained the fruit went quickly up to the summit of the hill, and a young monk said of him, 'That monk is as quick as a monkey.' Because of that cause and that condition he became a monkey for five hundred births. Therefore the four assemblies fully restrain their speech and do not say what is needless."

When Upagupta taught this Dharma, some of the great assembly attained the fruit of a stream-enterer, of a once-returner, of a non-returner, and of an arhat. Some generated roots of virtue toward becoming pratyekabuddhas. Those who resolved on awakening and became irreversible were also beyond measure. They rejoiced in what had been said and were delighted.

This is the chapter on Upagupta, the forty-seventh.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying in the land of Vārāṇasī. At that time, in a grove with a grassy meadow, the Blessed One was teaching the sublime Dharma to gods, humans and the fourfold assembly. At that time about five hundred geese were flying in the sky above. Hearing the sweet voice of the Blessed One, they were delighted and filled with devotion, and they circled in the sky, wishing to alight before the Blessed One. At that time some hunters had spread a bird net in that place; the five hundred or so geese were caught in the net, and the hunters killed them. All of them were born in the realm of the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, appearing on the laps of their fathers and mothers as children about eight years old, of fine form and lovely to look upon, lighting up everything around with their radiance, shining and pure like a mountain of gold. They thought, "Through

what condition were we born as gods?" and they remembered their former existence. Knowing that they had been born as gods through hearing the sound of the Dharma being taught, they descended at once from the sky, carrying divine flowers, incense and other offerings, and came to the place in Vārāṇasī, in Jambudvīpa, where the Blessed One was staying.

With their divine light they made the whole place where the Blessed One was staying shine like jewels, and all together they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One. Joining their palms, they made this request: "Merely by hearing the voice of the Blessed One teaching the Dharma, we were born in a sublime abode of the gods. Now, out of kindness to us, please teach us the sublime Dharma once more." When they had requested this, the Blessed One taught the Dharma of the Four Noble Truths. Those gods understood it and attained the fruit of stream-entry. From then on they would no longer fall into the three lower realms; they went back to the realm of the gods, and within seven births all their defilements were exhausted.

Then Ānanda said to the Blessed One, "Please tell us where those gods came from who last night lit up everything with their rays of light and came to bow at the feet of the Blessed One."

The Blessed One said, "Listen well and keep it in mind, and I shall explain. When I was teaching the Dharma to the fourfold assembly of gods and humans in a certain grove, about five hundred geese felt faith in the sound of the Dharma being taught. They felt joy toward me and were coming toward me, but before they reached me they were caught by hunters and all were killed. Through their mind of faith in the sound of the Dharma they were born in the realm of the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, and, remembering their former existence, they came to bow to me."

When Ānanda heard what the Blessed One had said, he was overjoyed, delighted and pleased, and he praised it, saying, "How wondrous and marvelous!" Then he said this: "The coming of the Blessed One into the world is wondrous and marvelous: there is no one who is not satisfied by the rain of the Dharma. If even lowly beings, such as those born as animals, gain merit by hearing the Dharma, what need is there to speak of humans? The fruit of the merit of those who retain it with a mind of faith is greater by a hundredfold and a thousandfold; it is beyond comparison."

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "Excellent, excellent! As you have said, the coming of a Blessed One into the world serves the benefit and happiness of all.

He lets fall the rain of nectar everywhere and satisfies many beings. Therefore, apply yourself with a one-pointed mind to the teaching of the Buddha."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, Ānanda and the great assembly rejoiced and were delighted.

This is the chapter on the five hundred geese who were born as gods, the forty-eighth.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Rājagṛha, on Vulture Peak Mountain. At that time Devadatta, who constantly harbored ill will toward the Blessed One, wanted to do away with the Tathāgata and proclaim that he, Devadatta, was the Buddha. So he incited Prince Ajātaśatru to kill his father, saying, "It would be good if a new buddha and a new king governed the realm." Prince Ajātaśatru listened to him, killed his father, and took the throne himself.

At that time the people of the land came to feel ill will toward all the monks and did not even want to see them. Then, on another occasion, when the monks went into the town to beg for alms, the people were angry and would not even speak to them. The monks returned with empty begging bowls, went to Vulture Peak Mountain, and said this to the Blessed One: "Because Devadatta has committed evil, nonvirtuous deeds, all the patrons have come to feel ill will toward the monks."

When they had said this, the Blessed One spoke these words to Ānanda: "Whatever sentient being feels ill will toward a monk who wears saffron robes, that person feels ill will toward the buddhas, pratyekabuddhas and arhats of the past, and feels ill will toward the buddhas, pratyekabuddhas and arhats of the future. Know that he feels ill will toward the buddhas, pratyekabuddhas and arhats who are present now. Because he thus feels ill will toward the noble ones of the three times, the immeasurable results of evil and blameworthy deeds will ripen.

"Why is that? The saffron Dharma robe is the victory banner of the noble ones of the three times. Whatever sentient being shaves off his hair and beard and wears dyed robes will before long have his mind completely freed from all suffering, will attain undefiled wisdom, and will become a protector, a refuge and an ally for all beings. Whatever sentient being gives rise to a mind of faith toward one who has gone forth and wears the dyed Dharma robe will attain immeasurable merit. Ānanda, I too in the past felt faith toward one who had gone forth and wore the dyed Dharma robe, and because I showed him

reverence I attained complete awakening."

Ānanda said, "Please tell us how the Blessed One in the past showed reverence to one who had gone forth and wore the dyed Dharma robe. We wish to hear it."

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "Listen very well and keep it in mind, and I shall explain it to you. Ānanda, countless, immeasurable eons ago in the past, there was here in Jambudvīpa a great king called Debyi, who ruled over some eighty-four thousand minor kings. At that time the Dharma of the Buddha did not exist in the world, but there were pratyekabuddhas living in the mountains and groves, who traveled through the sky and worked for the benefit of sentient beings. At that time the wild animals served and honored them.

"There lived there a lion called Firm Vow, the hair of whose body was like the color of gold and gleamed brightly. For food it ate fruits and roots; it did not kill living beings. At that time a hunter saw it and was overjoyed, thinking, 'Now I shall find happiness! If I kill this lion and present its skin to the king, I will certainly be rid of my poverty.' On another occasion he shaved his head, put on a Dharma robe, tucked his bow and arrows under his arm, and went to where the lion was. At that time the lion was lying asleep, and the hunter shot it with a poisoned arrow. The lion woke up and was about to spring at the hunter, but seeing that he wore a Dharma robe, it thought, 'A man such as this does not remain long in the world; before long he will be completely freed from all suffering.'

"Why is that? This dyed Dharma robe is the victory banner of the noble ones of the past, the future and the present. If I harm him, I will be harboring ill will toward the noble ones of the three times." Thinking this, it gave up the intention to kill. Overcome by the poisoned arrow, at the point where body and life were parting, it spoke these words: "ya la la ba śa sa svāhā." At the words it spoke, all of heaven and earth shook, and rain fell from a cloudless sky. When the gods looked with their divine eyes, they saw that here in this world a hunter had killed a bodhisattva who had taken the form of a lion, and divine flowers fell like rain from the sky above, making offerings to the lion's corpse.

"Then the hunter flayed the lion's skin, came home, and presented it to King Debyi, asking for a reward. The king thought, 'In the writings and treatises it says that any animal whose fur is the color of gold is certainly a bodhisattva, a great being. Why then should I give a reward to this hunter? If I give it, I will be no different from the one who killed it.' When the hunter pressed him again,

the king gave him a small amount and spoke to the hunter thus: 'When you killed this lion, did something extraordinary happen, or what omens appeared?' Asked this, the hunter said, 'From its mouth it spoke these eight syllables, and heaven and earth shook, rain fell from a cloudless sky, and the gods let flowers fall.'

"When the king heard him say this, he was deeply displeased, and, filled with faith, he gathered all his ministers and the learned and wise elders of former generations. When they examined the words the lion had spoken, not a single one could understand them. In a secluded place there lived a learned and knowledgeable sage called Śama. The king invited that sage and asked him, and the sage explained thus: 'The meaning of what is called ya la la is this: it says that those alone who shave their heads and wear the dyed Dharma robe are swiftly freed from birth and death. The meaning of what is called ba śa sa is this: it says that all who shave their heads and wear the dyed Dharma robe bear the mark of the noble ones, and are close to nirvāṇa. The meaning of what is called svāhā is this: if they shave their heads and wear the dyed Dharma robe, they should be honored by all, gods, humans and the whole world.'

"When the sage had said this, the king was overjoyed. He gathered the eighty-four thousand minor kings and the many others, and with a tall chariot made of the seven precious substances, he placed the lion's skin on top of it so that everyone could see it, and had them make offerings to it with incense and flowers and bow before it. Then he had a golden casket made, placed the lion's skin inside it, and built a stūpa. At that time all those many people who thought virtuously were born, after their deaths, as gods in the higher realms.

"Ānanda, at that time, on that occasion, because that lion gave rise to a virtuous mind toward a man wearing the dyed Dharma robe, for a hundred thousand eons he became a wheel-turning king and gave happiness to all sentient beings; having increased his meritorious deeds, he attained complete awakening. Do not think that the lion Firm Vow at that time, on that occasion, was someone else: he is now I myself. At that time, on that occasion, because King Debyi made offerings to the lion's skin, for a hundred thousand eons he was supreme among gods and humans and did every kind of virtue: he is the bodhisattva Maitreya. At that time, on that occasion, the sage was Śāriputra. The hunter was Devadatta."

Then, when the great assembly heard the Blessed One say this, they were overjoyed and said this: "Not knowing them to be noble ones, we harbored ill will. So that, out of the Tathāgata's kindness to us, it may not become an evil deed, we confess it with remorse." When they had said this, the Blessed One, with great compassion, taught the Dharma of the Four Noble Truths. In accordance with their former causes they obtained the fruits: some attained stream-entry, once-returning, non-returning and arhatship, and some resolved on unsurpassed awakening. Ānanda and the great fourfold assembly were delighted and rejoiced in what the Blessed One had said.

This is the chapter called the lion Firm Vow, the forty-ninth.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Rājagṛha, on Vulture Peak Mountain. At that time, not far from the city, there was a filthy pool of water, where many people threw their excrement and urine and all kinds of filth. Within that pool there was a great creature like a snake, with four feet. It ran about in the water; sometimes it came out, and sometimes it went along on top of the water. It lived there for many years and experienced immeasurable suffering.

On another occasion the Blessed One, surrounded by many monks arrayed before him, went to the edge of that pool. Seeing the creature, he said, "Which of you knows the former cause of this creature?" The monks thought about it, but not one of them could understand what that creature had done in the past, and they said, "None of us knows anything about it."

The Blessed One said, "Listen well and keep it in mind, and I shall explain the former cause of this creature. Long ago in the past, a buddha called Vipaśyin came into the world, worked for the benefit of sentient beings, and passed into nirvāṇa. Within the teaching of that buddha, ten thousand monks practiced the pure conduct of Brahmā, practicing it in complete purity. They lived on a mountain of hermitages, a most delightful place, where to the right and the left flowering trees and fruit trees grew in abundance, and between the trees there were springs and bathing pools. At that time the monks strove at their conduct and applied themselves diligently, so that all of them attained the fruits, from the first fruit up to the fourth, and there were no ordinary beings among them.

"On another occasion about five hundred merchants were setting out to the ocean to obtain jewels. Taking a turn on their way, they came to that mountain, and seeing how intensely the monks strove at their practice, the

merchants consulted together and thought to make an offering. But because there were many patrons, they found no opportunity. Unable to do as they had intended, they bowed to the Saṅgha in leave-taking before setting out to the ocean, and said this: 'If we return safely, without mishap, we will make an offering.' The Saṅgha said nothing, and the merchants set out on the ocean.

"Those merchants found many jewels in the ocean and returned safely, and to that Saṅgha they presented a supreme and very precious jewel, as a provision for the Saṅgha's alms food. The Saṅgha accepted it and entrusted it to a monk who was the steward. Later, when the Saṅgha came to be short of alms food, they thought to use the jewel for alms food, and they instructed the steward monk, 'Bring the jewel the merchants presented.' That monk said, 'The merchants gave the jewel to me alone; they did not give it to all of you.' The Saṅgha told that monk, 'The merchants presented that jewel to the Saṅgha and had you keep it safe; they did not give it to you.' The monk became angry and said, 'Will you eat excrement? Do not say the jewel is anything but mine!' Then the members of the Saṅgha, seeing that the monk was angry and had given rise to ill will, dispersed each his own way.

"Because he thus spoke harsh words to the Saṅgha with ill will, when his body broke up and he died, he fell into the great hell of beings called Avīci, and for ninety-one eons he wallowed in filth. Released from there, he has now been born here in this pit of filth, and although many years have passed, he is not yet free.

"Thus, in the past, the Buddha Śikhin too came here with the Saṅgha of monks and showed him to his disciples, explaining what had caused his state. After that the Buddha Protector of All also came here with the Saṅgha of monks and explained what had caused his state. Then, when he died, he was born again in the hells, and after countless tens of thousands of years had passed he was later born again in this pit. After that the Buddha Krakucchanda also came here with the Saṅgha of monks and told his past story. After that the Buddha Kanakamuni also came here. After that the Buddha Kāśyapa also came here with his disciples and told his past story. Now I, the Buddha Śākyamuni, the last of the seven buddhas, have also shown you this creature here. In the same way, the thousand buddhas of the Fortunate Eon will come here with their disciples and tell the story of what this creature did in the past."

When the monks heard what the Blessed One had said, the hairs of their bodies all stood on end, and each of them guarded his actions of body, speech

and mind with great care. The great assembly rejoiced in what the Blessed One had said and were delighted.

This is the chapter telling the story of the creature, the fiftieth.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time the venerable Śāriputra, three times each day and night, would look with his divine eye to see which sentient beings had the good fortune to be trained, and he would go wherever there was one fit to be trained.

On another occasion some merchants who were going to another country to trade took a dog with them. On the way the dog stole a merchant's meat, and the merchant, enraged, broke the dog's legs, abandoned it in an empty wilderness and went on. Then Śāriputra, looking with his divine eye, saw that the dog was starving. He put on his Dharma robe, took up his begging bowl, and went begging for alms; at once he flew through the sky and went to the dog's side, and gave rise to a mind of love and tender compassion. He fed the dog with the food. Having eaten the food, the dog was overjoyed, and Śāriputra taught the sublime Dharma to the dog. Then the dog died and was born in Śrāvastī as the son of a brahmin.

On another occasion Śāriputra went alone on his alms round and arrived at the brahmin's door. The brahmin said to Śāriputra, "Why do you go about alone? Have you no novice?" Śāriputra said, "I have no novice, so I go about alone. They say you have a son. Could you give him to me, or not?" The brahmin said, "I have one called Kyunte. He is still young and small and cannot do anything, so I will give him when he has grown up." When Śāriputra heard him say this, he kept it in mind and went back to the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta.

When seven years had passed, he went again to the brahmin's house and asked the brahmin for his son, and the brahmin gave him to Śāriputra. Śāriputra took the boy and led him to the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta. He made him a novice, and when he taught him the sublime Dharma in its many forms, the boy's mind was liberated, he became an arhat, and he came to possess the six superknowledges and every good quality.

On another occasion, when the novice Kyunte examined with the power of his wisdom what he had done in his former life to obtain this body, meet his preceptor and attain the fruit, he saw and realized that in his previous life he had been a starving dog, and that through the kindness of his preceptor Śāriputra he had obtained a human body and attained the fruit. Overjoyed, he

thought, "Through the kindness of this preceptor I have been freed from suffering. Now, for as long as I live, I shall remain a novice and not take full ordination, so that I may serve my preceptor."

Then Ānanda said to the Blessed One, "What evil deed did this novice commit in times past, that he came to have the body of a dog? And what root of virtue did he plant, that he came to be liberated?"

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "Long ago in the past, in the time of the Buddha Kāśyapa, some monks were living together. Among them was a young monk with a beautiful voice, and when he chanted praises and melodies, everyone delighted to hear him. At that time there was also an old monk whose voice was not beautiful, yet he too chanted praises and verses with melody. That old monk was an arhat, possessed of all the qualities of a renunciant.

"On another occasion the young monk with the beautiful voice spoke words of contempt to the old monk whose voice was not beautiful: 'Your chanting is like a dog howling in pain.' Then the old monk asked the young monk, 'Do you know me?' He replied, 'I know you: you are an elder monk of the Buddha Kāśyapa.' The old monk said, 'I am an arhat, possessed of the qualities of a renunciant.' At this the young monk was terrified, and with remorse he confessed his fault to him. Although the old monk accepted his confession, because of the harsh words he had spoken he was born as a dog for five hundred births in succession. Because he had gone forth and kept moral discipline, he has met me here and come to be liberated."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, Ānanda and the great assembly rejoiced and were delighted.

This is the chapter on the novice Kyunte, the fifty-first.

The Sūtra called the Wise and the Foolish is complete.

It appears to have been translated from Chinese.

Translator's Notes

• "The place of complete victory" renders dkyil 'khor rnam par rgyal ba, evidently the site of awakening (bodhimaṇḍa) in Magadha. The king's name Excellent Color (kha dog dam pa) and the being called the Reliever (ngal bso po), who takes the form of a yakṣa to test the king, are translated literally, as their Sanskrit forms could not be identified with confidence; in the parallel Chinese version the tester is Śakra. Kanaśinipali is a Tibetan transliteration, given as spelled. In the sentence "why now abandon," the Tibetan reads ji srid du ("as long as"), which

makes little sense here; it has been read as a question ("why") as the context requires.
• The brahmins Leuduci and Leunguchu and King Byinglinggarli are Tibetan sound-spellings, apparently of the Chinese forms of the names (this sūtra was translated into Tibetan from Chinese); they are given as spelled since their Sanskrit forms cannot be fixed with confidence. "An elephant that could travel a hundred thousand leagues" renders ban glang rgyang grags brgya stong du phyin pa; the exact sense of ban glang is uncertain.
• The crown prince's name Damgam is given as the Tibetan spells it, apparently a sound-spelling of a Chinese form; its Sanskrit original cannot be fixed with confidence.
• The queen mother is called lha mdzes, literally "Beautiful Goddess"; as the Bodhisattva's mother she is identified as Queen Māyā, as in the parallel version. The sixth line of the verse is terse and literally reads "for others too, a dharma in accord with oneself"; it is rendered closely.
• The name of King Śibi's palace, de ba brta, is given as the Tibetan spells it, Devabarta; its Sanskrit original is uncertain. Śakra's "loss of the five excellences of his body" refers to the signs of decline that mark the approaching death of a god.
• The sentences from "The King Śibi of that time" to "pass into nirvāṇa" use humble speech addressed to the Blessed One and are taken as the close of Brahmā's narration of the former-life stories, followed by the narrative frame describing his praise. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is an unusual form blending the terms for once-returner and non-returner; it has been rendered as "the state of no return" (anāgāmin), but "once-returner" is possible. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as the low-caste executioners leading the terrified sons; the syntax is loose. The prince's name □□□□□□□□□ is Mahādeva as a personal name here, not the god Śiva. The prince names follow the parallel tigress story (Mahāpraṇāda, Mahādeva, Mahāsattva).
• The name of the middle son, □□□□□□□□□□, is a phonetic transcription that I could not identify with confidence; it has been given as spelled, Vamisutra (it may stand for a name such as Vasumitra). The repeated □□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□ is treated as a duplication and rendered once. □□□□□□□□ is taken here as the five realms of rebirth, not tantras. The identifications name only the cubs, not the tigress, as the text has it.
• □□□□□ is rendered "apple", its usual sense. □□□□□□□□□□ is taken as the non-Buddhist wandering ascetic (parivrājaka), which fits the wife's objection to "another teacher's" precepts. In the king's command to the minister, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□, "I will not allow you not to find it."
• □□□□□□ is obscure; from context it is rendered "fell on hard times". □□□□□□□ in the closing of the fourth story is taken in the sense of the arhat's awakening mentioned earlier.
• □□□□□□□□□□ in the list of hell torments makes little sense as written ("human chariots"); it is read as □□□□□□□□□□, "chariots of fire". □□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□□ are rendered loosely as "molten metal" and "vile filth". □□□□□□□□□ is taken as the goddess of good fortune (Śrī).
• "Parted from the five qualities" (yon tan lnga dang bral) refers to a god's loss of his divine qualities or pleasures as death approaches, akin to the signs of a god's impending death. The phrase ram bu btegs, rendered "took up the refrain," is uncertain; it seems to mean that the man joined in or answered the women's song loudly. "Unharmed" renders mnyes par, literally "pleasantly," describing his safe return from the water.
• The queen's name is written Barli in this Tibetan; it is taken here as the Tibetan form of Mallikā, Prasenajit's chief queen, who is the mother in parallel versions of this story. The Tibetan rje'u rigs is rendered "vaiśya class."
• The words immediately describing the householder (khyim a ro / khong khro 'dra langs gi med la / bdag des) are garbled as written; they are taken as "the householder, who had no anger in him," reading khong khro ... med for "without anger" and bdag des as the end of khyim bdag des. The phrase kun gyis te, rendered "with the others," is unclear.
• The names Golden Treasure (gser dbyig) and Divine Flower (lha'i me tog) are translated by

meaning, as their Sanskrit forms cannot be identified with confidence. The text places the buddha Kanakamuni ninety-one eons ago, and that is kept as written.
• The names Divine Flower (lha'i me tog) and Divine Jewel (lha'i rin chen) are translated by meaning, as their Sanskrit forms cannot be identified with confidence.
• The sage's name, literally "Patient One," is given in English because the Tibetan here is not the usual rendering of Kṣāntivādin, the figure in the well-known version of this story; the English also keeps the wordplay of his answers "I am the Patient One." King rtsod byung ("Arising of Strife") is taken as Kali (Kalirāja), the king in the Kṣāntivādin story. Chu bo 'od srung is taken as Nadīkāśyapa ("River Kāśyapa"), one of the three Kāśyapa brothers, whose group together made up the thousand monks. "From a place where they could not be seen" translates bden pa mi snang ba'i gnas, which literally reads "a place where truth does not appear"; it may mean a hidden spot.
• King byams pa'i stobs is given as Maitrībala, the usual Sanskrit name of this jātaka king. rDzogs byed is taken as Pūraṇa (Pūraṇa Kāśyapa), the first of the six non-Buddhist teachers. "He was obstructed by wrong views" reads glags pa as bgags pa ("blocked"); as written the word is unclear here.
• The other five of the six teachers are identified as follows: phyugs lhas kyi bu ma ska ri as Maskarin Gośālīputra, rnam par smra ba'i bu kun nas rgyal ba as Sañjayin Vairaṭṭīputra, skra'i lwa ba can mi pham pa as Ajita Keśakambala, kA tyA ya na nog can as Kakuda Kātyāyana, and gnyen gyi bu gcer bu pa as Nirgrantha Jñātiputra. "Miracles of superhuman qualities" translates mi'i bla ma'i chos kyi cho 'phrul (Skt. uttaramanuṣyadharma prātihārya).
• Several names here are transcriptions that cannot be identified with confidence, so they are written as the Tibetan spells them: the land Vargi (war gyi, perhaps Vṛji), its king Śuncida (shun tsi da), the land Tikicaśiri (ti ki tsa shi ri), and its king Indravami (in dra ba mi, perhaps Indravarman). The king of Kauśāmbī is spelled Udrayana here (u dra ya na), not the usual Udayana. "Eighty thousand" renders stong phrag brgyad khri, which is irregular as written.
• "Tooth stick" takes phyag dar, which usually means "sweeping," as the tooth stick (Skt. dantakāṣṭha) that the next sentence calls tshems shing.
• Two of the lotus kinds are uncertain: □□□□□□□ is taken as an orange-red or vermilion color, and □□□□□□ is rendered tentatively as "butter-colored." The word □□□ in the description of the lotus fragrance is read as □□, "fragrance, scent," which fits the context.
• The householder □□□□□ is a transliterated name that I cannot identify with confidence; it is given as "Cinda" following the Tibetan spelling.
• The king's name □□□□□□□□□□□□ is half translation, half transcription; it is taken as Rathanemi ("chariot" plus "nemi," rim), which is likely but not certain. The queen's name □□□□□□□□□ is a transcription I cannot identify with confidence and is kept as "Sulipala." □□□□□□□□□□ is rendered Prajñāprabha, with its meaning "Light of Wisdom."
• The names of the two kings, □□□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□□, are transcriptions I cannot identify with confidence and are given as spelled, Mahāśakuli and Liśipaca. The prince's name □□□□□□□□ is translated by its meaning, "Stump," since no Sanskrit original can be identified with confidence. □□□□□, "soldier," in the description of the bridegroom is read as □□□□, "bridegroom," which the context plainly requires; and □□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□.
• The prince's new name □□□□□□□□ is a transcription I cannot identify with confidence and is given as spelled, Sulanśan. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered Prajāpatī, following the Tibetan, even though she is named here as the prince's wife. The number of the six teachers' followers is □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, nine hundred thousand, as the text states here, although an earlier passage gave ninety thousand.
• The pratyekabuddha's name, Drangsong Ri, is rendered literally as "Sage Mountain"; no Sanskrit form could be identified with confidence. The coin the oil presser says the pratyekabuddha cannot earn is a zho, a small unit of weight and money. The Buddha's illness,

bser ma'i snyun, is a disorder associated with cold wind; "chill ailment" is an approximation. The "measures" are srang, a unit of weight (tael). In the list of fruits, phyir mi ldog pa stands for the non-returner, while phyir mi ldog pa'i sa is the irreversible ground of bodhisattvas.

• The beast's name, Kunta, is a phonetic form in the Tibetan; it is kept as written, since its Sanskrit original could not be identified with certainty. The verb bsngo in "constantly reviles the Blessed One" is read in its colloquial sense "to scold, revile" rather than "to dedicate."

• The householder's name, dpal skyes, is given as Śrījāta, the regular Sanskrit equivalent of the Tibetan, though the Indic original of this name in this story is not certain. In the list of fruits, phyir ldog pa stands for the once-returner and phyir mi ldog pa for the non-returner.

• The bandit named Asika is kept as the Tibetan spells it; his Sanskrit identity is uncertain. The "sweeper who throws away filth" is taken as a separate person from Upāli, the former barber.

• The disciple named Nabun is kept in the Tibetan form; his Sanskrit identity could not be established with confidence.

• The husband's name, sar phag chen po, is not securely identifiable; it may be a phonetic rendering of an Indian word such as sārtha (caravan) and is given here in phonetic form as "Great Sarphak". The cold hell chab brom is likewise not a standard name and is given phonetically as "Chabdrom". The phrase de'u re bral in Śrījāta's thought is obscure; it is taken as "lest I become separated". The first question about who delights to be born in the hells has no named speaker in the Tibetan.

• The monk's name □□□□ is not securely identifiable and is given phonetically as "Lita". The king's name □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as Dharmodgata, its usual Sanskrit equivalent. The maidservant's phrase dge slong gis ma yogs pa'i lhag ma is obscure; it is taken as "the leftovers the monk has not finished".

• In the monk's reply, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as "may you be purified," answering the young monks' confession (mthol tshangs), not as the god Brahmā. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□ is taken as the usual five-point prostration (lus kyi yan lag lnga).

• The country name □□□□ is given phonetically as "Anta"; its Indian identification is uncertain. Here □□□□□□□ is the substance vajra (the ocean's floor and rim), not a personal name. The phrase "in four ways" introduces the four kinds of monks compared to mangoes.

• The word □□□□□□□, the substance with which the feast seal is stamped on the wrist, is not identified; from the story it is something sweet, and it is kept as "keule". The brahmin who licks off the seal is then called a wandering ascetic (kun tu rgyu, parivrājaka), as in the Tibetan.

• The examples the novice recalls allude to well-known stories of monks who kept their precepts at the cost of life, among them the monks bound with grass by bandits, the monk who saw a goose swallow a jewel and kept silent though suspected and beaten, and the monk who gave his plank to a senior monk in a shipwreck. The word rendered "goose" (bya gag) denotes a goose or similar waterbird. The bones (rus bu) of the novice are rendered "remains," since the body has just died.

• The name of the limbless boy, ma 'ji byi la, could not be identified with a Sanskrit form and has no clear meaning in Tibetan; it is given as a phonetic rendering, Majibila. In the wife's speech, nor ba dag is read as nor bdag, "heir, master of the wealth," as the context plainly requires. The brothers' names, sbyin pa and tshul khrims, are rendered by their meanings, Generosity and Moral Discipline.

• The phrase rendered "stepped forward" (sar 'phags pa) is obscure; it may instead mean that he raised himself up or spoke loudly. The merchant's remark that the other party would not get a single coin "even if he were to become king" is taken literally; it may mean "even if the case went before the king."

• The buddha's name, rendered literally as Merit Protector (bsod skyabs), could not be identified with a Sanskrit form with confidence. The poor woman's name, Ke, is given as written. The nun's name dkar mo, "White One," is rendered Śuklā. The phrase rendered "the

five robes" (chos gos smad lnga) is unusual and may refer to the set of robes of a nun.
• The place name a pa de is taken as Avanti, Mahākātyāyana's home region, where the parallel accounts set this story. In the line about the slave's rebirth, the Tibetan says a goddess (lha'i sras mo) had passed away and the old woman was born in her place, among the five hundred companions of the son of the gods.
• "The teaching on renunciation" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□, read as short for the standard formula's □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ (renunciation), which follows the teaching on impurity in this stock sequence. The well's description □□□□□□□□□□□ is obscure; it is rendered loosely as "square and level." The names Golden God and Golden Light are translated literally, since their Sanskrit forms in this text cannot be identified with confidence.
• The monk's name, □□□□□□□□□□□, is translated literally as "Two Families," since a Sanskrit form cannot be identified with confidence. In □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ the verb is read as □□□□□□□, "please permit." □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, literally "listen constantly," is rendered as the usual exhortation "listen well."
• The novice □□□□□□□ is identified as Cunda, Śāriputra's novice attendant in the canonical accounts of his death; the earlier spelling □□□□□ (rendered "Kunta") may refer to a different figure. The grove □□□□□□□□□ is rendered "the Mango Grove."
• Ānanda's request, literally "in the Blessed One's former life too he died first and afterward [the Blessed One] passed away," is read as referring to Śāriputra dying first. The names of the two queens (Flower Giver, Great Eyes), the prince (Excellent Discipline) and the palace (Good Life) are translated literally, since their Sanskrit forms cannot be identified with confidence. □□□□□□□□□□□ is taken, as in an earlier passage, to mean "square."
• The brahmin's name, spelled □□□□□□□□□ in the Tibetan, is identified as Raudrākṣa, the brahmin who begs King Candraprabha's head in the Indian versions of this story. □□□□□□□□□□□, "wandering ascetics" (parivrājakas), are then addressed as brahmins in the text.
• The princes' plea "Consider that we too are still learning by following you" renders the obscure phrase bdag cag kyang mi'i rjes su bslabs par dgongs; the sense is uncertain. "Leagues" renders the Tibetan dpag tshad (yojana).
• "It would not be borne" renders the unclear thugs mi thub bo in the brahmin's reply. The king's name here is spelled gsal thub rather than the usual gsal rgyal; it is taken as Prasenajit. The minister's name ri dags means "deer" and is given as Mṛga; in parallel versions of this story the minister is known as Mṛgadhara.
• Śirititta is a phonetic rendering of the Tibetan sound-spelling of the place name, which could not be identified with confidence. Balamitra is reconstructed from the Tibetan stobs grogs po ("strength-friend"). The mother's name, lha mtshams ma, could not be identified and is translated literally as "Divine Boundary". "Perished" renders the unusual kha dag.
• The daughter-in-law is here called by the same name as the woman earlier said to be her mother (lha mtshams ma, rendered Divine Boundary); the text is followed as it stands. "The fruit of once-returning" renders lan cig phyir mi ldog pa'i 'bras bu, an unusual blend of the terms for once-returner and non-returner; non-returning may be intended. "The king did not believe it" renders the awkward double negative thugs ma ches pa med pa, taken in the sense required by the minister's renewed insistence.
• The relatives' outcry (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□

• The country □□□□□□□□□□□□ (also □□□□□□) is rendered "Golden Land"; it may correspond to Suvarṇabhūmi, but as it is placed south of Śrāvastī the identification is left open. □□□□□□□ is taken as Kapphiṇa (Mahākapphiṇa for his son, the later disciple). The vassal kings are first numbered □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ (360,000), but those who come as "half" are □□□□□□□□□□□□□ (18,000); both numbers are given as the text has them. Earlier the army is □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ (36,000) battalions.
• "Some attained stream-entry, once-returning or non-returning" renders □□□, an irregular phrase that seems to run together once-returning (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) and non-returning (□□□□□□□□□□□□). Here □□□□□ (□□□□□□□□□□□□, □□□□□□□□□□□, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) means a realm or class of rebirth, not tantra. The new king □□□□□□□□ is kept as Vaiḍūrya, as the Tibetan transcribes him; he corresponds to Prasenajit's son known elsewhere as Virūḍhaka.
• □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as "Upanandā of the group of six" (the notorious group of six nuns); the identification of □□□□□□□□□□□□ with Upanandā is probable but not certain. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is the nun Utpalavarṇā. In "the boy, seeing his mother coming" the phrase □□□□□□□□ is read as "the mother coming," not "not come." Here □□□□□□□ is a short form of Utpalavarṇā's name. In her story Utpalavarṇā speaks of herself with the humble □□□□□, rendered "I."
• "Listen attentively" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, literally "listen constantly," evidently for the usual "listen well." The place □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is Ṛṣipatana (the Deer Park near Vārāṇasī). The short form □□□□□□□ here refers to the nun Utpalavarṇā (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) and is kept as Utpalavarṇā, as in the preceding piece.
• The king's name □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is a Tibetan sound-spelling of an Indic name that cannot be confidently reconstructed; it is given here in simple phonetics as Shudolagarni. The rendering of the buddha's name □□□□□ as Puṣya is a probable identification.
• In the snake story, □□□□□□ is used in its everyday sense of a place being settled or at peace, not the meditative term calm abiding. □□□□□□□□□, the monk who received the gold, is taken as the monk responsible for arranging the community's meals and supplies.
• The wife's name □□□□□ is translated by its meaning, Bliss, as its Sanskrit form cannot be identified with confidence. □□□□□□, the second rākṣasī, is a sound-spelling given in simple phonetics as Alampa. In the closing of the golden vase story, the line "the snake reviled me, and yet I humbled myself toward it" is a plausible reading of a terse sentence that could also mean that the snake humbled itself after reviling.
• The city name □□□□□□□ is a sound-spelling that cannot be identified with confidence and is given in phonetics as Barute. The youth's name □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is translated by its meaning, Great Generosity, in keeping with the rendering Generosity used for this name earlier in the text; its Sanskrit form would be Mahādāna.
• "Those the color of mountain water" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ literally; the class of sea creature meant is not identified. The phrase rendered "it will be over with him at once" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is idiomatic; the sense appears to be that he would die of fasting. The city name □□□□□□ is a sound-spelling that could not be identified with an Indian form and is kept in phonetics. Coral renders □□□□□□□□□□□ (Skt. musāragalva).
• "Mountains that look like the color of water" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) evidently refers to the same hazard rendered in the previous passage as "those the color of mountain water," apparently submerged or water-colored rocks. The bowl he takes in hand (□□□□□□□) is presumably an incense or offering bowl.
• The "three hundred and thirty thousand leagues" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ literally (thirty-three hundred-thousand). In the last two sentences the Tibetan reads "forty leagues" after the first dipping and "eighty leagues" after "dipping twice"; whether the eighty is

cumulative or an additional amount is not stated.
• "A hundred thousand leagues" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ literally; it may simply mean an elephant of enormous range. "A level plain" renders □□□□□□□□, whose first element is unclear; it might also be read as a place name.
• "Lovely Goddess" (□□□□□□□) is rendered literally; the name of the Buddha's mother in this identification could not be confidently identified with a Sanskrit form (the usual name of his mother, Māyā, is rendered differently in Tibetan), and □□ may here be the royal honorific, giving "the lovely queen". "Mirror Face" (□□□□□□□□□□□) is likewise given literally; it may correspond to Sanskrit Ādarśamukha, but this is not certain. The "three wishes" refer to the three conditions Ānanda requested and was granted when he became the Buddha's attendant; the Tibetan does not state the agent of granting. "Ground of non-returning" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, the stage of irreversibility. "League" renders both □□□□□□ (yojana) for the wheel and □□□□□□□□□ (krośa) for the jewel's range.
• The text says twenty thousand pratyekabuddhas came from each of the four directions, but then gives the number honored as forty thousand (□□□□□□□); both numbers are translated as written. The brahmin's name □□□□ is a transliteration whose Sanskrit original is uncertain; it is given as "Hayi". "Good Seeker" (□□□□□□□□) and "Evil Seeker" (□□□□□□□) are translated literally, as their Sanskrit forms could not be confidently identified. "Called upon the gods" renders the uncertain □□□□□□□□. The "nun whose defilements were exhausted" is the arhat nun Utpalavarṇā in the tradition, though she is not named here.
• "Jewel Armor" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□), "Good Purpose" (□□□□□□□) and "Evil Purpose" (□□□□□□□□) are given literally, as their Sanskrit forms could not be confidently identified. In the passage on Jewel Armor's thoughts, the rare phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as "when my life comes to an end". In the opening, □□□□ is read as □□□, "me", as the context requires. The beggars' phrase □□□□□□□□□□ is taken in its literal sense "having held a wedding"; it may instead be a slip for □□□□□□□□□, "through carelessness".
• "Hidden rocks the color of the water" renders the obscure □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, literally "those having the color of mountain and water"; it may instead name a kind of sea creature. "Coral" renders □□□□□□□□□□ (Skt. musāragalva), whose identity is debated (coral, cat's-eye or a kind of shell).
• "The young captain" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□, referring to Good Purpose, who had declared himself captain of the expedition; it could also be read as "the captain's son", but no such son appears in the story. In the old captain's reply, □□□□□□□□□□ is read as "if the king".
• □□□□□□□ is given as Lishiba, a sound-rendering of the country name (Chinese Lishiba in the parallel version of this tale); its Indian form is not securely identifiable. □□□□ is a stringed instrument (the Chinese version has a zheng, a zither); it is kept as "kima". The phrase about the ship (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is rendered literally as going under in some places and coming up in others; it may instead mean that some of the vessels sank.
□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ... □□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read with the younger brother as the one who would not rise, as the following sentence requires.
• □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ in the list of attainments, between stream-entry and arhatship, is taken here as the stage of non-return; it can also mean irreversibility. The sentence about the people of Jambudvīpa (□□□ ...
□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is somewhat compressed; it is read as identifying the people who benefited from the jewel rain with the eighty thousand devaputras and the prophesied disciples. The final sentence breaks off the instruction that continues in the next piece.
• The householder's name □□□□□□□□□□ has been translated by meaning as Harmonizer; its Indian form is not certain (it may correspond to a name such as Sandhāna). The householder □□□□□□□ has likewise been translated by meaning as Sweet Voice. □□□□ is taken as gourds, in which the sown grain was found growing.

• The first of the eight voices (□□□□□) is rendered as a sparrow's; the exact bird is uncertain. The land □□□□□□□□ is kept as spelled, Pukalada; it may stand for Puṣkalāvatī, but this is not certain. The king's name □□□□□□□□□ is translated by meaning as Eye-Opener, since its Sanskrit form cannot be identified with confidence; the vassal king □□□□□□□ and the minister □□□□□□ are kept as sound-renderings. In "it is not right for Your Majesty alone to defy him," the verb □□□□□□ does not here have its usual sense of dedication; the meaning "oppose, set oneself against" is inferred from the context.
• The destination is written pa la da bar ne'i yul; I have rendered it "the land of Dabarne" to match the name used earlier, taking the opening syllables as part of the same place name. The first omen, gnam grum pa, is uncertain and is rendered loosely as the sky seeming to break apart.
• The rival king appears here as pa la dbar ne and pa la da bar; I have kept the short form Dabarne used earlier in the text. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ in the list of fruits is read as non-returner (normally □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□).
• □□□□□□□□□ ("one who does not harm") is rendered Ahiṃsaka, the name of this youth (later Aṅgulimāla) in the Sanskrit tradition.
• "Act of immediate retribution" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ (ānantarya), here matricide. □□□□□□□□□ is taken as a female elephant.
• The king's name □□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered Kṛkī, the king associated with the Buddha Kāśyapa; the final syllable is not reflected. Since a stūpa of earth could not have the dimensions stated, I keep the text's measurements as given.
• The king's name □□□□□□□□ is a phonetic spelling (this sūtra was translated into Tibetan from Chinese); I could not identify the Indian form with confidence (it may reflect Brahmadatta), so it is given as Balamadar. □□□□□□□, "Speckled Feet," is the standard rendering of Kalmāṣapāda, the hero of this well-known tale; the text's own etymology is kept in the translation.
• In the verse, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as "ordinary beings, from first to last" (□□□□□□□ "end and beginning"); the phrase is terse. The four venomous snakes are the traditional image for the four elements of the body. The king's name here is spelled □□□□□□, slightly differently from □□□□□□□□ (Balamadar) in the previous story; it is a different king in a different tale and is given phonetically as Baladar, since the Indian form could not be identified with confidence.
• "A monk who did menial labor" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, literally "who did the work of a person," apparently labor as a worker; the text later calls it "the work of the Saṅgha." In the Buddha's words to Maudgalyāyana, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□

and Vaśicira; I could not securely identify their Sanskrit forms. In the bride's parents' condition, □□□□□ ("army") is read as □□□□ ("son-in-law"), which the context plainly requires. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is obscure; "at nightfall he would come back home" is a contextual rendering.

• The brahmin's name □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ appears to be a transliteration; the parallel Chinese version of this story names him Piṇḍola, and I have used that form, though the Tibetan spelling is irregular. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("Lovely") is rendered Sundara, a plausible but unconfirmed Sanskrit form. □□□□□□□□□□ ("one with a staff") is Daṇḍin, matching the Chinese parallel. Throughout, □□□□□ ("army") is read as □□□□ ("son-in-law"), as the context requires.

• The tree □□□□□□□□ is given as transliterated (śakoṭaka); it is presumably the śākhoṭaka tree (Streblus asper). □□□□□□□□, rendered "was granted land," could also be read more loosely as "was given leave."

• The brahmin's name □□□□□□□ is given as transliterated (Śincira); I could not securely identify its Sanskrit form. "The six teachers" are the six non-Buddhist teachers of the Buddha's time.

• The monk's name □□□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered by its meaning, "Supreme Honey"; the honey-offering monkey's monk is known in Sanskrit sources as Madhuvāsiṣṭha, but the Tibetan does not clearly reflect that form. The householder's name □□□□□□□□□□ and the son's name □□□□□□□□ are given as transcriptions because their Indian forms could not be identified with confidence. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ literally reads "the father of King Prasenajit died"; in context it is taken as the boy's father dying and King Prasenajit installing the boy in his place. □□□□□□□□□□ is taken as the five points of the body (forehead, hands, knees) in prostration.

• The prince's name Vaiḍūrya is the same word as the gem vaiḍūrya (here with □□□□□□□□□, rendered "lapis lazuli"); the gem is translated, the prince's name kept. □□□ is rendered "ounce," a standard weight for gold and precious substances.

• □□□□□□□□□□□□ ("elephant keeper") is rendered Hastipāla, the evident Sanskrit form. The phrase "the two brothers Hastipāla" follows the Tibetan, which introduces a brother without naming him. Ajātaśatru's having killed his father is stated in the future-tinged form □□□□□□ in the Tibetan, but the sense is that he kills even his own father.

• □□□□□□□□ is a red mineral pigment (realgar), rendered "red pigment." Here □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ refers to the monks' meditative practice, not the Yogācāra school.

• The future buddha's name □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ could not be identified with a Sanskrit form and is translated by meaning. The king's name □□□□□ is taken as Bandhumat, the king associated with the buddha Vipaśyin in tradition. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as the set of three robes.

• The father's name, □□□□□□□□, could not be identified with a Sanskrit name with confidence and is translated by its meaning, "Respectful". In the Indian versions of this story of Māndhātṛ, the father is Upoṣadha, but the Tibetan here does not render that name. Mūrdhaja ("Born from the Crown") is the Sanskrit name corresponding to □□□□□□□□□□□□□, the future wheel-turning king known elsewhere as Māndhātṛ.

• Pūrvavideha (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) and Aparagodānīya (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) are the standard eastern and western continents; the shortened forms "Videha" and "Godānīya" in the text are kept. The gods' palace is named □□□□□□□□□□□□, "Delightful"; I have translated the name rather than guess at a Sanskrit form. The number of gates, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, is read as "eleven and a half hundreds", that is 1,150. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("distinguished by the quickness or slowness of the gods") is terse; the parallel tradition says the human king could be told apart because his eyes blinked while the gods' did not, but the Tibetan is translated as it stands. The buddha □□□□□ is a sound-spelling, taken here as Puṣya. The text gives four days for the rain of jewels in the king's summary, although the earlier narrative said seven; both are kept as written.

• The first fruit, second and third are stream-entry, once-returning and non-returning. The daughter's name □□□□□□ is a sound-spelling of Sumanā. The land □□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as Takṣaśilā, as its sound and the Chinese parallel indicate. In the mother's reply, the Tibetan literally reads "your mother does not let you kill wild animals because of not loving you ... but", which contradicts her preceding words; it is understood with the negation carried over ("Nor is it for lack of love"). The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is terse and is rendered as the prince taking leave of the king.
• The attendant □□□□□□□□□ is a sound-spelling; it is taken as Yaśas, the name of Ānanda's disciple in the parallel version of this story, though the Tibetan form is unusual. The second son's name □□□□□□□□□□□□ could not be identified; it mixes a Tibetan word (□□□□□, "earnest") with what looks like a garbled sound-spelling of a "-gupta" name, and it is given as it sounds. The text calls Upagupta a wandering ascetic and then the Buddha calls him "this brahmin"; both are kept. The text gives the first-born son the name Upagupta, although the boy who is finally given is the third; this is translated as it stands. The buddha's name □□□□□□□□□□□□ is translated by its meaning, "Protector of All", as its Sanskrit form is uncertain.
• "The first fruit" is stream-entry. The ten precepts are those of a novice. The "formal act consisting of a motion and three proclamations" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ (jñapticaturtha karman), the procedure of full ordination. The sixth heaven of the gods is Paranirmitavaśavartin, the realm of Māra. In this section of the text it is Yaśas, not Upagupta, who is said to transform Māra's conjured woman into a skeleton, and the "venerable one" crowned by Māra is left unnamed; both are translated as they stand.
• "Sixty cubits high and sixty cubits wide": the Tibetan reads □□□□□□, which is not an evident unit; it is taken here, by parallel with the following □□□□□□□□□□□□ and the sixteen cubits (□□□) of the Buddha's body above, as a slip for a measure of cubits. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as eighty times ten thousand, i.e. eight hundred thousand.
• The king's name □□□□□□ is a sound-spelling whose Sanskrit original I cannot identify with confidence; it is given in simple phonetics as "Debyi". The lion's name □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is translated by meaning as "Firm Vow", since its Sanskrit form cannot be identified with confidence. □□□□□□□□□ is rendered simply as "a certain grove"; the first element is unclear. □□□□□□□ is taken as "last night" (□□□□).
• The lion's eight syllables are a sound-spelling of an obscure Sanskrit-like formula; the text itself glosses each part, so they are left in romanization. The sage's name □□□ is given as a plain romanization, "Śama"; its Sanskrit original cannot be identified with confidence. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as ten times ten thousand, a hundred thousand eons.
• □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is evidently a garbled writing of □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, "will you eat excrement?", and is translated so. The novice's name □□□□□□□ is a sound-spelling; it corresponds to the novice known in the Chinese version as Junti, often identified with Cunda, but this is not certain, so it is given in simple phonetics as Kyunte. The past buddhas are given by their standard identifications: □□□□□□□□□□□ Śikhin, □□□□□□□□□□□□□ Krakucchanda, □□□□□□□□ Kanakamuni; □□□□□□□□□□□□ (Viśvabhū) is kept as "Protector of All" for consistency with earlier pieces.
• □□□□□□□□□□ ("difficult to hear") makes little sense of a beautiful voice; it is read as □□□□□□□□□□, "delighted to hear". In □□□□□□□□□□, □□□□□ is the confession or purification just made (□□□□□□□□), not the god Brahmā.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.